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Chapter 1

Introduction



You must have already been introduced to a study of basic microeconomics. This chapter begins by giving you a simplified account of how macroeconomics differs from the microeconomics that you have known.

Those of you who will choose later to specialise in economics, for your higher studies, will know about the more complex analyses that are used by economists to study macroeconomics today. But the basic questions of the study of macroeconomics would remain the same and you will find that these are actually the broad economic questions that concern all citizens – Will the prices as a whole rise or come down? Is the employment condition of the country as a whole, or of some sectors of the economy, getting better or is it worsening? What would be reasonable indicators to show that the economy is better or worse? What steps, if any, can the State take, or the people ask for, in order to improve the state of the economy? These are the kind of questions that make us think about the health of the country's economy as a whole. These questions are dealt within macroeconomics at different levels of complexity.

In this book you will be introduced to some of the basic principles of macroeconomic analysis. The principles will be stated, as far as possible, in simple language. Sometimes elementary algebra will be used in the treatment for introducing the reader to some rigour.

If we observe the economy of a country as a whole it will appear that the output levels of all the goods and services in the economy have a tendency to move together. For example, if output of food grain is experiencing a growth, it is generally accompanied by a rise in the output level of industrial goods. Within the category of industrial goods also output of different kinds of goods tend to rise or fall simultaneously. Similarly, prices of different goods and services generally have a tendency to rise or fall simultaneously. We can also observe that the employment level in different production units also goes up or down together.

If aggregate output level, price level, or employment level, in the different production units of an economy,

bear close relationship to each other then the task of analysing the entire economy becomes relatively easy. Instead of dealing with the above mentioned variables at individual (disaggregated) levels, we can think of a single good as the representative of all the goods and services produced within the economy. This representative good will have a level of production which will correspond to the average production level of all the goods and services. Similarly, the price or employment level of this representative good will reflect the general price and employment level of the economy.

In macroeconomics we usually simplify the analysis of how the country's total production and the level of employment are related to attributes (called 'variables') like prices, rate of interest, wage rates, profits and so on, by focusing on a single imaginary commodity and what happens to it. We are able to afford this simplification and thus usefully abstain from studying what happens to the many real commodities that actually are bought and sold in the market because we generally see that what happens to the prices, interests, wages and profits etc. for one commodity more or less also happens for the others. Particularly, when these attributes start changing fast, like when prices are going up (in what is called an inflation), or employment and production levels are going down (heading for a depression), the general directions of the movements of these variables for all the individual commodities are usually of the same kind as are seen for the aggregates for the economy as a whole.

We will see below why, sometimes, we also depart from this useful simplification when we realise that the country's economy as a whole may best be seen as composed of distinct sectors. For certain purposes the interdependence of (or even rivalry between) two sectors of the economy (agriculture and industry, for example) or the relationships between sectors (like the household sector, the business sector and government in a democratic set-up) help us understand some things happening to the country's economy much better, than by only looking at the economy as a whole.

While moving away from different goods and focusing on a representative good may be convenient, in the process, we may be overlooking some vital distinctive characteristics of individual goods. For example, production conditions of agricultural and industrial commodities are of a different nature. Or, if we treat a single category of labour as a representative of all kinds of labours, we may be unable to distinguish the labour of the manager of a firm from the labour of the accountant of the firm. So, in many cases, instead of a single representative category of good (or labour, or production technology), we may take a handful of different kinds of goods. For example, three general kinds of commodities may be taken as a representative of all commodities being produced within the economy: agricultural goods, industrial goods and services. These goods may have different production technology and different prices. Macroeconomics also tries to analyse how the individual output levels, prices, and employment levels of these different goods gets determined.

From this discussion here, and your earlier reading of microeconomics, you may have already begun to understand in what

way macroeconomics differs from microeconomics. To recapitulate briefly, in microeconomics, you came across individual 'economic agents' (see box) and the nature of the motivations that drive them. They were 'micro' (meaning 'small') agents – consumers choosing their respective optimum combinations of goods to buy, given their tastes and incomes; and producers trying to make maximum profit out of producing their goods keeping their costs as low as possible and selling at a price as high as they could get in the markets. In other words, microeconomics was a study of individual markets of demand and supply and the 'players', or the decision-makers, were also individuals (buyers or sellers, even companies) who were seen as trying to maximise their profits (as producers or sellers) and their personal satisfaction or welfare levels (as consumers). Even a large company was 'micro' in the sense that it had to act in the interest of its own shareholders which was not necessarily the interest of the country as a whole. For microeconomics the 'macro' (meaning 'large') phenomena affecting the economy as a whole, like inflation or unemployment, were either not mentioned or were taken as given. These were not variables that individual buyers or sellers could change. The nearest that microeconomics got to macroeconomics was when it looked at General Equilibrium, meaning the equilibrium of supply and demand in each market in the economy.

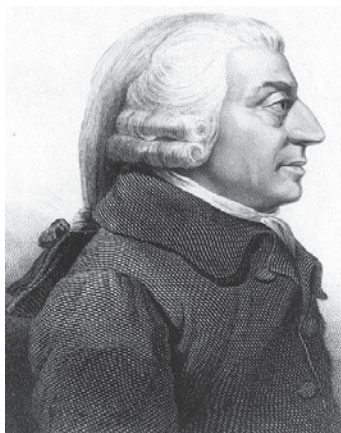
Economic Agents

By economic units or economic agents, we mean those individuals or institutions which take economic decisions. They can be consumers who decide what and how much to consume. They may be producers of goods and services who decide what and how much to produce. They may be entities like the government, corporation, banks which also take different economic decisions like how much to spend, what interest rate to charge on the credits, how much to tax, etc.

Macroeconomics tries to address situations facing the economy as a whole. **Adam Smith**, the founding father of modern economics, had suggested that if the buyers and sellers in each market take their decisions following only their own self-interest, economists will not need to think of the wealth and welfare of the country as a whole separately. But economists gradually discovered that they had to look further.

Economists found that first, in some cases, the markets did not or could not exist. Secondly, in some other cases, the markets existed but failed to produce equilibrium of demand and supply. Thirdly, and most importantly, in a large number of situations society (or the State, or the people as a whole) had decided to pursue certain important social goals unselfishly (in areas like employment, administration, defence, education and health) for which some of the aggregate effects of the microeconomic decisions made by the individual economic agents needed to be modified. For these purposes macroeconomists had to study the effects in the markets of taxation and other budgetary policies, and policies for bringing about changes in money supply, the rate of interest, wages, employment, and output. Macroeconomics has,

Adam Smith



Adam Smith is regarded as the founding father of modern economics (it was known as political economy at that time). He was a Scotsman and a professor at the University of Glasgow. Philosopher by training, his well known work *An Enquiry into the Nature and Cause of the Wealth of Nations* (1776) is regarded as the first major comprehensive book on the subject. The passage from the book, 'It is not from the benevolence of the butcher, the brewer, of the baker, that we expect our dinner, but from their regard to their own interest.

We address ourselves, not to their humanity but to their self-love, and never talk to them of our own necessities but of their advantage' is often cited as an advocacy for free market economy. The Physiocrats of France were prominent thinkers of political economy before Smith.

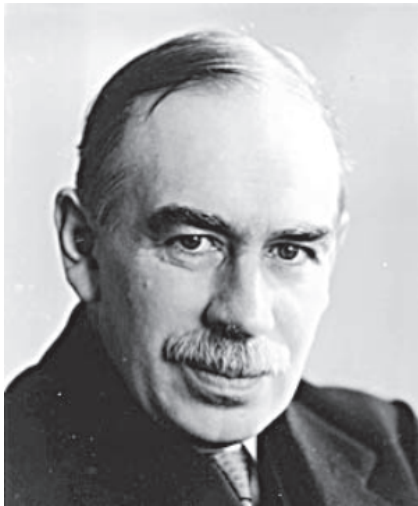
therefore, deep roots in microeconomics because it has to study the aggregate effects of the forces of demand and supply in the markets. However, in addition, it has to deal with policies aimed at also modifying these forces, if necessary, to follow choices made by society outside the markets. In a developing country like India such choices have to be made to remove or reduce unemployment, to improve access to education and primary health care for all, to provide for good administration, to provide sufficiently for the defence of the country and so on. Macroeconomics shows two simple characteristics that are evident in dealing with the situations we have just listed. These are briefly mentioned below.

First, who are the macroeconomic decision makers (or 'players')? Macroeconomic policies are pursued by the State itself or statutory bodies like the Reserve Bank of India (RBI), Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) and similar institutions. Typically, each such body will have one or more public goals to pursue as defined by law or the Constitution of India itself. These goals are not those of individual economic agents maximising their private profit or welfare. Thus the macroeconomic agents are basically different from the individual decision-makers.

Secondly, what do the macroeconomic decision-makers try to do? Obviously they often have to go beyond economic objectives and try to direct the deployment of economic resources for such public needs as we have listed above. Such activities are not aimed at serving individual self-interests. They are pursued for the welfare of the country and its people as a whole.

1.1 EMERGENCE OF MACROECONOMICS

Macroeconomics, as a separate branch of economics, emerged after the British economist **John Maynard Keynes** published his celebrated book *The General Theory of Employment, Interest and Money* in 1936. The dominant thinking in economics before Keynes was that all the labourers who are ready to work will find employment and all the factories will be working at their full capacity. This school of thought is known as the classical tradition.

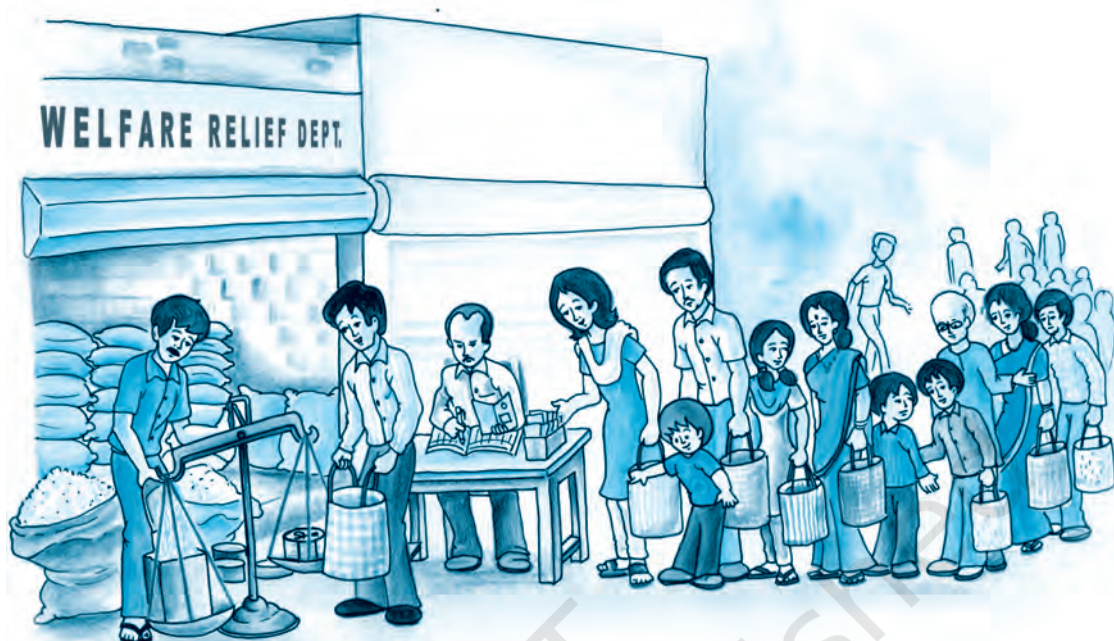


John Maynard Keynes

John Maynard Keynes, British economist, was born in 1883. He was educated in King's College, Cambridge, United Kingdom and later appointed its Dean. Apart from being a sharp intellectual he actively involved in international diplomacy during the years following the First World War. He prophesied the break down of the peace agreement of the War in the book *The Economic Consequences of the Peace* (1919). His book *General Theory of Employment, Interest and Money* (1936) is regarded as one of the most

influential economics books of the twentieth century. He was also a shrewd foreign currency speculator.

However, **the Great Depression** of 1929 and the subsequent years saw the output and employment levels in the countries of Europe and North America fall by huge amounts. It affected other countries of the world as well. Demand for goods in the market was low, many factories were lying idle, workers were thrown out of jobs. In USA, from 1929 to 1933, **unemployment rate** rose from 3 per cent to 25 per cent (unemployment rate may be defined as the number of people who are not working and are looking for jobs divided by the total number of people who are working or looking for jobs). Over the same period aggregate output in USA fell by about 33 per cent. These events made economists think about the functioning of the economy in a new way. The fact that the economy may have long lasting unemployment had to be theorised about and explained. Keynes' book was an attempt in this direction. Unlike his predecessors, his approach was to examine the working of the economy in its entirety and examine the interdependence of the different sectors. The subject of macroeconomics was born.



1.2 CONTEXT OF THE PRESENT BOOK OF MACROECONOMICS

We must remember that the subject under study has a particular historical context. We shall examine the working of the economy of a capitalist country in this book. In a **capitalist country** production activities are mainly carried out by capitalist enterprises. A typical capitalist enterprise has one or several **entrepreneurs** (people who exercise control over major decisions and bear a large part of the risk associated with the firm/enterprise). They may themselves supply the **capital** needed to run the enterprise, or they may borrow the capital. To carry out production they also need **natural resources** – a part consumed in the process of production (e.g. raw materials) and a part fixed (e.g. plots of land). And they need the most important element of human labour to carry out production. This we shall refer to as **labour**. After producing output with the help of these three factors of production, namely capital, land and labour, the entrepreneur sells the product in the market. The money that is earned is called **revenue**. Part of the revenue is paid out as rent for the service rendered by land, part of it is paid to capital as interest and part of it goes to labour as wages. The rest of the revenue is the earning of the entrepreneurs and it is called **profit**. Profits are often used by the producers in the next period to buy new machinery or to build new factories, so that production can be expanded. These expenses which raise productive capacity are examples of **investment expenditure**.

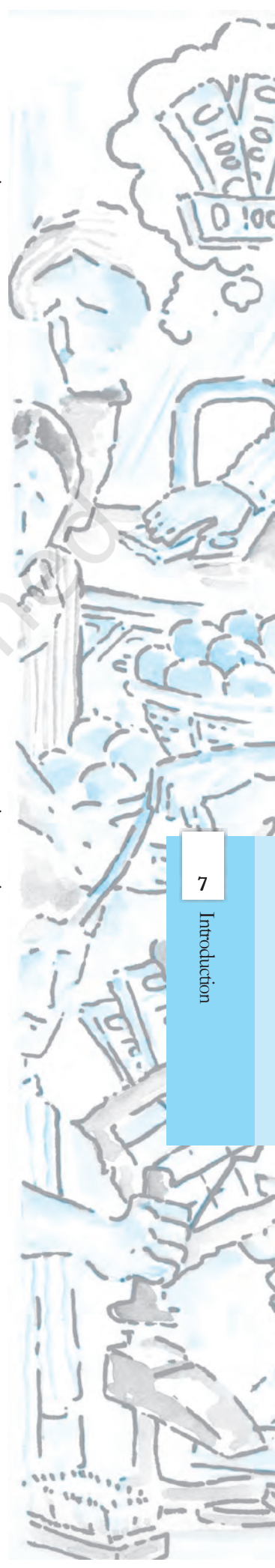
In short, a capitalist economy can be defined as an economy in which most of the economic activities have the following characteristics (a) there is private ownership of means of production (b) production takes place for selling the output in the market (c) there is sale and purchase of labour services at a price which is called the **wage rate** (the

labour which is sold and purchased against wages is referred to as **wage labour**).

If we apply the above mentioned four criteria to the countries of the world we would find that capitalist countries have come into being only during the last three to four hundred years. Moreover, strictly speaking, even at present, a handful of countries in North America, Europe and Asia will qualify as capitalist countries. In many underdeveloped countries production (in agriculture especially) is carried out by peasant families. Wage labour is seldom used and most of the labour is performed by the family members themselves. Production is not solely for the market; a great part of it is consumed by the family. Neither do many peasant farms experience significant rise in capital stock over time. In many tribal societies the ownership of land does not exist; the land may belong to the whole tribe. In such societies the analysis that we shall present in this book will not be applicable. It is, however, true that many developing countries have a significant presence of production units which are organised according to capitalist principles. The production units will be called **firms** in this book. In a firm the entrepreneur (or entrepreneurs) is at the helm of affairs. She hires wage labour from the market, she employs the services of capital and land as well. After hiring these inputs she undertakes the task of production. Her motive for producing goods and services (referred to as output) is to sell them in the market and earn profits. In the process she undertakes risks and uncertainties. For example, she may not get a high enough price for the goods she is producing; this may lead to fall in the profits that she earns. It is to be noted that in a capitalist country the factors of production earn their incomes through the process of production and sale of the resultant output in the market.

In both the developed and developing countries, apart from the private capitalist sector, there is the institution of State. The role of the state includes framing laws, enforcing them and delivering justice. The **state**, in many instances, undertakes production – apart from imposing taxes and spending money on building public infrastructure, running schools, colleges, providing health services etc. These economic functions of the state have to be taken into account when we want to describe the economy of the country. For convenience we shall use the term “**Government**” to denote state.

Apart from the firms and the government, there is another major sector in an economy which is called the **household sector**. By a household we mean a single individual who takes decisions relating to her own consumption, or a group of individuals for whom decisions relating to consumption are jointly determined. Households also save and pay taxes. How do they get the money for these activities? We must remember that the households consist of people. These people work in firms as workers and earn wages. They are the ones who work in the government departments and earn salaries, or they are the owners of firms and earn profits. Indeed the market in which the firms sell their products could not have been functioning without the demand coming from the households. Moreover, they can also earn rent by leasing land or earn interest by lending capital.



So far we have described the major players in the domestic economy. But all the countries of the world are also engaged in external trade. The **external sector** is the fourth important sector in our study. Trade with the external sector can be of two kinds

1. The domestic country may sell goods to the rest of the world. These are called **exports**.
2. The economy may also buy goods from the rest of the world. These are called **imports**. Besides exports and imports, the rest of the world affects the domestic economy in other ways as well.
3. Capital from foreign countries may flow into the domestic country, or the domestic country may be exporting capital to foreign countries.

Summary

Macroeconomics deals with the aggregate economic variables of an economy. It also takes into account various interlinkages which may exist between the different sectors of an economy. This is what distinguishes it from microeconomics; which mostly examines the functioning of the particular sectors of the economy, assuming that the rest of the economy remains the same. Macroeconomics emerged as a separate subject in the 1930s due to Keynes. The Great Depression, which dealt a blow to the economies of developed countries, had provided Keynes with the inspiration for his writings. In this book we shall mostly deal with the working of a capitalist economy. Hence it may not be entirely able to capture the functioning of a developing country. Macroeconomics sees an economy as a combination of four sectors, namely households, firms, government and external sector.

Key Concepts

Rate of interest	Wage rate
Profits	Economic agents or units
Great Depression	Unemployment rate
Four factors of production	Means of production
Inputs	Land
Labour	Capital
Entrepreneurship	Investment expenditure
Wage labour economy	Capitalist country or capitalist
Firms	Capitalist firms
Output	Households
Government	External sector
Exports	Imports

Exercises

1. What is the difference between microeconomics and macroeconomics?
2. What are the important features of a capitalist economy?
3. Describe the four major sectors in an economy according to the macroeconomic point of view.
4. Describe the Great Depression of 1929.

Suggested Readings

1. Bhaduri, A., 1990. *Macroeconomics: The Dynamics of Commodity Production*, pages 1 – 27, Macmillan India Limited, New Delhi.
2. Mankiw, N. G., 2000. *Macroeconomics*, pages 2 – 14, Macmillan Worth Publishers, New York.



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Chapter 2

National Income Accounting



In this chapter we will introduce the fundamental functioning of a simple economy. In section 2.1 we describe some primary ideas we shall work with. In section 2.2 we describe how we can view the aggregate income of the entire economy going through the sectors of the economy in a circular way. The same section also deals with the three ways to calculate the national income; namely product method, expenditure method and income method. The last section 2.3 describes the various sub-categories of national income. It also defines different price indices like GDP deflator, Consumer Price Index, Wholesale Price Indices and discusses the problems associated with taking GDP of a country as an indicator of the aggregate welfare of the people of the country.

2.1 SOME BASIC CONCEPTS OF MACROECONOMICS

One of the pioneers of the subject we call in economics today, Adam Smith, named his most influential work – *An Enquiry into the Nature and Cause of the Wealth of Nations*. What generates the economic wealth of a nation? What makes countries rich or poor? These are some of the central questions of economics. It is not that countries which are endowed with a bounty of natural wealth – minerals or forests or the most fertile lands – are naturally the richest countries. In fact the resource rich Africa and Latin America have some of the poorest countries in the world, whereas many prosperous countries have scarcely any natural wealth. There was a time when possession of natural resources was the most important consideration but even then the resource had to be transformed through a production process.

The economic wealth, or well-being, of a country thus does not necessarily depend on the mere possession of resources; the point is how these resources are used in generating a flow of production and how, as a consequence, income and wealth are generated from that process.

Let us now dwell upon this flow of production. How does this flow of production arise? People combine their energies with natural and manmade environment within a certain social and technological structure to generate a flow of production.

In our modern economic setting this flow of production arises out of production of commodities – goods and services by millions of enterprises large and small. These enterprises range from giant

corporations employing a large number of people to single entrepreneur enterprises. But what happens to these commodities after being produced? Each producer of commodities intends to sell her output. So from the smallest items like pins or buttons to the largest ones like aeroplanes, automobiles, giant machinery or any saleable service like that of the doctor, the lawyer or the financial consultant the goods and services produced are to be sold to the consumers. The consumer may, in turn, be an individual or an enterprise and the good or service purchased by that entity might be for final use or for use in further production. When it is used in further production it often loses its characteristic as that specific good and is transformed through a productive process into another good. Thus a farmer producing cotton sells it to a spinning mill where the raw cotton undergoes transformation to yarn; the yarn is, in turn, sold to a textile mill where, through the productive process, it is transformed into cloth; the cloth is, in turn, transformed through another productive process into an article of clothing which is then ready to be sold finally to the consumers for final use. Such an item that is meant for final use and will not pass through any more stages of production or transformations is called a **final good**.

Why do we call this a final good? Because once it has been sold it passes out of the active economic flow. It will not undergo any further transformation at the hands of any producer. It may, however, undergo transformation by the action of the ultimate purchaser. In fact many such final goods are transformed during their consumption. Thus the tea leaves purchased by the consumer are not consumed in that form – they are used to make drinkable tea, which is consumed. Similarly most of the items that enter our kitchen are transformed through the process of cooking. But cooking at home is not an economic activity, even though the product involved undergoes transformation. Home cooked food is not sold to the market. However, if the same cooking or tea brewing was done in a restaurant where the cooked product would be sold to customers, then the same items, such as tea leaves, would cease to be final goods and would be counted as inputs to which economic value addition can take place. Thus it is not in the nature of the good but in the economic nature of its use that a good becomes a final good.

Of the final goods, we can distinguish between **consumption goods** and **capital goods**. Goods like food and clothing, and services like recreation that are consumed when purchased by their ultimate consumers are called consumption goods or consumer goods. (This also includes services which are consumed but for convenience we may refer to them as consumer goods.)

Then there are other goods that are of durable character which are used in the production process. These are tools, implements and machines. While they make production of other commodities feasible, they themselves don't get transformed in the production process. They are also final goods yet they are not final goods to be ultimately consumed. Unlike the final goods that we have considered above, they are the crucial backbone of any production process, in aiding and enabling the production to take place. These goods form a part of capital, one of the crucial factors of production in which a productive enterprise has invested, and they continue to enable the production process to go on for continuous cycles of production. These are capital goods and they gradually undergo wear and tear, and thus are repaired or gradually replaced over time. The stock of capital that an economy possesses is thus preserved, maintained and renewed partially or wholly over time and this is of some importance in the discussion that will follow.

We may note here that some commodities like television sets, automobiles or home computers, although they are for ultimate consumption, have one characteristic in common with capital goods – they are also durable. That is, they are not extinguished by immediate or even short period consumption; they have a relatively long life as compared to articles such as food or even clothing. They also undergo wear and tear with gradual use and often need repairs and replacements of parts, i.e., like machines they also need to be preserved, maintained and renewed. That is why we call these goods **consumer durables**.

Thus if we consider all the final goods and services produced in an economy in a given period of time they are either in the form of consumption goods (both durable and non-durable) or capital goods. As final goods they do not undergo any further transformation in the economic process.

Of the total production taking place in the economy a large number of products don't end up in final consumption and are not capital goods either. Such goods may be used by other producers as material inputs. Examples are steel sheets used for making automobiles and copper used for making utensils. These are **intermediate goods**, mostly used as raw material or inputs for production of other commodities. *These are not final goods.*

Now, to have a comprehensive idea of the total flow of production in the economy, we need to have a quantitative measure of the aggregate level of final goods produced in the economy. However, in order to get a quantitative assessment – a measure of the total final goods and services produced in the economy – it is obvious that we need a *common measuring rod*. We cannot add metres of cloth produced to tonnes of rice or number of automobiles or machines. Our common measuring rod is money. Since each of these commodities is produced for sale, *the sum total of the monetary value of these diverse commodities gives us a measure of final output*. But why are we to measure final goods only? Surely intermediate goods are crucial inputs to any production process and a significant part of our manpower and capital stock are engaged in production of these goods. However, since we are dealing with value of output, we should realise that the value of the final goods already includes the value of the intermediate goods that have entered into their production as inputs. Counting them separately will lead to the error of *double counting*. Whereas considering intermediate goods may give a fuller description of total economic activity, counting them will highly exaggerate the final value of our economic activity.

At this stage it is important to introduce the concepts of **stocks** and **flows**. Often we hear statements like the average salary of someone is Rs 10,000 or the output of the steel industry is so many tonnes or so many rupees in value. But these are incomplete statements because it is not clear whether the income which is being referred to is yearly or monthly or daily income and surely that makes a huge difference. Sometimes, when the context is familiar, we assume that the time period is known and therefore do not mention it. But inherent in all such statements is a definite period of time. Otherwise such statements are meaningless. Thus income, or output, or profits are concepts that make sense only when a time period is specified. These are called flows because they occur in a period of time. Therefore we need to delineate a time period to get a quantitative measure of these. Since a lot of accounting is done annually in an economy, many of these are expressed annually like annual profits or production. **Flows are defined over a period of time.**

In contrast, capital goods or consumer durables once produced do not wear out or get consumed in a delineated time period. In fact capital goods continue to serve us through different cycles of production. The buildings or machines in a factory are there irrespective of the specific time period. There can be addition to, or deduction from, these if a new machine is added or a machine falls in disuse and is not replaced. These are called stocks. ***Stocks are defined at a particular point of time.*** However we can measure a *change in stock* over a specific period of time like how many machines were added this year. Such changes in stocks are thus flows, which can be measured over specific time periods. A particular machine can be part of the capital stock for many years (unless it wears out); but that machine can be part of the flow of new machines added to the capital stock only for a single year when it was initially installed.

To further understand the difference between stock variables and flow variables, let us take the following example. Suppose a tank is being filled with water coming from a tap. The amount of water which is flowing into the tank from the tap per minute is a flow. But how much water there is in the tank at a particular point of time is a stock concept.

To come back to our discussion on the measure of final output, that part of our final output that comprises of capital goods constitutes **gross investment** of an economy¹. These may be machines, tools and implements; buildings, office spaces, storehouses or infrastructure like roads, bridges, airports or jetties. But all the capital goods produced in a year do not constitute an addition to the capital stock already existing. A significant part of current output of capital goods goes in maintaining or replacing part of the existing stock of capital goods. This is because the already existing capital stock suffers wear and tear and needs maintenance and replacement. A part of the capital goods produced this year goes for replacement of existing capital goods and is not an addition to the stock of capital goods already existing and its value needs to be subtracted from gross investment for arriving at the measure for net investment. This deletion, which is made from the value of gross investment in order to accommodate regular wear and tear of capital, is called **depreciation**.

So new addition to capital stock in an economy is measured by net investment or new capital formation, which is expressed as

$$\text{Net Investment} = \text{Gross investment} - \text{Depreciation}$$

Let us examine this concept called depreciation a little more in detail. Let us consider a new machine that a firm invests in. This machine may be in service for the next twenty years after which it falls into disrepair and needs to be replaced. We can now imagine as if the machine is being gradually used up in each year's production process and each year one twentieth of its original value is getting depreciated. So, instead of considering a bulk investment for replacement after twenty years, we consider an annual depreciation cost every year. This is the usual sense in which the term depreciation is used and inherent in its conception is the expected life of a particular capital good, like twenty years in our example of the machine. Depreciation is thus an annual allowance for wear and tear of a

¹This is how economists define investment. This must not be confused with the commonplace notion of investment which implies using money to buy physical or financial assets. Thus use of the term investment to denote purchase of shares or property or even having an insurance policy has nothing to do with how economists define investment. Investment for us is always capital formation, a gross or net addition to capital stock.

capital good.² In other words it is the cost of the good divided by number of years of its useful life.³

Notice here that depreciation is an accounting concept. No real expenditure may have actually been incurred each year yet depreciation is annually accounted for. In an economy with thousands of enterprises with widely varying periods of life of their equipment, in any particular year, some enterprises are actually making the bulk replacement spending. Thus, we can realistically assume that there will be a steady flow of actual replacement spending which will more or less match the amount of annual depreciation being accounted for in that economy.

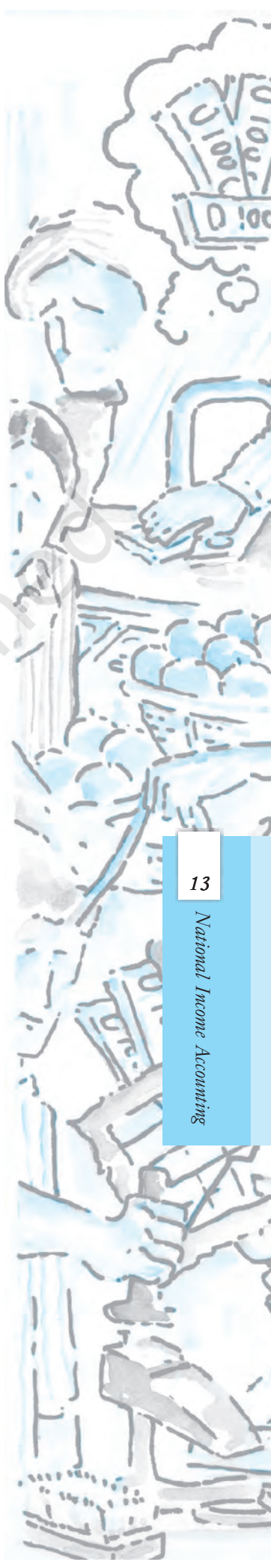
Now if we go back to our discussion of total final output produced in an economy, we see that there is output of consumer goods and services and output of capital goods. The consumer goods sustain the consumption of the entire population of the economy. Purchase of consumer goods depends on the capacity of the people to spend on these goods which, in turn, depends on their income. The other part of the final goods, the capital goods, are purchased by business enterprises. They are used either for maintenance of the capital stock because there are wear and tear of it, or they are used for addition to their capital stock. In a specific time period, say in a year, the total production of final goods can thus be either in the form of consumption or investment. This implies that there is a trade-off. If an economy, produces more of consumer goods, it is producing less of capital goods and vice-versa.

It is generally observed that more sophisticated and heavy capital goods raise the ability of a labourer to produce goods. The traditional weaver would take months to weave a sari but with modern machinery thousands of pieces of clothing are produced in a day. Decades were taken to construct the great historical monuments like the Pyramids or the Taj Mahal but with modern construction machinery one can build a skyscraper in a few years. More production of newer varieties of capital goods therefore would help in the greater production of consumer goods.

But aren't we contradicting ourselves? Earlier we have seen how, of the total output of final goods of an economy, if a larger share goes for production of capital goods, a smaller share is available for production of consumer goods. And now we are saying more capital goods would mean more consumer goods. There is no contradiction here however. What is important here is the element of time. At a *particular period*, given a level of total output of the economy, it is true if more capital goods are produced less of consumer goods would be produced. But production of more capital goods would mean that in *future* the labourers would have more capital equipments to work with. We have seen that this leads to a higher capacity of the economy to produce with the same number of labourers. Thus total input itself would be higher compared to the case when less capital goods were produced. If total output is higher the amount of consumer goods that can be produced would surely be higher.

²Depreciation does not take into account unexpected or sudden destruction or disuse of capital as can happen with accidents, natural calamities or other such extraneous circumstances.

³We are making a rather simple assumption here that there is a constant rate of depreciation based on the original value of the asset. There can be other methods to calculate depreciation in actual practice.



Thus the economic cycle not only rolls on, higher production of capital goods enables the economy to expand. It is possible to find another view of the circular flow in the discussion we have made so far.

Since we are dealing with all goods and services that are produced for the market, the crucial factor enabling such sale is demand for such products backed by purchasing power. One must have the necessary ability to purchase commodities. Otherwise one's need for commodities does not get recognised by the market.

We have already discussed above that one's ability to buy commodities comes from the income one earns as labourer (earning wages), or as entrepreneur (earning profits), or as landlord (earning rents), or as owner of capital (earning interests). In short, the incomes that people earn as owners of factors of production are used by them to meet their demand for goods and services.

So we can see a circular flow here which is facilitated through the market. Simply put, the firms' demand for factors of production to run the production process creates payments to the public. In turn, the public's demand for goods and services creates payments to the firms and enables the sale of the products they produce.

So the social act of consumption and production are intricately linked and, in fact, there is a circular causation here. The process of production in an economy generates factor payments for those involved in production and generates goods and services as the outcome of the production process. The incomes so generated create the capacity to purchase the final consumption goods and thus enable their sale by the business enterprises, the basic object of their production. The capital goods which are also generated in the production process also enable their producers to earn income – wages, profits etc. in a similar manner. The capital goods add to, or maintain, the capital stock of an economy and thus make production of other commodities possible.

2.2 CIRCULAR FLOW OF INCOME AND METHODS OF CALCULATING NATIONAL INCOME

The description of the economy in the previous section enables us to have a rough idea of how a simple economy – without a government, external trade or any savings – may function. The households receive their payments from the firms for productive activities they perform for the latter. As we have mentioned before, there may fundamentally be four kinds of contributions that can be made during the production of goods and services (a) contribution made by human labour, remuneration for which is called wage (b) contribution made by capital, remuneration for which is called interest (c) contribution made by entrepreneurship, remuneration of which is profit (d) contribution made by fixed natural resources (called 'land'), remuneration for which is called rent.

In this simplified economy, there is only one way in which the households may dispose off their earnings – by spending their entire income on the goods and services produced by the domestic firms. The other channels of disposing their income are closed: we have assumed that the households do not save, they do not pay taxes to the government – since there is no government, and neither do they buy imported goods since there is no external trade in this simple economy. In other words, factors of production use their remunerations to buy the goods and services which they assisted in producing. The aggregate consumption by the households of the economy is equal to the aggregate expenditure on goods and services produced by the firms in the economy. The

entire income of the economy, therefore, comes back to the producers in the form of sales revenue. There is no leakage from the system – there is no difference between the amount that the firms had distributed in the form of factor payments (which is the sum total of remunerations earned by the four factors of production) and the aggregate consumption expenditure that they receive as sales revenue.

In the next period the firms will once again produce goods and services and pay remunerations to the factors of production. These remunerations will once again be used to buy the goods and services. Hence year after year we can imagine the aggregate income of the economy going through the two sectors, firms and households, in a circular way. This is represented in Fig. 2.1. When the income is being spent on the goods and services produced by the firms, it takes the form of *aggregate expenditure* received by the firms. Since the value of expenditure must be equal to the value of goods and services, we can equivalently measure the aggregate income by “*calculating the aggregate value of goods and services produced by the firms*”. When the aggregate revenue received by the firms is paid out to the factors of production it takes the form of aggregate income.

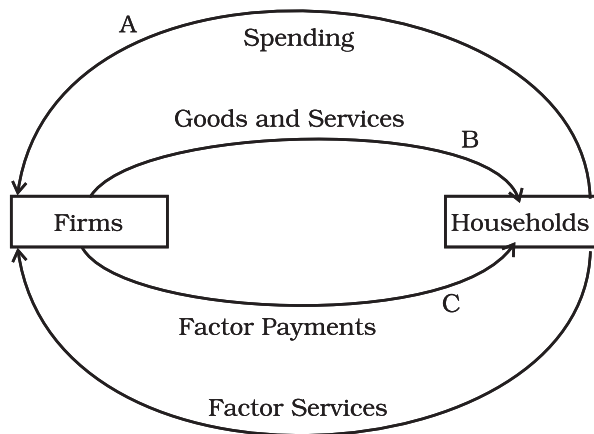


Fig. 2.1: Circular Flow of Income in a Simple Economy

In Fig. 2.1, the uppermost arrow, going from the households to the firms, represents the spending the households undertake to buy goods and services produced by the firms. The second arrow going from the firms to the households is the counterpart of the arrow above. It stands for the goods and services which are flowing from the firms to the households. In other words, this flow is what the households are getting from the firms, for which they are making the expenditures. In short, the two arrows on the top represent the goods and services market – the arrow above represents the flow of payments for the goods and services, the arrow below represents the flow of goods and services. The two arrows at the bottom of the diagram similarly represent the factors of production market. The lower most arrow going from the households to the firms symbolises the services that the households are rendering to the firms. Using these services the firms are manufacturing the output. The arrow above this, going from the firms to the households, represents the payments made by the firms to the households for the services provided by the latter.

Since the same amount of money, representing the aggregate value of goods and services, is moving in a circular way, if we want to estimate the aggregate value of goods and services produced during a year we can measure the annual value of the flows at any of the dotted lines indicated in the diagram. We can measure the uppermost flow (at point A) by measuring the aggregate value of spending that the firms receive for the final goods and services which they produce. This method will be called the **expenditure method**. If we measure the flow at B by measuring the aggregate value of final goods and services produced by all

the firms, it will be called **product method**. At C, measuring the sum total of all factor payments will be called **income method**.

Observe that the aggregate spending of the economy must be equal to the aggregate income earned by the factors of production (the flows are equal at A and C). Now let us suppose that at a particular period of time the households decide to spend more on the goods and services produced by the firms. For the time being let us ignore the question where they would find the money to finance that extra spending since they are already spending all of their income (they may have borrowed the money to finance the additional spending). Now if they spend more on the goods and services, the firms will produce more goods and services to meet this extra demand. Since they will produce more, the firms must also pay the factors of production extra remunerations. How much extra amount of money will the firms pay? The additional factor payments must be equal to the value of the additional goods and services that are being produced. Thus the households will eventually get the extra earnings required to support the initial additional spending that they had undertaken. In other words, the households can decide to spend more – spend beyond their means. And in the end their income will rise exactly by the amount which is necessary to carry out the extra spending. Putting it differently, an economy may decide to spend more than the present level of income. But by doing so, its income will eventually rise to a level consistent with the higher spending level. This may seem a little paradoxical at first. But since income is moving in a circular fashion, it is not difficult to figure out that a rise in the flow at one point must eventually lead to a rise in the flow at all levels. This is one more example of how the functioning of a single economic agent (say, a household) may differ from the functioning of the economy as a whole. In the former the spending gets restricted by the individual income of a household. It can never happen that a single worker decides to spend more and this leads to an equivalent rise in her income. We shall spend more time on how higher aggregate spending leads to change in aggregate income in a later chapter.

The above mentioned sketchy illustration of an economy is admittedly a simplified one. Such a story which describes the functioning of an imaginary economy is called a **macroeconomic model**. It is clear that a model does not describe an actual economy in detail. For example, our model assumes that households do not save, there is no government, no trade with other countries. However models do not want to capture an economy in its every minute detail – their purpose is to highlight some essential features of the functioning of an economic system. But one has to be cautious not to simplify the matters in such a way that misrepresents the essential nature of the economy. The subject of economics is full of models, many of which will be presented in this book. One task of an economist is to figure out which model is applicable to which real life situation.

If we change our simple model described above and introduce savings, will it change the principal conclusion that the aggregate estimate of the income of the economy will remain the same whether we decide to calculate it at A, B or C? It turns out that this conclusion does not change in a fundamental way. No matter how complicated an economic system may be, the annual production of goods and services estimated through each of the three methods is the same.

We have seen that the aggregate value of goods and services produced in an economy can be calculated by three methods. We now discuss the detailed steps of these calculations.

2.2.1 The Product or Value Added Method

In product method we calculate the aggregate annual value of goods and services produced (if a year is the unit of time). How to go about doing this? Do we add up the value of all goods and services produced by all the firms in an economy? The following example will help us to understand.

Let us suppose that there are only two kinds of producers in the economy. They are the wheat producers (or the farmers) and the bread makers (the bakers). The wheat producers grow wheat and they do not need any input other than human labour. They sell a part of the wheat to the bakers. The bakers do not need any other raw materials besides wheat to produce bread. Let us suppose that in a year the total value of wheat that the farmers have produced is Rs 100. Out of this they have sold Rs 50 worth of wheat to the bakers. The bakers have used this amount of wheat completely during the year and have produced Rs 200 worth of bread. What is the value of total production in the economy? If we follow the simple way of aggregating the values of production of the sectors, we would add Rs 200 (value of production of the bakers) to Rs 100 (value of production of farmers). The result will be Rs 300.

A little reflection will tell us that the value of aggregate production is not Rs 300. The farmers had produced Rs 100 worth of wheat for which it did not need assistance of any inputs. Therefore the entire Rs 100 is rightfully the contribution of the farmers. But the same is not true for the bakers. The bakers had to buy Rs 50 worth of wheat to produce their bread. The Rs 200 worth of bread that they have produced is not entirely their own contribution. To calculate the net contribution of the bakers, we need to subtract the value of the wheat that they have bought from the farmers. If we do not do this we shall commit the mistake of 'double counting'. This is because Rs 50 worth of wheat will be counted twice. First it will be counted as part of the output produced by the farmers. Second time, it will be counted as the imputed value of wheat in the bread produced by the bakers.

Therefore, the net contribution made by the bakers is, $\text{Rs } 200 - \text{Rs } 50 = \text{Rs } 150$. Hence, aggregate value of goods produced by this simple economy is $\text{Rs } 100$ (net contribution by the farmers) + $\text{Rs } 150$ (net contribution by the bakers) = $\text{Rs } 250$.

The term that is used to denote the net contribution made by a firm is called its **value added**. We have seen that the raw materials that a firm buys from another firm which are completely used up in the process of production are called 'intermediate goods'. Therefore the value added of a firm is, *value of production of the firm - value of intermediate goods used by the firm*. The

value added of a firm is distributed among its four factors of production, namely, labour, capital,

entrepreneurship and land. Therefore wages, interest, profits and rents paid out by the firm must add up to the value added of the firm. Value added is a flow variable.

We can represent the example given above in terms of Table 2.1.

Table 2.1: Production, Intermediate Goods and Value Added

	Farmer	Baker
Total production	100	200
Intermediate goods used	0	50
Value added	100	$200 - 50 = 150$

Here all the variables are expressed in terms of money. We can think of the market prices of the goods being used to evaluate the different variables listed here. And we can introduce more players in the chain of production in the example and make it more realistic and complicated. For example, the farmer may be using fertilisers or pesticides to produce wheat. The value of these inputs will have to be deducted from the value of output of wheat. Or the bakers may be selling the bread to a restaurant whose value added will have to be calculated by subtracting the value of intermediate goods (bread in this case).

We have already introduced the concept of depreciation, which is also known as consumption of fixed capital. Since the capital which is used to carry out production undergoes wear and tear, the producer has to undertake replacement investments to keep the value of capital constant. The replacement investment is same as depreciation of capital. If we include depreciation in value added then the measure of value added that we obtain is called **Gross Value Added**. If we deduct the value of depreciation from gross value added we obtain **Net Value Added**. Unlike gross value added, net value added does not include wear and tear that capital has undergone. For example, let us say a firm produces Rs 100 worth of goods per year, Rs 20 is the value of intermediate goods used by it during the year and Rs 10 is the value of capital consumption. The gross value added of the firm will be, $\text{Rs } 100 - \text{Rs } 20 = \text{Rs } 80$ per year. The net value added will be, $\text{Rs } 100 - \text{Rs } 20 - \text{Rs } 10 = \text{Rs } 70$ per year.

It is to be noted that while calculating the value added we are taking the *value of production* of firm. But a firm may be unable to sell all of its produce. In such a case it will have some unsold stock at the end of the year. Conversely, it may so happen that a firm had some initial unsold stock to begin with. During the year that follows it has produced very little. But it has met the demand in the market by selling from the stock it had at the beginning of the year. How shall we treat these stocks which a firm may intentionally or unintentionally carry with itself? Also, let us remember that a firm buys raw materials from other firms. The part of raw material which gets used up is categorised as an intermediate good. What happens to the part which does not get used up?

In economics, the stock of unsold finished goods, or semi-finished goods, or raw materials which a firm carries from one year to the next is called **inventory**. Inventory is a stock variable. It may have a value at the beginning of the year; it may have a higher value at the end of the year. In such a case inventories have increased (or accumulated). If the value of inventories is less at the end of the year compared to the beginning of the year, inventories have decreased (decumulated). We can therefore infer that the *change of inventories of a firm during a year* $\equiv$ *production of the firm during the year* – *sale of the firm during the year*.

The sign ' $\equiv$ ' stands for identity. Unlike equality ('='), an identity always holds irrespective of what variables we have on the left hand and right hand sides of it. For example, we can write $2 + 2 \equiv 4$, because this is always true. But we must write $2 \times x = 4$. This is because two times x equals to 4 for a particular value of x , (namely when $x = 2$) and not always. We cannot write $2 \times x \equiv 4$.

Observe that since *production of the firm* $\equiv$ *value added + intermediate goods used by the firm*, we get, *change of inventories of a firm during a year* $\equiv$ *value added + intermediate goods used by the firm* – *sale of the firm during a year*.

For example, let us suppose that a firm had an unsold stock worth of Rs 100 at the beginning of a year. During the year it had produced Rs 1,000

worth of goods and managed to sell Rs 800 worth of goods. Therefore, the Rs 200 is the difference between production and sales. This Rs 200 worth of goods is the change in inventories. This will add to the Rs 100 worth of inventories the firm started with. Hence the inventories at the end of the year is, $\text{Rs } 100 + \text{Rs } 200 = \text{Rs } 300$. Notice that change in inventories takes place over a period of time. Therefore it is a **flow variable**.

Inventories are treated as capital. Addition to the stock of capital of a firm is known as **investment**. Therefore, change in the inventory of a firm is treated as investment. There can be three major categories of investment. First is the rise in the value of inventories of a firm over a year which is treated as investment expenditure undertaken by the firm. The second category of investment is the fixed business investment, which is defined as the addition to the machinery, factory buildings and equipment employed by the firms. The last category of investment is the residential investment, which refers to the addition of housing facilities.

Change in inventories may be planned or unplanned. In case of an unexpected fall in sales, the firm will have unsold stock of goods which it had not anticipated. Hence there will be **unplanned accumulation of inventories**. In the opposite case where there is unexpected rise in the sales there will be **unplanned decumulation of inventories**.

This can be illustrated with the help of the following example. Suppose a firm produces shirts. It starts the year with an inventory of 100 shirts. During the coming year it expects to sell 1,000 shirts. Hence, it produces 1,000 shirts, expecting to keep an inventory of 100 at the end of the year. However, during the year, the sales of shirts turn out to be unexpectedly low. The firm is able to sell only 600 shirts. This means that the firm is left with 400 unsold shirts. The firm ends the year with $400 + 100 = 500$ shirts. The unexpected rise of inventories by 400 will be an example of unplanned accumulation of inventories. If, on the other hand, the sales had been more than 1,000 we would have unplanned decumulation of inventories. For example, if the sales had been 1,050, then not only the production of 1,000 shirts will be sold, the firm will have to sell 50 shirts out of the inventory. This 50 unexpected reduction in inventories is an example of unexpected decumulation of inventories.

What can be the examples of **planned accumulation or decumulation of inventories**? Suppose the firm wants to raise the inventories from 100 shirts to 200 shirts during the year. Expecting sales of 1,000 shirts during the year (as before), the firm produces $1000 + 100 = 1,100$ shirts. If the sales are actually 1,000 shirts, then the firm indeed ends up with a rise of inventories. The new stock of inventories is 200 shirts, which was indeed planned by the firm. This rise is an example of planned accumulation of inventories. On the other hand if the firm had wanted to reduce the inventories from 100 to 25 (say), then it would produce $1000 - 75 = 925$ shirts. This is because it plans to sell 75 shirts out of the inventory of 100 shirts it started with (so that the inventory at the end of the year becomes $100 - 75 = 25$ shirts, which the firm wants). If the sales indeed turn out to be 1000 as expected by the firm, the firm will be left with the planned, reduced inventory of 25 shirts.

We shall have more to say on the distinction between unplanned and planned change in inventories in the chapters which follow.

Taking cognizance of change of inventories we may write

Gross value added of firm, i (GVA_i) $\equiv$ Gross value of the output produced by the firm i (Q_i) – Value of intermediate goods used by the firm (Z_i)

$GVA_i \equiv$ Value of sales by the firm (V_i) + Value of change in inventories (Δi) – Value of intermediate goods used by the firm (Z_i) (2.1)

Equation (2.1) has been derived by using: Change in inventories of a firm during a year $\equiv$ Production of the firm during the year – Sale of the firm during the year.

It is worth noting that the sales by the firm includes sales not only to domestic buyers but also to buyers abroad (the latter is termed as exports). It is also to be noted that all the above mentioned variables are flow variables. Generally these are measured on an annual basis. Hence they measure value of the flows per year.

Net value added of the firm $i \equiv GVA_i - \text{Depreciation of the firm } i (D_i)$

If we sum the gross value added of all the firms of the economy in a year, we get a measure of the value of aggregate amount of goods and services produced by the economy in a year (just as we had done in the wheat-bread example). Such an estimate is called **Gross Domestic Product (GDP)**. Thus $GDP \equiv$ Sum total of gross value added of all the firms in the economy.

If there are N firms in the economy, each assigned with a serial number from 1 to N , then $GDP \equiv$ Sum total of the gross value added of all the firms in the economy

$$\equiv GVA_1 + GVA_2 + \dots + GVA_N$$

Therefore

$$GDP \equiv \sum_{i=1}^N GVA_i \quad (2.2)$$

The symbol $\sum$ is a notation – it is used to denote summation. Suppose, there are 3 students, having pocket money of Rs. 200, 250 and 350 respectively.

We can say, if i^{th} student has pocket money X_i , then,

$X_1 = 200, X_2 = 250, X_3 = 300$. The total pocket money will be given by

$X_1 + X_2 + X_3$. The summation notation given above is useful in writing it in

a shorter form: $X_1 + X_2 + X_3$ can be written as $\sum_{i=1}^3 X_i$, which means that

there are three values of X corresponding to the three individuals 1 to 3, and we are referring to the sum of the values of X for individuals 1 to 3.

This notation is particularly useful in macroeconomics since we deal with aggregates. For instance, suppose there are 1000 consumers in the economy,

having consumption $c_1, c_2, \dots, c_{1000}$. If we want to compute the aggregate consumption for this economy, we have to add up all these values, which means aggregate consumption for this economy will be given by

$C = c_1 + c_2 + \dots + c_{1000}$. The summation notation, however, allows us to write it in a much shorter form. Since we are summing up the values of consumption for individual 1 to individual 1000, where the value of

consumption for the individual i is c_i , aggregate consumption will be

$$C = \sum_{i=1}^{1000} c_i.$$

In general, if we are taking sum of a quantity x_i over individuals 1 to n , it will be denoted by $\sum_{i=1}^n x_i$.

2.2.2 Expenditure Method

An alternative way to calculate the GDP is by looking at the demand side of the products. This method is referred to as the expenditure method. In the farmer-baker example that we have described before, the aggregate value of the output in the economy by expenditure method will be calculated in the following way. In this method we add the final expenditures that each firm makes. Final expenditure is that part of expenditure which is undertaken not for intermediate purposes. The Rs 50 worth of wheat which the bakers buy from the farmers counts as intermediate goods, hence it does not fall under the category of final expenditure. Therefore the aggregate value of output of the economy is Rs 200 (final expenditure received by the baker) + Rs 50 (final expenditure received by the farmer) = Rs 250 per year.

Firm i can make the final expenditure on the following accounts (a) the final consumption expenditure on the goods and services produced by the firm. We shall denote this by C_i . We may note that mostly it is the households which undertake consumption expenditure. There may be exceptions when the firms buy consumables to treat their guests or for their employees (b) the final investment expenditure, I_i , incurred by other firms on the capital goods produced by firm i . Observe that unlike the expenditure on intermediate goods which is not included in the calculation of GDP, expenditure on investments is included. The reason is that investment goods remain with the firm, whereas intermediate goods are consumed in the process of production (c) the expenditure that the government makes on the final goods and services produced by firm i . We shall denote this by G_i . We may point out that the final expenditure incurred by the government includes both the consumption and investment expenditure (d) the export revenues that firm i earns by selling its goods and services abroad. This will be denoted by X_i .

Thus the sum total of the revenues that the firm i earns is given by

$RV_i \equiv$ Sum total of final consumption, investment, government and exports expenditures received by the firm i

$$\equiv C_i + I_i + G_i + X_i$$

If there are N firms then summing over N firms we get

$\sum_{i=1}^N RV_i \equiv$ Sum total of final consumption, investment, government and exports expenditures received by all the firms in the economy

$$\equiv \sum_{i=1}^N C_i + \sum_{i=1}^N I_i + \sum_{i=1}^N G_i + \sum_{i=1}^N X_i \quad (2.3)$$

Let C be the aggregate final consumption expenditure of the entire economy. Notice that a part of C is spent on imports of consumption goods C

$= \sum_{i=1}^N C_i + C_m$. Let C_m denote expenditure on the imports of consumption goods. Therefore $C - C_m$ denotes that part of aggregate final consumption expenditure that is spent on the domestic firms. Similarly, let $I - I_m$ stand for that part of aggregate final investment expenditure that is spent on domestic firms, where I is the value of the aggregate final investment expenditure of the economy and out of this I_m is spent on foreign investment goods. Similarly $G - G_m$ stands for that part of aggregate final government expenditure that is spent on the domestic firms, where G is the aggregate expenditure of the government of the economy and G_m is the part of G which is spent on imports.

Therefore, $\sum_{i=1}^N C_i \equiv$ Sum total of final consumption expenditures received by all the firms in the economy $\equiv C - C_m$; $\sum_{i=1}^N I_i \equiv$ Sum total of final investment expenditures received by all the firms in the economy $\equiv I - I_m$; $\sum_{i=1}^N G_i \equiv$ Sum total of final government expenditures received by all the firms in the economy $\equiv G - G_m$. Substituting these in equation (2.3) we get

$$\begin{aligned}\sum_{i=1}^N RV_i &\equiv C - C_m + I - I_m + G - G_m + \sum_{i=1}^N X_i \\ &\equiv C + I + G + \sum_{i=1}^N X_i - (C_m + I_m + G_m) \\ &\equiv C + I + G + X - M\end{aligned}$$

Here $X \equiv \sum_{i=1}^N X_i$ denotes aggregate expenditure by the foreigners on the exports of the economy. $M \equiv C_m + I_m + G_m$ is the aggregate imports expenditure incurred by the economy.

We know, $GDP \equiv$ Sum total of all the final expenditure received by the firms in the economy.

In other words

$$GDP \equiv \sum_{i=1}^N RV_i \equiv C + I + G + X - M \quad (2.4)$$

Equation (2.4) expresses GDP according to the expenditure method. It may be noted that out of the five variables on the right hand side, investment expenditure, I , is the most unstable.

2.2.3 Income Method

As we mentioned in the beginning, the sum of final expenditures in the economy must be equal to the incomes received by all the factors of production taken together (final expenditure is the spending on final goods, it does not include spending on intermediate goods). This follows from the simple idea that the revenues earned by all the firms put together must be distributed among the factors of production as salaries, wages, profits, interest earnings and rents. Let there be M number of households in the economy. Let W_i be the wages and salaries received by the i -th household in a particular year. Similarly, P_i , In_i , R_i be the gross profits, interest payments and rents received by the i -th household in a particular year. Therefore, GDP is given by

$$GDP \equiv \sum_{i=1}^M W_i + \sum_{i=1}^M P_i + \sum_{i=1}^M In_i + \sum_{i=1}^M R_i \equiv W + P + In + R \quad (2.5)$$

$$\text{Here, } \sum_{i=1}^M W_i \equiv W, \sum_{i=1}^M P_i \equiv P, \sum_{i=1}^M In_i \equiv In, \sum_{i=1}^M R_i \equiv R.$$

Taking equations (2.2), (2.4) and (2.5) together we get

$$GDP \equiv \sum_{i=1}^N GVA_i \equiv C + I + G + X - M \equiv W + P + In + R \quad (2.6)$$

It is to be noted that in identity (2.6), I stands for sum total of both planned and unplanned investments undertaken by the firms.

Since, the identities (2.2), (2.4) and (2.6) are different expressions of the same variable, namely GDP, we may represent the equivalence by Fig. 2.2.

Now, let us look at a numerical example to see how all the three methods of estimating GDP give us the same answer.

Example: There are two firms, A and B. Suppose A uses no raw material and produces cotton worth Rs. 50. A sells its cotton to firm B, who uses it to produce cloth. B sells the cloth produced to consumers for Rs. 200.

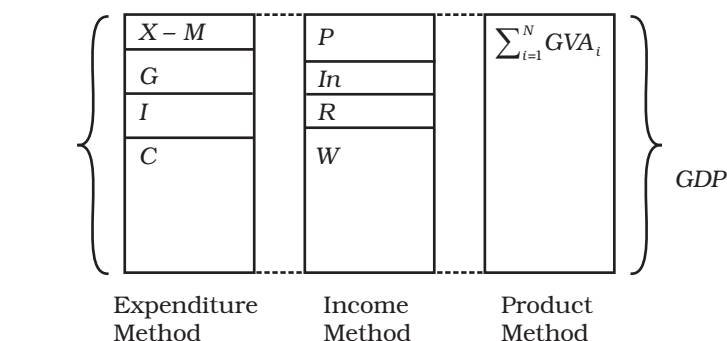


Fig. 2.2: Diagrammatic Representation of GDP by the Three Methods

1. GDP in the phase of production or the value added method:

Recall that value added (VA) = Sales – Intermediate Goods

Thus,

$$VA_A = 50 - 0 = 50$$

$$VA_B = 200 - 50 = 150$$

Thus,

$$GDP = VA_A + VA_B = 200.$$

Table 2.2: Distributions of GDPs for firms A and B

	Firm A	Firm B
Sales	50	200
Intermediate consumption	0	50
Value added	50	150

2. GDP in the phase of disposition or the expenditure method:

Recall that GDP = Sum of final expenditure or expenditures on goods and services for end use. In the above case, final expenditure is expenditure by consumers on cloth. Therefore, GDP = 200.

3. GDP in the phase of distribution or Income method

Let us look at the firms A and B again.

Now, of this 50 received by A, the firm gives Rs. 20 to the workers as wages, and keeps the remaining 30 as its profits. Similarly, B gives 60 as wages and keeps 90 as profits.

Table 2.3: Distributions of factor incomes of firms A and B

	Firm A	Firm B
Wages	20	60
Profits	30	90

Recall that GDP by income method = sum total of factor incomes, which is equal to total wages received (workers of A and B) and total profits earned (by A and B), which is equal⁴ to $80 + 120 = 200$.

2.2.4 Factor Cost, Basic Prices and Market Prices

In India, the most highlighted measure of national income has been the GDP at factor cost. The Central Statistics Office (CSO) of the Government of India has been reporting the GDP at factor cost and at market prices. In its revision in January 2015 the CSO replaced GDP at factor cost with the GVA at basic prices, and the GDP at market prices, which is now called only GDP, is now the most highlighted measure.

The idea of GVA has already been discussed: it is the value of total output produced in the economy less the value of intermediate consumption (the output which is used in production of output further, and not used in final consumption). Here we discuss the concept of basic prices. The distinction between factor cost, basic prices and market prices is based on the distinction between net **production** taxes (production taxes less production subsidies) and net **product** taxes (product taxes less product subsidies). Production taxes and subsidies are paid or received in relation to production and are independent of the volume of production such as land revenues, stamp and registration fee. Product taxes and subsidies, on the other hand, are paid or received per unit or product, e.g., excise tax, service tax, export and import duties etc. Factor cost includes only the payment to factors of production, it does not include any tax. In order to arrive at the market prices, we have to add to the factor cost the total indirect taxes less total subsidies. The basic prices lie in between: they include the production taxes (less production subsidies) but not product taxes (less product subsidies). Therefore in order to arrive at market prices we have to add product taxes (less product subsidies) to the basic prices.

As stated above, now the CSO releases GVA at basic prices. Thus, it includes the net production taxes but not net product taxes. In order to arrive at the GDP (at market prices) we need to add net product taxes to GVA at basic prices. Thus,

GVA at factor costs + Net production taxes = GVA at basic prices

GVA at basic prices + Net product taxes = GVA at market prices

Table 2.5 at the end of the chapter gives the figures for GDP (at market prices) and GVA at basic prices, while Table 2.6 gives the composition of GDP from expenditure side.

⁴ In this example, we have left out factor payments in the form of rent and interest. But this will not make any difference to the basic result, because after paying wages the remainder of value added by a firm will be distributed between rent, interest and profits (together called operating surplus).

2.3 SOME MACROECONOMIC IDENTITIES

Gross Domestic Product measures the aggregate production of final goods and services taking place within the domestic economy during a year. But the whole of it may not accrue to the citizens of the country. For example, a citizen of India working in Saudi Arabia may be earning her wage and it will be included in the Saudi Arabian GDP. But legally speaking, she is an Indian. Is there a way to take into account the earnings made by Indians abroad or by the factors of production owned by Indians? When we try to do this, in order to maintain symmetry, we must deduct the earnings of the foreigners who are working within our domestic economy, or the payments to the factors of production owned by the foreigners. For example, the profits earned by the Korean-owned Hyundai car factory will have to be subtracted from the GDP of India.

The macroeconomic variable which takes into account such additions and subtractions is known as **Gross National Product (GNP)**. It is, therefore, defined as follows



The foreigners have a share in your domestic economy. Discuss this in the classroom.

$$\text{GNP} \equiv \text{GDP} + \text{Factor income earned by the domestic factors of production employed in the rest of the world} - \text{Factor income earned by the factors of production of the rest of the world employed in the domestic economy}$$

Hence, $\text{GNP} \equiv \text{GDP} + \text{Net factor income from abroad}$

(Net factor income from abroad = Factor income earned by the domestic factors of production employed in the rest of the world – Factor income earned by the factors of production of the rest of the world employed in the domestic economy).

We have already noted that a part of the capital gets consumed during the year due to wear and tear. This wear and tear is called depreciation. Naturally, depreciation does not become part of anybody's income. If we deduct depreciation from GNP the measure of aggregate income that we obtain is called **Net National Product (NNP)**. Thus

$$\text{NNP} \equiv \text{GNP} - \text{Depreciation}$$

It is to be noted that all these variables are evaluated at market prices. Through the expression given above, we get the value of NNP evaluated at market prices. But market price includes **indirect taxes**. When indirect taxes are imposed on goods and services, their prices go up. Indirect taxes accrue to the government. We have to deduct them from NNP evaluated at market prices in order to calculate that part of NNP which actually accrues to the factors of production. Similarly, there may be **subsidies** granted by the government on the prices of some commodities (in India petrol is heavily taxed by the government, whereas cooking gas is subsidised). So we need to add subsidies to the NNP evaluated at market prices. The measure that we obtain by doing so is called **Net National Product at factor cost** or **National Income**.

Thus, $\text{NNP at factor cost} \equiv \text{National Income (NI)} \equiv \text{NNP at market prices} - (\text{Indirect taxes} - \text{Subsidies}) \equiv \text{NNP at market prices} - \text{Net indirect taxes}$ (Net indirect taxes $\equiv$ Indirect taxes – Subsidies)

We can further subdivide the National Income into smaller categories. Let us try to find the expression for the part of NI which is received by households. We shall call this **Personal Income (PI)**. First, let us note that out of NI, which is earned by the firms and government enterprises, a part of profit is not distributed among the factors of production. This is called **Undistributed Profits (UP)**. We have to deduct UP from NI to arrive at PI, since UP does not accrue to the households. Similarly, Corporate Tax, which is imposed on the earnings made by the firms, will also have to be deducted from the NI, since it does not accrue to the households. On the other hand, the households do receive interest payments from private firms or the government on past loans advanced by them. And households may have to pay interests to the firms and the government as well, in case they had borrowed money from either. So, we have to deduct the net interests paid by the households to the firms and government. The households receive transfer payments from government and firms (pensions, scholarship, prizes, for example) which have to be added to calculate the Personal Income of the households.

Thus, Personal Income (PI) $\equiv$ NI – Undistributed profits – **Net interest payments made by households** – **Corporate tax** + **Transfer payments to the households from the government and firms**.

However, even PI is not the income over which the households have complete say. They have to pay taxes from PI. If we deduct the **Personal Tax Payments** (income tax, for example) and **Non-tax Payments** (such as fines) from PI, we obtain what is known as the Personal Disposable Income. Thus

Personal Disposable Income (PDI) $\equiv$ PI – Personal tax payments – Non-tax payments.

Personal Disposable Income is the part of the aggregate income which belongs to the households. They may decide to consume a part of it, and save the rest. In Fig. 2.3 we present a diagrammatic representation of the relations between these major macroeconomic variables.

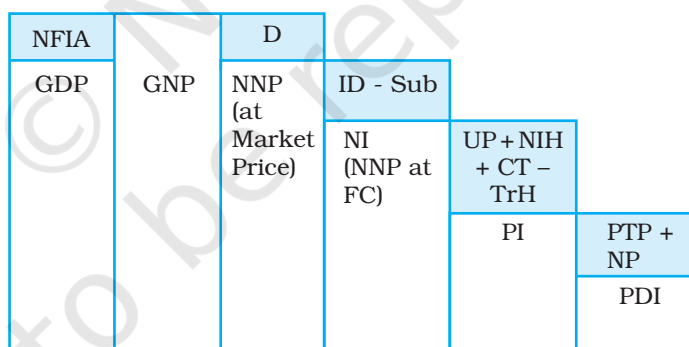


Fig. 2.3: Diagrammatic representation of the subcategories of aggregate income. NFIA: Net Factor Income from Abroad, D: Depreciation, ID: Indirect Taxes, Sub: Subsidies, UP: Undistributed Profits, NIH: Net Interest Payments by Households, CT: Corporate Taxes, TrH: Transfers received by Households, PTP: Personal Tax Payments, NP: Non-Tax Payments.

National Disposable Income and Private Income

Apart from these categories of aggregate macroeconomic variables, in India, a few other aggregate income categories are also used in National Income accounting

- **National Disposable Income** = Net National Product at market prices + Other current transfers from the rest of the world

The idea behind National Disposable Income is that it gives an idea of

what is the maximum amount of goods and services the domestic economy has at its disposal. Current transfers from the rest of the world include items such as gifts, aids, etc.

- **Private Income** = Factor income from net domestic product accruing to the private sector + National debt interest + Net factor income from abroad + Current transfers from government + Other net transfers from the rest of the world.

Table 2.4: Basic National Income Aggregates⁵

1.	Gross Domestic Product at Market Prices (GDP_{MP})	• GDP is the market value of all final goods and services produced within a domestic territory of a country measured in a year. • All production done by the national residents or the non-residents in a country gets included, regardless of whether that production is owned by a local company or a foreign entity. • Everything is valued at market prices. $GDP_{MP} = C + I + G + X - M$
2.	GDP at Factor Cost (GDP_{FC})	• GDP at factor cost is gross domestic product at market prices, less net product taxes. • Market prices are the prices as paid by the consumers. Market prices also include product taxes and subsidies. The term factor cost refers to the prices of products as received by the producers. Thus, factor cost is equal to market prices, minus net indirect taxes. GDP at factor cost measures money value of output produced by the firms within the domestic boundaries of a country in a year. $GDP_{FC} = GDP_{MP} - NIT$
3.	Net Domestic Product at Market Prices (NDP_{MP})	• This measure allows policy-makers to estimate how much the country has to spend just to maintain their current GDP. If the country is not able to replace the capital stock lost through depreciation, then GDP will fall. $NDP_{MP} = GDP_{MP} - Dep.$
4.	NDP at Factor Cost (NDP_{FC})	• NDP at factor cost is the income earned by the factors in the form of wages, profits, rent, interest, etc., within the domestic territory of a country. $NDP_{FC} = NDP_{MP} - \text{Net Product Taxes} - \text{Net Production Taxes}$

⁵Following the System of National Accounts 2008 (SNA2008) given by the United Nations in partnership with some other agencies, countries are now switching to new aggregates. India shifted to these aggregates a few years back.

5.	Gross National Product at Market Prices (GNP_{MP})	GNP_{MP} is the value of all the final goods and services that are produced by the normal residents of India and is measured at the market prices, in a year. GNP refers to all the economic output produced by a nation's normal residents, whether they are located within the national boundary or abroad. - Everything is valued at the market prices. $GNP_{MP} = GDP_{MP} + NFIA$
6.	GNP at Factor Cost (GNP_{FC})	GNP at factor cost measures value of output received by the factors of production belonging to a country in a year. $GNP_{FC} = GNP_{MP} - \text{Net Product Taxes} - \text{Net Production Taxes}$
7.	Net National Product at Market Prices (NNP_{MP})	This is a measure of how much a country can consume in a given period of time. NNP measures output regardless of where that production has taken place (in domestic territory or abroad). $NNP_{MP} = GNP_{MP} - \text{Depreciation}$ $NNP_{MP} = NDP_{MP} + NFIA$
8.	NNP at Factor Cost (NNP_{FC}) Or National Income (NI)	NNP at factor cost is the sum of income earned by all factors in the production in the form of wages, profits, rent and interest, etc., belonging to a country during a year. - It is the National Product and is not bound by production in the national boundaries. It is the net domestic factor income added with the net factor income from abroad. $NI = NNP_{MP} - \text{Net Product Taxes} - \text{Net Production Taxes}$ $= NDP_{FC} + NFIA = NNP_{FC}$
9.	GVA at Market Prices	GDP at market prices
10.	GVA at basic prices	$GVA_{MP} - \text{Net Product Taxes}$
11.	GVA at factor cost	GVA at basic prices - Net Production Taxes

2.4 NOMINAL AND REAL GDP

One implicit assumption in all this discussion is that the prices of goods and services do not change during the period of our study. If prices change, then there may be difficulties in comparing GDPs. If we measure the GDP of a country in two consecutive years and see that the figure for GDP of the latter year is twice that of the previous year, we may conclude that the volume of production of the country has doubled. But it is possible that only prices of all goods and services have doubled between the two years whereas the production has remained constant.

Therefore, in order to compare the GDP figures (and other macroeconomic variables) of different countries or to compare the GDP figures of the same country at different points of time, we cannot rely on GDPs evaluated at current market prices. For comparison we take the help of **real GDP**. Real GDP is calculated in a way such that the goods and services are evaluated at some **constant set of prices** (or **constant prices**). Since these prices remain fixed, if the Real GDP changes we can be sure that it is the volume of production which is undergoing changes. **Nominal GDP**, on the other hand, is simply the value of GDP at the current prevailing prices. For example, suppose a country only produces bread. In the year 2000 it had produced 100 units of bread, price was Rs 10 per bread. GDP at current price was Rs 1,000. In 2001 the same country produced 110 units of bread at price Rs 15 per bread. Therefore nominal GDP in 2001 was Rs 1,650 (=110 × Rs 15). Real GDP in 2001 calculated at the price of the year 2000 (2000 will be called the base year) will be 110 × Rs 10 = Rs 1,100.

Notice that the ratio of nominal GDP to real GDP gives us an idea of how the prices have moved from the **base year** (the year whose prices are being used to calculate the real GDP) to the current year. In the calculation of real and nominal GDP of the current year, the volume of production is fixed. Therefore, if these measures differ it is only due to change in the price level between the base year and the current year. The ratio of nominal to real GDP is a well known index of prices. This is called **GDP Deflator**. Thus if GDP stands for nominal GDP and gdp stands for real GDP then, $\text{GDP deflator} = \frac{\text{GDP}}{\text{gdp}}$.

Sometimes the deflator is also denoted in percentage terms. In such a case $\text{deflator} = \frac{\text{GDP}}{\text{gdp}} \times 100$ per cent. In the previous example, the GDP deflator is $\frac{1,650}{1,100} = 1.50$ (in percentage terms this is 150 per cent). This implies that the price of bread produced in 2001 was 1.5 times the price in 2000. Which is true because price of bread has indeed gone up from Rs 10 to Rs 15. Like GDP deflator, we can have GNP deflator as well.

There is another way to measure change of prices in an economy which is known as the **Consumer Price Index (CPI)**. This is the index of prices of a given basket of commodities which are bought by the representative consumer. CPI is generally expressed in percentage terms. We have two years under consideration – one is the base year, the other is the current year. We calculate the cost of purchase of a given basket of commodities in the base year. We also calculate the cost of purchase of the same basket in the current year. Then we express the latter as a percentage of the former. This gives us the Consumer Price Index of the current year vis-à-vis the base year. For example let us take an economy which produces two goods, rice and cloth. A representative consumer buys 90 kg of rice and 5 pieces of cloth in a year. Suppose in the

year 2000 the price of a kg of rice was Rs 10 and a piece of cloth was Rs 100. So the consumer had to spend a total sum of $\text{Rs } 10 \times 90 = \text{Rs } 900$ on rice in 2000. Similarly, she spent $\text{Rs } 100 \times 5 = \text{Rs } 500$ per year on cloth. Summation of the two items is, $\text{Rs } 900 + \text{Rs } 500 = \text{Rs } 1,400$.

Now suppose the prices of a kg of rice and a piece of cloth has gone up to Rs 15 and Rs 120 in the year 2005. To buy the same quantity of rice and clothes the representative will have to spend Rs 1,350 and Rs 600 respectively (calculated in a similar way as before). Their sum will be, $\text{Rs } 1,350 + \text{Rs } 600 = \text{Rs } 1,950$. The CPI therefore will be $\frac{1,950}{1,400} \times 100 = 139.29$ (approximately).

It is worth noting that many commodities have two sets of prices. One is the retail price which the consumer actually pays. The other is the wholesale price, the price at which goods are traded in bulk. These two may differ in value because of the margin kept by traders. Goods which are traded in bulk (such as raw materials or semi-finished goods) are not purchased by ordinary consumers. Like CPI, the index for wholesale prices is called **Wholesale Price Index (WPI)**. In countries like USA it is referred to as Producer Price Index (PPI). Notice CPI (and analogously WPI) may differ from GDP deflator because

1. The goods purchased by consumers do not represent all the goods which are produced in a country. GDP deflator takes into account all such goods and services.
2. CPI includes prices of goods consumed by the representative consumer, hence it includes prices of imported goods. GDP deflator does not include prices of imported goods.
3. The weights are constant in CPI – but they differ according to production level of each good in GDP deflator.

2.5 GDP AND WELFARE

Can the GDP of a country be taken as an index of the welfare of the people of that country? If a person has more income he or she can buy more goods and services and his or her material well-being improves. So it may seem reasonable to treat his or her income level as his or her level of well-being. GDP is the sum total of value of goods and services created within the geographical boundary of a country in a particular year. It gets distributed among the people as incomes (except for retained earnings). So we may be tempted to treat higher level of GDP of a country as an index of greater well-being of the people of that country (to account for price changes, we may take the value of real GDP instead of nominal GDP). But there are at least three reasons why this may not be correct.

1. **Distribution of GDP – how uniform is it:** If the GDP of the country is rising, the welfare may not rise as a consequence. This is because the rise in GDP may be concentrated in the hands of very few individuals or firms. For the rest, the income may in fact have fallen. In such a case the welfare of the entire country cannot be said to have increased. For example, suppose in year 2000, an imaginary country had 100 individuals each earning Rs 10. Therefore the GDP of the country was Rs 1,000 (by income method). In 2001, let us suppose the same country had 90 individuals earning Rs 9 each, and the rest 10 individual earning Rs 20 each. Suppose there had been no change in the prices of goods and services between these two periods. The GDP of the country in the year 2001 was $90 \times (\text{Rs } 9) + 10 \times (\text{Rs } 20) = \text{Rs } 810 + \text{Rs } 200 = \text{Rs } 1,010$. Observe that

compared to 2000, the GDP of the country in 2001 was higher by Rs 10. But this has happened when 90 per cent of people of the country have seen a drop in their real income by 10 per cent (from Rs 10 to Rs 9), whereas only 10 per cent have benefited by a rise in their income by 100 per cent (from Rs 10 to Rs 20). 90 per cent of the people are worse off though the GDP of the country has gone up. If we relate welfare improvement in the country to the percentage of people who are better off, then surely GDP is not a good index.

2. **Non-monetary exchanges:** Many activities in an economy are not evaluated in monetary terms. For example, the domestic services women perform at home are not paid for. The exchanges which take place in the informal sector without the help of money are called barter exchanges. In barter exchanges, goods (or services) are directly exchanged against each other. But since money is not being used here, these exchanges are not registered as part of economic activity. In developing countries, where many remote regions are underdeveloped, these kinds of exchanges do take place, but they are generally not counted in the GDPs of these countries. This is a case of underestimation of GDP. Hence, GDP calculated in the standard manner may not give us a clear indication of the productive activity and well-being of a country.



How uniform is the distribution of GDP? It still seems that a majority of the people are poor and a few benefited.

3. **Externalities:** Externalities refer to the benefits (or harms) a firm or an individual causes to another for which they are not paid (or penalised). Externalities do not have any market in which they can be bought and sold. For example, let us suppose there is an oil refinery which refines crude petroleum and sells it in the market. The output of the refinery is the amount of oil it refines. We can estimate the value added of the refinery by deducting the value of intermediate goods used by the refinery (crude oil in this case) from the value of its output. The value added of the refinery will be counted as part of the GDP of the economy. But in carrying out the production the refinery may also be polluting the nearby river. This may cause harm to the people who use the water of the river. Hence their well being will fall. Pollution may also kill fish or other organisms of the river on which fish survive. As a result, the fishermen of the river may be losing their livelihood. Such harmful effects that the refinery is inflicting on others, for which it will not bear any cost, are called externalities. In this case, the GDP is not taking into account such negative externalities. Therefore, if we take GDP as a measure of welfare of the economy we shall be overestimating the actual welfare. This was an example of negative externality. There can be cases of positive externalities as well. In such cases, GDP will underestimate the actual welfare of the economy.

Summary

At a very fundamental level, the macroeconomy (it refers to the economy that we study in macroeconomics) can be seen as working in a circular way. The firms employ inputs supplied by households and produce goods and services to be sold to households. Households get the remuneration from the firms for the services rendered by them and buy goods and services produced by the firms. So we can calculate the aggregate value of goods and services produced in the economy by any of the three methods (a) measuring the aggregate value of factor payments (income method) (b) measuring the aggregate value of goods and services produced by the firms (product method) (c) measuring the aggregate value of spending received by the firms (expenditure method). In the product method, to avoid double counting, we need to deduct the value of intermediate goods and take into account only the aggregate value of final goods and services. We derive the formulae for calculating the aggregate income of an economy by each of these methods. We also take note that goods can also be bought for making investments and these add to the productive capacity of the investing firms. There may be different categories of aggregate income depending on whom these are accruing to. We have pointed out the difference between GDP, GNP, NNP at market price, NNP at factor cost, PI and PDI. Since prices of goods and services may vary, we have discussed how to calculate the three important price indices (GDP deflator, CPI, WPI). Finally we have noted that it may be incorrect to treat GDP as an index of the welfare of the country.

Key Concepts

Final goods	Consumption goods
Consumer durables	Capital goods
Intermediate goods	Stocks
Flows	Gross investment
Net investment	Depreciation
Wage	Interest
Profit	Rent
Circular flow of income	Product method of calculating National Income
Expenditure method of calculating National Income	Income method of calculating National Income
Macroeconomic model	Input
Value added	Inventories
Planned change in inventories	Unplanned change in inventories
Gross Domestic Product (GDP)	Net Domestic Product (NDP)
Gross National Product (GNP)	Net National Product (NNP) (at market price)
NNP (at factor cost) or National Income (NI)	Undistributed profits
Net interest payments made by households	Corporate tax
Transfer payments to the households from the government and firms	Personal Income (PI)
Personal tax payments	Non-tax payments
Personal Disposable Income (PDI)	National Disposable Income

Private Income	Nominal GDP
Real GDP	Base year
GDP Deflator	Consumer Price Index (CPI)
Wholesale Price Index (WPI)	Externalities



1. What are the four factors of production and what are the remunerations to each of these called?
2. Why should the aggregate final expenditure of an economy be equal to the aggregate factor payments? Explain.
3. Distinguish between stock and flow. Between net investment and capital which is a stock and which is a flow? Compare net investment and capital with flow of water into a tank.
4. What is the difference between planned and unplanned inventory accumulation? Write down the relation between change in inventories and value added of a firm.
5. Write down the three identities of calculating the GDP of a country by the three methods. Also briefly explain why each of these should give us the same value of GDP.
6. Define budget deficit and trade deficit. The excess of private investment over saving of a country in a particular year was Rs 2,000 crores. The amount of budget deficit was (–) Rs 1,500 crores. What was the volume of trade deficit of that country?
7. Suppose the GDP at market price of a country in a particular year was Rs 1,100 crores. Net Factor Income from Abroad was Rs 100 crores. The value of Indirect taxes – Subsidies was Rs 150 crores and National Income was Rs 850 crores. Calculate the aggregate value of depreciation.
8. Net National Product at Factor Cost of a particular country in a year is Rs 1,900 crores. There are no interest payments made by the households to the firms/government, or by the firms/government to the households. The Personal Disposable Income of the households is Rs 1,200 crores. The personal income taxes paid by them is Rs 600 crores and the value of retained earnings of the firms and government is valued at Rs 200 crores. What is the value of transfer payments made by the government and firms to the households?
9. From the following data, calculate Personal Income and Personal Disposable Income.

Rs (crore)

(a) Net Domestic Product at factor cost	8,000
(b) Net Factor Income from abroad	200
(c) Undisbursed Profit	1,000
(d) Corporate Tax	500
(e) Interest Received by Households	1,500
(f) Interest Paid by Households	1,200
(g) Transfer Income	300
(h) Personal Tax	500

10. In a single day Raju, the barber, collects Rs 500 from haircuts; over this day, his equipment depreciates in value by Rs 50. Of the remaining Rs 450, Raju pays sales tax worth Rs 30, takes home Rs 200 and retains Rs 220 for improvement and buying of new equipment. He further pays Rs 20 as income tax from his income. Based on this information, complete Raju's contribution to the following measures of income (a) Gross Domestic Product (b) NNP



at market price (c) NNP at factor cost (d) Personal income (e) Personal disposable income.

11. The value of the nominal GNP of an economy was Rs 2,500 crores in a particular year. The value of GNP of that country during the same year, evaluated at the prices of same base year, was Rs 3,000 crores. Calculate the value of the GNP deflator of the year in percentage terms. Has the price level risen between the base year and the year under consideration?
12. Write down some of the limitations of using GDP as an index of welfare of a country.

Suggested Readings

1. Bhaduri, A., 1990. *Macroeconomics: The Dynamics of Commodity Production*, pages 1 – 27, Macmillan India Limited, New Delhi.
2. Branson, W. H., 1992. *Macroeconomic Theory and Policy*, (third edition), pages 15 – 34, Harper Collins Publishers India Pvt Ltd., New Delhi.
3. Dornbusch, R and S. Fischer. 1988. *Macroeconomics*, (fourth edition) pages 29–62, McGraw Hill, Paris.
4. Mankiw, N. G., 2000. *Macroeconomics*, (fourth edition) pages 15–76, Macmillan Worth Publishers, New York.

Table 2.5: GVA and GDP for India at constant (2022–23) prices

S.No.	Item	PE (Provisional Estimates) 2022–23 (Amount In ₹ Crore)
1.	GVA at basic prices	14764840
2.	Net production taxes	1241585
3.	GDP (1+2)	16006425

Source: Annual Report, Reserve Bank of India, 2022–23
(Handbook of Statistics on Indian Economy)

^eThese are provisional estimates released by the CSO in 2018.

**Table 2.6: Components of Gross Domestic Product (2011-12)
Constant Prices**

S.No.	Item	(Provisional Estimates) 2022-23 (Rs. In Crore)
1.	Private Final Consumption Expenditure (PFCE)	9358694
2.	Government Final Consumption Expenditure (GFCE)	1577306
3.	Gross Fixed Capital Formation (GFCF)	5434691
4.	Change in Stocks	127463
5.	Valuables	226089
	Investment (3+4+5)	5788243
6.	Exports of Goods and Services	3754521
7.	Imports of Goods and Services	4091375
	Net Exports (6-7)	336854
8.	Discrepancies	380964
9.	GDP (1+2+3+4+5+6-7+8)	16006425

Source: Annual Report, Reserve Bank of India, 2022-23 (Handbook of Statistics on Indian Economy)

Chapter 3



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Money and Banking



Money is the commonly accepted medium of exchange. In an economy which consists of only one individual there cannot be any exchange of commodities and hence there is no role for money. Even if there is more than one individual but these individuals do not take part in market transactions, example: family living on an isolated island, money has no function for them. However, as soon as there is more than one economic agent who engage themselves in transactions through the market, money becomes an important instrument for facilitating these exchanges. Economic exchanges without the mediation of money are referred to as *barter exchanges*. However, they presume the rather improbable *double coincidence of wants*. Consider, for example, an individual who has a surplus of rice which she wishes to exchange for clothing. If she is not lucky enough she may not be able to find another person who has the diametrically opposite demand for rice with a surplus of clothing to offer in exchange. The search costs may become prohibitive as the number of individuals increases. Thus, to smoothen the transaction, an intermediate good is necessary which is acceptable to both parties. Such a good is called money. The individuals can then sell their produces for money and use this money to purchase the commodities they need. Though facilitation of exchanges is considered to be the principal role of money, it serves other purposes as well. Following are the main functions of money in a modern economy.

3.1 FUNCTIONS OF MONEY

As explained above, the first and foremost role of money is that it acts as a *medium of exchange*. Barter exchanges become extremely difficult in a large economy because of the high costs people would have to incur looking for suitable persons to exchange their surpluses.

Money also acts as a convenient *unit of account*. The value of all goods and services can be expressed in monetary units. When we say that the value of a certain wristwatch is Rs 500 we mean that the wristwatch can be exchanged for 500 units of money, where a unit of money is rupee in this case. If the price of a pencil is Rs 2 and that of a pen is Rs 10 we can calculate the relative price of a pen with respect to a pencil, viz. a pen is worth $10 \div 2 = 5$ pencils. The same notion can be used to calculate the value of

money itself with respect to other commodities. In the above example, a rupee is worth $1 \div 2 = 0.5$ pencil or $1 \div 10 = 0.1$ pen. Thus if prices of all commodities increase in terms of money i.e., there is a general increase in the price level, the value of money in terms of any commodity must have decreased – in the sense that a unit of money can now purchase less of any commodity. We call it a deterioration in the purchasing power of money.

A barter system has other deficiencies. It is difficult to carry forward one's wealth under the barter system. Suppose you have an endowment of rice which you do not wish to consume today entirely. You may regard this stock of surplus rice as an asset which you may wish to consume, or even sell off, for acquiring other commodities at some future date. But rice is a perishable item and cannot be stored beyond a certain period. Also, holding the stock of rice requires a lot of space. You may have to spend considerable time and resources looking for people with a demand for rice when you wish to exchange your stock for buying other commodities. This problem can be solved if you sell your rice for money. Money is not perishable and its storage costs are also considerably lower. It is also acceptable to anyone at any point of time. Thus money can act as a *store of value* for individuals. Wealth can be stored in the form of money for future use. However, to perform this function well, the value of money must be sufficiently stable. A rising price level may erode the purchasing power of money. It may be noted that any asset other than money can also act as a store of value, e.g. gold, landed property, houses or even bonds (to be introduced shortly). However, they may not be easily convertible to other commodities and do not have universal acceptability.

Some countries have made an attempt to move towards an economy which use less of cash and more of digital transactions. A cashless society describes an economic state whereby financial transactions are not connected with money in the form of physical bank notes or coins but rather through the transfer of digital information (usually an electronic representation of money) between the transacting parties. In India government has been consistently investing in various reforms for greater financial inclusion. During the last few years' initiatives such as Jan Dhan accounts, Aadhar enabled payment systems, e-Wallets, National financial Switch (NFS) and others have strengthened the government resolve to go cashless. Today, financial inclusion is seen as a realistic dream because of mobile and smart phone penetration across the country.

3.2 DEMAND FOR MONEY AND SUPPLY OF MONEY

3.2.1. Demand for Money

The demand for money tells us what makes people desire a certain amount of money. Since money is required to conduct transactions, the value of transactions will determine the money people will want to keep: the larger is the quantum of transactions to be made, the larger is the quantity of money demanded. Since the quantum of transactions to be made depends on income, it should be clear that a rise in income will lead to rise in demand for money. Also, when people keep their savings in the form of money rather than putting it in a bank which gives them interest, how much money people keep also depends on rate of interest. Specifically, when interest rates go up, people become less interested in holding money since holding money amounts to holding less of interest-earning deposits, and thus less interest received. Therefore, at higher interest rates, money demanded comes down.

3.2.2. Supply of Money

In a modern economy, money comprises cash and bank deposits. Depending on what types of bank deposits are being included, there are many measures of money¹. These are created by a system comprising two types of institutions: central bank of the economy and the commercial banking system.

Central bank

Central Bank is a very important institution in a modern economy. Almost every country has one central bank. India got its central bank in 1935. Its name is the 'Reserve Bank of India'. Central bank has several important functions. It issues the currency of the country. It controls money supply of the country through various methods, like bank rate, open market operations and variations in reserve ratios. It acts as a banker to the government. It is the custodian of the foreign exchange reserves of the economy. It also acts as a bank to the banking system, which is discussed in detail later.

From the point of view of money supply, we need to focus on its function of issuing currency. This currency issued by the central bank can be held by the public or by the commercial banks, and is called the 'high-powered money' or 'reserve money' or 'monetary base' as it acts as a basis for credit creation.

Commercial Banks

Commercial banks are the other type of institutions which are a part of the money-creating system of the economy. In the following section we look at the commercial banking system in detail. They accept deposits from the public and lend out part of these funds to those who want to borrow. The interest rate paid by the banks to depositors is lower than the rate charged from the borrowers. This difference between these two types of interest rates, called the 'spread' is the profit appropriated by the bank.

The process of deposit and loan (credit) creation by banks is explained below. In order to understand this process, let us discuss a story.

Once there was a goldsmith named Lala in a village. In this village, people used gold and other precious metals in order to buy goods and services. In other words, these metals were acting as money. People in the village started keeping their gold with Lala for safe-keeping. In return for keeping their gold, Lala issued paper receipts to people of the village and charged a small fee from them. Slowly, over time, the paper receipts issued by Lala began to circulate as money. This means that instead of giving gold for purchasing wheat, someone would pay for wheat or shoes or any other good by giving the paper receipts issued by Lala. Thus, the paper receipts started acting as money since everyone in the village accepted these as a medium of exchange.

Now, let us suppose that Lala had 100 Kgs of gold, deposited by different people and he had issued receipts corresponding to 100 kgs of gold. At this time Ramu comes to Lala and asks for a loan of 25 kgs of gold. Can Lala give the loan? The 100 kgs of gold with him already has claimants. However, Lala could decide that everyone with gold deposits will not come to withdraw their deposits at the same time and so he may as well give the loan to Ramu and charge him for it. If Lala gives the loan of 25 kgs of gold, Ramu could also pay Ali with these 25 kgs of gold and Ali could keep the 25 kgs of gold with Lala in return for a paper receipt. In effect, the paper receipts, acting as money, would

¹See the box on the measures of money supply at the end of the chapter.

have risen to 125 kgs now. It seems that Lala has created money out of thin air! The modern banking system works precisely the way Lala behaves in this example.

Commercial banks mediate between individuals or firms with excess funds and lend to those who need funds. People with excess funds can keep their funds in the form of deposits in banks and those who need funds, borrow funds in form of home loans, crop loans, etc. People prefer to keep money in banks because banks offer to pay some interest on any deposits made. Also, it may be safer to keep excess funds in a bank, rather than at home, just as people in the example above preferred to keep their gold with Lala instead of keeping at home. In the modern context, given cheques and debit cards, having a demand deposit makes transactions more convenient and safer, even when they do not earn any interest. (Imagine having to pay a large amount in cash – for purchasing a house.)

What does the bank do with the funds that have been deposited with it? Assuming that not everyone who has deposited funds with it will ask for their funds back at the same time, the bank can loan these funds to someone who needs the funds at interest (of course, the bank has to be sure it will get the funds back at the required time). So the bank will typically retain a portion of the funds to repay depositors whenever they demand their funds back, and loan the rest. Since banks earn interest from loans they make, any bank would like to lend the maximum possible. However, being able to repay depositors on demand is crucial to the bank's survival. Depositors would keep their funds in a bank only if they are fully confident of getting them back on demand. A bank must, therefore, balance its lending activities so as to ensure that sufficient funds are available to repay any depositor on demand.

3.3 MONEY CREATION BY BANKING SYSTEM

Banks can create money in a manner similar to that as given in Lala's story. Banks can lend simply because they do not expect all the depositors to withdraw what they have deposited at the same time. When the banks lend to any person, a new deposit is opened in that person's name. Thus money supply increases to old deposits plus new deposit (plus currency.)

Let us take an example. Assume that there is only one bank in the country. Let us construct a fictional balance sheet for this bank. Balance sheet is a record of assets and liabilities of any firm. Conventionally, the assets of the firm are recorded on the left hand side and liabilities on the right hand side. Accounting rules say that both sides of the balance sheet must be equal or total assets must be equal to the total liabilities. **Assets** are things a firm owns or what a firm can claim from others. In case of a bank, apart from buildings, furniture, etc., its assets are loans given to public. When the bank gives out loan of Rs 100 to a person, this is the bank's claim on that person for Rs 100. Another asset that a bank has is reserves. Reserves are deposits which commercial banks keep with the Central bank, Reserve Bank of India (RBI) and its cash. These reserves are kept partly as cash and partly in the form of financial instruments (bonds and treasury bills) issued by the RBI. Reserves are similar to deposits we keep with banks. We keep deposits and these deposits are our assets, they can be withdrawn by us. Similarly, commercial banks like State Bank of India (SBI) keep their deposits with RBI and these are called Reserves.

$$\text{Assets} = \text{Reserves} + \text{Loans}$$

Liabilities for any firm are its debts or what it owes to others. For a bank, the main liability is the deposits which people keep with it.

$$\text{Liabilities} = \text{Deposits}$$

The accounting rule states that both sides of the account must balance. Hence if assets are greater than liabilities, they are recorded on the right hand side as Net Worth.

$$\text{Net Worth} = \text{Assets} - \text{Liabilities}$$

3.3.1 Balance Sheet of a Fictional Bank

Let our fictional bank start with deposits (liabilities) equal to Rs 100. This could be because Ms Fernandes has deposited Rs 100 in the bank. Let this bank deposit the same amount with RBI as reserves. Table 3.1 represents its balance sheet.

3.1 Balance Sheet of a Bank

Assets		Liabilities	
Reserves	Rs 100	Deposits	Rs 100
		Net Worth	Rs 0
Total	Rs 100	Total	Rs 100

If we assume that there is no currency in circulation, then the total money supply in the economy will be equal to Rs 100.

$$M_1 = \text{Currency} + \text{Deposits} = 0 + 100 = 100$$

3.3.2 Limits to Credit Creation and Money Multiplier

Suppose Mr. Mathew comes to this bank for a loan of Rs 500. Can our bank give this loan? If it gives the loan and Mr Mathew deposits the loan amount in the bank itself, the total bank deposits and therefore, the total money supply will rise. It seems as though the banks can go on creating as much money as they want.

But is there a limit to money or credit creation by banks? Yes, and this is determined by the Central bank (RBI). The RBI decides a certain percentage of deposits which every bank must keep as reserves. This is done to ensure that no bank is 'over lending'. This is a legal requirement and is binding on the banks. This is called the 'Required Reserve Ratio' or the 'Reserve Ratio' or 'Cash Reserve Ratio' (CRR).

Cash Reserve Ratio (CRR) = Percentage of deposits which a bank must keep as cash reserves with the bank.

Apart from the CRR, banks are also required to keep some reserves in liquid form in the short term. This ratio is called Statutory Liquidity Ratio or SLR.

In our fictional example, suppose CRR = 20 per cent, then with deposits of Rs 100, our bank will need to keep Rs 20 (20 per cent of 100) as cash reserves. Only the remaining amount of deposits, i.e., Rs 80 (100 – 20 = 80) can be used to give loans. The statutory requirement of the reserve ratio acts as a limit to the amount of credit that banks can create.

We can understand this by going back to our fictional example of an economy with one bank. Let us assume that our bank starts with a deposit of Rs 100 made by Leela. The reserve ratio is 20 per cent. Thus our bank has Rs 80 (100 – 20)

to lend and the bank lends out Rs 80 to Jaspal Kaur, which shows up in the bank's deposits in the next round as liabilities, making a total of Rs 180 as deposits. Now our bank is required to keep 20 per cent of 180 i.e. Rs 36 as cash reserves. Recall that our bank had started with Rs 100 as cash. Since it is required to keep only Rs 36 as reserves, it can lend Rs 64 again ($100 - 36 = 64$). The bank lends out Rs 64 to Junaid. This in turn shows up in the bank as deposits. The process keeps repeating itself till all the required reserves become Rs 100. The required reserves will be Rs 100 only when the total deposits become Rs 500. This is because for deposits of Rs 500, cash reserves would have to be Rs 100 (20 per cent of $500 = 100$). The process is illustrated in Table 3.2.

Table 3.2: **Money Multiplier Process**

Column 1	Column 2	Column 3	Column 4
Round	Deposit in Bank	Required Reserve	Loan made by Bank
1	100.00	20.00	80.00
2	180.00	36.00	64.00
.	.	.	.
.	.	.	.
.	.	.	.
.	.	.	.
...	.	.	.
Last	500.00	100.00	400.00

The first column lists each round. The second column depicts the total deposits with the bank at the beginning of each round. Twenty per cent of these deposits need to be deposited with the RBI as required reserves (column 3). What the bank lends in each round gets added to the deposits with the bank in the next round. Column 4 indicates the Loans made by the banks.

Table 3.3: **Balance Sheet of the Bank**

Assets		Liabilities	
Reserves	Rs 100	Deposits (100+400)	Rs 500
Loans	Rs 400		
Total	Rs 500	Total	Rs 500

Since the bank is only expected to keep 20 per cent of its deposits as reserves, thus, reserves of Rs 100 (20 per cent of 500 = 100) can support the deposits of Rs 500. In other words, our bank can give a loan of Rs 400. Table 3.3 demonstrates its balance sheet.

$$M_1 = \text{Currency} + \text{Deposits} = 0 + 500 = 500$$

Thus, money supply increases from Rs 100 to Rs 500.

Given a CRR of 20 per cent, the bank cannot give a loan beyond Rs 400. Hence, requirement of reserves acts as a limit to money creation.

$$\text{Money Multiplier} = \frac{1}{\text{Cash Reserve Ratio}}$$

In our example, money multiplier = $\frac{1}{20\%} = \frac{1}{0.2} = 5$. Thus, reserves of Rs 100 create deposits of Rs (5 X 100)=Rs 500.

3.4 POLICY TOOLS TO CONTROL MONEY SUPPLY

Reserve Bank is the only institution which can issue currency. When commercial banks need more funds in order to be able to create more credit, they may go to market for such funds or go to the Central Bank. Central bank provides them funds through various instruments. This role of RBI, that of being ready to lend to banks at all times is another important function of the central bank, and due to this central bank is said to be the **lender of last resort**.

The RBI controls the money supply in the economy in various ways. The tools used by the Central bank to control money supply can be quantitative or qualitative. Quantitative tools, control the extent of money supply by changing the CRR, or bank rate or open market operations. Qualitative tools include persuasion by the Central bank in order to make commercial banks discourage or encourage lending which is done through moral suasion, margin requirement, etc.

It should be evident by now that if the Central bank changes the reserve ratio, this would lead to changes in lending by the banks which, in turn, would impact the deposits and hence, the money supply. In the previously discussed example, what would the money multiplier be if the RBI increases the reserve ratio to 25 per cent? Notice that in the previous case, Rs 100 in reserves could support deposits of Rs 400. But the banking system would now be able to loan Rs 300 only. It would have to call back some loans to meet the increased reserve requirements. Hence, money supply would fall.

Another important tool by which the RBI also influences money supply is **Open Market Operations**. Open Market Operations refers to buying and selling of bonds issued by the Government in the open market. This purchase and sale is entrusted to the Central bank on behalf of the Government. When RBI buys a Government bond in the open market, it pays for it by giving a cheque. This cheque increases the total amount of reserves in the economy and thus increases the money supply. Selling of a bond by RBI (to private individuals or institutions) leads to reduction in quantity of reserves and hence the money supply.

There are two types of open market operations: outright and repo. Outright open market operations are permanent in nature: when the central bank buys these securities (thus injecting money into the system), it is without any promise to sell them later. Similarly, when the central bank sells these securities (thus withdrawing money from the system), it is without any promise to buy them

later. As a result, the injection/absorption of the money is of permanent nature. However, there is another type of operation in which when the central bank buys the security, this agreement of purchase also has specification about date and price of resale of this security. This type of agreement is called a **repurchase agreement** or **repo**. The interest rate at which the money is lent in this way is called the repo rate. Similarly, instead of outright sale of securities the central bank may sell the securities through an agreement which has a specification about the date and price at which it will be repurchased. This type of agreement is called a **reverse repurchase agreement** or **reverse repo**. The rate at which the money is withdrawn in this manner is called the reverse repo rate. The Reserve Bank of India conducts repo and reverse repo operations at various maturities: overnight, 7-day, 14- day, etc. This type of operations have now become the main tool of monetary policy of the Reserve Bank of India.

The RBI can influence money supply by changing the rate at which it gives loans to the commercial banks. This rate is called the **Bank Rate** in India. By increasing the bank rate, loans taken by commercial banks become more expensive; this reduces the reserves held by the commercial bank and hence decreases money supply. A fall in the bank rate can increase the money supply.

Box 3.1: Demand and Supply for Money : A Detailed Discussion

Money is the most liquid of all assets in the sense that it is universally acceptable and hence can be exchanged for other commodities very easily. On the other hand, it has an opportunity cost. If, instead of holding on to a certain cash balance, you put the money in a fixed deposits in some bank you can earn interest on that money. While deciding on how much money to hold at a certain point of time one has to consider the trade off between the advantage of liquidity and the disadvantage of the foregone interest. Demand for money balance is thus often referred to as liquidity preference. People desire to hold money balance broadly from two motives.

The Transaction Motive

The principal motive for holding money is to carry out transactions. If you receive your income weekly and pay your bills on the first day of every week, you need not hold any cash balance throughout the rest of the week; you may as well ask your employer to deduct your expenses directly from your weekly salary and deposit the balance in your bank account. But our expenditure patterns do not normally match our receipts. People earn incomes at discrete points in time and spend it continuously throughout the interval. Suppose you earn Rs 100 on the first day of every month and run down this balance evenly over the rest of the month. Thus your cash balance at the beginning and end of the month are Rs 100 and 0, respectively. Your average cash holding can then be calculated as $(Rs\ 100 + Rs\ 0) \div 2 = Rs\ 50$, with which you are making transactions worth Rs 100 per month. Hence your average transaction demand for money is equal to half your monthly income, or, in other words, half the value of your monthly transactions.

Consider, next, a two-person economy consisting of two entities – a firm (owned by one person) and a worker. The firm pays the worker a salary of Rs 100 at the beginning of every month. The worker, in turn,

spends this income over the month on the output produced by the firm – the only good available in this economy! Thus, at the beginning of each month the worker has a money balance of Rs 100 and the firm a balance of Rs 0. On the last day of the month the picture is reversed – the firm has gathered a balance of Rs 100 through its sales to the worker. The average money holding of the firm as well as the worker is equal to Rs 50 each. Thus the total transaction demand for money in this economy is equal to Rs 100. The total volume of monthly transactions in this economy is Rs 200 – the firm has sold its output worth Rs 100 to the worker and the latter has sold her services worth Rs 100 to the firm. The transaction demand for money of the economy is again a fraction of the total volume of transactions in the economy over the unit period of time.

In general, therefore, the transaction demand for money in an economy, M_T^d , can be written in the following form

$$M_T^d = k.T \quad (3.1)$$

where, T is the total value of (nominal) transactions in the economy over unit period and k is a positive fraction.

The two-person economy described above can be looked at from another angle. You may perhaps find it surprising that the economy uses money balance worth only Rs 100 for making transactions worth Rs 200 per month. The answer to this riddle is simple – each rupee is changing hands twice a month. On the first day, it is being transferred from the employer's pocket to that of the worker and sometime during the month, it is passing from the worker's hand to the employer's. The number of times a unit of money changes hands during the unit period is called the **velocity of circulation of money**. In the above example, it is 2, inverse of half – the ratio of money balance and the value of transactions. Thus, in general, we may rewrite equation (3.1) in the following form

$$\frac{1}{k}.M_T^d = T, \text{ or, } v.M_T^d = T \quad (3.2)$$

where, $v = 1/k$ is the velocity of circulation. Note that the term on the right hand side of the above equation, T , is a flow variable whereas money demand, M_T^d , is a stock concept – it refers to the stock of money people are willing to hold at a particular point of time. The velocity of money, v , however, has a time dimension. It refers to the number of times every unit of stock changes hand during a unit period of time, say, a month or a year. Thus, the left hand side, $v.M_T^d$, measures the total value of monetary transactions that has been made with this stock in the unit period of time. This is a flow variable and is, therefore, equal to the right hand side.

We are ultimately interested in learning the relationship between the aggregate transaction demand for money of an economy and the (nominal) GDP in a given year. The total value of annual transactions in an economy includes transactions in all intermediate goods and services and is clearly much greater than the nominal GDP. However, normally, there exists a stable, positive relationship between value of transactions and the nominal GDP. An increase in nominal GDP implies an increase in the total value of transactions and hence a greater transaction demand for money from equation (3.1). Thus, in general, equation (3.1) can be modified in the following way

$$M_T^d = kPY \quad (3.3)$$

where Y is the real GDP and P is the general price level or the GDP deflator. The above equation tells us that transaction demand for money is positively related to the real income of an economy and also to its average price level.

The Speculative Motive

An individual may hold her wealth in the form of landed property, bullion, bonds, money etc. For simplicity, let us club all forms of assets other than money together into a single category called 'bonds'. Typically, bonds are papers bearing the promise of a future stream of monetary returns over a certain period of time. These papers are issued by governments or firms for borrowing money from the public and they are tradable in the market. Consider the following two-period bond. A firm wishes to raise a loan of Rs 100 from the public. It issues a bond that assures Rs 10 at the end of the first year and Rs 10 plus the principal of Rs 100 at the end of the second year. Such a bond is said to have a face value of Rs 100, a maturity period of two years and a coupon rate of 10 per cent. Assume that the rate of interest prevailing in your savings bank account is equal to 5 per cent. Naturally you would like to compare the earning from this bond with the interest earning of your savings bank account. The exact question that you would ask is as follows: How much money, if kept in my savings bank account, will generate Rs 10 at the end of one year? Let this amount be X . Therefore

$$X(1 + \frac{5}{100}) = 10$$

In other words,

$$X = \frac{10}{(1 + \frac{5}{100})}$$

This amount, Rs X , is called the present value of Rs 10 discounted at the market rate of interest. Similarly, let Y be the amount of money which if kept in the savings bank account will generate Rs 110 at the end of two years. Thus, the present value of the stream of returns from the bond should be equal to

$$PV = X + Y = \frac{10}{(1 + \frac{5}{100})} + \frac{(10+100)}{(1 + \frac{5}{100})^2}$$

Calculation reveals that it is Rs 109.29 (approx.). It means that if you put Rs 109.29 in your savings bank account it will fetch the same return as the bond. But the seller of the bond is offering the same at a face value of only Rs 100. Clearly the bond is more attractive than the savings bank account and people will rush to get hold of the bond. Competitive bidding will raise the price of the bond above its face value, till price of the bond is equal to its PV. If price rises above the PV the bond becomes less attractive compared to the savings bank account and people would like to get rid of it. The bond will be in excess supply and there will be downward pressure on the bond-price which will bring it back to the PV. It is clear that under competitive assets market condition the price of a bond must always be equal to its present value in equilibrium.

Now consider an increase in the market rate of interest from 5 per cent to 6 per cent. The present value, and hence the price of the same bond, will become

$$\frac{10}{(1 + \frac{6}{100})} + \frac{(10 + 100)}{(1 + \frac{6}{100})^2} = 107.33 \text{ (approx.)}$$

It follows that the price of a bond is inversely related to the market rate of interest.

Different people have different expectations regarding the future movements in the market rate of interest based on their private information regarding the economy. If you think that the market rate of interest should eventually settle down to 8 per cent per annum, then you may consider the current rate of 5 per cent too low to be sustainable over time. You expect interest rate to rise and consequently bond prices to fall. If you are a bond holder a decrease in bond price means a loss to you – similar to a loss you would suffer if the value of a property held by you suddenly depreciates in the market. Such a loss occurring from a falling bond price is called a capital loss to the bond holder. Under such circumstances, you will try to sell your bond and hold money instead. Thus speculations regarding future movements in interest rate and bond prices give rise to the speculative demand for money.

When the interest rate is very high everyone expects it to fall in future and hence anticipates capital gains from bond-holding. Hence people convert their money into bonds. Thus, speculative demand for money is low. When interest rate comes down, more and more people expect it to rise in the future and anticipate capital loss. Thus they convert their bonds into money giving rise to a high speculative demand for money. Hence speculative demand for money is inversely related to the rate of interest. Assuming a simple form, the speculative demand for money can be written as

$$M_s^d = \frac{r_{\max} - r}{r - r_{\min}} \quad (3.4)$$

where r is the market rate of interest and $r_{\max}$ and $r_{\min}$ are the upper and lower limits of r , both positive constants. It is evident from the above equation that as r decreases from $r_{\max}$ to $r_{\min}$, the value of M_s^d increases from 0 to ∞ .

As mentioned earlier, interest rate can be thought of as an opportunity cost or 'price' of holding money balance. If supply of money in the economy increases and people purchase bonds with this extra money, demand for bonds will go up, bond prices will rise and rate of interest will decline.

In other words, with an increased supply of money in the economy the price you have to pay for holding money balance, viz. the rate of interest, should

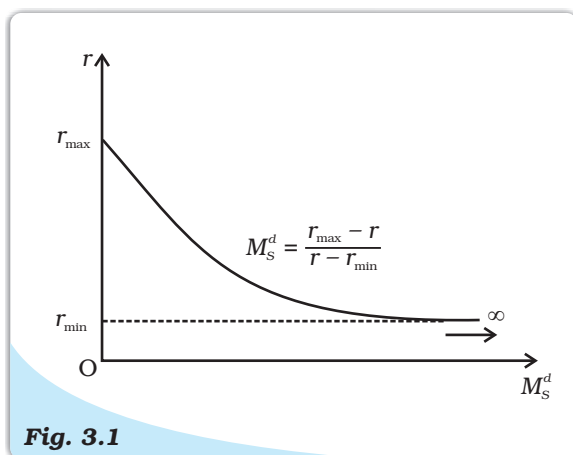


Fig. 3.1

The Speculative Demand for Money

come down. However, if the market rate of interest is already low enough so that everybody expects it to rise in future, causing capital losses, nobody will wish to hold bonds. Everyone in the economy will hold their wealth in money balance and if additional money is injected within the economy it will be used up to satiate people's craving for money balances without increasing the demand for bonds and without further lowering the rate of interest below the floor $r_{\min}$. Such a situation is called a **liquidity trap**. The speculative money demand function is infinitely elastic here.

In Fig. 3.1 the speculative demand for money is plotted on the horizontal axis and the rate of interest on the vertical axis. When $r = r_{\max}$, speculative demand for money is zero. The rate of interest is so high that everyone expects it to fall in future and hence is sure about a future capital gain. Thus everyone has converted the speculative money balance into bonds. When $r = r_{\min}$, the economy is in the liquidity trap. Everyone is sure of a future rise in interest rate and a fall in bond prices. Everyone puts whatever wealth they acquire in the form of money and the speculative demand for money is infinite.

Total demand for money in an economy is, therefore, composed of transaction demand and speculative demand. The former is directly proportional to real GDP and price level, whereas the latter is inversely related to the market rate of interest. The aggregate money demand in an economy can be summarised by the following equation

$$M^d = M_T^d + M_S^d$$

$$\text{or, } M^d = kPY + \frac{r_{\max}}{r} \frac{r}{r_{\min}} \quad (3.5)$$

THE SUPPLY OF MONEY : VARIOUS MEASURES

In a modern economy money consists mainly of currency notes and coins issued by the monetary authority of the country. In India currency notes are issued by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI), which is the monetary authority in India. However, coins are issued by the Government of India. Apart from currency notes and coins, the balance in savings, or current account deposits, held by the public in commercial banks is also considered money since cheques drawn on these accounts are used to settle transactions. Such deposits are called demand deposits as they are payable by the bank on demand from the account-holder. Other deposits, e.g. fixed deposits, have a fixed period to maturity and are referred to as **time deposits**.

Though a hundred-rupee note can be used to obtain commodities worth Rs 100 from a shop, the value of the paper itself is negligible – certainly less than Rs 100. Similarly, the value of the metal in a five-rupee coin is probably not worth Rs 5. Why then do people accept such notes and coins in exchange of goods which are apparently more valuable than these? The value of the currency notes and coins is derived from the guarantee provided by the issuing authority of these items. Every currency note bears on its face a promise from the Governor of RBI that if someone produces the note to RBI, or any other commercial bank, RBI will be responsible for

giving the person purchasing power equal to the value printed on the note. The same is also true of coins. Currency notes and coins are therefore called **fiat money**. They do not have **intrinsic value** like a gold or silver coin. They are also called **legal tenders** as they cannot be refused by any citizen of the country for settlement of any kind of transaction. Cheques drawn on savings or current accounts, however, can be refused by anyone as a mode of payment. Hence, demand deposits are not legal tenders.

Legal Definitions: Narrow and Broad Money

Money supply, like money demand, is a stock variable. The total stock of money in circulation among the public at a particular point of time is called money supply. RBI publishes figures for four alternative measures of money supply, viz. M1, M2, M3 and M4. They are defined as follows

$$M1 = CU + DD$$

$$M2 = M1 + \text{Savings deposits with Post Office savings banks}$$

$$M3 = M1 + \text{Net time deposits of commercial banks}$$

$$M4 = M3 + \text{Total deposits with Post Office savings organisations (excluding National Savings Certificates)}$$

where, CU is currency (notes plus coins) held by the public and DD is net demand deposits held by commercial banks. The word 'net' implies that only deposits of the public held by the banks are to be included in money supply. The interbank deposits, which a commercial bank holds in other commercial banks, are not to be regarded as part of money supply.

M1 and M2 are known as **narrow money**. M3 and M4 are known as **broad money**. These measures are in decreasing order of liquidity. M1 is most liquid and easiest for transactions whereas M4 is least liquid of all. M3 is the most commonly used measure of money supply. It is also known as **aggregate monetary resources**².

²See Appendix 3.2 for an estimate of the variations in M1 and M3 over time.

Box No. 3.2: Demonetisation

Demonetisation was a new initiative taken by the Government of India in November 2016 to tackle the problem of corruption, black money, terrorism and circulation of fake currency in the economy. Old currency notes of Rs 500, and Rs 1000 were no longer legal tender. New currency notes in the denomination of Rs 500 and Rs 2000 were launched. The public were advised to deposit old currency notes in their bank account till 31 December 2016 without any declaration and upto 31 March 2017 with the RBI with declaration.

Further to avoid a complete breakdown and cash crunch, notes government had allowed exchange of Rs 4000 old currency the by new currency per person and per day. Further till 12 December 2016, old currency notes were acceptable as legal tender at petrol pumps, government hospitals and for payment of government dues, like taxes, power bills, etc.

This move received both appreciation and criticism. There were long queues outside banks and ATM booths. The shortage of currency in circulation had an adverse impact on the economic activities. However, things improved with time and normalcy returned.

This move has had positive impact also. It improved tax compliance as a large number of people were brought in the tax ambit. The savings of an individual were channelised into the formal financial system. As a result, banks have more resources at their disposal which can be used to provide more loans at lower interest rates. It is a demonstration of State's decision to put a curb on black money, showing that tax evasion will no longer be tolerated. Tax evasion will result in financial penalty and social condemnation. Tax compliance will improve and corruption will decrease. Demonetisation could also help tax administration in another way, by shifting transactions out of the cash economy into the formal payment system. Households and firms have begun to shift from cash to electronic payment technologies.

Exchange of commodities without the mediation of money is called Barter Exchange. It suffers from lack of double coincidence of wants. Money facilitates exchanges by acting as a commonly acceptable medium of exchange. In a modern economy, people hold money broadly for two motives – transaction motive and speculative motive. Supply of money, on the other hand, consists of currency notes and coins, demand and time deposits held by commercial banks, etc. It is classified as narrow and broad money according to the decreasing order of liquidity. In India, the supply of money is regulated by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) which acts as the monetary authority of the country. Various actions of the public, the commercial banks of the country and RBI are responsible for changes in the supply of money in the economy. RBI regulates money supply by controlling the stock of high powered money, the bank rate and reserve requirements of the commercial banks. It also sterilises the money supply in the economy against external shocks.

Key Concepts

Barter exchange	Double coincidence of wants
Money	Medium of exchange
Unit of account	Store of value
Bonds	Rate of interest
Liquidity trap	Fiat money
Legal tender	Narrow money
Broad money	Currency deposit ratio
Reserve deposit ratio	High powered money
Money multiplier	Lender of last resort
Open market operation	Bank Rate
Cash Reserve Ratio (CRR)	Repo Rate
Reverse Repo Rate	

Exercises

1. What is a barter system? What are its drawbacks?
2. What are the main functions of money? How does money overcome the shortcomings of a barter system?
3. What is transaction demand for money? How is it related to the value of transactions over a specified period of time?
4. What are the alternative definitions of money supply in India?
5. What is a 'legal tender'? What is 'fiat money'?
6. What is High Powered Money?
7. Explain the functions of a commercial bank.
8. What is money multiplier? What determines the value of this multiplier?
9. What are the instruments of monetary policy of RBI?
10. Do you consider a commercial bank 'creator of money' in the economy?
11. What role of RBI is known as 'lender of last resort'?

Suggested Readings

1. Dornbusch, R. and S. Fischer. 1990. *Macroeconomics*, (fifth edition) pages 345 – 427, McGraw Hill, Paris.
2. Sikdar, S., 2006. *Principles of Macroeconomics*, pages 77 – 89, Oxford University Press, New Delhi.

The Sum of an Infinite Geometric Series

We want to find out the sum of an infinite geometric series of the following form

$$S = a + a.r + a.r^2 + a.r^3 + \dots + a.r^n + \dots + \infty$$

where a and r are real numbers and $0 < r < 1$. To compute the sum, multiply the above equation by r to obtain

$$r.S = a.r + a.r^2 + a.r^3 + \dots + a.r^{n+1} + \dots + \infty$$

Subtract the second equation from the first to get

$$S - r.S = a$$

or, $(1 - r)S = a$

which yields

$$S = \frac{a}{1-r}$$

In the example used for the derivation of the money multiplier, $a = 1$ and $r = 0.4$. Hence the value of the infinite series is

$$\frac{1}{1-0.4} = \frac{5}{3}$$

Money Supply in India

Table 3.4: Changes in M1 and M3 Over Time (in crore)

Year	M1 (Narrow Money)	M3 (Broad Money)
1999-00	341796	1124174
2000-01	379433	1313204
2001-02	422824	1498336
2002-03	473558	1717936
2003-04	578694	2005654
2004-05	649766	2245653
2005-06	826389	2719493
2006-07	967925	3310038
2007-08	1155810	4017855
2008-09	1259671	4794775
2009-10	1489268	5602698
2010-11	1638345	6504116
2011-12	1737394	7384831
2012-13	1897526	8389819
2013-14	2059762	9517386
2014-15	2292404	10550168
2015-16	2602538	11617615
2016-17	2681957	12791940
2017-18	3267331	13962587
2018-19	3710464	15432067
2019-20	4125948	16799963
2020-21	4794299	18844578
2021-22	5307125	20493129
2022-23	5674795	22343760

Source: Handbook of Statistics on Indian Economy, Reserve Bank of India, 2022-23

The difference in values between the two columns is attributable to the time deposits held by commercial banks.

Changes in the Composition of the Sources of Monetary Base Over Time Components of Money Stock

Table 3.5: Sources of Change in Monetary Base (in ₹ Crore)

<i>Year</i>	<i>Currency in Circulation</i>	<i>Cash with Banks</i>	<i>Currency with the Public</i>	<i>Other Deposit with the RBI</i>	<i>Banker's Deposit with the RBI</i>
1981-82	15411	937	14474	168	5419
1991-92	63738	2640	61098	885	34882
2001-02	250974	10179	240794	2831	84147
2004-05	368661	12347	356314	6454	113996
2005-06	429578	17454	412124	6843	135511
2006-07	504099	21244	482854	7467	197295
2007-08	590801	22390	568410	9027	328447
2008-09	691153	25703	665450	5533	291275
2009-10	799549	32056	767492	3806	352299
2010-11	949659	37823	911836	3653	423509
2011-12	1067230	43560	1023670	2822	356291
2012-13	1190975	49914	1141061	3240	320671
2013-14	1301074	55255	1245819	1965	429703
2014-15	1448312	62131	1386182	14590	465561
2015-16	1663463	66209	1597254	15451	501826
2016-17	1335266	71142	124124	21091	544127
2017-18	1829348	69635	1759712	23907	565525
2018-19	2136770	84561	2052209	31742	601969
2019-20	2447279	97563	2349748	38507	543888
2020-21	2853763	101935	2751828	47351	698867
2021-22	3133716	98028	3035689	58444	876726
2022-23	3378521	102085	3276436	77761	930477

Source: Handbook of Statistics on Indian Economy, Reserve Bank of India, 2022-23



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Chapter 4

Determination of Income and Employment



We have so far talked about the national income, price level, rate of interest etc. in an ad hoc manner – without investigating the forces that govern their values. The basic objective of macroeconomics is to develop theoretical tools, called models, capable of describing the processes which determine the values of these variables. Specifically, the models attempt to provide theoretical explanation to questions such as what causes periods of slow growth or recessions in the economy, or increment in the price level, or a rise in unemployment. It is difficult to account for all the variables at the same time. Thus, when we concentrate on the determination of a particular variable, we must hold the values of all other variables constant. This is a stylisation typical of almost any theoretical exercise and is called the assumption of *ceteris paribus*, which literally means ‘other things remaining equal’. You can think of the procedure as follows – in order to solve for the values of two variables x and y from two equations, we solve for one variable, say x , in terms of y from one equation first, and then substitute this value into the other equation to obtain the complete solution. We apply the same method in the analysis of the macroeconomic system.

In this chapter we deal with the determination of National Income under the assumption of fixed price of final goods and constant rate of interest in the economy. The theoretical model used in this chapter is based on the theory given by John Maynard Keynes.

4.1 AGGREGATE DEMAND AND ITS COMPONENTS

In the chapter on National Income Accounting, we have come across terms like consumption, investment, or the total output of final goods and services in an economy (GDP). These terms have dual connotations. In Chapter 2 they were used in the accounting sense – denoting actual values of these items as measured by the activities within the economy in a certain year. We call these actual or accounting values **ex post** measures of these items.

These terms, however, can be used with a different connotation. Consumption may denote not what people have actually consumed in a given year, but what they

had planned to consume during the same period. Similarly, investment can mean the amount a producer plans to add to her inventory. It may be different from what she ends up doing. Suppose the producer plans to add Rs 100 worth goods to her stock by the end of the year. Her planned investment is, therefore, Rs 100 in that year. However, due to an unforeseen upsurge of demand for her goods in the market the volume of her sales exceeds what she had planned to sell and, to meet this extra demand, she has to sell goods worth Rs 30 from her stock. Therefore, at the end of the year, her inventory goes up by Rs $(100 - 30) = \text{Rs } 70$ only. Her planned investment is Rs 100 whereas her actual, or *ex post*, investment is Rs 70 only. We call the planned values of the variables – consumption, investment or output of final goods – their **ex ante** measures.

In simple words, **ex-ante** depicts what has been planned, and **ex-post** depicts what has actually happened. In order to understand the determination of income, we need to know the planned values of different components of aggregate demand. Let us look at these components now.

4.1.1. Consumption

The most important determinant of consumption demand is household income. A consumption function describes the relation between consumption and income. The simplest consumption function assumes that consumption changes at a constant rate as income changes. Of course, even if income is zero, some consumption still takes place. Since this level of consumption is independent of income, it is called *autonomous consumption*. We can describe this function as:

$$C = \bar{C} + cY \quad (4.1)$$

The above equation is called the consumption function. Here C is the consumption expenditure by households. This consists of two components autonomous consumption and induced consumption (cY).

Autonomous consumption is denoted by $\bar{C}$ and shows the consumption which is independent of income. If consumption takes place even when income is zero, it is because of autonomous consumption. The induced component of consumption, cY shows the dependence of consumption on income. When income rises by Re 1, induced consumption rises by MPC i.e. c or the marginal propensity to consume. It may be explained as a rate of change of consumption as income changes.

$$MPC = \frac{\Delta C}{\Delta Y} = c$$

Now, let us look at the value that MPC can take. When income changes, change in consumption (ΔC) can never exceed the change in income (ΔY). The maximum value which c can take is 1. On the other hand consumer may choose not to change consumption even when income has changed. In this case $MPC = 0$. Generally, MPC lies between 0 and 1 (inclusive of both values). This means that as income increases either

the consumers does not increase consumption at all ($MPC = 0$) or use entire change in income on consumption ($MPC = 1$) or use part of the change in income for changing consumption ($0 < MPC < 1$).

Imagine a country Imagenia which has a consumption function described by $C = 100 + 0.8Y$.

This indicates that even when Imagenia does not have any income, its citizens still consume Rs. 100 worth of goods. Imagenia's autonomous consumption is 100. Its marginal propensity to consume is 0.8. This means that if income goes up by Rs. 100 in Imagenia, consumption will go up by Rs. 80.

Let us also look at another dimension of this, savings. Savings is that part of income that is not consumed. In other words,

$$S = Y - C$$

We define the marginal propensity to save (MPS) as the rate of change in savings as income increases.

$$MPS = \frac{\Delta S}{\Delta Y} = s$$

Since, $S = Y - C$,

$$\begin{aligned} s &= \frac{\Delta(Y - C)}{\Delta Y} \\ &= \frac{\Delta Y}{\Delta Y} - \frac{\Delta C}{\Delta Y} \\ &= 1 - c \end{aligned}$$

Some Definitions

Marginal propensity to consume (MPC): it is the change in consumption per unit change in income. It is denoted by c and is equal to $\frac{\Delta C}{\Delta Y}$.

Marginal propensity to save (MPS): it is the change in savings per unit change in income. It is denoted by s and is equal to $1 - c$. It implies that $s + c = 1$.

Average propensity to consume (APC): it is the consumption per unit of income i.e., $\frac{C}{Y}$.

Average propensity to save (APS): it is the savings per unit of income i.e., $\frac{S}{Y}$.

4.1.2. Investment

Investment is defined as addition to the stock of physical capital (such as machines, buildings, roads etc., i.e. anything that adds to the future productive capacity of the economy) and changes in the inventory (or the stock of finished goods) of a producer. Note that ‘investment goods’ (such as machines) are also part of the final goods – they are not intermediate goods like raw materials. Machines produced in an economy in a given year are not ‘used up’ to produce other goods but yield their services over a number of years.

Investment decisions by producers, such as whether to buy a new machine, depend, to a large extent, on the market rate of interest. However, for simplicity, we assume here that firms plan to invest the same amount every year. We can write the ex ante investment demand as

$$I = \bar{I} \quad (4.2)$$

where $\bar{I}$ is a positive constant which represents the autonomous (given or exogenous) investment in the economy in a given year.

4.2 DETERMINATION OF INCOME IN TWO-SECTOR MODEL

In an economy without a government, the ex ante aggregate demand for final goods is the sum total of the ex ante consumption expenditure and ex ante investment expenditure on such goods, viz. $AD = C + I$. Substituting the values of C and I from equations (4.1) and (4.2), aggregate demand for final goods can be written as

$$AD = \bar{C} + \bar{I} + c.Y$$

If the final goods market is in equilibrium this can be written as

$$Y = \bar{C} + \bar{I} + c.Y$$

where Y is the ex ante, or planned, output of final goods. This equation can be further simplified by adding up the two autonomous terms, $\bar{C}$ and $\bar{I}$, making it

$$Y = \bar{A} + c.Y \quad (4.3)$$

where $\bar{A} = \bar{C} + \bar{I}$ is the total autonomous expenditure in the economy. In reality, these two components of autonomous expenditure behave in different ways. $\bar{C}$, representing subsistence consumption level of an economy, remains more or less stable over time. However, $\bar{I}$ has been observed to undergo periodic fluctuations.

A word of caution is in order. The term Y on the left hand side of equation (4.3) represents the ex ante output or the planned supply of final goods. On the other hand, the expression on the right hand side denotes ex ante or planned aggregate demand for final goods in the economy. Ex ante supply is equal to ex ante demand only when the final goods market, and hence the economy, is in equilibrium. Equation (4.3) should not, therefore, be confused with the accounting identity of Chapter 2, which states that the ex post value of total output must always be equal to the sum total of ex post consumption and ex post investment in the economy. If ex ante demand for final goods falls short of the output of final goods that the producers have planned to produce in a given year, equation (4.3) will not hold. Stocks will be piling up in the warehouses which we may consider as *unintended accumulation of inventories*. It should be noted that inventories or stocks refers to that part of output produced which is not sold and therefore remains with the firm. Change in inventory is called

inventory investment. It can be negative as well as positive: if there is a rise in inventory, it is positive inventory investment, while a depletion of inventory is negative inventory investment. The inventory investment can take place due to two reasons: (i) the firm decides to keep some stocks for various reasons (this is called *planned* inventory investment) (ii) the sales differ from the planned level of sales, in which case the firm has to add to/run down existing inventories (this is called *unplanned* inventory investment). **Thus even though planned Y is greater than planned $C + I$, actual Y will be equal to actual $C + I$, with the extra output showing up as unintended accumulation of inventories in the ex post I on the right hand side of the accounting identity.**

At this point, we can introduce a government in this economy. The major economic activities of the government that affect the aggregate demand for final goods and services can be summarized by the fiscal variables Tax (T) and Government Expenditure (G), both autonomous to our analysis. Government, through its expenditure G on final goods and services, adds to the aggregate demand like other firms and households. On the other hand, taxes imposed by the government take a part of the income away from the household, whose disposable income, therefore, becomes $Y_d = Y - T$. Households spend only a fraction of this disposable income for consumption purpose. Hence, equation (4.3) has to be modified in the following way to incorporate the government

$$Y = \bar{C} + \bar{I} + G + c(Y - T)$$

Note that $G - c.T$, like $\bar{C}$ or $\bar{I}$, just adds to the autonomous term $\bar{A}$. It does not significantly change the analysis in any qualitative way. We shall, for the sake of simplicity, ignore the government sector for the rest of this chapter. Observe also, that without the government imposing indirect taxes and subsidies, the total value of final goods and services produced in the economy, GDP, becomes identically equal to the National Income. Henceforth, throughout the rest of the chapter, we shall refer to Y as GDP or National Income interchangeably.

4.3 DETERMINATION OF EQUILIBRIUM INCOME IN THE SHORT RUN

You would recall that in microeconomic theory when we analyse the equilibrium of demand and supply in a single market, the demand and supply curves simultaneously determine the equilibrium price and the equilibrium quantity. In macroeconomic theory we proceed in two steps: at the first stage, we work out a macroeconomic equilibrium taking the price level as fixed. At the second stage, we allow the price level to vary and again, analyse macroeconomic equilibrium.

What is the justification for taking the price level as fixed? Two reasons can be put forward: (i) at the first stage, we are assuming an economy with unused resources: machineries, buildings and labours. In such a situation, the law of diminishing returns will not apply; hence additional output can be produced without increasing marginal cost. Accordingly, price level does not vary even if the quantity produced changes (ii) this is just a simplifying assumption which will be changed later.

4.3.1 Macroeconomic Equilibrium with Price Level Fixed

(A) Graphical Method

As already explained, the consumers demand can be expressed by the equation

$$C = \bar{C} + cY$$

Where $\bar{C}$ is Autonomous expenditure and c is the marginal propensity to consume.

How can this relation be shown as a graph? To answer this question we will need to recall the “intercept form of the linear equation”,

$$Y = a + bX$$

Here, the variables are X and Y and there is a linear relation between them. a and b are constants. This equation is depicted in figure 4.1. The constant ‘ a ’ is shown as the “intercept” on the Y axis, i.e., the value of Y when X is zero. The constant ‘ b ’ is the slope of the line i.e. tangent $\theta = b$.

Consumption Function – Graphical Representation

Using the same logic, the consumption function can be shown as follows:

Consumption function,

where, $\bar{C}$ = intercept of the consumption function
 c = slope of consumption function
 $= \tan \alpha$

Investment Function – Graphical Representation

In a two sector model, there are two sources of final demand, the first is consumption and the second is investment.

The investment function was shown as $I = \bar{I}$

Graphically, this is shown as a horizontal line at a height equal to $\bar{I}$ above the horizontal axis.

In this model, I is autonomous which means, it is the same no matter whatever is the level of income.

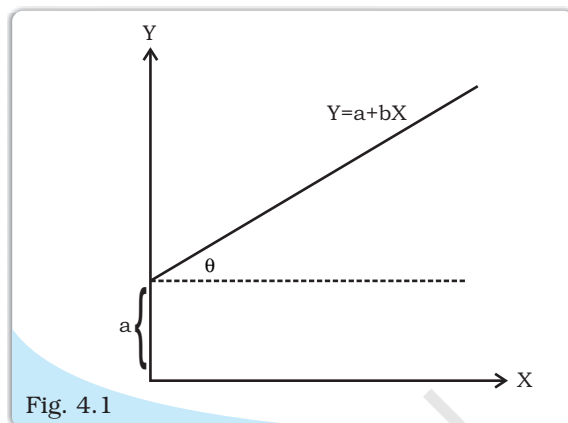


Fig. 4.1

Intercept form of the linear equation.

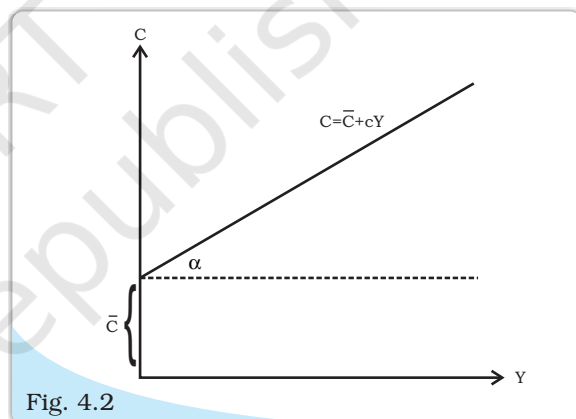


Fig. 4.2

Consumption function with intercept $\bar{C}$.

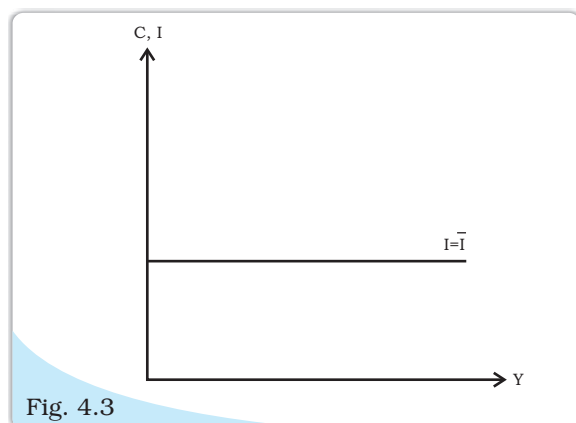


Fig. 4.3

Investment function with I as autonomous.

Aggregate Demand: Graphical Representation

The Aggregate Demand function shows the total demand (made up of consumption + investment) at each level of income. Graphically it means the aggregate demand function can be obtained by vertically adding the consumption and investment function.

Here, $OM = \bar{C}$

$OJ = \bar{I}$

$OL = \bar{C} + \bar{I}$

The aggregate demand function is parallel to the consumption function i.e., they have the same slope c .

It may be noted that this function shows ex ante demand.

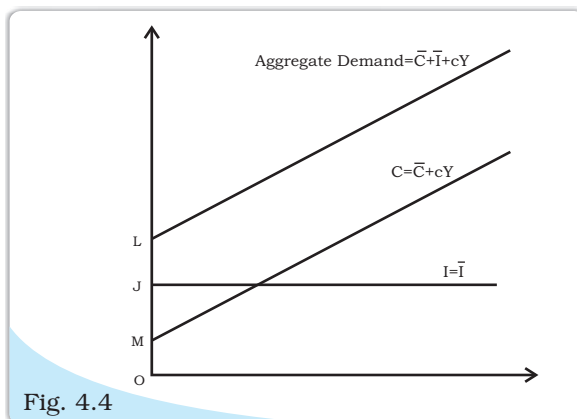


Fig. 4.4

Aggregate demand is obtained by vertically adding the consumption and investment functions.

Supply Side of Macroeconomic Equilibrium

In microeconomic theory, we show the supply curve on a diagram with price on the vertical axis and quantity supplied on horizontal axis.

In the first stage of macroeconomic theory, we are taking the price level as fixed. Here, aggregate supply or the GDP is assumed to smoothly move up or down since they are unused resources of all types available. Whatever is the level of GDP, that much will be supplied and price level has no role to play. This kind of supply situation is shown by a 45° line. Now, the 45° line has the feature that every point on it has the same horizontal and vertical coordinates.

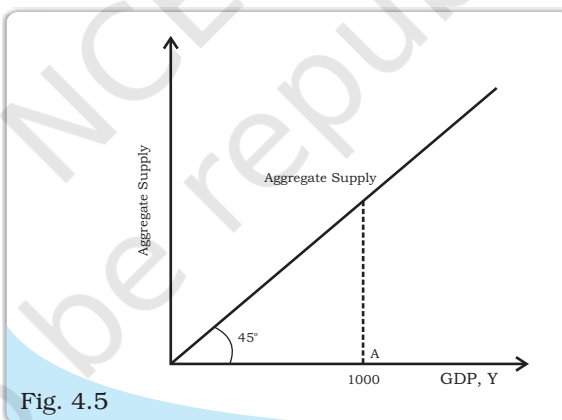


Fig. 4.5

Aggregate supply curve with 45° line.

Suppose, GDP is Rs. 1,000 at point A. How much will be supplied? The answer is Rs. 1000 worth of goods. How can that point be shown? The answer is that supply corresponding to point A is at point B which is obtained at the intersection of the 45° line and the vertical line at A.

Equilibrium

Equilibrium is shown graphically by putting ex ante aggregate demand and supply together in a diagram (Fig. 4.6). The point where ex ante aggregate demand is equal to ex ante aggregate supply will be equilibrium. Thus,

equilibrium point is E and equilibrium level of income is OY_1 .

(B) Algebraic Method

Ex ante aggregate demand = $\bar{I} + \bar{C} + cY$

Ex ante aggregate supply = Y

Equilibrium requires that the plans of suppliers are matched by plans of those who provide final demands in the economy. Thus, in this situation, ex ante aggregate demand = ex ante aggregate supply,

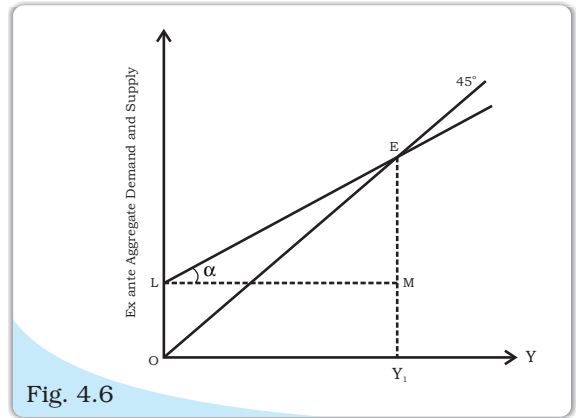


Fig. 4.6

Equilibrium of ex ante aggregate demand and supply

$$\bar{C} + \bar{I} + cY = Y$$

$$Y(1 - c) = \bar{C} + \bar{I}$$

$$Y = \frac{\bar{C} + \bar{I}}{(1 - c)} \quad (4.4)$$

4.3.2 Effect of an Autonomous Change in Aggregate Demand on Income and Output

We have seen that the equilibrium level of income depends on aggregate demand. Thus, if aggregate demand changes, the equilibrium level of income changes. This can happen in any one or combination of the following situations:

1. Change in consumption: this can happen due to (i) change in $\bar{C}$ (ii) change in c .
2. Change in investment: we have assumed that investment is autonomous. However, it just means that it does not depend on income. There are a number of variables other than income which can affect investment. One important factor is availability of credit: easy availability of credit encourages investment. Another factor is interest rate: interest rate is the cost of investible funds, and at higher interest rates, firms tend to lower investment. Let us now concentrate on change in investment with the help of the following example.

Let $C = 40 + 0.8Y$, $I = 10$. In this case, the equilibrium income (obtained by equation Y to AD) comes out to be 250¹.

Now, let investment rise to 20. It can be seen that the new equilibrium will be 300. This can be seen by looking at the graph. This increase in income is due to rise in investment, which is a component of autonomous expenditure here.

When autonomous investment increases, the AD_1 line shifts in parallel upwards and assumes the position AD_2 . The value of aggregate demand at

$$Y = C + I = 40 + 0.8Y + 10, \text{ so that } Y = 50 + 0.8Y, \text{ or } Y = \frac{1}{1 - 0.8} 50 = 250$$

output Y_1^* is $Y_1^* F$, which is greater than the value of output $OY_1^* = Y_1^* E_1$ by an amount $E_1 F$. $E_1 F$ measures the amount of excess demand that emerges in the economy as a result of the increase in autonomous expenditure. Thus, E_1 no longer represents the equilibrium. To find the new equilibrium in the final goods market we must look for the point where the new aggregate demand line, AD_2 , intersects the 45° line. That occurs at point E_2 , which is, therefore, the new equilibrium point. The new equilibrium values of output and aggregate demand are Y_2^* and AD_2^* , respectively.

Note that in the new equilibrium, output and aggregate demand have increased by an amount $E_1 G = E_2 G$, which is greater than the initial increment in autonomous expenditure, $\Delta \bar{I} = E_1 F = E_2 J$. Thus an initial increment in the autonomous expenditure seems to have a multiplier on the equilibrium values of aggregate demand and output. What causes aggregate demand and output to increase by an amount larger than the size of the initial increment in autonomous expenditure? We discuss it in section 4.3.3.

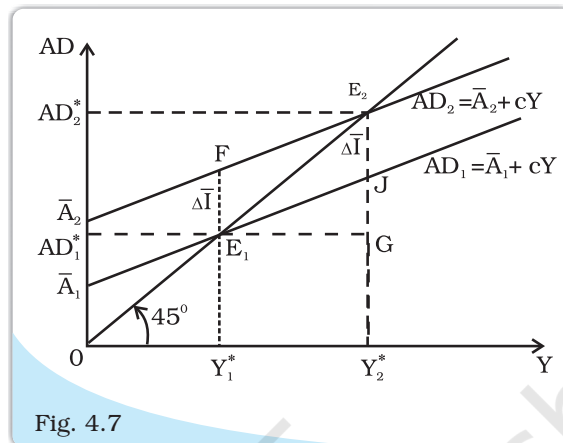


Fig. 4.7
Equilibrium Output and Aggregate Demand in the Fixed Price Model

4.3.3 The Multiplier Mechanism

It was seen in the previous section that with a change in the autonomous expenditure of 10 units, the change in equilibrium income is equal to 50 units (from 250 to 300). We can understand this by looking at the *multiplier mechanism*, which is explained below:

The production of final goods employs factors such as labour, capital, land and entrepreneurship. In the absence of indirect taxes or subsidies, the total value of the final goods output is distributed among different factors of production – wages to labour, interest to capital, rent to land etc. Whatever is left over is appropriated by the entrepreneur and is called profit. Thus the sum total of aggregate factor payments in the economy, National Income, is equal to the aggregate value of the output of final goods, GDP. In the above example the value of the extra output, 10, is distributed among various factors as factor payments and hence the income of the economy goes up by 10. When income increases by 10, consumption expenditure goes up by $(0.8)10$, since people spend 0.8 (= mpc) fraction of their additional income on consumption. Hence, in the next round, aggregate demand in the economy goes up by $(0.8)10$ and there again emerges an excess demand equal to $(0.8)10$. Therefore, in the next production cycle, producers increase their planned output further by $(0.8)10$ to restore equilibrium. When this extra output is distributed among factors, the income of the economy goes up by $(0.8)10$ and consumption demand increases further by $(0.8)^2 10$, once again creating excess demand of the same amount. This process goes on, round after round, with producers increasing their output to clear the excess demand in each round and consumers spending a part of their additional

income from this extra production on consumption items – thereby creating further excess demand in the next round.

Let us register the changes in the values of aggregate demand and output at each round in Table 4.1.

The last column measures the increments in the value of the output of final goods (and hence the income of the economy) in each round. The second and third columns measure the increments in total consumption expenditure in the economy and increments in the value of aggregate demand in a similar way. In order to find out the total increase in output of the final goods, we must add up the infinite geometric series in the last column, i.e.,

$$10 + (0.8)10 + (0.8)^2 10 + \dots \dots \dots \infty \\ = 10 \{1 + (0.8) + (0.8)^2 + \dots \dots \dots \infty\} = \frac{10}{1 - 0.8} = 50$$

Table 4.1: The Multiplier Mechanism in the Final Goods Market

	Consumption	Aggregate Demand	Output/Income
Round 1	0	10 (Autonomous Increment)	10
Round 2	(0.8)10	(0.8)10	(0.8)10
Round 3	(0.8) ² 10	(0.8) ² 10	(0.8) ² 10
Round 4	(0.8) ³ 10	(0.8) ³ 10	(0.8) ³ 10
.	.	.	.
.	.	.	.
.	.	.	.
.	.	.	etc.

The increment in equilibrium value of total output thus exceeds the initial increment in autonomous expenditure. The ratio of the total increment in equilibrium value of final goods output to the initial increment in autonomous expenditure is called the **investment multiplier** of the economy. Recalling that 10 and 0.8 represent the values of $\Delta \bar{I} = \Delta \bar{A}$ and mpc , respectively, the expression for the multiplier can be explained as

$$\text{The investment multiplier} = \frac{\Delta Y}{\Delta A} = \frac{1}{1 - c} = \frac{1}{s} \quad (4.5)$$

where ΔY is the total increment in final goods output and $c = mpc$. Observe that the size of the multiplier depends on the value of c . As c becomes larger the multiplier increases.

Paradox of Thrift

If all the people of the economy increase the proportion of income they save (i.e. if the mps of the economy increases) the total value of savings in the economy will not increase – it will either decline or remain unchanged. This result is known as the **Paradox of Thrift** – which states that as people become more thrifty they end up saving less or same as before. This result, though sounds apparently impossible, is actually a simple application of the model we have learnt.

Let us continue with the example. Suppose at the initial equilibrium of $Y = 250$, there is an exogenous or autonomous shift in peoples' expenditure pattern – they suddenly become more thrifty. This may happen due to a new information regarding an imminent war or some other impending disaster, which makes people more circumspect and conservative about their expenditures. Hence the mps of the economy increases, or, alternatively, the mpc decreases from 0.8 to 0.5. At the initial income level of $AD_1 = Y_1 = 250$, this sudden decline in mpc will imply a decrease in aggregate consumption spending and hence in aggregate demand, $AD = \bar{A} + cY$, by an amount equal to $(0.8 - 0.5) 250 = 75$. This can be regarded as an autonomous reduction in consumption expenditure, to the extent that the change in mpc is occurring from some exogenous cause and is not a consequence of changes in the variables of the model. But as aggregate demand decreases by 75, it falls short of the output $Y_1 = 250$ and there emerges an excess supply equal to 75 in the economy. Stocks are piling up in warehouses and producers decide to cut the value of production by 75 in the next round to restore equilibrium in the market. But that would mean a reduction in factor payments in the next round and hence a reduction in income by 75. As income decreases people reduce consumption proportionately but, this time, according to the new value of mpc which is 0.5. Consumption expenditure, and hence aggregate demand, decreases by $(0.5)75$, which creates again an excess supply in the market. In the next round, therefore, producers reduce output further by $(0.5)75$. Income of the people decreases accordingly and consumption expenditure and aggregate demand goes down again by $(0.5)^2 75$. The process goes on. However, as can be inferred from the dwindling values of the successive round effects, the process is convergent. What is the total decrease in the value of output and aggregate demand? Add up the infinite series $75 + (0.5) 75 + (0.5)^2 75 + \dots \infty$ and the total reduction in output turns out to be

$$\frac{75}{1 - 0.5} = 150$$

But that means the new equilibrium output of the economy is only $Y_2^* = 100$. People are now saving $S_2^* = Y_2^* - C_2^* = Y_2^* - (\bar{C} + c_2.Y_2^*) = 100 - (40 + 0.5 \cdot 100) = 10$ in aggregate, whereas under the previous equilibrium they were saving $S_1^* = Y_1^* - C_1^* = Y_1^* - (\bar{C} + c_1.Y_1^*) = 250 - (40 + 0.8 \cdot 250) = 10$ at the previous mpc, $c_1 = 0.8$. Total value of savings in the economy has, therefore, remained unchanged.

When $\bar{A}$ changes the line shifts upwards or downwards in parallel. When c changes, however, the line swings up or down. An increase in mps,

or a decline in mpc, reduces the slope of the AD line and it swings downwards. We depict the situation in Fig. 4.8.

At the initial values of the parameters, $\bar{A} = 50$ and $c = 0.8$, the equilibrium value of the output and aggregate demand from equation (4.4) was

$$Y_1^* = \frac{50}{1-0.8} = 250$$

Under the changed value of the parameter $c = 0.5$, the new equilibrium value of output and aggregate demand is

$$Y_2^* = \frac{50}{1-0.5} = 100$$

The equilibrium output and aggregate demand have declined by 150. As explained above, this, in turn, implies that there is no change in the total value of savings.

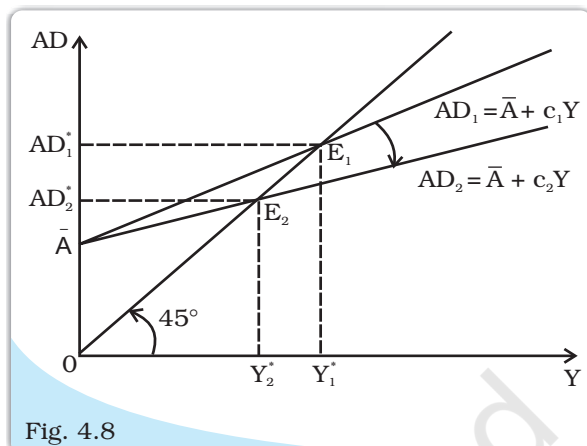


Fig. 4.8

Paradox of Thrift – Downward Swing of AD Line

4.4 SOME MORE CONCEPTS

The equilibrium output in the economy also determines the level of employment, given the quantities of other factors of production (think of a production function at aggregate level). This means that the level of output determined by the equality of Y with AD does not necessarily mean the level of output at which everyone is employed.

Full employment level of income is that level of income where all the factors of production are fully employed in the production process. Recall that equilibrium attained at the point of equality of Y and AD by itself does not signify full employment of resources. Equilibrium only means that if left to itself the level of income in the economy will not change even when there is unemployment in the economy. The equilibrium level of output may be more or less than the full employment level of output. If it is less than the full employment of output, it is due to the fact that demand is not enough to employ all factors of production. This situation is called the situation of **deficient demand**. It leads to decline in prices in the long run. On the other hand, if the equilibrium level of output is more than the full employment level, it is due to the fact that the demand is more than the level of output produced at full employment level. This situation is called the situation of **excess demand**. It leads to rise in prices in the long run.

When, at a particular price level, aggregate demand for final goods equals aggregate supply of final goods, the final goods or product market reaches its equilibrium. Aggregate demand for final goods consists of ex ante consumption, ex ante investment, government spending etc. The rate of increase in ex ante consumption due to a unit increment in income is called marginal propensity to consume. For simplicity we assume a constant final goods price and constant rate of interest over short run to determine the level of aggregate demand for final goods in the economy. We also assume that the aggregate supply is perfectly elastic at this price. Under such circumstances, aggregate output is determined solely by the level of aggregate demand. This is known as effective demand principle. An increase (decrease) in autonomous spending causes aggregate output of final goods to increase (decrease) by a larger amount through the multiplier process.

Aggregate demand	Aggregate supply
Equilibrium	Ex ante
Ex post	Ex ante consumption
Marginal propensity to consume	Ex ante investment
Unintended changes in inventories	Autonomous change
Parametric shift	Effective demand principle
Paradox of thrift	Autonomous expenditure multiplier

1. What is marginal propensity to consume? How is it related to marginal propensity to save?
2. What is the difference between ex ante investment and ex post investment?
3. What do you understand by 'parametric shift of a line'? How does a line shift when its (i) slope decreases, and (ii) its intercept increases?
4. What is 'effective demand'? How will you derive the autonomous expenditure multiplier when price of final goods and the rate of interest are given?
5. Measure the level of ex-ante aggregate demand when autonomous investment and consumption expenditure (A) is Rs 50 crores, and MPS is 0.2 and level of income (Y) is Rs 4000 crores. State whether the economy is in equilibrium or not (cite reasons).
6. Explain 'Paradox of Thrift'.

Suggested Readings

1. Dornbusch, R. and S. Fischer. 1990. *Macroeconomics*, (fifth edition) pages 63 – 105. McGraw Hill, Paris.

Chapter 5



12105CH05

Government Budget and the Economy



We introduced the government in chapter one as denoting the state. We stated that apart from the private sector, there is the government which plays a very important role. An economy in which there is both the private sector and the Government is known as a **mixed economy**. There are many ways in which the government influences economic life. In this chapter, we will limit ourselves to the functions which are carried on through the **government budget**.

This chapter proceeds as follows. In section 5.1 we present the components of the government budget to bring out the sources of government revenue and avenues of government spending. In section 5.2 we discuss the topic of balanced, surplus or deficit budget to account for the difference between expenditures and revenue collection. It specifically deals with the meaning of different kinds of budget deficits, their implications and the measures to contain them. Box. 5.1 deals with fiscal policy and a simple description of the multiplier. The role the government plays has implications for its deficits which further affect its debt—what the government owes. The chapter concludes with an analysis of the debt issue.

5.1 GOVERNMENT BUDGET — MEANING AND ITS COMPONENTS

There is a constitutional requirement in India (Article 112) to present before the Parliament a statement of estimated receipts and expenditures of the government in respect of every financial year which runs from 1 April to 31 March. This 'Annual Financial Statement' constitutes the main **budget** document of the government.

Although the budget document relates to the receipts and expenditure of the government for a particular financial year, the impact of it will be there in subsequent years. There is a need therefore to have two accounts—those that relate to the current financial year only are included in the revenue account (also called **revenue budget**) and those that concern the assets and liabilities of the government into the capital account (also called **capital budget**). In order to understand the accounts, it is important to first understand the objectives of the government budget.

5.1.1 Objectives of Government Budget

The government plays a very important role in increasing the welfare of the people. In order to do that the government intervenes in the economy in the following ways.

Allocation Function of Government Budget

Government provides certain goods and services which cannot be provided by the market mechanism i.e. by exchange between individual consumers and producers. Examples of such goods are national defence, roads, government administration etc. which are referred to as **public goods**.

To understand why public goods need to be provided by the government, we must understand the difference between **private goods** such as clothes, cars, food items etc. and public goods. There are two major differences. One, the benefits of public goods are available to all and are not only restricted to one particular consumer. For example, if a person eats a chocolate or wears a shirt, these will not be available to others. It is said that this person's consumption stands in rival relationship to the consumption of others. However, if we consider a public park or measures to reduce air pollution, the benefits will be available to all. One person's consumption of a good does not reduce the amount available for consumption for others and so several people can enjoy the benefits, that is, the consumption of many people is not '**rivalrous**'.

Two, in case of private goods anyone who does not pay for the goods can be excluded from enjoying its benefits. If you do not buy a ticket, you will not be allowed to watch a movie at a local cinema hall. However, in case of public goods, there is no feasible way of excluding anyone from enjoying the benefits of the good. That is why public goods are called **non-excludable**. Even if some users do not pay, it is difficult and sometimes impossible to collect fees for the public good. These non-paying users are known as '**free-riders**'. Consumers will not voluntarily pay for what they can get for free and for which there is no exclusive title to the property being enjoyed. The link between the producer and consumer which occurs through the payment process is broken and the government must step in to provide for such goods.

There is, however, a difference between **public provision** and **public production**. Public provision means that they are financed through the budget and can be used without any direct payment. Public goods may be produced by the government or the private sector. When goods are produced directly by the government it is called public production.

Redistribution Function of Government Budget

From chapter two we know that the total national income of the country goes to either the private sector, that is, firms and households (known as private income) or the government (known as public income). Out of private income, what finally reaches the households is known as personal income and the amount that can be spent is the personal disposable income. The government sector affects the personal disposable income of households by making transfers and collecting taxes. It is through this that the government can change the distribution of income and bring about a distribution that is considered 'fair' by society. This is the **redistribution function**.

Stabilisation Function of Government Budget

The government may need to correct fluctuations in income and employment. The overall level of employment and prices in the economy depends upon the level of aggregate demand which depends on the spending decisions of millions of private economic agents apart from the government. These decisions, in turn, depend on many factors such as income and credit availability. In any period, the level of demand may not be sufficient for full utilisation of labour and other resources of the economy. Since wages and prices do not fall below a level, employment cannot be brought back to the earlier level automatically. The government needs to intervene to raise the aggregate demand.

On the other hand, there may be times when demand exceeds available output under conditions of high employment and thus may give rise to inflation. In such situations, restrictive conditions may be needed to reduce demand.

The intervention of the government whether to expand demand or reduce it constitutes the **stabilisation function**.

5.1.2 Classification of Receipts

Revenue Receipts: Revenue receipts are those receipts that do not lead to a claim on the government. They are therefore termed non-redeemable. They are divided into tax and non-tax revenues. Tax revenues, an important component of revenue receipts, have for long been divided into direct taxes (personal income tax) and firms (corporation tax), and indirect taxes like excise taxes (duties levied on goods produced within the country), customs duties (taxes imposed on goods imported into and exported out of India) and service tax¹. Other direct taxes like wealth tax, gift tax and estate duty (now abolished) have never brought in large amount of revenue and thus have been referred to as 'paper taxes'.

The redistribution objective is sought to be achieved through progressive income taxation, in which higher the income, higher is the tax rate. Firms are taxed on a proportional basis, where the tax rate is a particular proportion of profits. With respect to excise taxes, necessities of life are exempted or taxed at low rates, comforts and semi-luxuries are moderately taxed, and luxuries, tobacco and petroleum products are taxed heavily.

Non-tax revenue of the central government mainly consists of interest receipts on account of loans by the central government, dividends and profits on investments made by the government, fees and other receipts for services rendered by the government. Cash grants-in-aid from foreign countries and international organisations are also included.

The estimates of revenue receipts take into account the effects of tax proposals made in the Finance Bill².

Capital Receipts: The government also receives money by way of loans or from the sale of its assets. Loans will have to be returned to the agencies from which they have been borrowed. Thus they create liability. Sale of government assets, like sale of shares in Public Sector Undertakings (PSUs) which is referred

¹The India Tax system witnessed a dramatic change with the introduction of the GST (Goods and Services Tax) which encompasses both goods and services and was implemented by the Centre, 28 states and 7 Union territories from 1 July, 2017.

²A Finance Bill, presented along with the Annual Financial Statement, provides details on the imposition, abolition, remission, alteration or regulation of taxes proposed in the Budget.

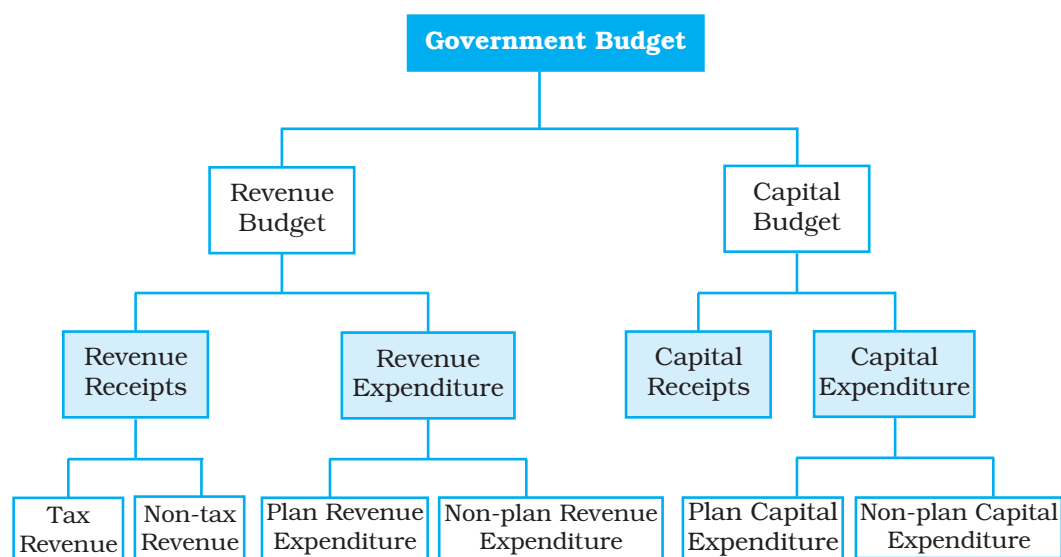


Chart 1: The Components of the Government Budget

to as PSU disinvestment, reduce the total amount of financial assets of the government. All those receipts of the government which create liability or reduce financial assets are termed as capital receipts. When government takes fresh loans it will mean that in future these loans will have to be returned and interest will have to be paid on these loans. Similarly, when government sells an asset, then it means that in future its earnings from that asset, will disappear. Thus, these receipts can be debt creating or non-debt creating.

5.1.3. Classification of Expenditure

Revenue Expenditure

Revenue Expenditure is expenditure incurred for purposes other than the creation of physical or financial assets of the central government. It relates to those expenses incurred for the normal functioning of the government departments and various services, interest payments on debt incurred by the government, and grants given to state governments and other parties (even though some of the grants may be meant for creation of assets).

Budget documents classify total expenditure into **plan and non-plan expenditure**³. This is shown in item 6 on Table 5.1 within revenue expenditure, a distinction is made between plan and non-plan. According to this classification, plan revenue expenditure relates to central Plans (the Five-Year Plans) and central assistance for State and Union Territory plans. Non-plan expenditure, the more important component of revenue expenditure, covers a vast range of general, economic and social services of the

³A case against this kind of classification has been put forth on the ground that it has led to an increasing tendency to start new schemes/projects neglecting maintenance of existing capacity and service levels. It has also led to the misperception that non-plan expenditure is inherently wasteful, adversely affecting resource allocation to social sectors like education and health where salary comprises an important element.

government. The main items of non-plan expenditure are interest payments, defence services, subsidies, salaries and pensions.

Interest payments on market loans, external loans and from various reserve funds constitute the single largest component of non-plan revenue expenditure. Defence expenditure, is committed expenditure in the sense that given the national security concerns, there exists little scope for drastic reduction. Subsidies are an important policy instrument which aim at increasing welfare. Apart from providing implicit subsidies through under-pricing of public goods and services like education and health, the government also extends subsidies explicitly on items such as exports, interest on loans, food and fertilisers. The amount of subsidies as a percent of GDP was 2.02 per cent in 2014-15 and is 1.8 per cent of GDP in 2015-16, 1 per cent in 2018-19, 3.6 per cent in 2020-21 and 1.2 per cent in 2022-23 (B.E).

Capital Expenditure

There are expenditures of the government which result in creation of physical or financial assets or reduction in financial liabilities. This includes expenditure on the acquisition of land, building, machinery, equipment, investment in shares, and loans and advances by the central government to state and union territory governments, PSUs and other parties. Capital expenditure is also categorised as plan and non-plan in the budget documents. Plan capital expenditure, like its revenue counterpart, relates to central plan and central assistance for state and union territory plans. Non-plan capital expenditure covers various general, social and economic services provided by the government.

The budget is not merely a statement of receipts and expenditures. Since Independence, with the launching of the Five-Year Plans, it has also become a significant national policy statement. The budget, it has been argued, reflects and shapes, and is, in turn, shaped by the country's economic life. Along with the budget, three policy statements are mandated by the Fiscal Responsibility and Budget Management Act, 2003 (FRBMA)⁴. The Medium-term Fiscal Policy Statement sets a three-year rolling target for specific fiscal indicators and examines whether revenue expenditure can be financed through revenue receipts on a sustainable basis and how productively capital receipts including market borrowings are being utilised. The Fiscal Policy Strategy Statement sets the priorities of the government in the fiscal area, examining current policies and justifying any deviation in important fiscal measures. The Macroeconomic Framework Statement assesses the prospects of the economy with respect to the GDP growth rate, fiscal balance of the central government and external balance⁵.

5.2 BALANCED, SURPLUS AND DEFICIT BUDGET

The government may spend an amount equal to the revenue it collects. This is known as a **balanced** budget. If it needs to incur higher expenditure, it will have

⁴Box 5.2 provides a brief account of this legislation and its implication for Government finances.

⁵The 2005-06 Indian Budget introduced a statement highlighting the gender sensitivities of the budgetary allocations. Gender budgeting is an exercise to translate the stated gender commitments of the government into budgetary commitments, involving special initiatives for empowering women and examination of the utilisation of resources allocated for women and the impact of public expenditure and policies of the government on women. The 2006-07 budget enlarged the earlier statement.

to raise the amount through taxes in order to keep the budget balanced. When tax collection exceeds the required expenditure, the budget is said to be in **surplus**. However, the most common feature is the situation when expenditure exceeds revenue. This is when the government runs a budget **deficit**.

5.2.1 Measures of Government Deficit

When a government spends more than it collects by way of revenue, it incurs a budget deficit⁶. There are various measures that capture government deficit and they have their own implications for the economy.

Revenue Deficit: The revenue deficit refers to the excess of government's revenue expenditure over revenue receipts

$$\text{Revenue deficit} = \text{Revenue expenditure} - \text{Revenue receipts}$$

Table 5.1: Receipts and Expenditures of the Central Government, 2023–24 (P.A.)

	(As per cent of GDP)
1. Revenue Receipts (a+b)	9.2
(a) Tax revenue (net of states' share)	7.9
(b) Non-tax revenue	1.4
2. Revenue Expenditure of which	11.8
(a) Interest payments	3.6
(b) Major subsidies	1.4
(c) Defence expenditure	1.0
3. Revenue Deficit (2–1)	2.6
4. Capital Receipts (a+b+c) of which	5.8
(a) Recovery of loans	0.1
(b) Other receipts (mainly PSU ¹ disinvestment)	0.1
(c) Borrowings and other liabilities	5.6
5. Capital Expenditure	3.2
6. Non-debt Receipts	9.4
[1+4(a)+4(b)]	
7. Total Expenditure	1.5
[2+5=7(a)+7(b)]	
(a) Plan expenditure	–
(b) Non-plan expenditure	–
8. Fiscal deficit [7–1–4(a)–4(b)]	5.6
9. Primary Deficit [8–2(a)]	2.0

Source: *Economic Survey*, 2023–24,

¹ Public Sector Undertaking

Item 3 in Table 5.1 shows that revenue deficit in 2023–24 (P.A.) is 2.6 per cent of GDP. The revenue deficit includes only such transactions that affect the current income and expenditure of the government. When the government incurs a revenue deficit, it implies that the government is dissaving and is using up the savings of the other sectors of the economy to finance a part of its consumption expenditure. This situation means that the government will have to borrow not only to finance its investment but also its consumption requirements. This will lead to a build up of stock of debt and interest liabilities and force the government,

⁶More formally, it refers to the excess of total expenditure (both revenue and capital) over total receipts (both revenue and capital). From the 1997-98 budget, the practice of showing budget deficit has been discontinued in India.

eventually, to cut expenditure. Since a major part of revenue expenditure is committed expenditure, it cannot be reduced. Often the government reduces productive capital expenditure or welfare expenditure. This would mean lower growth and adverse welfare implications.

Fiscal Deficit: Fiscal deficit is the difference between the government's total expenditure and its total receipts excluding borrowing

$$\text{Gross fiscal deficit} = \text{Total expenditure} - (\text{Revenue receipts} + \text{Non-debt creating capital receipts})$$

Non-debt creating capital receipts are those receipts which are not borrowings and, therefore, do not give rise to debt. Examples are recovery of loans and the proceeds from the sale of PSUs. From Table 5.1 we can see that non-debt creating capital receipts equals 9.4 per cent of GDP, obtained by subtracting, borrowing and other liabilities from total capital receipts [1+4(a)+4(b)]. The fiscal deficit, therefore turn out to be 5.6 per cent of GDP. The fiscal deficit will have to be financed through borrowing. Thus, it indicates the total borrowing requirements of the government from all sources. From the financing side

$$\text{Gross fiscal deficit} = \text{Net borrowing at home} + \text{Borrowing from RBI} + \text{Borrowing from abroad}$$

Net borrowing at home includes that directly borrowed from the public through debt instruments (for example, the various small savings schemes) and indirectly from commercial banks through Statutory Liquidity Ratio (SLR). The gross fiscal deficit is a key variable in judging the financial health of the public sector and the stability of the economy. From the way gross fiscal deficit is measured as given above, it can be seen that revenue deficit is a part of fiscal deficit (Fiscal Deficit = Revenue Deficit + Capital Expenditure - non-debt creating capital receipts). A large share of revenue deficit in fiscal deficit indicated that a large part of borrowing is being used to meet its consumption expenditure needs rather than investment.

Primary Deficit: We must note that the borrowing requirement of the government includes interest obligations on accumulated debt. The goal of measuring primary deficit is to focus on present fiscal imbalances. To obtain an estimate of borrowing on account of current expenditures exceeding revenues, we need to calculate what has been called the primary deficit. It is simply the fiscal deficit minus the interest payments

$$\text{Gross primary deficit} = \text{Gross fiscal deficit} - \text{Net interest liabilities}$$

Net interest liabilities consist of interest payments minus interest receipts by the government on net domestic lending.

Box 5.1: Fiscal Policy

One of Keynes's main ideas in *The General Theory of Employment, Interest and Money* was that government fiscal policy should be used to stabilise the level of output and employment. Through changes in its expenditure and taxes, the government attempts to increase output and income and seeks to stabilise the ups and downs in the economy. In the process, fiscal policy creates a *surplus* (when total receipts exceed expenditure) or a *deficit budget* (when total expenditure

exceed receipts) rather than a *balanced budget* (when expenditure equals receipts). In what follows, we study the effects of introducing the government sector in our earlier analysis of the determination of income.

The government directly affects the level of equilibrium income in two specific ways – government purchases of goods and services (G) increase aggregate demand and taxes, and transfers affect the relation between income (Y) and disposable income (YD) – the income available for consumption and saving with the households.

We take taxes first. We assume that the government imposes taxes that do not depend on income, called **lump-sum taxes** equal to T . We assume throughout the analysis that government makes a constant amount of transfers, $\bar{TR}$. The consumption function is now

$$C = \bar{C} + cYD = \bar{C} + c(Y - T + \bar{TR}) \quad (5.1)$$

where YD = disposable income.

We note that taxes lower disposable income and consumption. For instance, if one earns Rs 1 lakh and has to pay Rs 10,000 in taxes, she has the same disposable income as someone who earns Rs 90,000 but pays no taxes. The definition of aggregate demand augmented to include the government will be

$$AD = \bar{C} + c(Y - T + \bar{TR}) + I + G \quad (5.2)$$

Graphically, we find that the lump-sum tax shifts the consumption schedule downward in a parallel way and hence the aggregate demand curve shifts in a similar fashion. The income determination condition in the product market will be $Y = AD$, which can be written as

$$Y = \bar{C} + c(Y - T + \bar{TR}) + I + G \quad (5.3)$$

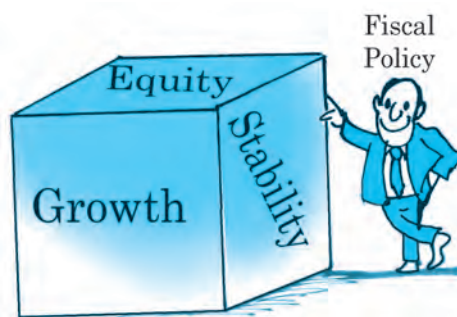
Solving for the equilibrium level of income, we get

$$Y^* = \frac{1}{1-c} (\bar{C} - cT + c\bar{TR} + I + G) \quad (5.4)$$

Changes in Government Expenditure

We consider the effects of increasing government purchases (G) keeping taxes constant. When G exceeds T , the government runs a deficit. Because G is a component of aggregate spending, planned aggregate expenditure will increase. The aggregate demand schedule shifts up to AD' . At the initial level of output, demand exceeds supply and firms expand production. The new equilibrium is at E' . The multiplier mechanism (described in Chapter 4) is in operation. The government spending multiplier is derived as follows:

Suppose G changes to a new level ($G + \Delta G$) and as a result Y changes to a new level ($Y^* + \Delta Y$). The new levels of G and Y can also be put into equation (5.4).



How does the Fiscal Policy try to achieve its basic objectives?

$$\text{So } (Y^* + \Delta Y) = \frac{1}{1-c} (\bar{C} - cT + c\bar{TR} + I + G + \Delta G) \quad (5.4a)$$

Subtracting equation (5.4) from equation (5.4a) we get

$$\Delta Y = \frac{1}{1-c} \Delta G \quad (5.5)$$

or

$$\frac{\Delta Y}{\Delta G} = \frac{1}{1-c} \quad (5.6)$$

In Fig. 5.1, government expenditure increases from G to G' and causes equilibrium income to increase from Y to Y' .

Changes in Taxes

We find that a cut in taxes increases disposable income ($Y - T$) at each level of income. This shifts the aggregate expenditure schedule upwards by a fraction c of the decrease in taxes. This is shown in Fig 5.2.

From equation 5.3, we can calculate the tax multiplier using the same method as for the government expenditure multiplier.

$$\Delta Y^* = \frac{1}{1-c} (-c) (\Delta T) \quad (5.7)$$

The tax multiplier

$$= \frac{\Delta Y}{\Delta T} = \frac{-c}{1-c} \quad (5.8)$$

Because a tax cut (increase) will cause an increase (reduction) in consumption and output, the tax multiplier is a negative multiplier. Comparing equation (5.6) and (5.8), we find that the tax multiplier is smaller in absolute value compared to the government spending multiplier. This is because an increase in government spending directly affects total spending whereas taxes enter the multiplier process through their impact on disposable income, which influences household consumption (which is a part of total spending).

Thus, with a ΔT reduction in taxes, consumption, and hence total spending, increases in the first instance by $c\Delta T$. To understand how the two multipliers differ, we consider the following example.

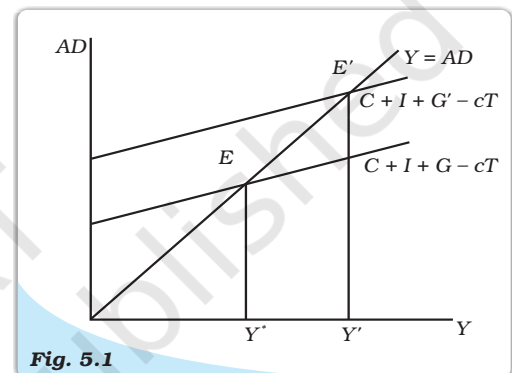


Fig. 5.1

Effect of Higher Government Expenditure

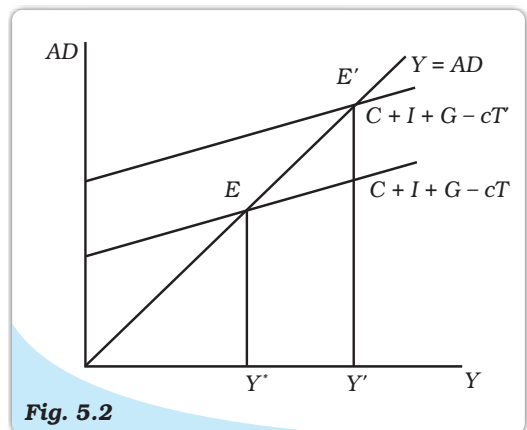


Fig. 5.2

Effect of a Reduction in Taxes

EXAMPLE 5.1

Assume that the marginal propensity to consume is 0.8. The government expenditure multiplier will then be

$$\frac{1}{1-c} = \frac{1}{1-0.8} = \frac{1}{0.2} = 5.$$

For an increase in government spending by 100, the equilibrium income will

increase by $500\left(\frac{1}{1-c}\Delta G = 5 \times 100\right)$.

The tax multiplier is given by

$$\frac{-c}{1-c} = \frac{-0.8}{1-0.8} = \frac{-0.8}{0.2} = -4.$$

A tax cut of 100 ($\Delta T = -100$) will increase equilibrium income by 400. Thus, the equilibrium income increases in this case by less than the amount by which it increased under a G increase.



Why is the poor man crying? Suggest measures to wipe off his tears.

Within the present framework, if we take different values of the marginal propensity to consume and calculate the values of the two multipliers, we find that the tax multiplier is always one less in absolute value than the government expenditure multiplier. This has an interesting implication. If an increase in government spending is matched by an equal increase in taxes, so that the budget remains balanced, output will rise by the amount of the increase in government spending. Adding the two policy multipliers gives

$$\text{The balanced budget multiplier} = \frac{\Delta Y^*}{\Delta G} = \frac{1}{1-c} + \frac{-c}{1-c} = \frac{1-c}{1-c} = 1 \quad (5.9)$$

A balanced budget multiplier of unity implies that a 100 increase in G financed by 100 increase in taxes increases income by just 100. This can be seen from Example 1 where an increase in G by 100 increases output by 500. A tax increase would reduce income by 400 with the net increase of income equal to 100. The equilibrium income refers to the final income that one arrives at in a period sufficiently long for all the rounds of the multipliers to work themselves out. We find that output increases by exactly the amount of increased G with no induced consumption spending due to increase in taxes. To see why the balanced budget multiplier is 1, we examine the multiplier process. The increase in government spending by a certain amount raises income by that amount directly and then indirectly through the multiplier chain increasing income by

$$\Delta Y = \Delta G + c\Delta G + c^2\Delta G + \dots = \Delta G(1 + c + c^2 + \dots) \quad (5.10)$$

But the tax increase only enters the multiplier process when the cut in disposable income reduces consumption by c times the reduction in taxes. Thus the effect on income of the tax increase is given by

$$\Delta Y = -c\Delta T - c^2\Delta T + \dots = -\Delta T(c + c^2 + \dots) \quad (5.11)$$

The difference between the two gives the net effect on income. Since $\Delta G = \Delta T$, from 5.10 and 5.11, we get $\Delta Y = \Delta G$, that is, income increases by the amount by which government spending increases and the balanced budget multiplier is unity. This multiplier can also be derived from equation 5.3 as follows

$$\Delta Y = \Delta \bar{G} + c(\Delta Y - \Delta T) \text{ since investment does not change } (\Delta I = 0) \quad (5.12)$$

Since, $\Delta \bar{G} = \Delta T$, we have

$$\frac{\Delta Y}{\Delta \bar{G}} = \frac{1-c}{1-c} = 1 \quad (5.13)$$

Case of Proportional Taxes: A more realistic assumption would be that the government collects a constant fraction, t , of income in the form of taxes so that $T = tY$. The consumption function with proportional taxes is given by

$$C = \bar{C} + c(Y - tY + \bar{TR}) = \bar{C} + c(1-t)Y + c\bar{TR} \quad (5.14)$$

We note that proportional taxes not only lower consumption at each level of income but also lower the slope of the consumption function. The mpc out of income falls to $c(1-t)$. The new aggregate demand schedule, AD' , has a larger intercept but is flatter as shown in Fig. 5.3.

Now we have

$$\begin{aligned} AD &= \bar{C} + c(1-t)Y + c\bar{TR} + I + G \\ &= \bar{A} + c(1-t)Y \end{aligned} \quad (5.15)$$

Where $\bar{A}$ = autonomous expenditure and equals $\bar{C} + c\bar{TR} + I + G$. Income determination condition in the product market is, $Y = AD$, which can be written as

$$Y = \bar{A} + c(1-t)Y \quad (5.16)$$

Solving for the equilibrium level of income

$$Y^* = \frac{1}{1-c(1-t)} \bar{A} \quad (5.17)$$

so that the multiplier is given by

$$\frac{\Delta Y}{\Delta \bar{A}} = \frac{1}{1-c(1-t)} \quad (5.18)$$

Comparing this with the value of the multiplier with lump-sum taxes case, we find that the value has become smaller. When income rose as a result of an increase in government spending in the case of lump-sum taxes,

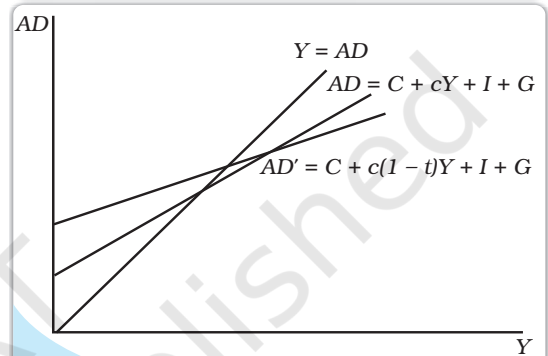


Fig. 5.3

Government and Aggregate Demand (proportional taxes make the AD schedule flatter)

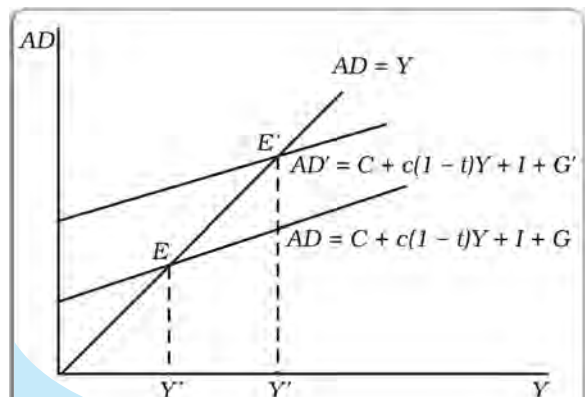


Fig. 5.4

Increase in Government Expenditure (with proportional taxes)

consumption increased by c times the increase in income. With proportional taxes, consumption will rise by less, $(c - ct = c(1 - t))$ times the increase in income.

For changes in G , the multiplier will now be given by

$$\Delta Y = \Delta \bar{G} + c(1 - t)\Delta Y \quad (5.19)$$

$$\Delta Y = \frac{1}{1 - c(1 - t)} \Delta \bar{G} \quad (5.20)$$

The income increases from Y^* to Y' as shown in Fig. 5.4.

The decrease in taxes works in effect like an increase in propensity to consume as shown in Fig. 5.5. The AD curve shifts up to AD' . At the initial level of income, aggregate demand for goods exceeds output because the tax reduction causes increased consumption. The new higher level of income is Y' .

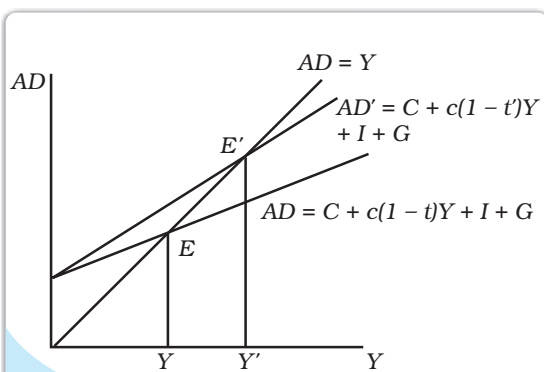


Fig. 5.5

Effects of a Reduction in the Proportional Tax Rate

EXAMPLE 5.2

In Example 5.1, if we take a tax rate of 0.25, we find consumption will now rise by 0.60 ($c(1 - t) = 0.8 \times 0.75$) for every unit increase in income instead of the earlier 0.80. Thus, consumption will increase by less than before. The

government expenditure multiplier will be $\frac{1}{1 - c(1 - t)} = \frac{1}{1 - 0.6} = \frac{1}{0.4} = 2.5$ which is smaller than that obtained with lump-sum taxes. If government expenditure rises by 100, output will rise by the multiplier times the rise in government expenditure, that is, by $2.5 \times 100 = 250$. This is smaller than the increase in output with lump-sum taxes.

The proportional income tax, thus, acts as an **automatic stabiliser** – a shock absorber because it makes disposable income, and thus consumer spending, less sensitive to fluctuations in GDP. When GDP rises, disposable income also rises but by less than the rise in GDP because a part of it is siphoned off as taxes. This helps limit the upward fluctuation in consumption spending. During a recession when GDP falls, disposable income falls less sharply, and consumption does not drop as much as it otherwise would have fallen had the tax liability been fixed. This reduces the fall in aggregate demand and stabilises the economy.

We note that these fiscal policy instruments can be varied to offset the effects of undesirable shifts in investment demand. That is, if investment falls from I_0 to I_1 , government spending can be raised from G_0 to G_1 so that autonomous expenditure ($C + I_0 + G_0 = C + I_1 + G_1$) and equilibrium income remain the same. This deliberate action to stabilise the economy is often referred to as **discretionary fiscal policy** to distinguish it from the inherent automatic stabilising properties of the fiscal system. As discussed earlier, proportional taxes help to stabilise the economy against upward and downward movements. Welfare transfers also help to stabilise income.

During boom years, when employment is high, tax receipts collected to finance such expenditure increase exerting a stabilising pressure on high consumption spending; conversely, during a slump, these welfare payments help sustain consumption. Further, even the private sector has built-in stabilisers. Corporations maintain their dividends in the face of a change in income in the short run and households try to maintain their previous living standards. All these work as shock absorbers without the need for any decision-maker to take action. That is, they work automatically. The built-in stabilisers, however, reduce only part of the fluctuation in the economy, the rest must be taken care of by deliberate policy initiative.

Transfers: We suppose that instead of raising government spending in goods and services, government increases transfer payments, $\bar{TR}$. Autonomous spending, $\bar{A}$, will increase by $c\Delta\bar{TR}$, so output will rise by less than the amount by which it increases when government expenditure increases because a part of any increase in transfer payments is saved. Using the method used earlier for deriving the government expenditure multiplier and the taxation multiplier the change in equilibrium income for a change in transfers is given by

$$\Delta Y = \frac{c}{1-c} \Delta TR \quad (5.21)$$

or

$$\frac{\Delta Y}{\Delta TR} = \frac{c}{1-c} \quad (5.22)$$

EXAMPLE 5.3

We suppose that the marginal propensity to consume is 0.75 and we have lump-sum taxes. The change in equilibrium income when government

purchases increase by 20 is given by $\Delta Y = \frac{1}{1-0.75} \Delta G = 4 \times 20 = 80$. An

increase in transfers of 20 will raise equilibrium income by $\Delta Y = \frac{0.75}{1-0.75} \Delta TR = 3 \times 20 = 60$. Thus, we find that income increases by less than it increased with a rise in government purchases.

Debt

Budgetary deficits must be financed by either taxation, borrowing or printing money. Governments have mostly relied on borrowing, giving rise to what is called government debt. The concepts of deficits and debt are closely related. Deficits can be thought of as a *flow* which add to the *stock* of debt. If the government continues to borrow year after year, it leads to the accumulation of debt and the government has to pay more and more by way of interest. These interest payments themselves contribute to the debt.

Perspectives on the Appropriate Amount of Government Debt: There are two interlinked aspects of the issue. One is whether government debt is a burden and two, the issue of financing the debt. The burden of debt must be discussed keeping in mind that what is true of one small trader's debt may not be true for the government's debt, and one must deal with the 'whole' differently from the 'part'. Unlike any one trader, the government can raise resources through taxation and printing money.

By borrowing, the government transfers the burden of reduced consumption on future generations. This is because it borrows by issuing bonds to the people living at present but may decide to pay off the bonds some twenty years later by raising taxes. These may be levied on the young population that have just entered the work force, whose disposable income will go down and hence consumption. Thus, national savings, it was argued, would fall. Also, government borrowing from the people reduces the savings available to the private sector. To the extent that this reduces capital formation and growth, debt acts as a 'burden' on future generations.

Traditionally, it has been argued that when a government cuts taxes and runs a budget deficit, consumers respond to their after-tax income by spending more. It is possible that these people are short-sighted and do not understand the implications of budget deficits. They may not realise that at some point in the future, the government will have to raise taxes to pay off the debt and accumulated interest. Even if they comprehend this, they may expect the future taxes to fall not on them but on future generations.

A counter argument is that consumers are forward-looking and will base their spending not only on their current income but also on their expected future income. They will understand that borrowing today means higher taxes in the future. Further, the consumer will be concerned about future generations because they are the children and grandchildren of the present generation and the family which is the relevant decision making unit, continues living. They would increase savings now, which will fully offset the increased government dissaving so that national savings do not change. This view is called **Ricardian equivalence** after one of the greatest nineteenth century economists, David Ricardo, who first argued that in the face of high deficits, people save more. It is called 'equivalence' because it argues that taxation and borrowing are equivalent means of financing expenditure. When the government increases spending by borrowing today, which will be repaid by taxes in the future, it will have the same impact on the economy as an increase in government expenditure that is financed by a tax increase today.

It has often been argued that 'debt does not matter because we owe it to ourselves'. This is because although there is a transfer of resources between generations, purchasing power remains within the nation. However, any debt that is owed to foreigners involves a burden since we have to send goods abroad corresponding to the interest payments.

Other Perspectives on Deficits and Debt: One of the main criticisms of deficits is that they are inflationary. This is because when government increases spending or cuts taxes, aggregate demand increases. Firms may not be able to produce higher quantities that are being demanded at the ongoing prices. Prices will, therefore, have to rise. However, if there are unutilised resources, output is held back by lack of demand. A high fiscal deficit is accompanied by higher demand and greater output and, therefore, need not be inflationary.

It has been argued that there is a decrease in investment due to a reduction in the amount of savings available to the private sector. This is because if the government decides to borrow from private citizens by issuing bonds to finance its deficits, these bonds will compete with corporate bonds and other financial instruments for the available supply of funds. If some private savers decide to buy bonds, the funds remaining to be invested in private hands will be smaller. Thus, some private borrowers will get 'crowded out' of the financial markets as the government claims an increasing share of the economy's total savings. However, one must note that the economy's flow of savings is not really

fixed unless we assume that income cannot be augmented. If government deficits succeed in their goal of raising production, there will be more income and, therefore, more saving. In this case, both government and industry can borrow more.

Also, if the government invests in infrastructure, future generations may be better off, provided the return on such investments is greater than the rate of interest. The actual debt could be paid off by the growth in output. The debt should not then be considered burdensome. The growth in debt will have to be judged by the growth of the economy as a whole.

Deficit Reduction: Government deficit can be reduced by an increase in taxes or reduction in expenditure. In India, the government has been trying to increase tax revenue with greater reliance on direct taxes (indirect taxes are regressive in nature – they impact all income groups equally). There has also been an attempt to raise receipts through the sale of shares in PSUs. However, the major thrust has been towards reduction in government expenditure. This could be achieved through making government activities more efficient through better planning of programmes and better administration. A recent study⁷ by the Planning Commission has estimated that to transfer Re1 to the poor, government spends Rs 3.65 in the form of food subsidy, showing that cash transfers would lead to increase in welfare. The other way is to change the scope of the government by withdrawing from some of the areas where it operated before. Cutting back government programmes in vital areas like agriculture, education, health, poverty alleviation, etc. would adversely affect the economy. Governments in many countries run huge deficits forcing them to eventually put in place self-imposed constraints of not increasing expenditure over pre-determined levels (Box 5.2 gives the main features of the FRBMA in India). These will have to be examined keeping in view the above factors. We must note that larger deficits do not always signify a more expansionary fiscal policy. The same fiscal measures can give rise to a large or small deficit, depending on the state of the economy. For example, if an economy experiences a recession and GDP falls, tax revenues fall because firms and households pay lower taxes when they earn less. This means that the deficit increases in a recession and falls in a boom, even with no change in fiscal policy.

⁷“Performance Evaluation of the Targeted Public Distribution System” by the Programme Evaluation Organisation, Planning Commission.

1. Public goods, as distinct from private goods, are collectively consumed. Two important features of public goods are – they are non-rivalrous in that one person can increase her satisfaction from the good without reducing that obtained by others and they are non-excludable, and there is no feasible way of excluding anyone from enjoying the benefits of the good. These make it difficult to collect fees for their use and private enterprise will in general not provide these goods. Hence, they must be provided by the government.
2. The three functions of allocation, redistribution and stabilisation operate through the expenditure and receipts of the government.
3. The budget, which gives a statement of the receipts and expenditure of the government, is divided into the revenue budget and capital budget to distinguish between current financial needs and investment in the country's capital stock.
4. The growth of revenue deficit as a percentage of fiscal deficit points to a deterioration in the quality of government expenditure involving lower capital formation.
5. Proportional taxes reduce the autonomous expenditure multiplier because taxes reduce the marginal propensity to consume out of income.
6. Public debt is burdensome if it reduces future growth in output.

Public goods

Automatic stabiliser

Discretionary fiscal policy

Ricardian equivalence

Box 5.2: Fiscal Responsibility and Budget Management Act, 2003 (FRBMA)

In a multi-party parliamentary system, electoral concerns play an important role in determining expenditure policies. A legislative provision, it is argued, that is applicable to all governments – present and future – is likely to be effective in keeping deficits under control. The enactment of the FRBMA, in August 2003, marked a turning point in fiscal reforms, binding the government through an institutional framework to pursue a prudent fiscal policy. The central government must ensure inter-generational equity and long-term macro-economic stability by achieving sufficient revenue surplus, removing fiscal obstacles to monetary policy and effective debt management by limiting deficits and borrowing. The rules under the Act were notified with effect from July, 2004.

Main Features

1. The Act mandates the central government to take appropriate measures to reduce fiscal deficit to not more than 3 percent of GDP and to eliminate the revenue deficit by March 31, 2009⁸ and thereafter build up adequate revenue surplus.
2. It requires the reduction in fiscal deficit by 0.3 per cent of GDP each year and the revenue deficit by 0.5 per cent. If this is not achieved

⁸This has been rescheduled by one year to 2009-10, primarily on account of a shift in plan priorities in favour of revenue expenditure - intensive programmes and schemes.

through tax revenues, the necessary adjustment has to come from a reduction in expenditure.

3. The actual deficits may exceed the targets specified only on grounds of national security or natural calamity or such other exceptional grounds as the central government may specify.
4. The central government shall not borrow from the Reserve Bank of India except by way of advances to meet temporary excess of cash disbursements over cash receipts.
5. The Reserve Bank of India must not subscribe to the primary issues of central government securities from the year 2006-07.
6. Measures to be taken to ensure greater transparency in fiscal operations.
7. The central government to lay before both Houses of Parliament three statements—Medium-term Fiscal Policy Statement, The Fiscal Policy Strategy Statement, The Macroeconomic Framework Statement along with the Annual Financial Statement.
8. Quarterly review of the trends in receipts and expenditure in relation to the budget be placed before both Houses of Parliament.

The act applies to the central government. However, 26 states have already enacted fiscal responsibility legislations which have made the rule based fiscal reform programme of the government more broad based. Although the government has emphasised that the FRBMA is an important institutional mechanism to ensure fiscal prudence and support macro economic balance there have been fears that welfare expenditure may get reduced to meet the targets mandated by the Act.

FRBM Review Committee

In the last thirteen years since the FRBM act was enacted, the Indian economy has graduated to a middle income country. At the time of enactment of the FRBM, there was a general thinking that fiscal rules were better than discretion. However, since then the advanced countries have moved away from this but in India, the government has affirmed its faith in the fiscal policy principles set out in the FRBM. Therefore, there is support for retaining the basic operational framework designed in 2003 but to revamp it to incorporate the changing scenario in India and also with an eye for the future path of growth – the task that has been handed to the FRBM Review Committee.

Box 5.3: GST: One Nation, One Tax, One Market

Goods and Service Tax (GST) is the single comprehensive indirect tax, operational from 1 July 2017, on supply of goods and services, right from the manufacturer/ service provider to the consumer. It is a destination based consumption tax with facility of Input Tax Credit in the supply chain. It is applicable throughout the country with one rate for one type of goods/service. It has amalgamated a large number of Central and State taxes and cesses. It has replaced large number of taxes on goods and services levied on production/sale of goods or provision of service.

As there have been a number of intermediate goods/services, which were manufactured/provided in the economy, the pre GST tax regime imposed taxes not on the value added at each stage but on the total value of the commodity/service with minimal facility of utilisation of Input Tax

Credit (ITC). The total value included taxes paid on intermediate goods/services. This amounted to cascading of tax. Under GST, the tax is discharged at every stage of supply and the credit of tax paid at the previous stage is available for set off at the next stage of supply of goods and/or services. It is thus effectively a tax on value addition at each stage of supply. In view of our large and fast growing economy, it addresses to establish parity in taxation across the country, and extend principles of 'value- added taxation' to all goods and services.

It has replaced various types of taxes/cesses, levied by the Central and State/UT Governments. Some of the major taxes that were levied by Centre were Central Excise Duty, Service Tax, Central Sales Tax, Cesses like KKC and SBC. The major State taxes were VAT/Sales Tax, Entry Tax, Luxury Tax, Octroi, Entertainment Tax, Taxes on Advertisements, Taxes on Lottery /Betting/ Gambling, State Cesses on goods etc. These have been subsumed in GST.

Five petroleum products have been kept out of GST for the time being but with passage of time, they will get subsumed in GST. State Governments will continue to levy VAT on alcoholic liquor for human consumption. Tobacco and tobacco products will attract both GST and Central Excise Duty. Under GST, there are 6 (six) standard rates applied i.e. 0%, 3%,5%, 12%,18% and 28% on supply of all goods and/or services across the country.

GST is the biggest tax reform in the country since independence and was rolled out on the mid-night of 30 June/1 July, 2017 during a special midnight session of the Parliament. The 101th Constitution Amendment Act received assent of the President of India on 8 September, 2016. The amendment introduced Article 246A in the Constitution cross empowering Parliament and Legislatures of States to make laws with reference to Goods and Service Tax imposed by the Union and the States. Thereafter CGST Act, UTGST Act and SGST Acts were enacted for GST. GST has simplified the multiplicity of taxes on goods and services. The laws, procedures and rates of taxes across the country are standardised. It has facilitated the freedom of movement of goods and services and created a common market in the country. It is aimed at reducing the cost of business operations and cascading effect of various taxes on consumers. It has also reduced the overall cost of production, which will make Indian products/services more competitive in the domestic and international markets. It will also result into higher economic growth as GDP is expected to rise by about 2%. Compliance will also be easier as all tax payment related services like registration, returns, payments are available online through a common portal www.gst.gov.in. It has expanded the tax base, introduced higher transparency in the taxation system, reduced human interface between Taxpayer and Government and is furthering ease of doing business.

1. Explain why public goods must be provided by the government.
2. Distinguish between revenue expenditure and capital expenditure.
3. 'The fiscal deficit gives the borrowing requirement of the government'. Elucidate.
4. Give the relationship between the revenue deficit and the fiscal deficit.
5. Suppose that for a particular economy, investment is equal to 200, government purchases are 150, net taxes (that is lump-sum taxes minus transfers) is 100 and consumption is given by $C = 100 + 0.75Y$ (a) What

- is the level of equilibrium income? (b) Calculate the value of the government expenditure multiplier and the tax multiplier. (c) If government expenditure increases by 200, find the change in equilibrium income.
6. Consider an economy described by the following functions: $C = 20 + 0.80Y$, $I = 30$, $G = 50$, $TR = 100$ (a) Find the equilibrium level of income and the autonomous expenditure multiplier in the model. (b) If government expenditure increases by 30, what is the impact on equilibrium income? (c) If a lump-sum tax of 30 is added to pay for the increase in government purchases, how will equilibrium income change?
 7. In the above question, calculate the effect on output of a 10 per cent increase in transfers, and a 10 per cent increase in lump-sum taxes. Compare the effects of the two.
 8. We suppose that $C = 70 + 0.70Y$, D , $I = 90$, $G = 100$, $T = 0.10Y$ (a) Find the equilibrium income. (b) What are tax revenues at equilibrium income? Does the government have a balanced budget?
 9. Suppose marginal propensity to consume is 0.75 and there is a 20 per cent proportional income tax. Find the change in equilibrium income for the following (a) Government purchases increase by 20 (b) Transfers decrease by 20.
 10. Explain why the tax multiplier is smaller in absolute value than the government expenditure multiplier.
 11. Explain the relation between government deficit and government debt.
 12. Does public debt impose a burden? Explain.
 13. Are fiscal deficits inflationary?
 14. Discuss the issue of deficit reduction.
 15. What do you understand by G.S.T? How good is the system of G.S.T as compared to the old tax system? State its categories.

Suggested Readings

1. Dornbusch, R. and S. Fischer. 1994. *Macroeconomics*, sixth edition. McGraw-Hill, Paris.
2. Mankiw, N.G., 2000. *Macroeconomics*, fourth edition. Macmillan Worth publishers, New York.
3. *Economic Survey*, Government of India, various issues.



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Chapter 6

Open Economy Macroeconomics



An **open economy** is one which interacts with other countries through various channels. So far we had not considered this aspect and just limited to a closed economy in which there are no linkages with the rest of the world in order to simplify our analysis and explain the basic macroeconomic mechanisms. In reality, most modern economies are open. There are three ways in which these linkages are established.

1. **Output Market:** An economy can trade in goods and services with other countries. This widens choice in the sense that consumers and producers can choose between domestic and foreign goods.
2. **Financial Market:** Most often an economy can buy financial assets from other countries. This gives investors the opportunity to choose between domestic and foreign assets.
3. **Labour Market:** Firms can choose where to locate production and workers to choose where to work. There are various immigration laws which restrict the movement of labour between countries.

Movement of goods has traditionally been seen as a substitute for the movement of labour. We focus on the first two linkages. Thus, an open economy is said to be one that trades with other nations in goods and services and most often, also in financial assets. Indians for instance, can consume products which are produced around the world and some of the products from India are exported to other countries.

Foreign trade, therefore, influences Indian aggregate demand in two ways. First, when Indians buy foreign goods, this spending escapes as a **leakage** from the circular flow of income decreasing aggregate demand. Second, our exports to foreigners enter as an **injection** into the circular flow, increasing aggregate demand for goods produced within the domestic economy.

When goods move across national borders, **money** must be used for the transactions. At the international level there is no single currency that is issued by a single bank. Foreign

economic agents will accept a national currency only if they are convinced that the amount of goods they can buy with a certain amount of that currency will not change frequently. In other words, the currency will maintain a stable purchasing power. Without this confidence, a currency will not be used as an international medium of exchange and unit of account since there is no international authority with the power to force the use of a particular currency in international transactions.

In the past, governments have tried to gain confidence of potential users by announcing that the national currency will be freely convertible at a fixed price into another asset. Also, the issuing authority will have no control over the value of that asset into which the currency can be converted. This other asset most often has been gold, or other national currencies. There are two aspects of this commitment that has affected its credibility — the ability to convert freely in unlimited amounts and the price at which this conversion takes place. The **international monetary system** has been set up to handle these issues and ensure stability in international transactions.

With the increase in the volume of transactions, gold ceased to be the asset into which national currencies could be converted (See Box 6.2). Although some national currencies have international acceptability, what is important in transactions between two countries is the currency in which the trade occurs. For instance, if an Indian wants to buy a good made in America, she would need dollars to complete the transaction. If the price of the good is ten dollars, she would need to know how much it would cost her in Indian rupees. That is, she will need to know the price of dollar in terms of rupees. The price of one currency in terms of another currency is known as the **foreign exchange rate** or simply the **exchange rate**. We will discuss this in detail in section 6.2.

6.1 THE BALANCE OF PAYMENTS

The balance of payments (BoP) record the transactions in goods, services and assets between residents of a country with the rest of the world for a specified time period typically a year. There are two main accounts in the BoP — the current account and the capital account¹.

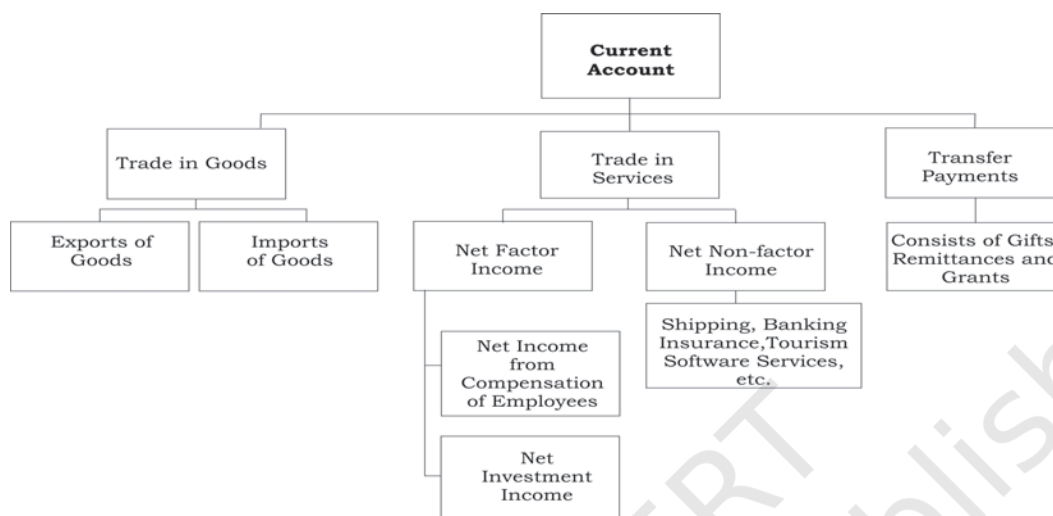
6.1.1 Current Account

Current Account is the record of trade in goods and services and transfer payments. Figure 6.1 illustrates the components of Current Account. Trade in goods includes exports and imports of goods. Trade in services includes factor income and non-factor income transactions. Transfer payments are the receipts which the residents of a country get for 'free', without having to provide any goods or services in return. They consist of gifts, remittances and grants. They could be given by the government or by private citizens living abroad.

¹ There is a new classification in which the balance of payments have been divided into three accounts — the current account, the financial account and the capital account. This is as per the new accounting standards specified by the International Monetary Fund (IMF) in the sixth edition of the Balance of Payments and International Investment Position Manual (BPM6). India has also made the change but the Reserve Bank of India continues to publish data accounting to the old classification.

Buying foreign goods is expenditure from our country and it becomes the income of that foreign country. Hence, the purchase of foreign goods or imports decreases the domestic demand for goods and services in our country. Similarly, selling of foreign goods or exports brings income to our country and adds to the aggregate domestic demand for goods and services in our country.

Fig. 6.1: Components of Current Account



Balance on Current Account

Current Account is in balance when receipts on current account are equal to the payments on the current account. A surplus current account means that the nation is a lender to other countries and a deficit current account means that the nation is a borrower from other countries.

Current Account Surplus	Balanced Current Account	Current Account Deficit
Receipts > Payments	Receipts = Payments	Receipts < Payments

Balance on Current Account has two components:

- Balance of Trade or Trade Balance
- Balance on Invisibles

Balance of Trade (BOT) is the difference between the value of exports and value of imports of goods of a country in a given period of time. Export of goods is entered as a credit item in BOT, whereas import of goods is entered as a debit item in BOT. It is also known as Trade Balance.

BOT is said to be in balance when exports of goods are equal to the imports of goods. Surplus BOT or Trade surplus will arise if country exports more goods than what it imports. Whereas, Deficit BOT or Trade deficit will arise if a country imports more goods than what it exports.

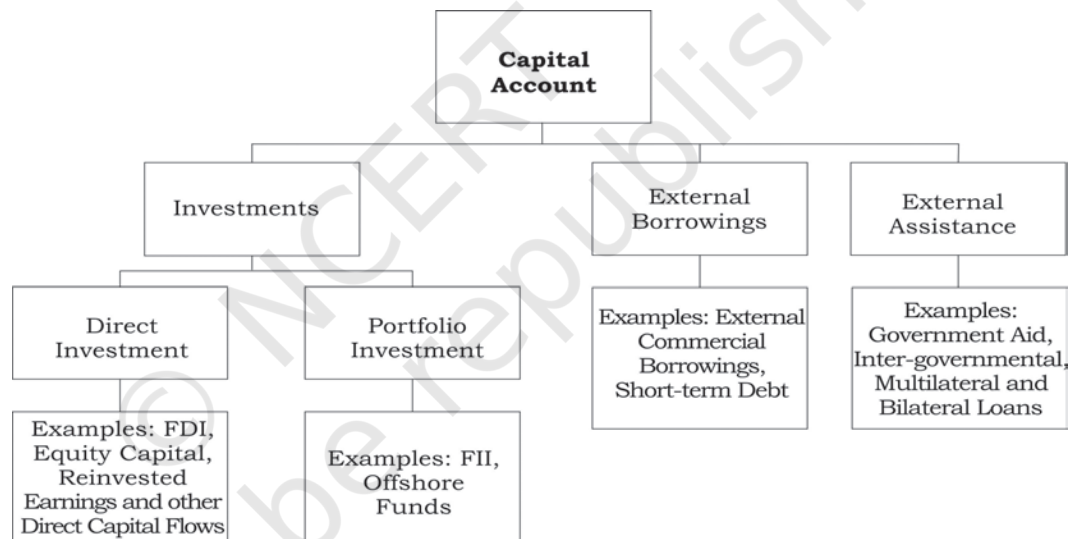
Net Invisibles is the difference between the value of exports and value

of imports of invisibles of a country in a given period of time. Invisibles include services, transfers and flows of income that take place between different countries. Services trade includes both factor and non-factor income. Factor income includes net international earnings on factors of production (like labour, land and capital). Non-factor income is net sale of service products like shipping, banking, tourism, software services, etc.

6.1.2 Capital Account

Capital Account records all international transactions of assets. An asset is any one of the forms in which wealth can be held, for example: money, stocks, bonds, Government debt, etc. Purchase of assets is a debit item on the capital account. If an Indian buys a UK Car Company, it enters capital account transactions as a debit item (as foreign exchange is flowing out of India). On the other hand, sale of assets like sale of share of an Indian company to a Chinese customer is a credit item on the capital account. Fig. 6.2 classifies the items which are a part of capital account transactions. These items are Foreign Direct Investments (FDIs), Foreign Institutional Investments (FIIs), external borrowings and assistance.

Fig. 6.2: Components of Capital Account



Balance on Capital Account

Capital account is in balance when capital inflows (like receipt of loans from abroad, sale of assets or shares in foreign companies) are equal to capital outflows (like repayment of loans, purchase of assets or shares in foreign countries). Surplus in capital account arises when capital inflows are greater than capital outflows, whereas deficit in capital account arises when capital inflows are lesser than capital outflows.

6.1.3 Balance of Payments Surplus and Deficit

The essence of international payments is that just like an individual who spends more than her income must finance the difference by selling assets or by borrowing, a country that has a deficit in its current account (spending more

than it receives from sales to the rest of the world) must finance it by selling assets or by borrowing abroad. Thus, any current account deficit must be financed by a capital account surplus, that is, a net capital inflow.

$$\text{Current account} + \text{Capital account} = 0$$

In this case, in which a country is said to be in balance of payments equilibrium, the current account deficit is financed entirely by international lending without any reserve movements.

Alternatively, the country could use its reserves of foreign exchange in order to balance any deficit in its balance of payments. The reserve bank sells foreign exchange when there is a deficit. This is called **official reserve sale**. The decrease (increase) in official reserves is called the **overall balance of payments deficit (surplus)**. The basic premise is that the monetary authorities are the ultimate financiers of any deficit in the balance of payments (or the recipients of any surplus).

We note that official reserve transactions are more relevant under a regime of fixed exchange rates than when exchange rates are floating. (See sub heading 'Fixed Exchange Rates' under section 6.2.2)

Autonomous and Accommodating Transactions

International economic transactions are called **autonomous** when transactions are made due to some reason other than to bridge the gap in the balance of payments, that is, when they are independent of the state of BoP. One reason could be to earn profit. These items are called 'above the line' items in the BoP. The balance of payments is said to be in surplus (deficit) if autonomous receipts are greater (less) than autonomous payments.

Accommodating transactions (termed 'below the line' items), on the other hand, are determined by the gap in the balance of payments, that is, whether there is a deficit or surplus in the balance of payments. In other words, they are determined by the net consequences of the autonomous transactions. Since the official reserve transactions are made to bridge the gap in the BoP, they are seen as the accommodating item in the BoP (all others being autonomous).

Errors and Omissions

It is difficult to record all international transactions accurately. Thus, we have a third element of BoP (apart from the current and capital accounts) called **errors and omissions** which reflects this.

Table 6.1 provides a sample of Balance of Payments for India. Note in this table, there is a trade deficit and current account deficit but a capital account surplus. As a result, BOP is in balance.

BoP Deficit	Balanced BoP	BoP Surplus
Overall Balance < 0	Overall Balance = 0	Overall Balance > 0
Reserve Change > 0	Reserve Change = 0	Reserve Change < 0

Box 6.1: The balance of payments accounts presented above divide the transactions into two accounts, current account and capital account. However, following the new accounting standards introduced by the International Monetary Fund in the sixth edition of the *Balance of Payments and International Investment Position Manual* (BPM6) the Reserve Bank of India also made changes in the structure of balance of payments accounts. According to the new classification, the transactions are divided into three accounts: current account, financial account and capital account. The most important change is that almost all the transactions arising on account of trade in financial assets such as bonds and equity shares are now placed in the financial account. However, RBI continues to publish the balance of payments accounts as per the old system also, therefore the details of the new system are not being given here. The details are given in the *Balance of Payments Manual for India* published by the Reserve Bank of India in September 2010.

Table 6.1: **Balance of Payments for India (in million USD)**

No.	Item	Million USD
1.	Exports (of goods only)	150
2.	Imports (of goods only)	240
3.	Trade Balance [2 - 1]	-90
4.	(Net) Invisibles [4a + 4b + 4c]	52
	a. Non-factor Services	30
	b. Income	-10
	c. Transfers	32
5.	Current Account Balance [3+ 4]	-38
6.	Capital Account Balance	41.15
	[6a + 6b + 6c + 6d + 6e + 6f]	
	a. External Assistance (net)	0.15
	b. External Commercial Borrowings (net)	2
	c. Short-term Debt	10
	d. Banking Capital (net) of which	15
	Non-resident Deposits (net)	9
	e. Foreign Investments (net) of which	19
	[6eA + 6eB]	
	A. FDI (net)	13

	B. Portfolio (net)	6
	f. Other Flows (net)	-5
7.	Errors and Omissions	3.15
8.	Overall Balance [5 + 6 + 7]	0
9.	Reserves Change	0

6.2 THE FOREIGN EXCHANGE MARKET

So far, we have considered the accounting of international transactions on the whole, we will now take up a single transaction. Let us assume that a single Indian resident wants to visit London on a vacation (an import of tourist services). She will have to pay in pounds for her stay there. She will need to know where to obtain the pounds and at what price. As mentioned at the beginning of this chapter, this price is known as the exchange rate. The market in which national currencies are traded for one another is known as the **foreign exchange market**.

The major participants in the foreign exchange market are commercial banks, foreign exchange brokers and other authorised dealers and monetary authorities. It is important to note that although participants themselves may have their own trading centres, the market itself is world-wide. There is a close and continuous contact between the trading centres and the participants deal in more than one market.

6.2.1 Foreign Exchange Rate

Foreign Exchange Rate (also called Forex Rate) is the price of one currency in terms of another. It links the currencies of different countries and enables comparison of international costs and prices. For example, if we have to pay Rs 50 for \$1 then the exchange rate is Rs 50 per dollar.

To make it simple, let us consider that India and USA are the only countries in the world and so there is only one exchange rate that needs to be determined.

Demand for Foreign Exchange

People demand foreign exchange because: they want to purchase goods and services from other countries; they want to send gifts abroad; and, they want to purchase financial assets of a certain country.

A rise in price of foreign exchange will increase the cost (in terms of rupees) of purchasing a foreign good. This reduces demand for imports and hence demand for foreign exchange also decreases, other things remaining constant.

Supply of Foreign Exchange

Foreign currency flows into the home country due to the following reasons: exports by a country lead to the purchase of its domestic goods and services by the foreigners; foreigners send gifts or make transfers; and, the assets of a home country are bought by the foreigners.

A rise in price of foreign exchange will reduce the foreigner's cost (in terms of USD) while purchasing products from India, other things remaining constant. This increases India's exports and hence supply for foreign exchange may

increase (whether it actually increases depends on a number of factors, particularly elasticity of demand for exports and imports).

6.2.2 Determination of the Exchange Rate

Different countries have different methods of determining their currency's exchange rate. It can be determined through Flexible Exchange Rate, Fixed Exchange Rate or Managed Floating Exchange Rate.

Flexible Exchange Rate

This exchange rate is determined by the market forces of demand and supply. It is also known as **Floating Exchange Rate**. As depicted in Fig. 6.1, the exchange rate is determined where the demand curve intersects with the supply curve, i.e., at point e on the Y – axis. Point q on the x – axis determines the quantity of US Dollars that have been demanded and supplied on e exchange rate. In a completely flexible system, the Central banks do not intervene in the foreign exchange market.

Suppose the demand for foreign goods and services increases (for example, due to increased international travelling by Indians), then as depicted in Fig. 6.2, the demand curve shifts upward and right to the original demand curve. The increase in demand for foreign goods and services result in a change in the exchange rate. The initial exchange rate $e_0 = 50$, which means that we need to exchange Rs 50 for one dollar. At the new equilibrium, the exchange rate becomes $e_1 = 70$, which means that we need to pay more rupees for a dollar now (i.e., Rs 70). It indicates that the value of rupees in terms of dollars has fallen and value of dollar in terms of rupees has risen. Increase in exchange rate implies that the price of foreign currency (dollar) in terms of domestic currency (rupees) has increased. This is called **Depreciation** of domestic currency (rupees) in terms of foreign currency (dollars).

Similarly, in a flexible exchange rate regime, when the price of domestic currency (rupees) in terms of foreign currency (dollars) increases, it is called **Appreciation** of the domestic currency (rupees) in terms of foreign currency (dollars). This means that the

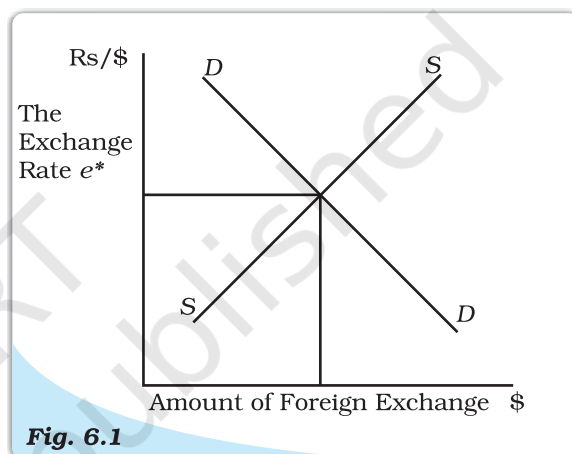


Fig. 6.1

Equilibrium under Flexible Exchange Rates

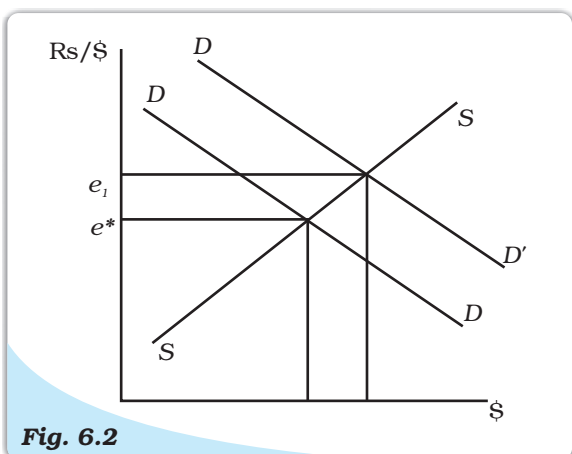


Fig. 6.2

Effect of an Increase in Demand for Imports in the Foreign Exchange Market

value of rupees relative to dollar has risen and we need to pay fewer rupees in exchange for one dollar.

Speculation

Money in any country is an asset. If Indians believe that British pound is going to increase in value relative to the rupee, they will want to hold pounds. Thus exchange rates also get affected when people hold foreign exchange on the expectation that they can make gains from the appreciation of the currency. This expectation in turn can actually affect the exchange rate in the following way. If the current exchange rate is Rs. 80 to a pound and investors believe that the pound is going to appreciate by the end of the month and will be worth Rs.85, investors think if they gave the dealer Rs. 80,000 and bought 1000 pounds, at the end of the month, they would be able to exchange the pounds for Rs. 85,000, thus making a profit of Rs. 5,000. This expectation would increase the demand for pounds and cause the rupee-pound exchange rate to increase in the present, making the beliefs self-fulfilling.

Interest Rates and the Exchange Rate

In the short run, another factor that is important in determining exchange rate movements is the interest rate differential i.e. the difference between interest rates between countries. There are huge funds owned by banks, multinational corporations and wealthy individuals which move around the world in search of the highest interest rates. If we assume that government bonds in country A pay 8 per cent rate of interest whereas equally safe bonds in country B yield 10 per cent, the interest rate differential is 2 per cent. Investors from country A will be attracted by the high interest rates in country B and will buy the currency of country B selling their own currency. At the same time investors in country B will also find investing in their own country more attractive and will therefore demand less of country A's currency. This means that the demand curve for country A's currency will shift to the left and the supply curve will shift to the right causing a depreciation of country A's currency and an appreciation of country B's currency. Thus, a rise in the interest rates at home often leads to an appreciation of the domestic currency. Here, the implicit assumption is that no restrictions exist in buying bonds issued by foreign governments.

Income and the Exchange Rate

When income increases, consumer spending increases. Spending on imported goods is also likely to increase. When imports increase, the demand curve for foreign exchange shifts to the right. There is a depreciation of the domestic currency. If there is an increase in income abroad as well, domestic exports will rise and the supply curve of foreign exchange shifts outward. On balance, the domestic currency may or may not depreciate. What happens will depend on whether exports are growing faster than imports. In general, other things remaining equal, a country whose aggregate demand grows faster than the rest of the world's normally finds its currency depreciating because its imports grow faster than its exports. Its demand curve for foreign currency shifts faster than its supply curve.

Exchange Rates in the Long Run

The purchasing Power (PPP) theory is used to make long-run predictions about exchange rates in a flexible exchange rate system. According to the theory, as long as there are no barriers to trade like tariffs (taxes on trade) and quotas

(quantitative limits on imports), exchange rates should eventually adjust so that the same product costs the same whether measured in rupees in India, or dollars in the US, yen in Japan and so on, except for differences in transportation. Over the long run, therefore, exchange rates between any two national currencies adjust to reflect differences in the price levels in the two countries.

EXAMPLE 6.1

If a shirt costs \$8 in the US and Rs 400 in India, the rupee-dollar exchange rate should be Rs 50. To see why, at any rate higher than Rs 50, say Rs 60, it costs Rs 480 per shirt in the US but only Rs 400 in India. In that case, all foreign customers would buy shirts from India. Similarly, any exchange rate below Rs 50 per dollar will send all the shirt business to the US. Next, we suppose that prices in India rise by 20 per cent while prices in the US rise by 50 per cent. Indian shirts would now cost Rs 480 per shirt while American shirts cost \$12 per shirt. For these two prices to be equivalent, \$12 must be worth Rs 480, or one dollar must be worth Rs 40. The dollar, therefore, has depreciated.

Fixed Exchange Rates

In this exchange rate system, the Government fixes the exchange rate at a particular level. In Fig. 6.3, the market determined exchange rate is e . However, let us suppose that for some reason the Indian Government wants to encourage exports for which it needs to make rupee cheaper for foreigners it would do so by fixing a higher exchange rate, say Rs 70 per dollar from the current exchange rate of Rs 50 per dollar. Thus, the new exchange rate set by the Government is e_1 , where $e_1 > e$. At this exchange rate, the supply of dollars exceeds the demand for dollars. The RBI intervenes to purchase the dollars for rupees in the foreign exchange market in order to absorb this excess supply which has been marked as AB in the figure. Thus, through intervention, the Government can maintain any exchange rate in the economy. But it will be accumulating more and more foreign exchange so long as this intervention goes on. On the other hand if the government was to set an exchange rate at a level such as e_2 , there would be an excess demand for dollars in the foreign exchange market. To meet this excess demand for dollars, the government would have to withdraw dollars from its past holdings of dollars. If it fails to do so, a black market for dollars may come up.

In a fixed exchange rate system, when some government action increases the exchange rate (thereby, making domestic currency cheaper) is called **Devaluation**. On the other hand, a **Revaluation** is said to occur, when the Government decreases the exchange rate (thereby, making domestic currency costlier) in a fixed exchange rate system.

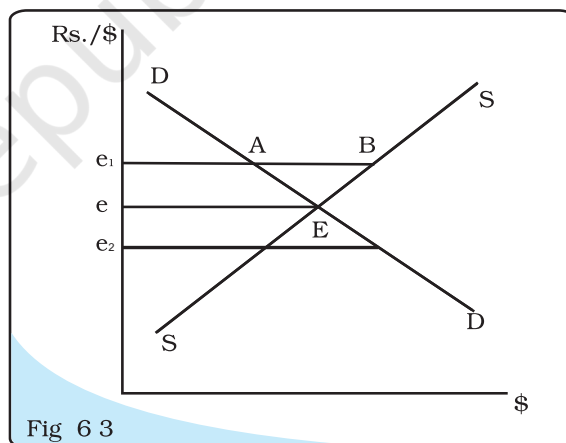


Fig 6 3

Foreign Exchange Market with Fixed Exchange Rates

6.2.3 Merits and Demerits of Flexible and Fixed Exchange Rate Systems

The main feature of the fixed exchange rate system is that there must be credibility that the government will be able to maintain the exchange rate at the level specified. Often, if there is a deficit in the BoP, in a fixed exchange rate system, governments will have to intervene to take care of the gap by use of its official reserves. If people know that the amount of reserves is inadequate, they would begin to doubt the ability of the government to maintain the fixed rate. This may give rise to speculation of devaluation. When this belief translates into aggressive buying of one currency thereby forcing the government to devalue, it is said to constitute a speculative attack on a currency. Fixed exchange rates are prone to these kinds of attacks, as has been witnessed in the period before the collapse of the Bretton Woods System.

The flexible exchange rate system gives the government more flexibility and they do not need to maintain large stocks of foreign exchange reserves. The major advantage of flexible exchange rates is that movements in the exchange rate automatically take care of the surpluses and deficits in the BoP. Also, countries gain independence in conducting their monetary policies, since they do not have to intervene to maintain exchange rate which are automatically taken care of by the market.

6.2.4 Managed Floating

Without any formal international agreement, the world has moved on to what can be best described as a **managed floating** exchange rate system. It is a mixture of a flexible exchange rate system (the float part) and a fixed rate system (the managed part). Under this system, also called **dirty floating**, central banks intervene to buy and sell foreign currencies in an attempt to moderate exchange rate movements whenever they feel that such actions are appropriate. Official reserve transactions are, therefore, not equal to zero.

Key Concepts

Open economy	Balance of payments
Current account deficit	Official reserve transactions
Autonomous and accommodating transactions	Nominal and real exchange rate
Purchasing power parity	Flexible exchange rate
Depreciation	Interest rate differential
Fixed exchange rate	Devaluation
Managed floating	Demand for domestic goods
Marginal propensity to import	Net exports
Open economy multiplier	



1. Differentiate between balance of trade and current account balance.
2. What are official reserve transactions? Explain their importance in the balance of payments.
3. Distinguish between the nominal exchange rate and the real exchange rate. If you were to decide whether to buy domestic goods or foreign goods, which rate would be more relevant? Explain.
4. Suppose it takes 1.25 yen to buy a rupee, and the price level in Japan is 3 and the price level in India is 1.2. Calculate the real exchange rate between India and Japan (the price of Japanese goods in terms of Indian goods). (**Hint:** First find out the nominal exchange rate as a price of yen in rupees).
5. Explain the automatic mechanism by which BoP equilibrium was achieved under the gold standard.
6. How is the exchange rate determined under a flexible exchange rate regime?
7. Differentiate between devaluation and depreciation.
8. Would the central bank need to intervene in a managed floating system? Explain why.
9. Are the concepts of demand for domestic goods and domestic demand for goods the same?
10. What is the marginal propensity to import when $M = 60 + 0.06Y$? What is the relationship between the marginal propensity to import and the aggregate demand function?
11. Why is the open economy autonomous expenditure multiplier smaller than the closed economy one?
12. Calculate the open economy multiplier with proportional taxes, $T = tY$, instead of lump-sum taxes as assumed in the text.
13. Suppose $C = 40 + 0.8Y$, $D, T = 50, I = 60, G = 40, X = 90, M = 50 + 0.05Y$ (a) Find equilibrium income. (b) Find the net export balance at equilibrium income (c) What happens to equilibrium income and the net export balance when the government purchases increase from 40 and 50?
14. In the above example, if exports change to $X = 100$, find the change in equilibrium income and the net export balance.
15. Suppose the exchange rate between the Rupee and the dollar was Rs. 30=1\$ in the year 2010. Suppose the prices have doubled in India over 20 years while they have remained fixed in USA. What, according to the purchasing power parity theory will be the exchange rate between dollar and rupee in the year 2030.
16. If inflation is higher in country A than in Country B, and the exchange rate between the two countries is fixed, what is likely to happen to the trade balance between the two countries?
17. Should a current account deficit be a cause for alarm? Explain.
18. Suppose $C = 100 + 0.75Y$, $D, I = 500, G = 750$, taxes are 20 per cent of income, $X = 150, M = 100 + 0.2Y$. Calculate equilibrium income, the budget deficit or surplus and the trade deficit or surplus.
19. Discuss some of the exchange rate arrangements that countries have entered into to bring about stability in their external accounts.

Suggested Readings

1. Dornbusch, R. and S. Fischer, 1994. *Macroeconomics*, sixth edition, McGraw-Hill, Paris.
2. *Economic Survey*, Government of India, 2006-07.
3. Krugman, P.R. and M. Obstfeld, 2000. *International Economics, Theory and Policy*, fifth edition, Pearson Education.

DETERMINATION OF EQUILIBRIUM INCOME IN OPEN ECONOMY

With consumers and firms having an option to buy goods produced at home and abroad, we now need to distinguish between domestic demand for goods and the demand for domestic goods.

National Income Identity for an Open Economy

In a closed economy, there are three sources of demand for domestic goods – Consumption (C), government spending (G), and domestic investment (I). We can write

$$Y = C + I + G \quad (6.1)$$

In an open economy, exports (X) constitute an additional source of demand for domestic goods and services that comes from abroad and therefore must be added to aggregate demand. Imports (M) supplement supplies in domestic markets and constitute that part of domestic demand that falls on foreign goods and services. Therefore, the national income identity for an open economy is

$$Y + M = C + I + G + X \quad (6.2)$$

Rearranging, we get

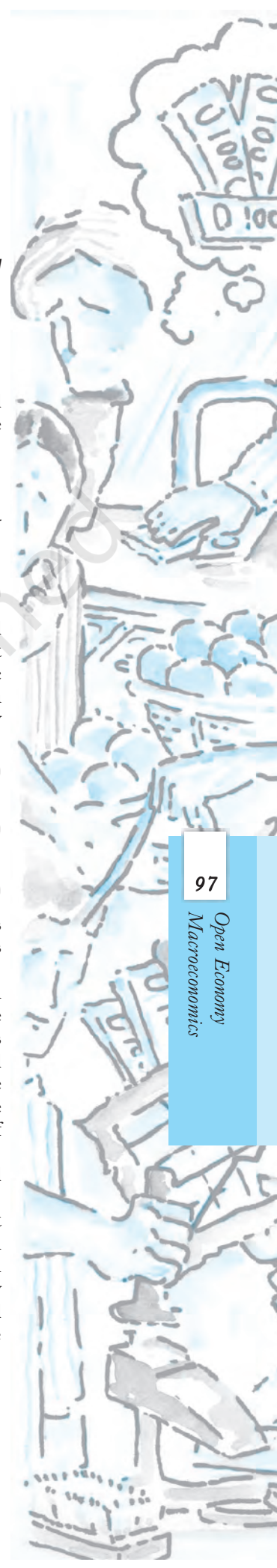
$$Y = C + I + G + X - M \quad (6.3)$$

or

$$Y = C + I + G + NX \quad (6.4)$$

where, NX is **net exports** (exports – imports). A positive NX (with exports greater than imports) implies a trade surplus and a negative NX (with imports exceeding exports) implies a trade deficit.

To examine the roles of imports and exports in determining equilibrium income in an open economy, we follow the same procedure as we did for the closed economy case – we take investment and government spending as autonomous. In addition, we need to specify the determinants of imports and exports. The demand for imports depends on domestic income (Y) and the real exchange rate (R). Higher income leads to higher imports. Recall that the real exchange rate is defined as the relative price of foreign goods in terms of domestic goods. A higher R makes foreign goods relatively more expensive, thereby leading to a decrease in the quantity of imports. Thus, imports depend positively on Y and negatively on R . The export of one country is, by definition, the import of another. Thus, our exports would constitute of foreign imports. It would depend on foreign income, Y_f , and on R . A rise in Y_f will increase foreign demand for our goods, thus leading to higher exports. An increase in R , which makes domestic goods cheaper, will increase our exports. Exports depend positively on foreign income and the real exchange rate. Thus, exports and imports depend on domestic income, foreign income and the real exchange rate. We assume price



levels and the nominal exchange rate to be constant, hence R will be fixed. From the point of view of our country, foreign income, and therefore exports, are considered exogenous ($X = \bar{X}$).

The demand for imports is thus assumed to depend on income and have an autonomous component

$$M = \bar{M} + mY, \text{ where } \bar{M} > 0 \text{ is the autonomous component, } 0 < m < 1. \quad (6.5)$$

Here m is the **marginal propensity to import**, the fraction of an extra rupee of income spent on imports, a concept analogous to the marginal propensity to consume.

The equilibrium income would be

$$Y = \bar{C} + c(Y - T) + \bar{I} + \bar{G} + \bar{X} - \bar{M} - mY \quad (6.6)$$

Taking all the autonomous components together as $\bar{A}$, we get

$$Y = \bar{A} + cY - mY \quad (6.7)$$

$$\text{or,} \quad (1 - c + m)Y = \bar{A} \quad (6.8)$$

$$\text{or,} \quad Y^* = \frac{1}{1 - c + m} \bar{A} \quad (6.9)$$

In order to examine the effects of allowing for foreign trade in the income-expenditure framework, we need to compare equation (6.10) with the equivalent expression for the equilibrium income in a closed economy model. In both equations, equilibrium income is expressed as a product of two terms, the autonomous expenditure multiplier and the level of autonomous expenditures. We consider how each of these change in the open economy context.

Since m , the marginal propensity to import, is greater than zero, we get a smaller multiplier in an open economy. It is given by

$$\text{The open economy multiplier} = \frac{\Delta Y}{\Delta A} = \frac{1}{1 - c + m} \quad (6.10)$$

EXAMPLE 6.2

If $c = 0.8$ and $m = 0.3$, we would have the open and closed economy multiplier respectively as

$$\frac{1}{1 - c} = \frac{1}{1 - 0.8} = \frac{1}{0.2} = 5 \quad (6.11)$$

and

$$\frac{1}{1 - c + m} = \frac{1}{1 - 0.8 + 0.3} = \frac{1}{0.5} = 2 \quad (6.12)$$

If domestic autonomous demand increases by 100, in a closed economy output increases by 500 whereas it increases by only 200 in an open economy.

The fall in the value of the autonomous expenditure multiplier with the opening up of the economy can be explained with reference to our previous discussion of the multiplier process (Chapter 4). A change in autonomous expenditures, for instance a change in government spending, will have a direct effect on income and an induced effect on consumption with a further effect on income. With an mpc greater than zero, a proportion of the induced effect on consumption will be a demand for foreign, not domestic goods. Therefore, the induced effect on demand for domestic goods, and hence on domestic income, will be smaller. The increase in imports per unit of income constitutes an additional leakage from the circular flow of domestic income at each round of the multiplier process and reduces the value of the autonomous expenditure multiplier.

The second term in equation (6.10) shows that, in addition to the elements for a closed economy, autonomous expenditure for an open economy includes the level of exports and the autonomous component of imports. Thus, the changes in their levels are additional shocks that will change equilibrium income. From equation (6.10) we can compute the multiplier effects of changes in $\bar{X}$ and $\bar{M}$.

$$\frac{\Delta Y^*}{\Delta \bar{X}} = \frac{1}{1 - c + m} \quad (6.13)$$

$$\frac{\Delta Y^*}{\Delta \bar{M}} = \frac{-1}{1 - c + m} \quad (6.14)$$

An increase in demand for our exports is an increase in aggregate demand for domestically produced output and will increase demand just as would an increase in government spending or an autonomous increase in investment. In contrast, an autonomous rise in import demand is seen to cause a fall in demand for domestic output and causes equilibrium income to decline.

Glossary

Adam Smith (1723–1790) Regarded as the father of modern Economics. Author of *Wealth of Nations*.

Aggregate monetary resources Broad money without time deposits of post office savings organisation (M3).

Automatic stabilisers Under certain spending and tax rules, expenditures that automatically increase or taxes that automatically decrease when economic conditions worsen, therefore, stabilising the economy automatically.

Autonomous change A change in the values of variables in a macroeconomic model caused by a factor exogenous to the model.

Autonomous expenditure multiplier The ratio of increase (or decrease) in aggregate output or income to an increase (or decrease) in autonomous spending.

Balance of payments A set of accounts that summarise a country's transactions with the rest of the world.

Balanced budget A budget in which taxes are equal to government spending.

Balanced budget multiplier The change in equilibrium output that results from a unit increase or decrease in both taxes and government spending.

Bank rate The rate of interest payable by commercial banks to RBI if they borrow money from the latter in case of a shortage of reserves.

Barter exchange Exchange of commodities without the mediation of money.

Base year The year whose prices are used to calculate the real GDP.

Bonds A paper bearing the promise of a stream of future monetary returns over a specified period of time. Issued by firms or governments for borrowing money from the public.

Broad money Narrow money + time deposits held by commercial banks and post office savings organisation.

Capital Factor of production which has itself been produced and which is not generally entirely consumed in the production process.

Capital gain/loss Increase or decrease in the value of wealth of a bondholder due to an appreciation or reduction in the price of her bonds in the bond market.

Capital goods Goods which are bought not for meeting immediate need of the consumer but for producing other goods.

Capitalist country or economy A country in which most of the production is carried out by capitalist firms.

Capitalist firms These are firms with the following features (a) private ownership of means of production (b) production for the market (c) sale and purchase of labour at a price which is called the wage rate (d) continuous accumulation of capital.

Cash Reserve Ratio (CRR) The fraction of their deposits which the commercial banks are required to keep with RBI.

Circular flow of income The concept that the aggregate value of goods and services produced in an economy is going around in a circular way. Either as factor payments, or as expenditures on goods and services, or as the value of aggregate production.

Consumer durables Consumption goods which do not get exhausted immediately but last over a period of time are consumer durables.

Consumer Price Index (CPI) Percentage change in the weighted average price level. We take the prices of a given basket of consumption goods.

Consumption goods Goods which are consumed by the ultimate consumers or meet the immediate need of the consumer are called consumption goods. It may include services as well.

Corporate tax Taxes imposed on the income made by the corporations (or private sector firms).

Currency deposit ratio The ratio of money held by the public in currency to that held as deposits in commercial banks.

Deficit financing through central bank borrowing Financing of budget deficit by the government through borrowing money from the central bank. Leads to increase in money supply in an economy and may result in inflation.

Depreciation A decrease in the price of the domestic currency in terms of the foreign currency under floating exchange rates. It corresponds to an increase in the exchange rate.

Depreciation Wear and tear or depletion which capital stock undergoes over a period of time.

Devaluation The decrease in the price of domestic currency under pegged exchange rates through official action.

Double coincidence of wants A situation where two economic agents have complementary demand for each others' surplus production.

Economic agents or units Economic units or economic agents are those individuals or institutions which take economic decisions.

Effective demand principle If the supply of final goods is assumed to be infinitely elastic at constant price over a short period of time, aggregate output is determined solely by the value of aggregate demand. This is called effective demand principle.

Entrepreneurship The task of organising, coordinating and risk-taking during production.

Ex ante consumption The value of planned consumption.

Ex ante investment The value of planned investment.

Ex ante The planned value of a variable as opposed to its actual value.

Ex post The actual or realised value of a variable as opposed to its planned value.

Expenditure method of calculating national income Method of calculating the national income by measuring the aggregate value of final expenditure for the goods and services produced in an economy over a period of time.

Exports Sale of goods and services by the domestic country to the rest of the world.

External sector It refers to the economic transaction of the domestic country with the rest of the world.

Externalities Those benefits or harms accruing to another person, firm or any other entity which occur because some person, firm or any other entity may be involved in an economic activity. If someone is causing benefits or good externality to another, the latter does not pay the former. If someone is inflicting harm or bad externality to another, the former does not compensate the latter.

Fiat money Money with no intrinsic value.

Final goods Those goods which do not undergo any further transformation in the production process.

Firms Economic units which carry out production of goods and services and employ factors of production.

Fiscal policy The policy of the government regarding the level of government spending and transfers and the tax structure.

Fixed exchange rate An exchange rate between the currencies of two or more countries that is fixed at some level and adjusted only infrequently.

Flexible/floating exchange rate An exchange rate determined by the forces of demand and supply in the foreign exchange market without central bank intervention.

Flows Variables which are defined over a period of time.

Foreign exchange Foreign currency, all currencies other than the domestic currency of a given country.

Foreign exchange reserves Foreign assets held by the central bank of the country.

Four factors of production Land, Labour, Capital and Entrepreneurship. Together these help in the production of goods and services.

GDP Deflator Ratio of nominal to real GDP.

Government expenditure multiplier The numerical coefficient showing the size of the increase in output resulting from each unit increase in government spending.

Government The state, which maintains law and order in the country, imposes taxes and fines, makes laws and promotes the economic wellbeing of the citizens.

Great Depression The time period of 1930s (started with the stock market crash in New York in 1929) which saw the output in the developed countries fall and unemployment rise by huge amounts.

Gross Domestic Product (GDP) Aggregate value of goods and services produced within the domestic territory of a country. It includes the replacement investment of the depreciation of capital stock.

Gross fiscal deficit The excess of total government expenditure over revenue receipts and capital receipts that do not create debt.

Gross investment Addition to capital stock which also includes replacement for the wear and tear which the capital stock undergoes.

Gross National Product (GNP) GDP + Net Factor Income from Abroad. In other words GNP includes the aggregate income made by all citizens of the country, whereas GDP includes incomes by foreigners within the domestic economy and excludes incomes earned by the citizens in a foreign economy.

Gross primary deficit The fiscal deficit minus interest payments.

High powered money Money injected by the monetary authority in the economy. Consists mainly of currency.

Households The families or individuals who supply factors of production to the firms and which buy the goods and services from the firms.

Imports Purchase of goods and services by the domestic country to the rest of the world.

Income method of calculating national income Method of calculating national income by measuring the aggregate value of final factor payments made (= income) in an economy over a period of time.

Interest Payment for services which are provided by capital.

Intermediate goods Goods which are used up during the process of production of other goods.

Inventories The unsold goods, unused raw materials or semi-finished goods which a firm carries from a year to the next.

John Maynard Keynes (1883–1946) Arguably the founder of Macroeconomics as a separate discipline.

Labour Human physical effort used in production.

Land Natural resources used in production—either fixed or consumed.

Legal tender Money issued by the monetary authority or the government which cannot be refused by anyone.

Lender of last resort The function of the monetary authority of a country in which it provides guarantee of solvency to commercial banks in a situation of liquidity crisis or bank runs.

Liquidity trap A situation of very low rate of interest in the economy where every economic agent expects the interest rate to rise in future and consequently bond prices to fall, causing capital loss. Everybody holds her wealth in money and speculative demand for money is infinite.

Macroeconomic model Presenting the simplified version of the functioning of a macroeconomy through either analytical reasoning or mathematical, graphical representation.

Managed floating A system in which the central bank allows the exchange rate to be determined by market forces but intervene at times to influence the rate.

Marginal propensity to consume The ratio of additional consumption to additional income.

Medium of exchange The principal function of money for facilitating commodity exchanges.

Money multiplier The ratio of total money supply to the stock of high powered money in an economy.

Narrow money Currency notes, coins and demand deposits held by the public in commercial banks.

National disposable income Net National Product at market prices + Other Current Transfers from the rest of the World.

Net Domestic Product (NDP) Aggregate value of goods and services produced within the domestic territory of a country which does not include the depreciation of capital stock.

Net interest payments made by households Interest payment made by the households to the firms—interest payments received by the households.

Net investment Addition to capital stock; unlike gross investment, it does not include the replacement for the depletion of capital stock.

Net National Product (NNP) (at market price) GNP – depreciation.

NNP (at factor cost) or National Income (NI) NNP at market price – (Indirect taxes – Subsidies).

Nominal exchange rate The number of units of domestic currency one must give up to get an unit of foreign currency; the price of foreign currency in terms of domestic currency.

Nominal (GDP) GDP evaluated at current market prices.

Non-tax payments Payments made by households to the firms or the government as non-tax obligations such as fines.

Open market operation Purchase or sales of government securities by the central bank from the general public in the bond market in a bid to increase or decrease the money supply in the economy.

Paradox of thrift As people become more thrifty they end up saving less or same as before in aggregate.

Parametric shift Shift of a graph due to a change in the value of a parameter.

Personal Disposable Income (PDI) $PI - \text{Personal tax payments} - \text{Non-tax payments}$.

Personal Income (PI) $NI - \text{Undistributed profits} - \text{Net interest payments made by households} - \text{Corporate tax} + \text{Transfer payments to the households from the government and firms}$.

Personal tax payments Taxes which are imposed on individuals, such as income tax.

Planned change in inventories Change in the stock of inventories which has occurred in a planned way.

Present value (of a bond) That amount of money which, if kept today in an interest earning project, would generate the same income as the sum promised by a bond over its lifetime.

Private income Factor income from net domestic product accruing to the private sector + National debt interest + Net factor income from abroad + Current transfers from government + Other net transfers from the rest of the world.

Product method of calculating national income Method of calculating the national income by measuring the aggregate value of production taking place in an economy over a period of time.

Profit Payment for the services which are provided by entrepreneurship.

Public good Goods or services that are collectively consumed; it is not possible to exclude anyone from enjoying their benefits and one person's consumption does not reduce that available to others.

Purchasing power parity A theory of international exchange which holds that the price of similar goods in different countries is the same.

Real exchange rate The relative price of foreign goods in terms of domestic goods.

Real GDP GDP evaluated at a set of constant prices.

Rent Payment for services which are provided by land (natural resources).

Reserve deposit ratio The fraction of their total deposits which commercial banks keep as reserves.

Revaluation A decrease in the exchange rate in a pegged exchange rate system which makes the foreign currency cheaper in terms of the domestic currency.

Revenue deficit The excess of revenue expenditure over revenue receipts.

Ricardian equivalence The theory that consumers are forward looking and anticipate that government borrowing today will mean a tax increase in the future to repay the debt, and will adjust consumption accordingly so that it will have the same effect on the economy as a tax increase today.

Speculative demand Demand for money as a store of wealth.

Statutory Liquidity Ratio (SLR) The fraction of their total demand and time deposits which the commercial banks are required by RBI to invest in specified liquid assets.

Sterilisation Intervention by the monetary authority of a country in the money market to keep the money supply stable against exogenous or sometimes external shocks such as an increase in foreign exchange inflow.

Stocks Those variables which are defined at a point of time.

Store of value Wealth can be stored in the form of money for future use. This function of money is referred to as store of value.

Transaction demand Demand for money for carrying out transactions.

Transfer payments to households from the government and firms Transfer payments are payments which are made without any counterpart of services received by the payer. For examples, gifts, scholarships, pensions.

Undistributed profits That part of profits earned by the private and government owned firms which are not distributed among the factors of production.

Unemployment rate This may be defined as the number of people who were unable to find a job (though they were looking for jobs), as a ratio of total number of people who were looking for jobs.

Unit of account The role of money as a yardstick for measuring and comparing values of different commodities.

Unplanned change in inventories Change in the stock of inventories which has occurred in an unexpected way.

Value added Net contribution made by a firm in the process of production. It is defined as, Value of production – Value of intermediate goods used.

Wage Payment for the services which are rendered by labour.

Wholesale Price Index (WPI) Percentage change in the weighted average price level. We take the prices of a given basket of goods which is traded in bulk.

NOTE

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Introduction



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1.1 A SIMPLE ECONOMY

Think of any society. People in the society need many goods and services¹ in their everyday life including food, clothing, shelter, transport facilities like roads and railways, postal services and various other services like that of teachers and doctors. In fact, the list of goods and services that any individual² needs is so large that no individual in society, to begin with, has all the things she needs. Every individual has some amount of only a few of the goods and services that she would like to use. A family farm may own a plot of land, some grains, farming implements, maybe a pair of bullocks and also the labour services of the family members. A weaver may have some yarn, some cotton and other instruments required for weaving cloth. The teacher in the local school has the skills required to impart education to the students. Some others in society may not have any resource³ excepting their own labour services. Each of these decision making units can produce some goods or services by using the resources that it has and use part of the produce to obtain the many other goods and services which it needs. For example, the family farm can produce corn, use part of the produce for consumption purposes and procure clothing, housing and various services in exchange for the rest of the produce. Similarly, the weaver can get the goods and services that she wants in exchange for the cloth she produces in her yarn. The teacher can earn some money by teaching students in the school and use the money for obtaining the goods and services that she wants. The labourer also can try to fulfill her needs by using whatever money she can earn by working for someone else. Each individual can thus use her resources to fulfill her needs. It goes without saying that no individual has unlimited resources compared to her needs. The amount of corn that the family farm can produce is limited by the amount of resources it has, and hence, the amount of different goods

¹By goods we mean physical, tangible objects used to satisfy people's wants and needs. The term 'goods' should be contrasted with the term 'services', which captures the intangible satisfaction of wants and needs. As compared to food items and clothes, which are examples of goods, we can think of the tasks that doctors and teachers perform for us as examples of services.

²By individual, we mean an individual decision making unit. A decision making unit can be a single person or a group like a household, a firm or any other organisation.

³By resource, we mean those goods and services which are used to produce other goods and services, e.g. land, labour, tools and machinery, etc.

and services that it can procure in exchange of corn is also limited. As a result, the family is forced to make a choice between the different goods and services that are available. It can have more of a good or service only by giving up some amounts of other goods or services. For example, if the family wants to have a bigger house, it may have to give up the idea of having a few more acres of arable land. If it wants more and better education for the children, it may have to give up some of the luxuries of life. The same is the case with all other individuals in society. Everyone faces scarcity of resources, and therefore, has to use the limited resources in the best possible way to fulfill her needs.

In general, every individual in society is engaged in the production of some goods or services and she wants a combination of many goods and services not all of which are produced by her. Needless to say that there has to be some compatibility between what people in society collectively want to have and what they produce⁴. For example, the total amount of corn produced by family farm along with other farming units in a society must match the total amount of corn that people in the society collectively want to consume. If people in the society do not want as much corn as the farming units are capable of producing collectively, a part of the resources of these units could have been used in the production of some other good or services which is in high demand. On the other hand, if people in the society want more corn compared to what the farming units are producing collectively, the resources used in the production of some other goods and services may be reallocated to the production of corn. Similar is the case with all other goods or services. Just as the resources of an individual are scarce, the resources of the society are also scarce in comparison to what the people in the society might collectively want to have. The scarce resources of the society have to be allocated properly in the production of different goods and services in keeping with the likes and dislikes of the people of the society.

Any allocation⁵ of resources of the society would result in the production of a particular combination of different goods and services. The goods and services thus produced will have to be distributed among the individuals of the society. The allocation of the limited resources and the distribution of the final mix of goods and services are two of the basic economic problems faced by the society.

In reality, any economy is much more complex compared to the society discussed above. In the light of what we have learnt about the society, let us now discuss the fundamental concerns of the discipline of economics some of which we shall study throughout this book.

1.2 CENTRAL PROBLEMS OF AN ECONOMY

Production, exchange and consumption of goods and services are among the basic economic activities of life. In the course of these basic economic activities, every society has to face **scarcity** of resources and it is the scarcity of resources that gives rise to the problem of **choice**. The scarce resources of an economy have competing usages. In other words, every society has to decide on how to use its scarce resources. The problems of an economy are very often summarised as follows:

⁴Here we assume that all the goods and services produced in a society are consumed by the people in the society and that there is no scope of getting anything from outside the society. In reality, this is not true. However, the general point that is being made here about the compatibility of production and consumption of goods and services holds for any country or even for the entire world.

⁵By an allocation of the resources, we mean how much of which resource is devoted to the production of each of the goods and services.

What is produced and in what quantities?

Every society must decide on how much of each of the many possible goods and services it will produce. Whether to produce more of food, clothing, housing or to have more of luxury goods. Whether to have more agricultural goods or to have industrial products and services. Whether to use more resources in education and health or to use more resources in building military services. Whether to have more of basic education or more of higher education. Whether to have more of consumption goods or to have investment goods (like machine) which will boost production and consumption tomorrow.

How are these goods produced?

Every society has to decide on how much of which of the resources to use in the production of each of the different goods and services. Whether to use more labour or more machines. Which of the available technologies to adopt in the production of each of the goods?

For whom are these goods produced?

Who gets how much of the goods that are produced in the economy? How should the produce of the economy be distributed among the individuals in the economy? Who gets more and who gets less? Whether or not to ensure a minimum amount of consumption for everyone in the economy. Whether or not elementary education and basic health services should be available freely for everyone in the economy.

Thus, every economy faces the problem of allocating the scarce resources to the production of different possible goods and services and of distributing the produced goods and services among the individuals within the economy. *The allocation of scarce resources and the distribution of the final goods and services are the central problems of any economy.*

Production Possibility Frontier

Just as individuals face scarcity of resources, the resources of an economy as a whole are always limited in comparison to what the people in the economy collectively want to have. The scarce resources have alternative usages and every society has to decide on how much of each of the resources to use in the production of different goods and services. In other words, every society has to determine how to allocate its scarce resources to different goods and services.

An allocation of the scarce resource of the economy gives rise to a particular combination of different goods and services. Given the total amount of resources, it is possible to allocate the resources in many different ways and, thereby achieving different mixes of all possible goods and services. The collection of all possible combinations of the goods and services that can be produced from a given amount of resources and a given stock of technological knowledge is called the **production possibility set** of the economy.

EXAMPLE 1

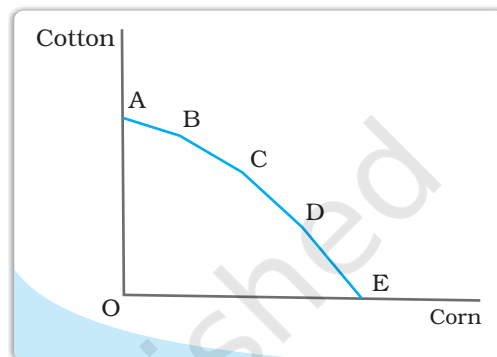
Consider an economy which can produce corn or cotton by using its resources. Table 1.1 gives some of the combinations of corn and cotton that the economy can produce. When its resources are fully utilised.

Table 1.1: Production Possibilities

Possibilities	Corn	Cotton
A	0	10
B	1	9
C	2	7
D	3	4
E	4	0

If all the resources are used in the production of corn, the maximum amount of corn that can be produced is 4 units and if all resources are used in the production of cotton, at the most, 10 units of cotton can be produced. The economy can also produce 1 unit of corn and 9 units of cotton or 2 units of corn and 7 units of cotton or 3 units of corn and 4 units of cotton. There can be many other possibilities. The figure illustrates the production possibilities of the economy. Any point on or below the curve represents a combination of corn and cotton that can be produced with the economy's resources. The curve gives the maximum amount of corn that can be produced in the economy for any given amount of cotton and vice-versa. This curve is called the **production possibility frontier**.

The **production possibility frontier** gives the combinations of corn and cotton that can be produced when the resources of the economy are fully utilised. Note that a point lying strictly below the production possibility frontier represents a combination of corn and cotton that will be produced when all or some of the resources are either underemployed or are utilised in a wasteful fashion.



If more of the scarce resources are used in the production of corn, less resources are available for the production of cotton and vice versa. Therefore, if we want to have more of one of the goods, we will have less of the other good. Thus, there is always a cost of having a little more of one good in terms of the amount of the other good that has to be forgone. This is known as the **opportunity cost^a** of an additional unit of the goods.

Every economy has to choose one of the many possibilities that it has. In other words, one of the central problems of the economy is to choose from one of the many production possibilities.

^aNote that the concept of opportunity cost is applicable to the individual as well as the society. The concept is very important and is widely used in economics. Because of its importance in economics, sometimes, opportunity cost is also called the economic cost.

1.3 ORGANISATION OF ECONOMIC ACTIVITIES

Basic problems can be solved either by the free interaction of the individuals pursuing their own objectives as is done in the market or in a planned manner by some central authority like the government.

1.3.1 The Centrally Planned Economy

In a centrally planned economy, the government or the central authority plans all the important activities in the economy. All important decisions regarding production, exchange and consumption of goods and services are made by the government. The central authority may try to achieve a particular allocation of resources and a consequent distribution of the final combination of goods and services which is thought to be desirable for society as a whole. For example, if it is found that a good or service which is very important for the prosperity and

well-being of the economy as a whole, e.g. education or health service, is not produced in adequate amount by the individuals on their own, the government might try to induce the individuals to produce adequate amount of such a good or service or, alternatively, the government may itself decide to produce the good or service in question. In a different context, if some people in the economy get so little a share of the final mix of goods and services produced in the economy that their survival is at stake, then the central authority may intervene and try to achieve an equitable distribution of the final mix of goods and services.

1.3.2 The Market Economy

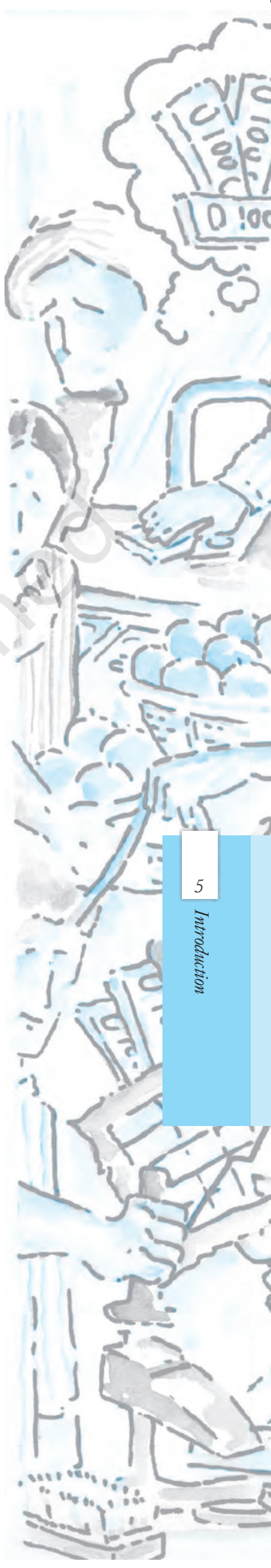
In contrast to a centrally planned economy, in a **market economy**, all economic activities are organised through the market. A **market**, as studied in economics, is an institution⁶ which organises the free interaction of individuals pursuing their respective economic activities. In other words, a market is a set of arrangements where economic agents can freely exchange their endowments or products with each other. It is important to note that the term 'market' as used in economics is quite different from the common sense understanding of a market. In particular, it has nothing as such to do with the marketplace as you might tend to think of. For buying and selling commodities, individuals may or may not meet each other in an actual physical location. Interaction between buyers and sellers can take place in a variety of situations such as a village-chowk or a super bazaar in a city, or alternatively, buyers and sellers can interact with each other through telephone or internet and conduct the exchange of commodities. The arrangements which allow people to buy and sell commodities freely are the defining features of a market.

For the smooth functioning of any system, it is imperative that there is coordination in the activities of the different constituent parts of the system. Otherwise, there can be chaos. You may wonder as to what are the forces which bring the coordination between the activities of millions of isolated individuals in a market system.

In a market system, all goods or services come with a price (which is mutually agreed upon by the buyers and sellers) at which the exchanges take place. The price reflects, on an average, the society's valuation of the good or service in question. If the buyers demand more of a certain good, the price of that good will rise. This signals to the producers of that good that the society as a whole wants more of that good than is currently being produced and the producers of the good, in their turn, are likely to increase their production. In this way, prices of goods and services send important information to all the individuals across the market and help achieve coordination in a market system. Thus, in a market system, the central problems regarding how much and what to produce are solved through the coordination of economic activities brought about by the price signals.

In reality, all economies are mixed economies where some important decisions are taken by the government and the economic activities are by and large conducted through the market. The only difference is in terms of the extent of the role of the government in deciding the course of economic activities. In the United States of America, the role of the government is minimal. The closest example of a centrally planned economy is the China for the major part of the twentieth century. In India, since Independence, the government has played a major role in planning economic activities. However, the role of the

⁶An institution is usually defined as an organisation with some purpose.



government in the Indian economy has been reduced considerably in the last couple of decades.

1.4 POSITIVE AND NORMATIVE ECONOMICS

It was mentioned earlier that in principle there are more than one ways of solving the central problems of an economy. These different mechanisms in general are likely to give rise to different solutions to those problems, thereby resulting in different allocations of the resources and also different distributions of the final mix of goods and services produced in the economy. Therefore, it is important to understand which of these alternative mechanisms is more desirable for the economy as a whole. In economics, we try to analyse the different mechanisms and figure out the outcomes which are likely to result under each of these mechanisms. We also try to evaluate the mechanisms by studying how desirable the outcomes resulting from them are. Often a distinction is made between **positive economic analysis** and **normative economic analysis** depending on whether we are trying to figure out how a particular mechanism functions or we are trying to evaluate it. In positive economic analysis, we study how the different mechanisms function, and in normative economics, we try to understand whether these mechanisms are desirable or not. However, this distinction between positive and normative economic analysis is not a very sharp one. The positive and the normative issues involved in the study of the central economic problems are very closely related to each other and a proper understanding of one is not possible in isolation to the other.

1.5 MICROECONOMICS AND MACROECONOMICS

Traditionally, the subject matter of economics has been studied under two broad branches: **Microeconomics** and **Macroeconomics**. In microeconomics, we study the behaviour of individual economic agents in the markets for different goods and services and try to figure out how prices and quantities of goods and services are determined through the interaction of individuals in these markets. In macroeconomics, on the other hand, we try to get an understanding of the economy as a whole by focusing our attention on aggregate measures such as total output, employment and aggregate price level. Here, we are interested in finding out how the levels of these aggregate measures are determined and how the levels of these aggregate measures change over time. Some of the important questions that are studied in macroeconomics are as follows: What is the level of total output in the economy? How is the total output determined? How does the total output grow over time? Are the resources of the economy (eg labour) fully employed? What are the reasons behind the unemployment of resources? Why do prices rise? Thus, instead of studying the different markets as is done in microeconomics, in macroeconomics, we try to study the behaviour of aggregate or macro measures of the performance of the economy.

1.6 PLAN OF THE BOOK

This book is meant to introduce you to the basic ideas in microeconomics. In this book, we will focus on the behaviour of the individual consumers and producers of a single commodity and try to analyse how the price and the quantity is determined in the market for a single commodity. In Chapter 2, we

shall study the consumer's behaviour. Chapter 3 deals with basic ideas of production and cost. In Chapter 4, we study the producer's behaviour. In Chapter 5, we shall study how price and quantity is determined in a perfectly competitive market for a commodity. Chapter 6 studies some other forms of market.

Key Concepts

Consumption	Production	Exchange
Scarcity	Production possibilities	Opportunity cost
Market	Market economy	Centrally planned economy
Mixed economy	Positive analysis	Normative analysis
Microeconomics	Macroeconomics	

Exercises

1. Discuss the central problems of an economy.
2. What do you mean by the production possibilities of an economy?
3. What is a production possibility frontier?
4. Discuss the subject matter of economics.
5. Distinguish between a centrally planned economy and a market economy.
6. What do you understand by positive economic analysis?
7. What do you understand by normative economic analysis?
8. Distinguish between microeconomics and macroeconomics.

Chapter 2

Theory of Consumer Behaviour



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In this chapter, we will study the behaviour of an individual consumer. The consumer has to decide how to spend her income on different goods¹. Economists call this the problem of choice. Most naturally, any consumer will want to get a combination of goods that gives her maximum satisfaction. What will be this 'best' combination? This depends on the likes of the consumer and what the consumer can afford to buy. The 'likes' of the consumer are also called 'preferences'. And what the consumer can afford to buy, depends on prices of the goods and the income of the consumer. This chapter presents two different approaches that explain consumer behaviour (i) Cardinal Utility Analysis and (ii) Ordinal Utility Analysis.

Preliminary Notations and Assumptions

A consumer, in general, consumes many goods; but for simplicity, we shall consider the consumer's choice problem in a situation where there are only two goods²: bananas and mangoes. Any combination of the amount of the two goods will be called a consumption bundle or, in short, a bundle. In general, we shall use the variable x_1 to denote the quantity of bananas and x_2 to denote the quantity of mangoes. x_1 and x_2 can be positive or zero. (x_1, x_2) would mean the bundle consisting of x_1 quantity of bananas and x_2 quantity of mangoes. For particular values of x_1 and x_2 , (x_1, x_2) , would give us a particular bundle. For example, the bundle (5, 10) consists of 5 bananas and 10 mangoes; the bundle (10, 5) consists of 10 bananas and 5 mangoes.

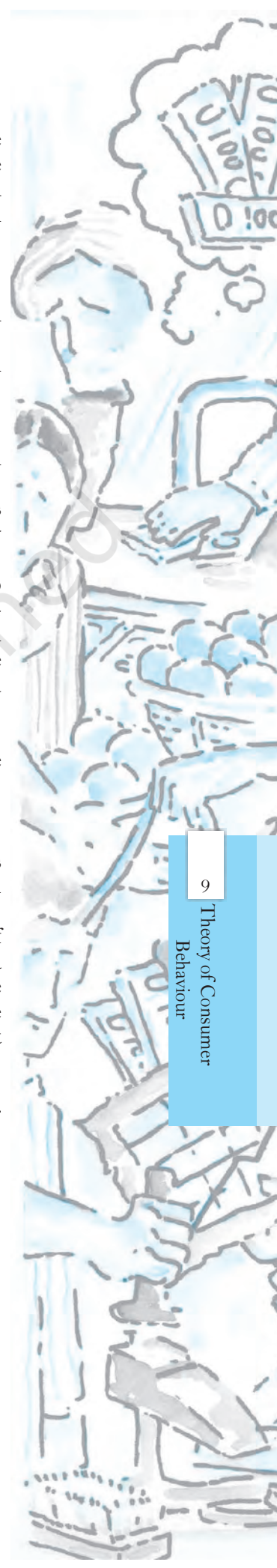
2.1 UTILITY

A consumer usually decides his demand for a commodity on the basis of utility (or satisfaction) that he derives from it. What is utility? Utility of a commodity is its want-satisfying capacity. The more the need of a commodity or the stronger the desire to have it, the greater is the utility derived from the commodity.

Utility is subjective. Different individuals can get different levels of utility from the same commodity. For example, some one who

¹We shall use the term goods to mean goods as well as services.

²The assumption that there are only two goods simplifies the analysis considerably and allows us to understand some important concepts by using simple diagrams.



likes chocolates will get much higher utility from a chocolate than some one who is not so fond of chocolates. Also, utility that one individual gets from the commodity can change with change in place and time. For example, utility from the use of a room heater will depend upon whether the individual is in Ladakh or Chennai (place) or whether it is summer or winter (time).

2.1.1 Cardinal Utility Analysis

Cardinal utility analysis assumes that level of utility can be expressed in numbers. For example, we can measure the utility derived from a shirt and say, this shirt gives me 50 units of utility. Before discussing further, it will be useful to have a look at two important measures of utility.

Measures of Utility

Total Utility: Total utility of a fixed quantity of a commodity (TU) is the total satisfaction derived from consuming the given amount of some commodity x . More of commodity x provides more satisfaction to the consumer. TU depends on the quantity of the commodity consumed. Therefore, TU_n refers to total utility derived from consuming n units of a commodity x .

Marginal Utility: Marginal utility (MU) is the change in total utility due to consumption of one additional unit of a commodity. For example, suppose 4 bananas give us 28 units of total utility and 5 bananas give us 30 units of total utility. Clearly, consumption of the 5th banana has caused total utility to increase by 2 units (30 units minus 28 units). Therefore, marginal utility of the 5th banana is 2 units.

$$MU_5 = TU_5 - TU_4 = 30 - 28 = 2$$

In general, $MU_n = TU_n - TU_{n-1}$, where subscript n refers to the n^{th} unit of the commodity

Total utility and marginal utility can also be related in the following way.

$$TU_n = MU_1 + MU_2 + \dots + MU_{n-1} + MU_n$$

This simply means that TU derived from consuming n units of bananas is the sum total of marginal utility of first banana (MU_1), marginal utility of second banana (MU_2), and so on, till the marginal utility of the n^{th} unit.

Table No. 2.1 and Figure 2.1 show an imaginary example of the values of marginal and total utility derived from consumption of various amounts of a commodity. Usually, it is seen that the marginal utility diminishes with increase in consumption of the commodity. This happens because having obtained some amount of the commodity, the desire of the consumer to have still more of it becomes weaker. The same is also shown in the table and graph.

Table 2.1: Values of marginal and total utility derived from consumption of various amounts of a commodity

Units	Total Utility	Marginal Utility
1	12	12
2	18	6
3	22	4
4	24	2
5	24	0
6	22	-2

Notice that MU_3 is less than MU_2 . You may also notice that total utility increases but at a diminishing rate: The rate of change in total utility due to change in quantity of commodity consumed is a measure of marginal utility. This marginal utility diminishes with increase in consumption of the commodity from 12 to 6, 6 to 4 and so on. This follows from the law of diminishing marginal utility. **Law of Diminishing Marginal Utility** states that marginal utility from consuming each additional unit of a commodity declines as its consumption increases, while keeping consumption of other commodities constant.

MU becomes zero at a level when TU remains constant. In the example, TU does not change at 5th unit of consumption and therefore $MU_5 = 0$. Thereafter, TU starts falling and MU becomes negative.

Derivation of Demand Curve in the Case of a Single Commodity (Law of Diminishing Marginal Utility)

Cardinal utility analysis can be used to derive demand curve for a commodity. What is demand and what is demand curve? The quantity of a commodity that a consumer is willing to buy and is able to afford, given prices of goods and income of the consumer, is called demand for that commodity. Demand for a commodity x , apart from the price of x itself, depends on factors such as prices of other commodities (see substitutes and complements 2.4.4), income of the consumer and tastes and preferences of the consumers. Demand curve is a graphic presentation of various quantities of a commodity that a consumer is willing to buy at different prices of the same commodity, while holding constant prices of other related commodities and income of the consumer.

Figure 2.2 presents hypothetical demand curve of an individual for commodity x at its different prices. Quantity is measured along the horizontal axis and price is measured along the vertical axis.

The downward sloping demand curve shows that at lower prices, the individual is willing to buy more of commodity x ; at higher prices, she is willing to buy less of commodity x . Therefore, there is a negative relationship between price of a commodity and quantity demanded which is referred to as the **Law of Demand**.

An explanation for a downward sloping demand curve rests on the notion of diminishing marginal utility. The law of diminishing marginal utility states that each successive unit of a commodity provides lower marginal utility.

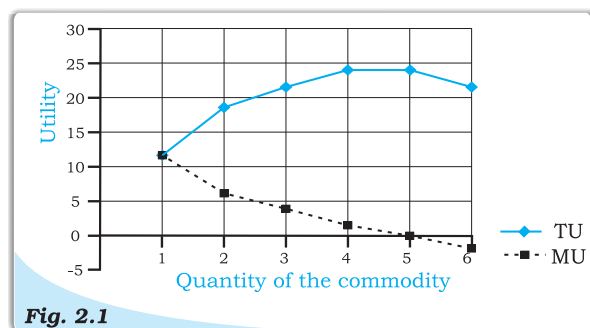


Fig. 2.1

The values of marginal and total utility derived from consumption of various amounts of a commodity. The marginal utility diminishes with increase in consumption of the commodity.

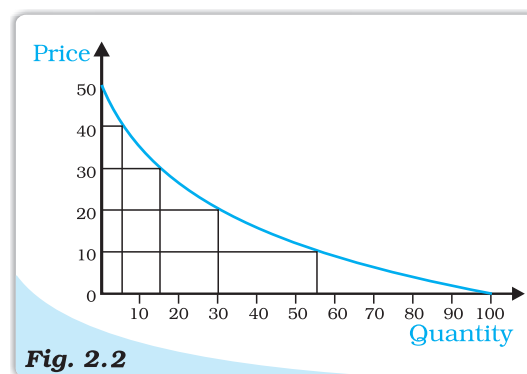


Fig. 2.2

Demand curve of an individual for commodity x

Therefore the individual will not be willing to pay as much for each additional unit and this results in a downward sloping demand curve. At a price of Rs. 40 per unit x , individual's demand for x was 5 units. The 6th unit of commodity x will be worth less than the 5th unit. The individual will be willing to buy the 6th unit only when the price drops below Rs. 40 per unit. Hence, the law of diminishing marginal utility explains why demand curves have a negative slope.

2.1.2 Ordinal Utility Analysis

Cardinal utility analysis is simple to understand, but suffers from a major drawback in the form of quantification of utility in numbers. In real life, we never express utility in the form of numbers. At the most, we can rank various alternative combinations in terms of having more or less utility. In other words, the consumer does not measure utility in numbers, though she often ranks various consumption bundles. This forms the starting point of this topic – Ordinal Utility Analysis.

A consumer's preferences over the set of available bundles can often be represented diagrammatically. We have already seen that the bundles available to the consumer can be plotted as points in a two-dimensional diagram. The points representing bundles which give the consumer equal utility can generally be joined to obtain a curve like the one in Figure 2.3. The consumer is said to be indifferent on the different bundles because each point of the bundles give the consumer equal utility. Such a curve joining all points representing bundles among which the consumer is indifferent is called an **indifference curve**. All the points such as A, B, C and D lying on an indifference curve provide the consumer with the same level of satisfaction.

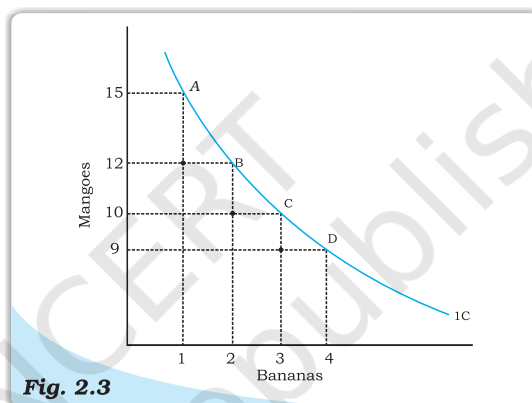


Fig. 2.3

Indifference curve. An indifference curve joins all points representing bundles which are considered indifferent by the consumer.

It is clear that when a consumer gets one more banana, he has to forego some mangoes, so that her total utility level remains the same and she remains on the same indifference curve. Therefore, indifference curve slopes downward. The amount of mangoes that the consumer has to forego, in order to get an additional banana, her total utility level being the same, is called **marginal rate of substitution (MRS)**. In other words, MRS is simply the rate at which the consumer will substitute bananas for mangoes, so that her total utility remains constant. So, $MRS = |\Delta Y / \Delta X|^3$.

One can notice that, in the table 2.2, as we increase the quantity of bananas, the quantity of mangoes sacrificed for each additional banana declines. In other words, MRS diminishes with increase in the number of bananas. As the number

³ $|\Delta Y / \Delta X| = \Delta Y / \Delta X$ if $(\Delta Y / \Delta X) \geq 0$

$= -\Delta Y / \Delta X$ if $(\Delta Y / \Delta X) < 0$

$MRS = |\Delta Y / \Delta X|$ means that MRS equals only the magnitude of the expression $\Delta Y / \Delta X$. If $\Delta Y / \Delta X = -3/1$ it means $MRS = 3$.

Table 2.2: Representation of Law of Diminishing Marginal Rate of Substitution

Combination	Quantity of bananas (Qx)	Quantity of Mangoes (Qy)	MRS
A	1	15	-
B	2	12	3:1
C	3	10	2:1
D	4	9	1:1

of bananas with the consumer increases, the MU derived from each additional banana falls. Similarly, with the fall in quantity of mangoes, the marginal utility derived from mangoes increases. So, with increase in the number of bananas, the consumer will feel the inclination to sacrifice small and smaller amounts of mangoes. This tendency for the MRS to fall with increase in quantity of bananas is known as **Law of Diminishing Marginal Rate of Substitution**. This can be seen from figure 2.3 also. Going from point A to point B, the consumer sacrifices 3 mangoes for 1 banana, going from point B to point C, the consumer sacrifices 2 mangoes for 1 banana, and going from point C to point D, the consumer sacrifices just 1 mango for 1 banana. Thus, it is clear that the consumer sacrifices smaller and smaller quantities of mangoes for each additional banana.

Shape of an Indifference Curve

It may be mentioned that the law of Diminishing Marginal Rate of Substitution causes an indifference curve to be convex to the origin. This is the most common shape of an indifference curve. But in case of goods being perfect substitutes⁴, the marginal rate of substitution does not diminish. It remains the same. Let's take an example.

Table 2.3: Representation of Law of Diminishing Marginal Rate of Substitution

Combination	Quantity of five Rupees notes (Qx)	Quantity of five Rupees coins (Qy)	MRS
A	1	8	-
B	2	7	1:1
C	3	6	1:1
D	4	5	1:1

Here, the consumer is indifferent for all these combinations as long as the total of five rupee coins and five rupee notes remains the same. For the consumer, it hardly matters whether she gets a five rupee coin or a five rupee note. So, irrespective of how many five rupee notes she has, the consumer will sacrifice only one five rupee coin for a five rupee note. So these two commodities are perfect substitutes for the consumer and indifference curve depicting these will be a straight line.

In the figure.2.4, it can be seen that consumer sacrifices the same number of five-rupee coins each time he has an additional five-rupee note.

⁴ Perfect Substitutes are the goods which can be used in place of each other, and provide exactly the same level of utility to the consumer.

Monotonic Preferences

Consumer's preferences are assumed to be such that between any two bundles (x_1, x_2) and (y_1, y_2) , if (x_1, x_2) has more of at least one of the goods and no less of the other good compared to (y_1, y_2) , then the consumer prefers (x_1, x_2) to (y_1, y_2) . Preferences of this kind are called **monotonic preferences**. Thus, a consumer's preferences are monotonic if and only if between any two bundles, the consumer prefers the bundle which has more of at least one of the goods and no less of the other good as compared to the other bundle.

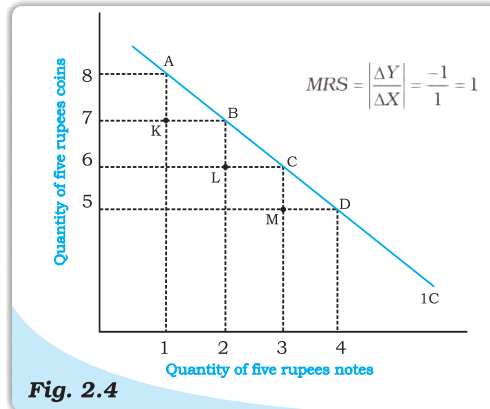


Fig. 2.4

Indifference Curve for perfect substitutes. Indifference curve depicting two commodities which are perfect substitutes is a straight line.

Indifference Map

The consumer's preferences over all the bundles can be represented by a family of indifference curves as shown in Figure 2.5. This is called an indifference map of the consumer. All points on an indifference curve represent bundles which are considered indifferent by the consumer. Monotonicity of preferences imply that between any two indifference curves, the bundles on the one which lies above are preferred to the bundles on the one which lies below.

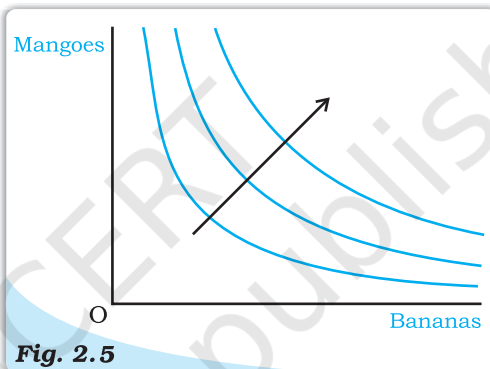


Fig. 2.5

Indifference Map. A family of indifference curves. The arrow indicates that bundles on higher indifference curves are preferred by the consumer to the bundles on lower indifference curves.

Features of Indifference Curve

1. Indifference curve slopes downwards from left to right:

An indifference curve slopes downwards from left to right, which means that in order to have more of bananas, the consumer has to forego some mangoes. If the consumer does not forego some mangoes with an increase in number of bananas, it will mean consumer having more of bananas with same number of mangoes, taking her to a higher indifference curve. Thus, as long as the consumer is on the same indifference curve, an increase in bananas must be compensated by a fall in quantity of mangoes.

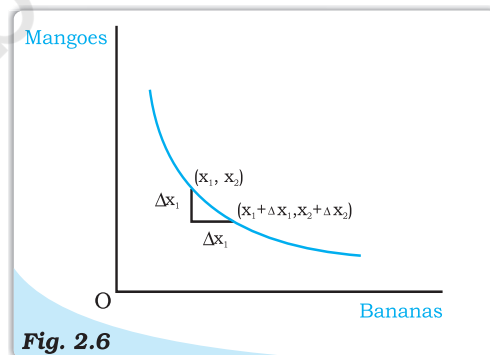


Fig. 2.6

Slope of the Indifference Curve. The indifference curve slopes downward. An increase in the amount of bananas along the indifference curve is associated with a decrease in the amount of mangoes. If $\Delta x_1 > 0$ then $\Delta x_2 < 0$.

2. Higher indifference curve gives greater level of utility:

As long as marginal utility of a commodity is positive, an individual will always prefer more of that commodity, as more of the commodity will increase the level of satisfaction.

Table 2.4: Representation of different level of utilities from different combination of goods

Combination	Quantity of bananas	Quantity of Mangoes
A	1	10
B	2	10
C	3	10

Consider the different combination of bananas and mangoes, A, B and C depicted in table 2.4 and figure 2.7. Combinations A, B and C consist of same quantity of mangoes but different quantities of bananas. Since combination B has more bananas than A, B will provide the individual a higher level of satisfaction than A. Therefore, B will lie on a higher indifference curve than A, depicting higher satisfaction. Likewise, C has more bananas than B (quantity of mangoes is the same in both B and C). Therefore, C will provide higher level of satisfaction than B, and also lie on a higher indifference curve than B.

A higher indifference curve consisting of combinations with more of mangoes, or more of bananas, or more of both, will represent combinations that give higher level of satisfaction.

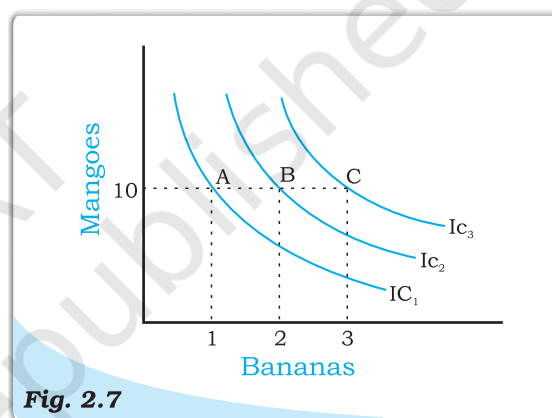


Fig. 2.7

Higher indifference curves give greater level of utility.

3. Two indifference curves never intersect each other:

Two indifference curves intersecting each other will lead to conflicting results. To explain this, let us allow two indifference curves to intersect each other as shown in the figure 2.8. As points A and B lie on the same indifference curve IC_1 , utilities derived from combination A and combination B will give the same level of satisfaction. Similarly, as points A and C lie on the same indifference curve IC_2 , utility derived from combination A and from combination C will give the same level of satisfaction.

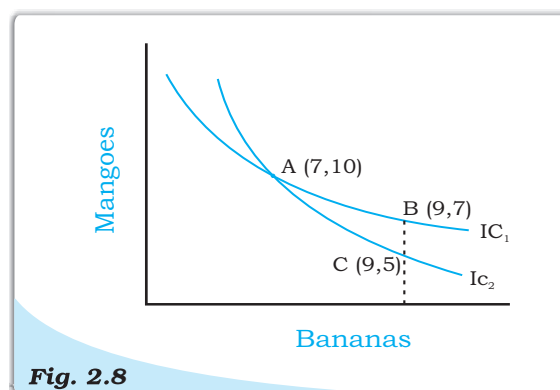


Fig. 2.8

Two indifference curves never intersect each other

From this, it follows that utility from point B and from point C will also be the same. But this is clearly an absurd result, as on point B, the consumer gets a greater number of mangoes with the same quantity of bananas. So consumer is better off at point B than at point C. Thus, it is clear that intersecting indifference curves will lead to conflicting results. Thus, two indifference curves cannot intersect each other.

2.2 THE CONSUMER'S BUDGET

Let us consider a consumer who has only a fixed amount of money (income) to spend on two goods. The prices of the goods are given in the market. The consumer cannot buy any and every combination of the two goods that she may want to consume. The consumption bundles that are available to the consumer depend on the prices of the two goods and the income of the consumer. Given her fixed income and the prices of the two goods, the consumer can afford to buy only those bundles which cost her less than or equal to her income.

2.2.1 Budget Set and Budget Line

Suppose the income of the consumer is M and the prices of bananas and mangoes are p_1 and p_2 respectively⁵. If the consumer wants to buy x_1 quantities of bananas, she will have to spend p_1x_1 amount of money. Similarly, if the consumer wants to buy x_2 quantities of mangoes, she will have to spend p_2x_2 amount of money. Therefore, if the consumer wants to buy the bundle consisting of x_1 quantities of bananas and x_2 quantities of mangoes, she will have to spend $p_1x_1 + p_2x_2$ amount of money. She can buy this bundle only if she has at least $p_1x_1 + p_2x_2$ amount of money. Given the prices of the goods and the income of a consumer, she can choose any bundle as long as it costs less than or equal to the income she has. In other words, the consumer can buy any bundle (x_1, x_2) such that

$$p_1x_1 + p_2x_2 \leq M \quad (2.1)$$

The inequality (2.1) is called the consumer's **budget constraint**. The set of bundles available to the consumer is called the **budget set**. The budget set is thus the collection of all bundles that the consumer can buy with her income at the prevailing market prices.

EXAMPLE 2.1

Consider, for example, a consumer who has Rs 20, and suppose, both the goods are priced at Rs 5 and are available only in integral units. The bundles that this consumer can afford to buy are: (0, 0), (0, 1), (0, 2), (0, 3), (0, 4), (1, 0), (1, 1), (1, 2), (1, 3), (2, 0), (2, 1), (2, 2), (3, 0), (3, 1) and (4, 0). Among these bundles, (0, 4), (1, 3), (2, 2), (3, 1) and (4, 0) cost exactly Rs 20 and all the other bundles cost less than Rs 20. The consumer cannot afford to buy bundles like (3, 3) and (4, 5) because they cost more than Rs 20 at the prevailing prices.

⁵ Price of a good is the amount of money that the consumer has to pay per unit of the good she wants to buy. If rupee is the unit of money and quantity of the good is measured in kilograms, the price of banana being p_1 means the consumer has to pay p_1 rupees per kilograms of banana that she wants to buy.

If both the goods are perfectly divisible⁶, the consumer's budget set would consist of all bundles (x_1, x_2) such that x_1 and x_2 are any numbers greater than or equal to 0 and $p_1x_1 + p_2x_2 \leq M$. The budget set can be represented in a diagram as in Figure 2.9.

All bundles in the positive quadrant which are on or below the line are included in the budget set. The equation of the line is

$$p_1x_1 + p_2x_2 = M \quad (2.2)$$

The line consists of all bundles which cost exactly equal to M . This line is called the budget line. Points below the budget line represent bundles which cost strictly less than M .

The equation (2.2) can also be written as⁷

$$x_2 = \frac{M}{p_2} - \frac{p_1}{p_2}x_1 \quad (2.3)$$

The budget line is a straight line with horizontal intercept $\frac{M}{p_1}$ and vertical intercept $\frac{M}{p_2}$. The horizontal intercept represents the bundle that the consumer can buy if she spends her entire income on bananas. Similarly, the vertical intercept represents the bundle that the consumer can buy if she spends her entire income on mangoes. The slope of the budget line is $-\frac{p_1}{p_2}$.

Price Ratio and the Slope of the Budget Line

Think of any point on the budget line. Such a point represents a bundle which costs the consumer her entire budget. Now suppose the consumer wants to have one more banana. She can do it only if she gives up some amount of the other good. How many mangoes does she have to give up if she wants to have an extra quantity of bananas? It would depend on the prices of the two goods. A quantity of banana costs p_1 . Therefore, she will have to reduce her expenditure on mangoes by p_1 amount, if she wants one more quantity of banana. With p_1 ,

she could buy $\frac{p_1}{p_2}$ quantities of mangoes. Therefore, if the consumer wants to have an extra quantity of bananas when she is spending all her money, she will have to give up $\frac{p_1}{p_2}$ quantities of mangoes. In other words, in the given market

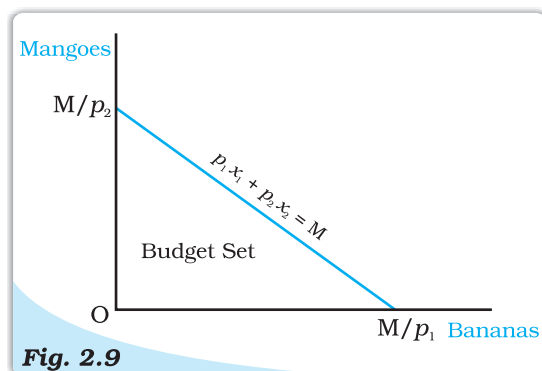


Fig. 2.9 **Budget Set.** Quantity of bananas is measured along the horizontal axis and quantity of mangoes is measured along the vertical axis. Any point in the diagram represents a bundle of the two goods. The budget set consists of all points on or below the straight line having the equation $p_1x_1 + p_2x_2 = M$.

⁶The goods considered in Example 2.1 were not divisible and were available only in integer units. There are many goods which are divisible in the sense that they are available in non-integer units also. It is not possible to buy half an orange or one-fourth of a banana, but it is certainly possible to buy half a kilogram of rice or one-fourth of a litre of milk.

⁷In school mathematics, you have learnt the equation of a straight line as $y = c + mx$ where c is the vertical intercept and m is the slope of the straight line. Note that equation (2.3) has the same form.

Derivation of the Slope of the Budget Line

The slope of the budget line measures the amount of change in mangoes required per unit of change in bananas along the budget line. Consider any two points (x_1, x_2) and $(x_1 + \Delta x_1, x_2 + \Delta x_2)$ on the budget line.^a

It must be the case that

$$p_1 x_1 + p_2 x_2 = M \quad (2.4)$$

$$\text{and, } p_1(x_1 + \Delta x_1) + p_2(x_2 + \Delta x_2) = M \quad (2.5)$$

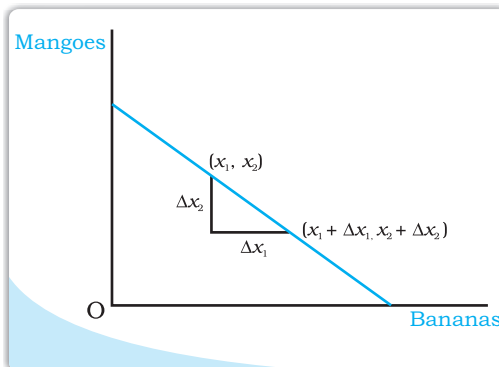
Subtracting (2.4) from (2.5), we obtain

$$p_1 \Delta x_1 + p_2 \Delta x_2 = 0 \quad (2.6)$$

By rearranging terms in (2.6), we obtain

$$\frac{\Delta x_2}{\Delta x_1} = -\frac{p_1}{p_2} \quad (2.7)$$

^a Δ (delta) is a Greek letter. In mathematics, Δ is sometimes used to denote 'a change'. Thus, Δx_1 stands for a change in x_1 and Δx_2 stands for a change in x_2 .



conditions, the consumer can substitute bananas for mangoes at the rate $\frac{p_1}{p_2}$.

The absolute value⁸ of the slope of the budget line measures the rate at which the consumer is able to substitute bananas for mangoes when she spends her entire budget.

2.2.2 Changes in the Budget Set

The set of available bundles depends on the prices of the two goods and the income of the consumer. When the price of either of the goods or the consumer's income changes, the set of available bundles is also likely to change. Suppose the consumer's income changes from M to M' but the prices of the two goods remain unchanged. With the new income, the consumer can afford to buy all bundles (x_1, x_2) such that $p_1 x_1 + p_2 x_2 \leq M'$. Now the equation of the budget line is

$$p_1 x_1 + p_2 x_2 = M' \quad (2.8)$$

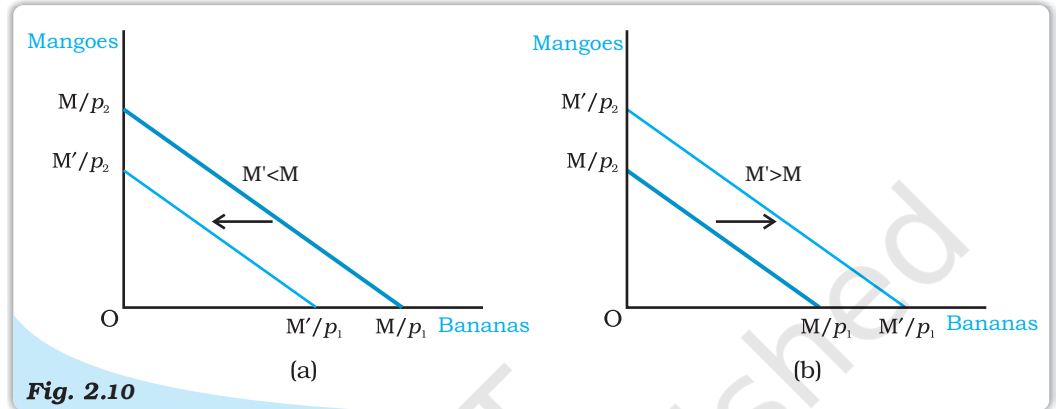
Equation (2.8) can also be written as

$$x_2 = \frac{M'}{p_2} - \frac{p_1}{p_2} x_1 \quad (2.9)$$

Note that the slope of the new budget line is the same as the slope of the budget line prior to the change in the consumer's income. However, the vertical intercept has changed after the change in income. If there is an increase in the

⁸The absolute value of a number x is equal to x if $x \geq 0$ and is equal to $-x$ if $x < 0$. The absolute value of x is usually denoted by $|x|$.

income, i.e. if $M' > M$, the vertical as well as horizontal intercepts increase, there is a parallel outward shift of the budget line. If the income increases, the consumer can buy more of the goods at the prevailing market prices. Similarly, if the income goes down, i.e. if $M' < M$, both intercepts decrease, and hence, there is a parallel inward shift of the budget line. If income goes down, the availability of goods goes down. Changes in the set of available bundles resulting from changes in consumer's income when the prices of the two goods remain unchanged are shown in Figure 2.10.



Changes in the Set of Available Bundles of Goods Resulting from Changes in the Consumer's Income. A decrease in income causes a parallel inward shift of the budget line as in panel (a). An increase in income causes a parallel outward shift of the budget line as in panel (b).

Now suppose the price of bananas change from p_1 to p'_1 but the price of mangoes and the consumer's income remain unchanged. At the new price of bananas, the consumer can afford to buy all bundles (x_1, x_2) such that $p'_1 x_1 + p_2 x_2 \leq M$. The equation of the budget line is

$$p'_1 x_1 + p_2 x_2 = M \quad (2.10)$$

Equation (2.10) can also be written as

$$x_2 = \frac{M}{p_2} - \frac{p'_1}{p_2} x_1 \quad (2.11)$$

Note that the vertical intercept of the new budget line is the same as the vertical intercept of the budget line prior to the change in the price of bananas. However, the slope of the budget line and horizontal intercept have changed after the price change. If the price of bananas increases, i.e. if $p'_1 > p_1$, the absolute value of the slope of the budget line increases, and the budget line becomes steeper (it pivots inwards around the vertical intercept and horizontal intercept decreases). If the price of bananas decreases, i.e., $p'_1 < p_1$, the absolute value of the slope of the budget line decreases and hence, the budget line becomes flatter (it pivots outwards around the vertical intercept and horizontal intercept increases). Figure 2.11 shows change in the budget set when the price of only one commodity changes while the price of the other commodity as well as income of the consumer are constant.

A change in price of mangoes, when price of bananas and the consumer's income remain unchanged, will bring about similar changes in the budget set of the consumer.

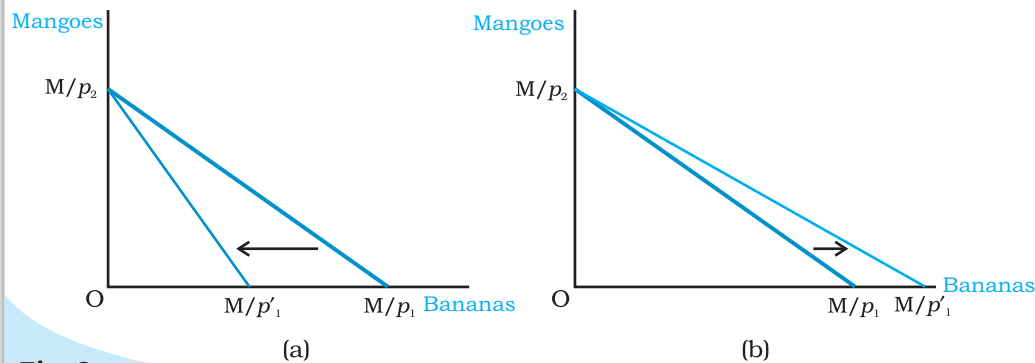


Fig. 2.11

Changes in the Set of Available Bundles of Goods Resulting from Changes in the Price of Bananas. An increase in the price of bananas makes the budget line steeper as in panel (a). A decrease in the price of bananas makes the budget line flatter as in panel (b).

2.3 OPTIMAL CHOICE OF THE CONSUMER

The budget set consists of all bundles that are available to the consumer. The consumer can choose her consumption bundle from the budget set. But on what basis does she choose her consumption bundle from the ones that are available to her? In economics, it is assumed that the consumer chooses her consumption bundle on the basis of her taste and preferences over the bundles in the budget set. It is generally assumed that the consumer has well defined preferences over the set of all possible bundles. She can compare any two bundles. In other words, between any two bundles, she either prefers one to the other or she is indifferent between the two.

Equality of the Marginal Rate of Substitution and the Ratio of the Prices

The optimum bundle of the consumer is located at the point where the budget line is tangent to one of the indifference curves. If the budget line is tangent to an indifference curve at a point, the absolute value of the slope of the indifference curve (MRS) and that of the budget line (price ratio) are same at that point. Recall from our earlier discussion that the slope of the indifference curve is the rate at which the consumer is willing to substitute one good for the other. The slope of the budget line is the rate at which the consumer is able to substitute one good for the other in the market. At the optimum, the two rates should be the same. To see why, consider a point where this is not so. Suppose the MRS at such a point is 2 and suppose the two goods have the same price. At this point, the consumer is willing to give up 2 mangoes if she is given an extra banana. But in the market, she can buy an extra banana if she gives up just 1 mango. Therefore, if she buys an extra banana, she can have more of both the goods compared to the bundle represented by the point, and hence, move to a preferred bundle. Thus, a point at which the MRS is greater, the price ratio cannot be the optimum. A similar argument holds for any point at which the MRS is less than the price ratio.

In economics, it is generally assumed that the consumer is a rational individual. A rational individual clearly knows what is good or what is bad for her, and in any given situation, she always tries to achieve the best for herself. Thus, not only does a consumer have well-defined preferences over the set of available bundles, she also acts according to her preferences. From the bundles which are available to her, a rational consumer always chooses the one which gives her maximum satisfaction.

In the earlier sections, it was observed that the budget set describes the bundles that are available to the consumer and her preferences over the available bundles can usually be represented by an indifference map. Therefore, the consumer's problem can also be stated as follows: The rational consumer's problem is to move to a point on the highest possible indifference curve given her budget set.

If such a point exists, where would it be located? *The optimum point would be located on the budget line.* A point below the budget line cannot be the optimum. Compared to a point below the budget line, there is always some point on the budget line which contains more of at least one of the goods and no less of the other, and is, therefore, preferred by a consumer whose preferences are monotonic. Therefore, if the consumer's preferences are monotonic, for any point below the budget line, there is some point on the budget line which is preferred by the consumer. Points above the budget line are not available to the consumer. Therefore, the optimum (most preferred) bundle of the consumer would be on the budget line.

Where on the budget line will the optimum bundle be located? *The point at which the budget line just touches (is tangent to), one of the indifference curves would be the optimum.*⁹ To see why this is so, note that any point on the budget line other than the point at which it touches the indifference curve lies on a lower indifference curve and hence is inferior. Therefore, such a point cannot be the consumer's optimum. The optimum bundle is located on the budget line at the point where the budget line is tangent to an indifference curve.

Figure 2.12 illustrates the consumer's optimum. At (x_1^*, x_2^*) , the budget line is tangent to the black coloured indifference curve. The first thing to note is that the indifference curve just touching the budget line is the highest possible indifference curve given the consumer's budget set. Bundles on the indifference curves above this, like the grey one, are not affordable. Points on the indifference curves below this, like the blue one, are certainly inferior to the points on the indifference curve, just touching the budget line. Any other point on the budget line lies on a lower indifference curve and hence, is inferior to (x_1^*, x_2^*) . Therefore, (x_1^*, x_2^*) is the consumer's optimum bundle.

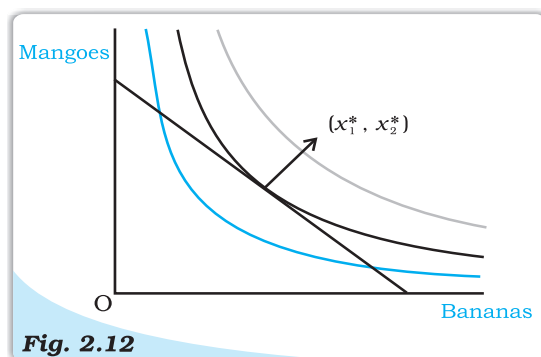


Fig. 2.12
Consumer's Optimum. The point (x_1^*, x_2^*) , at which the budget line is tangent to an indifference curve represents the consumers

⁹ To be more precise, if the situation is as depicted in Figure 2.12 then the optimum would be located at the point where the budget line is tangent to one of the indifference curves. However, there are other situations in which the optimum is at a point where the consumer spends her entire income on one of the goods only.

2.4 DEMAND

In the previous section, we studied the choice problem of the consumer and derived the consumer's optimum bundle given the prices of the goods, the consumer's income and her preferences. It was observed that the amount of a good that the consumer chooses optimally, depends on the price of the good itself, the prices of other goods, the consumer's income and her tastes and preferences. The quantity of a commodity that a consumer is willing to buy and is able to afford, given prices of goods and consumer's tastes and preferences is called **demand** for the commodity. Whenever one or more of these variables change, the quantity of the good chosen by the consumer is likely to change as well. Here we shall change one of these variables at a time and study how the amount of the good chosen by the consumer is related to that variable.

2.4.1 Demand Curve and the Law of Demand

If the prices of other goods, the consumer's income and her tastes and preferences remain unchanged, the amount of a good that the consumer optimally chooses, becomes entirely dependent on its price. The relation between the consumer's optimal choice of the quantity of a good and its price is very important and this relation is called the **demand function**. Thus, the consumer's demand function for a good

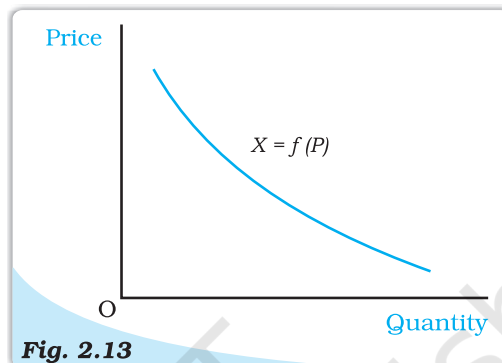


Fig. 2.13

Demand Curve. The demand curve is a relation between the quantity of the good chosen by a consumer and the price of the good. The independent variable (price) is measured along the vertical axis and dependent variable (quantity) is measured along the horizontal axis. The demand curve gives the quantity demanded by the consumer at each price.

Functions

Consider any two variables x and y . A function

$$y = f(x)$$

is a relation between the two variables x and y such that for each value of x , there is a unique value of the variable y . In other words, $f(x)$ is a rule which assigns a unique value y for each value of x . As the value of y depends on the value of x , y is called the dependent variable and x is called the independent variable.

EXAMPLE 1

Consider, for example, a situation where x can take the values 0, 1, 2, 3 and suppose corresponding values of y are 10, 15, 18 and 20, respectively. Here y and x are related by the function $y = f(x)$ which is defined as follows: $f(0) = 10$; $f(1) = 15$; $f(2) = 18$ and $f(3) = 20$.

EXAMPLE 2

Consider another situation where x can take the values 0, 5, 10 and 20. And suppose corresponding values of y are 100, 90, 70 and 40, respectively.

Here, y and x are related by the function $y = f(x)$ which is defined as follows: $f(0) = 100$; $f(10) = 90$; $f(15) = 70$ and $f(20) = 40$.

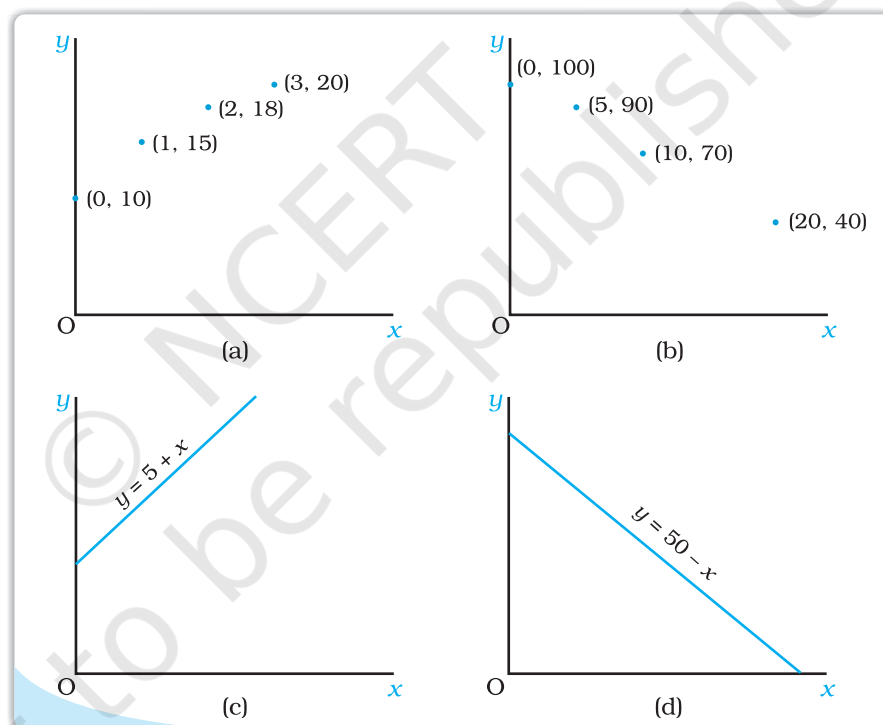
Very often a functional relation between the two variables can be expressed in algebraic form like

$$y = 5 + x \text{ and } y = 50 - x$$

A function $y = f(x)$ is an increasing function if the value of y does not decrease with increase in the value of x . It is a decreasing function if the value of y does not increase with increase in the value of x . The function in Example 1 is an increasing function. So is the function $y = x + 5$. The function in Example 2 is a decreasing function. The function $y = 50 - x$ is also decreasing.

Graphical Representation of a Function

A graph of a function $y = f(x)$ is a diagrammatic representation of the function. Following are the graphs of the functions in the examples given above.



Usually, in a graph, the independent variable is measured along the horizontal axis and the dependent variable is measured along the vertical axis. However, in economics, often the opposite is done. The demand curve, for example, is drawn by taking the independent variable (price) along the vertical axis and the dependent variable (quantity) along the horizontal axis. The graph of an increasing function is upward sloping or and the graph of a decreasing function is downward sloping. As we can see from the diagrams above, the graph of $y = 5 + x$ is upward sloping and that of $y = 50 - x$ is downward sloping.

gives the amount of the good that the consumer chooses at different levels of its price when the other things remain unchanged. The consumer's demand for a good as a function of its price can be written as

$$X = f(P) \quad (2.12)$$

where X denotes the quantity and P denotes the price of the good.

The demand function can also be represented graphically as in Figure 2.13. The graphical representation of the demand function is called the **demand curve**. The relation between the consumer's demand for a good and the price of the good is likely to be negative in general. In other words, the amount of a good that a consumer would optimally choose is likely to increase when the price of the good falls and it is likely to decrease with a rise in the price of the good.

2.4.2 Deriving a Demand Curve from Indifference Curves and Budget Constraints

Consider an individual consuming bananas (X_1) and mangoes (X_2), whose income is M and market prices of X_1 and X_2 are P'_1 and P'_2 respectively. Figure (a) depicts her consumption equilibrium at point C , where she buys X'_1 and X'_2 quantities of bananas and mangoes respectively. In panel (b) of figure 2.14, we plot P'_1 against X'_1 which is the first point on the demand curve for X_1 .

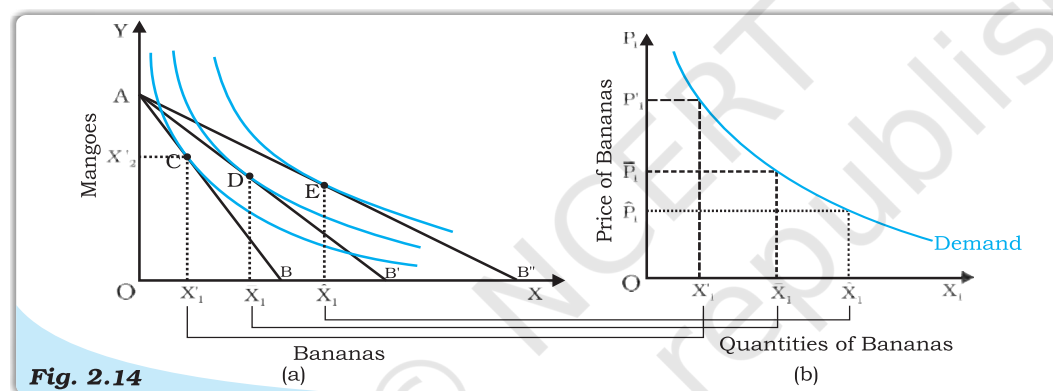


Fig. 2.14

Deriving a demand curve from indifference curves and budget constraints

Suppose the price of X_1 drops to $\bar{P}_1$ with P'_2 and M remaining constant. The budget set in panel (a), expands and new consumption equilibrium is on a higher indifference curve at point D , where she buys more of bananas ($\bar{X}_1 > X'_1$). Thus, demand for bananas increases as its price drops. We plot $\bar{P}_1$ against $\bar{X}_1$ in panel (b) of figure 2.14 to get the second point on the demand curve for X_1 . Likewise the price of bananas can be dropped further to $\hat{P}_1$, resulting in further increase in consumption of bananas to $\hat{X}_1$. $\hat{P}_1$ plotted against $\hat{X}_1$ gives us the third point on the demand curve. Therefore, we observe that a drop in price of bananas results in an increase in quantity of bananas purchased by an individual who maximises his utility. The demand curve for bananas is thus negatively sloped.

The negative slope of the demand curve can also be explained in terms of the two effects namely, **substitution effect** and **income effect** that come into play when price of a commodity changes. When bananas become cheaper, the consumer maximises his utility by substituting bananas for mangoes in order to derive the same level of satisfaction of a price change, resulting in an increase in demand for bananas.

Moreover, as price of bananas drops, consumer's purchasing power increases, which further increases demand for bananas (and mangoes). This is the income effect of a price change, resulting in further increase in demand for bananas.

Law of Demand: *Law of Demand states that other things being equal, there is a negative relation between demand for a commodity and its price. In other words, when price of the commodity increases, demand for it falls and when price of the commodity decreases, demand for it rises, other factors remaining the same.*

Linear Demand

A linear demand curve can be written as

$$\begin{aligned} d(p) &= a - bp; 0 \leq p \leq \frac{a}{b} \\ &= 0; p > \frac{a}{b} \end{aligned} \quad (2.13)$$

where a is the vertical intercept, $-b$ is the slope of the demand curve. At price 0, the demand is a , and at price

equal to $\frac{a}{b}$, the demand is 0. The slope of the demand curve measures the rate at which demand changes with respect to its price. For a unit increase in the price of the good, the demand falls by b units. Figure 2.15 depicts a linear demand curve.

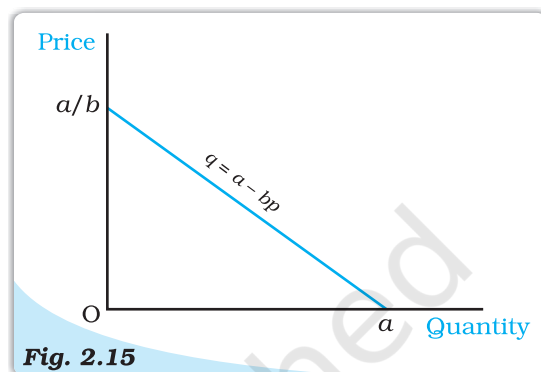


Fig. 2.15 *Linear Demand Curve. The diagram depicts the linear demand curve given by equation 2.13.*

2.4.3 Normal and Inferior Goods

The demand function is a relation between the consumer's demand for a good and its price when other things are given. Instead of studying the relation between the demand for a good and its price, we can also study the relation between the consumer's demand for the good and the income of the consumer. The quantity of a good that the consumer demands can increase or decrease with the rise in income depending on the nature of the good. For most goods, the quantity that a consumer chooses, increases as the consumer's income increases and decreases as the consumer's income decreases. Such goods are called **normal goods**. Thus, a consumer's demand for a normal good moves in the same direction as the income of the consumer. However, there are some goods the demands for which move in the opposite direction of the income of the consumer. Such goods are called **inferior goods**. As the income of the consumer increases, the demand for an inferior good falls, and as the income decreases, the demand for an inferior

A rise in the purchasing power (income) of the consumer can sometimes induce the consumer to reduce the consumption of a good. In such a case, the substitution effect and the income effect will work in opposite directions. The demand for such a good can be inversely or positively related to its price depending on the relative strengths of these two opposing effects. If the substitution effect is stronger than the income effect, the demand for the good and the price of the good would still be inversely related. However, if the income effect is stronger than the substitution effect, the demand for the good would be positively related to its price. Such a good is called a **Giffen good**.

good rises. Examples of inferior goods include low quality food items like coarse cereals.

A good can be a normal good for the consumer at some levels of income and an inferior good for her at other levels of income. At very low levels of income, a consumer's demand for low quality cereals can increase with income. But, beyond a level, any increase in income of the consumer is likely to reduce her consumption of such food items as she switches to better quality cereals.

2.4.4 Substitutes and Complements

We can also study the relation between the quantity of a good that a consumer chooses and the price of a related good. The quantity of a good that the consumer chooses can increase or decrease with the rise in the price of a related good depending on whether the two goods are **substitutes** or **complementary** to each other. Goods which are consumed together are called complementary goods. Examples of goods which are complement to each other include tea and sugar, shoes and socks, pen and ink, etc. Since tea and sugar are used together, an increase in the price of sugar is likely to decrease the demand for tea and a decrease in the price of sugar is likely to increase the demand for tea. Similar is the case with other complements. In general, the demand for a good moves in the opposite direction of the price of its complementary goods.

In contrast to complements, goods like tea and coffee are not consumed together. In fact, they are substitutes for each other. Since tea is a substitute for coffee, if the price of coffee increases, the consumers can shift to tea, and hence, the consumption of tea is likely to go up. On the other hand, if the price of coffee decreases, the consumption of tea is likely to go down. The demand for a good usually moves in the direction of the price of its substitutes.

2.4.5 Shifts in the Demand Curve

The demand curve was drawn under the assumption that the consumer's income, the prices of other goods and the preferences of the consumer are given. What happens to the demand curve when any of these things changes?

Given the prices of other goods and the preferences of a consumer, if the income increases, the demand for the good at each price changes, and hence, there is a shift in the demand curve. For normal goods, the demand curve shifts rightward and for inferior goods, the demand curve shifts leftward.

Given the consumer's income and her preferences, if the price of a related good changes, the demand for a good at each level of its price changes, and hence, there is a shift in the demand curve. If there is an increase in the price of a substitute good, the demand curve shifts rightward. On the other hand, if there is an increase in the price of a complementary good, the demand curve shifts leftward.

The demand curve can also shift due to a change in the tastes and preferences of the consumer. If the consumer's preferences change in favour of a good, the demand curve for such a good shifts rightward. On the other hand, the demand curve shifts leftward due to an unfavourable change in the preferences of the consumer. The demand curve for ice-creams, for example, is likely to shift rightward in the summer because of preference for ice-creams goes up in summer. Revelation of the fact that cold-drinks might be injurious to health can adversely affect preferences for cold-drinks. This is likely to result in a leftward shift in the demand curve for cold-drinks.

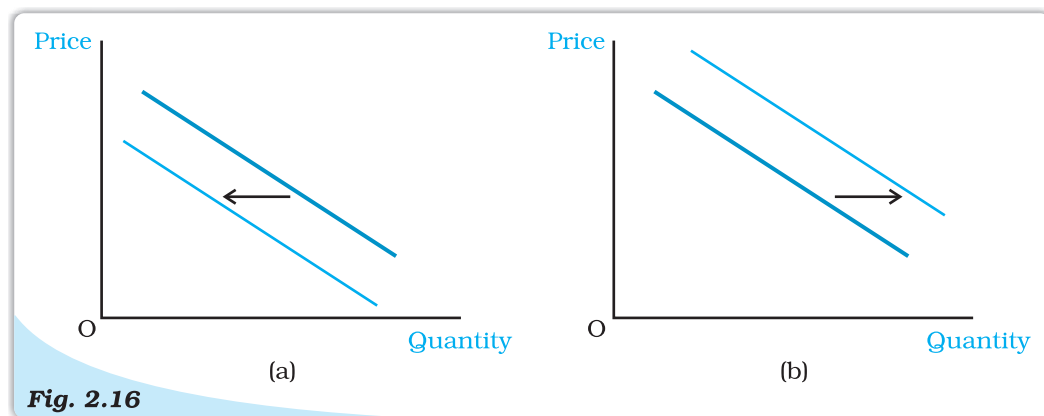


Fig. 2.16

Shifts in Demand. The demand curve in panel (a) shifts leftward and that in panel (b) shifts rightward.

Shifts in the demand curve are depicted in Figure 2.16. It may be mentioned that shift in demand curve takes place when there is a change in some factor, other than the price of the commodity.

2.4.6 Movements along the Demand Curve and Shifts in the Demand Curve

As it has been noted earlier, the amount of a good that the consumer chooses depends on the price of the good, the prices of other goods, income of the consumer and her tastes and preferences. The demand function is a relation between the amount of the good and its price when other things remain unchanged. The demand curve is a graphical representation of the demand function. At higher prices, the demand is less, and at lower prices, the demand is more. Thus, any change in the price leads to movements along the demand curve. On the other hand, changes in any of the other things lead to a shift in the demand curve. Figure 2.17 illustrates a movement along the demand curve and a shift in the demand curve.

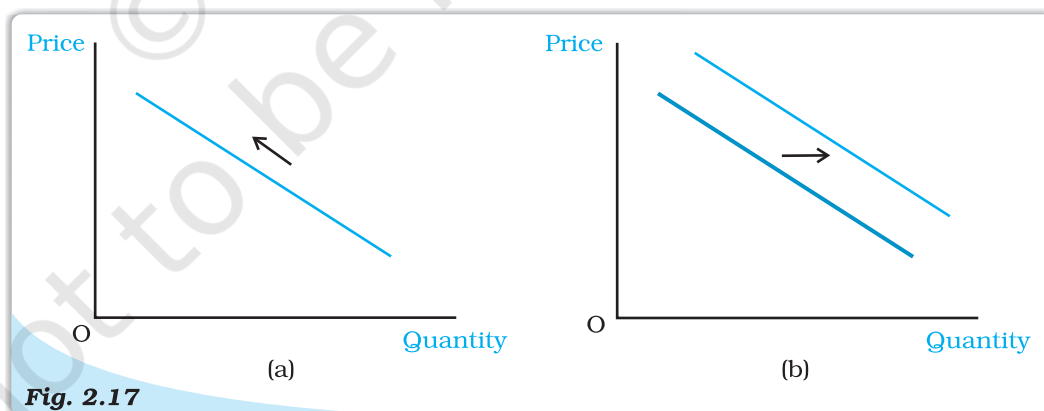


Fig. 2.17

Movement along a Demand Curve and Shift of a Demand Curve. Panel (a) depicts a movement along the demand curve and panel (b) depicts a shift of the demand curve.

2.5 MARKET DEMAND

In the last section, we studied the choice problem of the individual consumer and derived the demand curve of the consumer. However, in the market for a

good, there are many consumers. It is important to find out the market demand for the good. The market demand for a good at a particular price is the total demand of all consumers taken together. The market demand for a good can be derived from the individual demand curves. Suppose there are only two

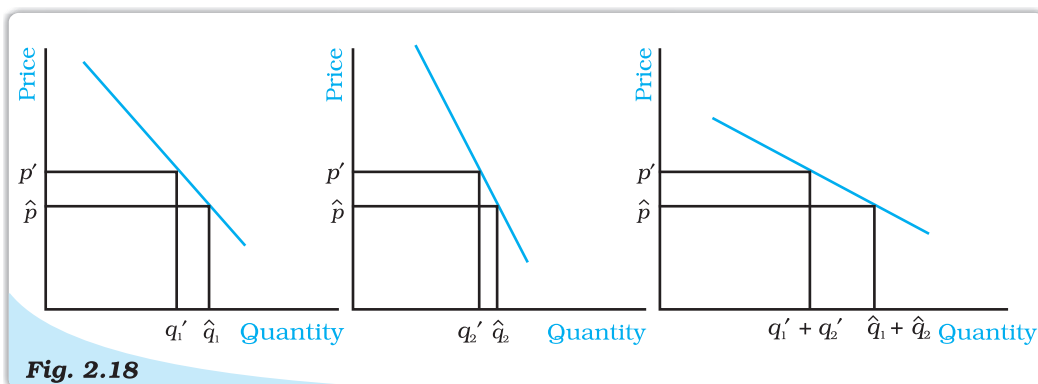


Fig. 2.18

Derivation of the Market Demand Curve. The market demand curve can be derived as a horizontal summation of the individual demand curves.

consumers in the market for a good. Suppose at price p' , the demand of consumer 1 is q_1' and that of consumer 2 is q_2' . Then, the market demand of the good at p' is $q_1' + q_2'$. Similarly, at price $\hat{p}$, if the demand of consumer 1 is $\hat{q}_1$ and that of consumer 2 is $\hat{q}_2$, the market demand of the good at $\hat{p}$ is $\hat{q}_1 + \hat{q}_2$. Thus, the market demand for the good at each price can be derived by adding up the demands of the two consumers at that price. If there are more than two consumers in the market for a good, the market demand can be derived similarly.

The market demand curve of a good can also be derived from the individual demand curves graphically by adding up the individual demand curves horizontally as shown in Figure 2.18. This method of adding two curves is called horizontal summation.

Adding up Two Linear Demand Curves

Consider, for example, a market where there are two consumers and the demand curves of the two consumers are given as

$$d_1(p) = 10 - p \quad (2.14)$$

$$\text{and } d_2(p) = 15 - p \quad (2.15)$$

Furthermore, at any price greater than 10, the consumer 1 demands 0 unit of the good, and similarly, at any price greater than 15, the consumer 2 demands 0 unit of the good. The market demand can be derived by adding equations (2.14) and (2.15). At any price less than or equal to 10, the market demand is given by $25 - 2p$, for any price greater than 10, and less than or equal to 15, market demand is $15 - p$, and at any price greater than 15, the market demand is 0.

2.6 ELASTICITY OF DEMAND

The demand for a good moves in the opposite direction of its price. But the impact of the price change is always not the same. Sometimes, the demand for a good changes considerably even for small price changes. On the other hand, there are some goods for which the demand is not affected much by price changes.

Demands for some goods are very responsive to price changes while demands for certain others are not so responsive to price changes. Price elasticity of demand is a measure of the responsiveness of the demand for a good to changes in its price. Price elasticity of demand for a good is defined as the percentage change in demand for the good divided by the percentage change in its price. Price-elasticity of demand for a good

$$e_D = \frac{\text{percentage change in demand for the good}}{\text{percentage change in the price of the good}} \quad (2.16a)$$

$$\begin{aligned} &= \frac{\frac{\Delta Q}{Q} \times 100}{\frac{\Delta P}{P} \times 100} \\ &= \left(\frac{\Delta Q}{Q} \right) \times \left(\frac{P}{\Delta P} \right) \end{aligned} \quad (2.16b)$$

Where, ΔP is the change in price of the good and ΔQ is the change in quantity of the good.

EXAMPLE 2.2

Suppose an individual buy 15 bananas when its price is Rs. 5 per banana. when the price increases to Rs. 7 per banana, she reduces his demand to 12 bananas.

Price Per banana (Rs.) : P	Quantity of bananas demanded : Q
Old Price : $P_1 = 5$	Old quantity : $Q_1 = 15$
New Price : $P_2 = 7$	New quantity: $Q_2 = 12$

In order to find her elasticity demand for bananas, we find the percentage change in quantity demanded and its price, using the information summarized in table.

Note that the price elasticity of demand is a negative number since the demand for a good is negatively related to the price of a good. However, for simplicity, we will always refer to the absolute value of the elasticity.

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Percentage change in quantity demanded} &= \frac{\Delta Q}{Q_1} \times 100 \\ &= \left(\frac{Q_2 - Q_1}{Q_1} \right) \times 100 \\ &= \frac{12 - 15}{15} \times 100 = -20 \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Percentage change in Market price} &= \frac{\Delta P}{P_1} \times 100 \\ &= \left(\frac{P_2 - P_1}{P_1} \right) \times 100 \\ &= \frac{7 - 5}{5} \times 100 = 40 \end{aligned}$$

Therefore, in our example, as price of bananas increases by 40 percent, demand for bananas drops by 20 percent. Price elasticity of demand $|e_D| = \frac{20}{40} = 0.5$. Clearly, the demand for bananas is not very responsive to a change in price of bananas. When the percentage change in quantity demanded is less than the percentage change in market price, $|e_D|$ is estimated to be less than one and the demand for the good is said to be inelastic at that price. Demand for essential goods is often found to be inelastic.

When the percentage change in quantity demanded is more than the percentage change in market price, the demand is said to be highly responsive to changes in market price and the estimated $|e_D|$ is more than one. The demand for the good is said to be elastic at that price. Demand for luxury goods is seen to be highly responsive to changes in their market prices and $|e_D| > 1$.

When the percentage change in quantity demanded equals the percentage change in its market price, $|e_D|$ is estimated to be equal to one and the demand for the good is said to be Unitary-elastic at that price. Note that the demand for certain goods may be elastic, unitary elastic and inelastic at different prices. In fact, in the next section, elasticity along a linear demand curve is estimated at different prices and shown to vary at each point on a downward sloping demand curve.

2.6.1 Elasticity along a Linear Demand Curve

Let us consider a linear demand curve $q = a - bp$. Note that at any point on the demand curve, the change in demand per unit change in the price $\frac{\Delta q}{\Delta p} = -b$.

Substituting the value of $\frac{\Delta q}{\Delta p}$ in (2.16b),

we obtain, $e_D = -b \frac{p}{q}$

putting the value of q ,

$$e_D = -\frac{bp}{a - bp} \quad (2.17)$$

From (2.17), it is clear that the elasticity of demand is different at different points on a linear demand curve. At $p = 0$, the elasticity is 0, at $q = 0$, elasticity is ∞ . At $p = \frac{a}{2b}$, the elasticity is 1, at any price greater than 0 and less

than $\frac{a}{2b}$, elasticity is less than 1, and at any price greater than $\frac{a}{2b}$, elasticity is greater than 1. The price elasticities of demand along the linear demand curve given by equation (2.17) are depicted in Figure 2.19.

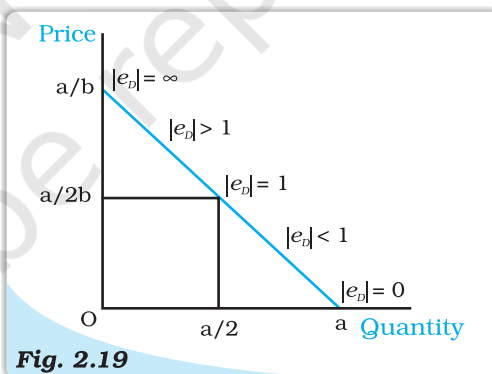
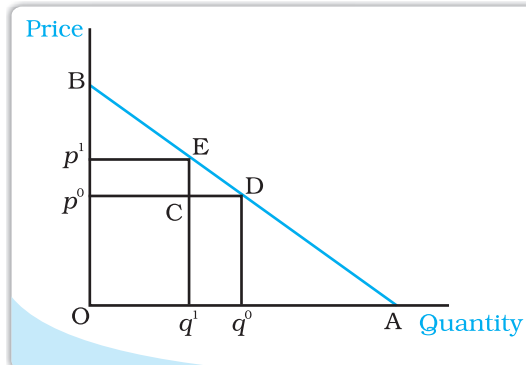


Fig. 2.19

Elasticity along a Linear Demand Curve. Price elasticity of demand is different at different points on the linear demand curve.

Geometric Measure of Elasticity along a Linear Demand Curve

The elasticity of a linear demand curve can easily be measured geometrically. The elasticity of demand at any point on a straight line demand curve is given by the ratio of the lower segment and the upper segment of the demand curve at that point. To see why this is the case, consider the following figure which depicts a straight line demand curve, $q = a - bp$.



Suppose at price p^0 , the demand for the good is q^0 . Now consider a small change in the price. The new price is p^1 , and at that price, demand for the good is q^1 .

$\Delta q = q^1 - q^0 = CD$ and $\Delta p = p^1 - p^0 = CE$.

$$\text{Therefore, } e_D = \frac{\Delta q / q^0}{\Delta p / p^0} = \frac{\Delta q}{\Delta p} \times \frac{p^0}{q^0} = \frac{q^1 - q^0}{p^1 - p^0} \times \frac{p^0}{q^0} = \frac{CD}{CE} \times \frac{Op^0}{Oq^0}$$

Since ECD and Bp^0D are similar triangles, $\frac{CD}{CE} = \frac{p^0D}{p^0B}$. But $\frac{p^0D}{p^0B} = \frac{Oq^0}{p^0B}$

$$e_D = \frac{Op^0}{p^0B} = \frac{q^0D}{p^0B}$$

Since, Bp^0D and BOA are similar triangles, $\frac{q^0D}{p^0B} = \frac{DA}{DB}$

$$\text{Thus, } e_D = \frac{DA}{DB}$$

The elasticity of demand at different points on a straight line demand curve can be derived by this method. Elasticity is 0 at the point where the demand curve meets the horizontal axis and it is ∞ at the point where the demand curve meets the vertical axis. At the midpoint of the demand curve, the elasticity is 1, at any point to the left of the midpoint, it is greater than 1 and at any point to the right, it is less than 1.

Note that along the horizontal axis $p = 0$, along the vertical axis $q = 0$ and at the midpoint of the demand curve $p = \frac{a}{2b}$.

Constant Elasticity Demand Curve

The elasticity of demand on different points on a linear demand curve is different varying from 0 to ∞ . But sometimes, the demand curves can be such that the elasticity of demand remains constant throughout. Consider, for example, a vertical demand curve as the one depicted in Figure 2.20(a). Whatever be the price, the demand is given at the level $\bar{q}$. A price never leads to a change in the demand for such a demand curve and $|e_D|$ is always 0. Therefore, a vertical demand curve is perfectly inelastic.

Figure 2.20 (b) depicts a horizontal demand curve, where market price remains constant at $\bar{P}$, whatever be the level of demand for the commodity. At any other price, quantity demanded drops to zero and therefore $|e_d| = \infty$. A horizontal demand curve is perfectly elastic.

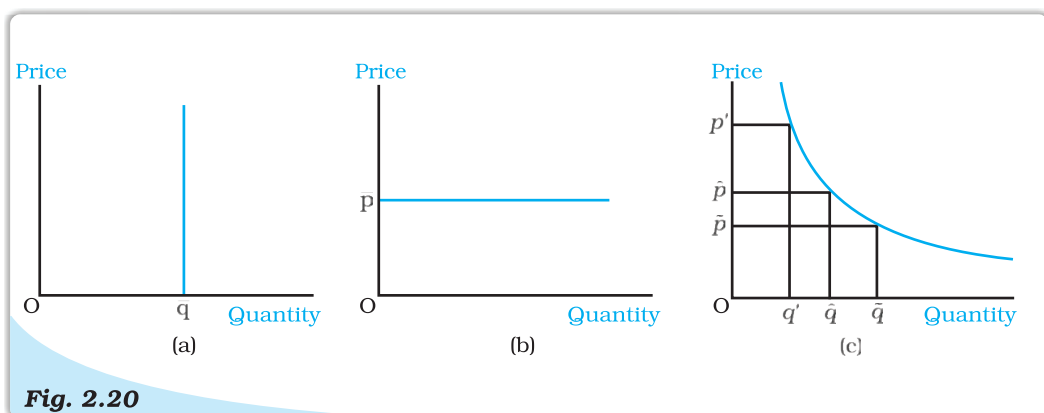


Fig. 2.20

Constant Elasticity Demand Curves. Elasticity of demand at all points along the vertical demand curve, as shown in panel (a), is 0. Elasticity of demand at all point along the horizontal demand curve, as shown in panel (b) is ∞ . Elasticity at all points on the demand curve in panel (c) is 1.

Figure 2.20(c) depicts a demand curve which has the shape of a rectangular hyperbola. This demand curve has a property that a percentage change in price along the demand curve always leads to equal percentage change in quantity. Therefore, $|e_d| = 1$ at every point on this demand curve. This demand curve is called the unitary elastic demand curve.

2.6.2 Factors Determining Price Elasticity of Demand for a Good

The price elasticity of demand for a good depends on the nature of the good and the availability of close substitutes of the good. Consider, for example, necessities like food. Such goods are essential for life and the demands for such goods do not change much in response to changes in their prices. Demand for food does not change much even if food prices go up. On the other hand, demand for luxuries can be very responsive to price changes. In general, demand for a necessity is likely to be price inelastic while demand for a luxury good is likely to be price elastic.

Though demand for food is inelastic, the demands for specific food items are likely to be more elastic. For example, think of a particular variety of pulses. If the price of this variety of pulses goes up, people can shift to some other variety of pulses which is a close substitute. The demand for a good is likely to be elastic if close substitutes are easily available. On the other hand, if close substitutes are not available easily, the demand for a good is likely to be inelastic.

2.6.3 Elasticity and Expenditure

The expenditure on a good is equal to the demand for the good times its price. Often it is important to know how the expenditure on a good changes as a result of a price change. The price of a good and the demand for the good are inversely related to each other. Whether the expenditure on the good goes up or down as a result of an increase in its price depends on how responsive the demand for the good is to the price change.

Consider an increase in the price of a good. If the percentage decline in quantity is greater than the percentage increase in the price, the expenditure on the good will go down. For example, see row 2 in table 2.5 which shows that as price of a commodity increases by 10%, its demand drops by 12%, resulting in a decline in expenditure on the good. On the other hand, if the percentage decline in quantity is less than the percentage increase in the price, the expenditure on

the good will go up (See row 1 in table 2.5). And if the percentage decline in quantity is equal to the percentage increase in the price, the expenditure on the good will remain unchanged (see row 3 in table 2.5).

Now consider a decline in the price of the good. If the percentage increase in quantity is greater than the percentage decline in the price, the expenditure on the good will go up (see row 4 in table 2.5). On the other hand, if the percentage increase in quantity is less than the percentage decline in the price, the expenditure on the good will go down (see row 5 in table 2.5). And if the percentage increase in quantity is equal to the percentage decline in the price, the expenditure on the good will remain unchanged (see row 6 in table 2.5).

The expenditure on the good would change in the opposite direction as the price change if and only if the percentage change in quantity is greater than the percentage change in price, i.e. if the good is price-elastic (see rows 2 and 4 in table 2.5). The expenditure on the good would change in the same direction as the price change if and only if the percentage change in quantity is less than the percentage change in price, i.e., if the good is price inelastic (see rows 1 and 5 in table 2.5). The expenditure on the good would remain unchanged if and only if the percentage change in quantity is equal to the percentage change in price, i.e., if the good is unit-elastic (see rows 3 and 6 in table 2.5).

Table 2.5: For hypothetical cases of price rise and drop, the following table summarises the relationship between elasticity and change in expenditure of a commodity

	Change in Price (P)	Change in Quantity demand (Q)	% Change in price demand	% Change in quantity	Impact on Expenditure = $P \times Q$	Nature of price Elasticity of demand $ e_d $
1	↑	↓	+10	-8	↑	Price Inelastic
2	↑	↓	+10	-12	↓	Price Elastic
3	↑	↓	+10	-10	No Change	Unit Elastic
4	↓	↑	-10	+15	↑	Price Elastic
5	↓	↑	-10	+7	↓	Price Inelastic
6	↓	↑	-10	+10	No Change	Unit Elastic

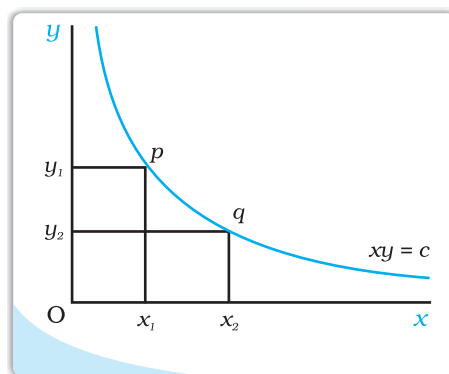
Rectangular Hyperbola

An equation of the form

$$xy = c$$

where x and y are two variables and c is a constant, giving us a curve called rectangular hyperbola. It is a downward sloping curve in the x - y plane as shown in the diagram. For any two points p and q on the curve, the areas of the two rectangles Oy_1px_1 and Oy_2qx_2 are same and equal to c .

If the equation of a demand curve takes the form $pq = e$, where e is a constant, it will be a rectangular hyperbola, where price (p) times quantity (q) is a constant. With such a demand curve, no matter at what point the consumer consumes, her expenditures are always the same and equal to e .



Relationship between Elasticity and change in Expenditure on a Good

Suppose at price p , the demand for a good is q , and at price $p + \Delta p$, the demand for the good is $q + \Delta q$.

At price p , the total expenditure on the good is pq , and at price $p + \Delta p$, the total expenditure on the good is $(p + \Delta p)(q + \Delta q)$.

If price changes from p to $(p + \Delta p)$, the change in the expenditure on the good is, $(p + \Delta p)(q + \Delta q) - pq = q\Delta p + p\Delta q + \Delta p\Delta q$.

For small values of Δp and Δq , the value of the term $\Delta p\Delta q$ is negligible, and in that case, the change in the expenditure on the good is approximately given by $q\Delta p + p\Delta q$.

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Approximate change in expenditure} &= \Delta E = q\Delta p + p\Delta q = \Delta p\left(q + p\frac{\Delta q}{\Delta p}\right) \\ &= \Delta p\left[q\left(1 + \frac{\Delta q}{\Delta p}\frac{p}{q}\right)\right] = \Delta p[q(1 + e_p)].\end{aligned}$$

Note that

if $e_p < -1$, then $q(1 + e_p) < 0$, and hence, ΔE has the opposite sign as Δp ,

if $e_p > -1$, then $q(1 + e_p) > 0$, and hence, ΔE has the same sign as Δp ,

if $e_p = -1$, then $q(1 + e_p) = 0$, and hence, $\Delta E = 0$.

- The budget set is the collection of all bundles of goods that a consumer can buy with her income at the prevailing market prices.
- The budget line represents all bundles which cost the consumer her entire income. The budget line is negatively sloping.
- The budget set changes if either of the two prices or the income changes.
- The consumer has well-defined preferences over the collection of all possible bundles. She can rank the available bundles according to her preferences over them.
- The consumer's preferences are assumed to be monotonic.
- An indifference curve is a locus of all points representing bundles among which the consumer is indifferent.
- Monotonicity of preferences implies that the indifference curve is downward sloping.
- A consumer's preferences, in general, can be represented by an indifference map.
- A consumer's preferences, in general, can also be represented by a utility function.
- A rational consumer always chooses her most preferred bundle from the budget set.
- The consumer's optimum bundle is located at the point of tangency between the budget line and an indifference curve.
- The consumer's demand curve gives the amount of the good that a consumer chooses at different levels of its price when the price of other goods, the consumer's income and her tastes and preferences remain unchanged.
- The demand curve is generally downward sloping.
- The demand for a normal good increases (decreases) with increase (decrease) in the consumer's income.
- The demand for an inferior good decreases (increases) as the income of the consumer increases (decreases).
- The market demand curve represents the demand of all consumers in the market

taken together at different levels of the price of the good.

- The price elasticity of demand for a good is defined as the percentage change in demand for the good divided by the percentage change in its price.
- The elasticity of demand is a pure number.
- Elasticity of demand for a good and total expenditure on the good are closely related.

Key Concepts

Budget set
Preference
Indifference curve
Monotonic preferences
Indifference map, Utility function
Demand
Demand curve
Income effect
Inferior good
Complement

Budget line
Indifference
Marginal Rate of substitution
Diminishing rate of substitution
Consumer's optimum
Law of demand
Substitution effect
Normal good
Substitute
Price elasticity of demand

Exercises

1. What do you mean by the budget set of a consumer?
2. What is budget line?
3. Explain why the budget line is downward sloping.
4. A consumer wants to consume two goods. The prices of the two goods are Rs 4 and Rs 5 respectively. The consumer's income is Rs 20.
 - (i) Write down the equation of the budget line.
 - (ii) How much of good 1 can the consumer consume if she spends her entire income on that good?
 - (iii) How much of good 2 can she consume if she spends her entire income on that good?
 - (iv) What is the slope of the budget line?

Questions 5, 6 and 7 are related to question 4.

5. How does the budget line change if the consumer's income increases to Rs 40 but the prices remain unchanged?
6. How does the budget line change if the price of good 2 decreases by a rupee but the price of good 1 and the consumer's income remain unchanged?
7. What happens to the budget set if both the prices as well as the income double?
8. Suppose a consumer can afford to buy 6 units of good 1 and 8 units of good 2 if she spends her entire income. The prices of the two goods are Rs 6 and Rs 8 respectively. How much is the consumer's income?
9. Suppose a consumer wants to consume two goods which are available only in integer units. The two goods are equally priced at Rs 10 and the consumer's income is Rs 40.
 - (i) Write down all the bundles that are available to the consumer.
 - (ii) Among the bundles that are available to the consumer, identify those which cost her exactly Rs 40.
10. What do you mean by 'monotonic preferences'?
11. If a consumer has monotonic preferences, can she be indifferent between the bundles (10, 8) and (8, 6)?
12. Suppose a consumer's preferences are monotonic. What can you say about her preference ranking over the bundles (10, 10), (10, 9) and (9, 9)?

13. Suppose your friend is indifferent to the bundles (5, 6) and (6, 6). Are the preferences of your friend monotonic?

14. Suppose there are two consumers in the market for a good and their demand functions are as follows:

$d_1(p) = 20 - p$ for any price less than or equal to 20, and $d_1(p) = 0$ at any price greater than 20.

$d_2(p) = 30 - 2p$ for any price less than or equal to 15 and $d_1(p) = 0$ at any price greater than 15.

Find out the market demand function.

15. Suppose there are 20 consumers for a good and they have identical demand functions:

$d(p) = 10 - 3p$ for any price less than or equal to $\frac{10}{3}$ and $d_1(p) = 0$ at any price greater than $\frac{10}{3}$.

What is the market demand function?

16. Consider a market where there are just two consumers and suppose their demands for the good are given as follows:

Calculate the market demand for the good.

p	d_1	d_2
1	9	24
2	8	20
3	7	18
4	6	16
5	5	14
6	4	12

17. What do you mean by a normal good?

18. What do you mean by an 'inferior good'? Give some examples.

19. What do you mean by substitutes? Give examples of two goods which are substitutes of each other.

20. What do you mean by complements? Give examples of two goods which are complements of each other.

21. Explain price elasticity of demand.

22. Consider the demand for a good. At price Rs 4, the demand for the good is 25 units. Suppose price of the good increases to Rs 5, and as a result, the demand for the good falls to 20 units. Calculate the price elasticity.

23. Consider the demand curve $D(p) = 10 - 3p$. What is the elasticity at price $\frac{5}{3}$?

24. Suppose the price elasticity of demand for a good is -0.2 . If there is a 5 % increase in the price of the good, by what percentage will the demand for the good go down?

25. Suppose the price elasticity of demand for a good is -0.2 . How will the expenditure on the good be affected if there is a 10 % increase in the price of the good?

27. Suppose there was a 4 % decrease in the price of a good, and as a result, the expenditure on the good increased by 2 %. What can you say about the elasticity of demand?

Chapter 3



Production and Costs

In the previous chapter, we have discussed the behaviour of the consumers. In this chapter as well as in the next, we shall examine the behaviour of a producer. Production is the process by which inputs are transformed into 'output'. Production is carried out by producers or **firms**. A firm acquires different inputs like labour, machines, land, raw materials etc. It uses these inputs to produce output. This output can be consumed by consumers, or used by other firms for further production. For example, a tailor uses a sewing machine, cloth, thread and his own labour to 'produce' shirts. A farmer uses his land, labour, a tractor, seed, fertilizer, water etc to produce wheat. A car manufacturer uses land for a factory, machinery, labour, and various other inputs (steel, aluminium, rubber etc) to produce cars. A rickshaw puller uses a rickshaw and his own labour to 'produce' rickshaw rides. A domestic helper uses her labour to produce 'cleaning services'.

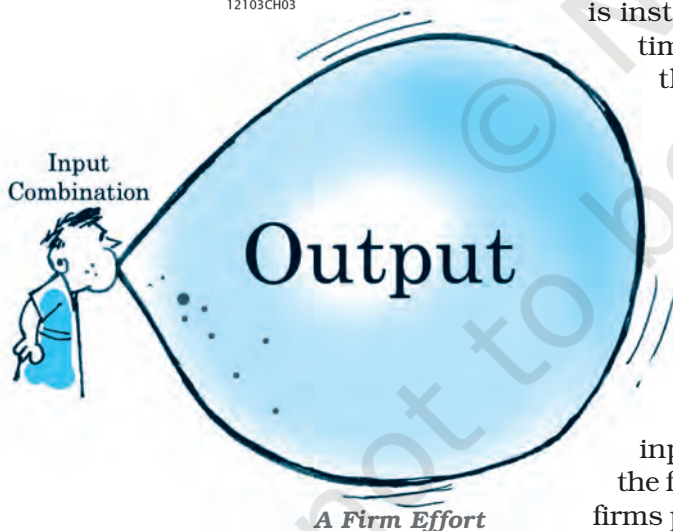
We make certain simplifying assumptions to start with. Production is instantaneous: in our very simple model of production no time elapses between the combination of the inputs and the production of the output. We also tend to use the terms production and supply synonymously and often interchangeably.

In order to acquire inputs a firm has to pay for them. This is called the **cost of production**. Once output has been produced, the firm sell it in the market and earns **revenue**. The difference between the revenue and cost is called the firm's **profit**. We assume that the objective of a firm is to earn the maximum profit that it can.

In this chapter, we discuss the relationship between inputs and output. Then we look at the cost structure of the firm. We do this to be able to identify the output at which firms profits are maximum.

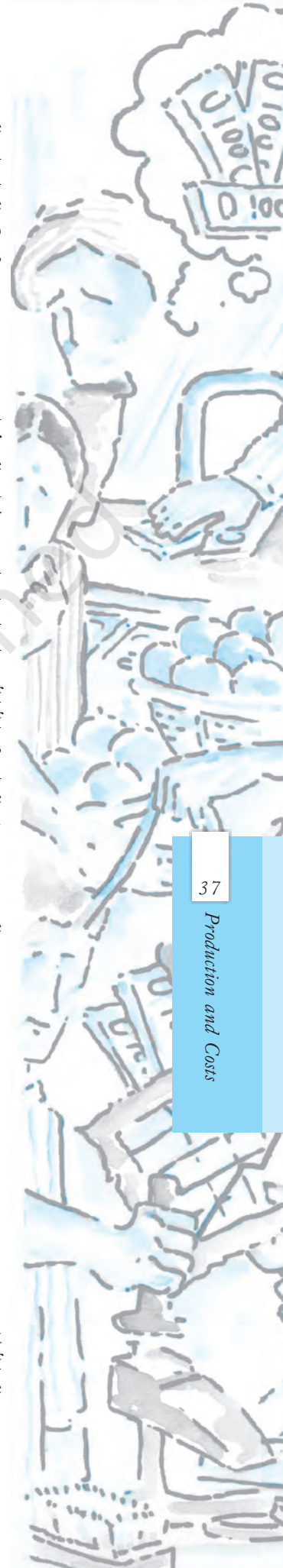


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3.1 PRODUCTION FUNCTION

The production function of a firm is a relationship between inputs used and output produced by the firm. For various quantities of inputs used, it gives the maximum quantity of output that can be produced.



Consider the farmer we mentioned above. For simplicity, we assume that the farmer uses only two inputs to produce wheat: land and labour. A production function tells us the maximum amount of wheat he can produce for a given amount of land that he uses, and a given number of hours of labour that he performs. Suppose that he uses 2 hours of labour/ day and 1 hectare of land to produce a maximum of 2 tonnes of wheat. Then, a function that describes this relation is called a production function.

One possible example of the form this could take is:

$$q = K \times L,$$

Where, q is the amount of wheat produced, K is the area of land in hectares, L is the number of hours of work done in a day.

Describing a production function in this manner tells us the exact relation between inputs and output. If either K or L increase, q will also increase. For any L and any K , there will be only one q . Since by definition we are taking the maximum output for any level of inputs, a production function deals only with the efficient use of inputs. Efficiency implies that it is not possible to get any more output from the same level of inputs.

A production function is defined for a given technology. It is the technological knowledge that determines the maximum levels of output that can be produced using different combinations of inputs. If the technology improves, the maximum levels of output obtainable for different input combinations increase. We then have a new production function.

The inputs that a firm uses in the production process are called factors of production. In order to produce output, a firm may require any number of different inputs. However, for the time being, here we consider a firm that produces output using only two factors of production – labour and capital. Our production function, therefore, tells us the maximum quantity of output (q) that can be produced by using different combinations of these two factors of productions—Labour (L) and Capital (K).

We may write the production function as

$$q = f(L, K) \quad (3.1)$$

where, L is labour and K is capital and q is the maximum output that can be produced.

Table 3.1: Production Function

Factor		Capital						
		0	1	2	3	4	5	6
Labour	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
	1	0	1	3	7	10	12	13
	2	0	3	10	18	24	29	33
	3	0	7	18	30	40	46	50
	4	0	10	24	40	50	56	57
	5	0	12	29	46	56	58	59
	6	0	13	33	50	57	59	60

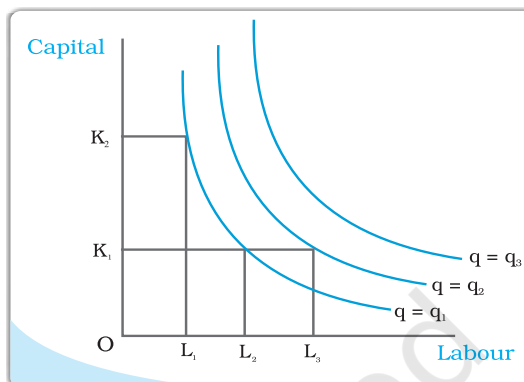
A numerical example of production function is given in Table 3.1. The left column shows the amount of labour and the top row shows the amount of capital. As we move to the right along any row, capital increases and as we move down along any column, labour increases. For different values of the two factors,

Isoquant

In Chapter 2, we have learnt about indifference curves. Here, we introduce a similar concept known as isoquant. It is just an alternative way of representing the production function. Consider a production function with two inputs labour and capital. An isoquant is the set of all possible combinations of the two inputs that yield the same maximum possible level of output. Each isoquant represents a particular level of output and is labelled with that amount of output.

Let us return to table 3.1 notice that the output of 10 units can be produced in 3 ways (4L, 1K), (2L, 2K), (1L, 4K). All these combination of L, K lie on the same isoquant, which represents the level of output 10. Can you identify the sets of inputs that will lie on the isoquant $q = 50$?

The diagram here generalizes this concept. We place L on the X axis and K on the Y axis. We have three isoquants for the three output levels, namely $q = q_1$, $q = q_2$ and $q = q_3$. Two input combinations (L_1, K_2) and (L_2, K_1) give us the same level of output q_1 . If we fix capital at K_1 and increase labour to L_3 , output increases and we reach a higher isoquant, $q = q_2$. When marginal products are positive, with greater amount of one input, the same level of output can be produced only using lesser amount of the other. Therefore, isoquants are negatively sloped.



the table shows the corresponding output levels. For example, with 1 unit of labour and 1 unit of capital, the firm can produce at most 1 unit of output; with 2 units of labour and 2 units of capital, it can produce at most 10 units of output; with 3 units of labour and 2 units of capital, it can produce at most 18 units of output and so on.

In our example, both the inputs are necessary for the production. If any of the inputs becomes zero, there will be no production. With both inputs positive, output will be positive. As we increase the amount of any input, output increases.

3.2 THE SHORT RUN AND THE LONG RUN

Before we begin with any further analysis, it is important to discuss two concepts—the **short run** and the **long run**.

In the **short run**, at least one of the factor – labour or capital – cannot be varied, and therefore, remains fixed. In order to vary the output level, the firm can vary only the other factor. The factor that remains fixed is called the **fixed factor** whereas the other factor which the firm can vary is called the **variable factor**.

Consider the example represented through Table 3.1. Suppose, in the short run, capital remains fixed at 4 units. Then the corresponding column shows the different levels of output that the firm may produce using different quantities of labour in the short run.

In the **long run**, all factors of production can be varied. A firm in order to produce different levels of output in the long run may vary both the inputs simultaneously. So, in the long run, there is no fixed factor.

For any particular production process, long run generally refers to a longer time period than the short run. For different production processes, the long run periods may be different. It is not advisable to define short run and long run in terms of say, days, months or years. We define a period as long run or short run simply by looking at whether all the inputs can be varied or not.

3.3 TOTAL PRODUCT, AVERAGE PRODUCT AND MARGINAL PRODUCT

3.3.1 Total Product

Suppose we vary a single input and keep all other inputs constant. Then for different levels of that input, we get different levels of output. This relationship between the variable input and output, keeping all other inputs constant, is often referred to as **Total Product (TP)** of the variable input.

Let us again look at Table 3.1. Suppose capital is fixed at 4 units. Now in the Table 3.1, we look at the column where capital takes the value 4. As we move down along the column, we get the output values for different values of labour. This is the total product of labour schedule with $K_2 = 4$. This is also sometimes called **total return** to or **total physical product** of the variable input. This is shown again in the second column of table in 3.2

Once we have defined total product, it will be useful to define the concepts of average product (AP) and marginal product (MP). They are useful in order to describe the contribution of the variable input to the production process.

3.3.2 Average Product

Average product is defined as the output per unit of variable input. We calculate it as

$$AP_L = \frac{TP_L}{L} \quad (3.2)$$

The last column of table 3.2 gives us a numerical example of average product of labour (with capital fixed at 4) for the production function described in table 3.1. Values in this column are obtained by dividing TP (column 2) by L (Column 1).

3.3.3 Marginal Product

Marginal product of an input is defined as the change in output per unit of change in the input when all other inputs are held constant. When capital is held constant, the marginal product of labour is

$$\begin{aligned} MP_L &= \frac{\text{Change in output}}{\text{Change in input}} \\ &= \frac{\Delta TP_L}{\Delta L} \end{aligned} \quad (3.3)$$

where Δ represents the change of the variable.

The third column of table 3.2 gives us a numerical example of Marginal Product of labour (with capital fixed at 4) for the production function described in table 3.1. Values in this column are obtained by dividing change in TP by

change in L. For example, when L changes from 1 to 2, TP changes from 10 to 24.

$$MP_L = (TP \text{ at } L \text{ units}) - (TP \text{ at } L - 1 \text{ unit}) \quad (3.4)$$

Here, Change in TP = 24 - 10 = 14

Change in L = 1

Marginal product of the 2nd unit of labour = 14/1 = 14

Since inputs cannot take negative values, marginal product is undefined at zero level of input employment. For any level of an input, the sum of marginal products of every preceeding unit of that input gives the total product. So total product is the sum of marginal products.

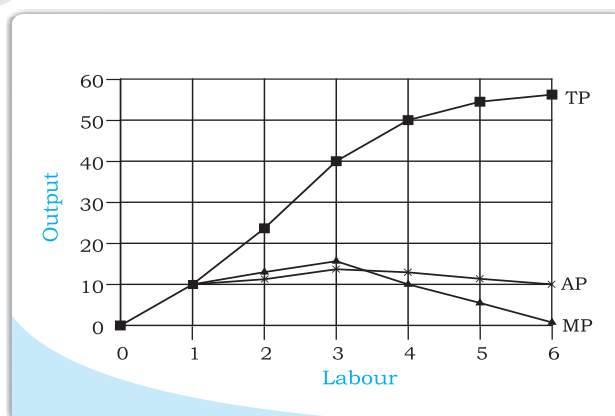
Table 3.2: Total Product, Marginal product and Average product

Labour	TP	MP_L	AP_L
0	0	-	-
1	10	10	10
2	24	14	12
3	40	16	13.33
4	50	10	12.5
5	56	6	11.2
6	57	1	9.5

Average product of an input at any level of employment is the average of all marginal products up to that level. Average and marginal products are often referred to as average and marginal returns, respectively, to the variable input.

3.4 THE LAW OF DIMINISHING MARGINAL PRODUCT AND THE LAW OF VARIABLE PROPORTIONS

If we plot the data in table 3.2 on graph paper, placing labour on the X-axis and output on the Y-axis, we get the curves shown in the diagram below. Let us examine what is happening to TP. Notice that TP increases as labour input increases. But the rate at which it increases is not constant. An increase in labour from 1 to 2 increases TP by 10 units. An increase in labour from 2 to 3 increases TP by 12. The rate at which TP increases, as explained above, is shown by the MP. Notice that the MP first increases (upto 3 units of labour) and then begins to



fall. This tendency of the MP to first increase and then fall is called the **law of variable proportions** or the **law of diminishing marginal product**. **Law of variable proportions** say that the marginal product of a factor input initially rises with its employment level. But after reaching a certain level of employment, it starts falling.

Why does this happen? In order to understand this, we first define the concept of factor proportions. Factor proportions represent the ratio in which the two inputs are combined to produce output.

As we hold one factor fixed and keep increasing the other, the factor proportions change. Initially, as we increase the amount of the variable input, the factor proportions become more and more suitable for the production and marginal product increases. But after a certain level of employment, the production process becomes too crowded with the variable input.

Suppose table 3.2 describes the output of a farmer who has 4 hectares of land, and can choose how much labour he wants to use. If he uses only 1 worker, he has too much land for the worker to cultivate alone. As he increases the number of workers, the amount of labour per unit land increases, and each worker adds proportionally more and more to the total output. Marginal product increases in this phase. When the fourth worker is hired, the land begins to get 'crowded'. Each worker now has insufficient land to work efficiently. So the output added by each additional worker is now proportionally less. The marginal product begins to fall.

We can use these observations to describe the general shapes of the TP, MP and AP curves as below.

3.5 SHAPES OF TOTAL PRODUCT, MARGINAL PRODUCT AND AVERAGE PRODUCT CURVES

An increase in the amount of one of the inputs keeping all other inputs constant results in an increase in output. Table 3.2 shows how the total product changes as the amount of labour increases. The total product curve in the input-output plane is a positively sloped curve. Figure 3.1 shows the shape of the total product curve for a typical firm.

We measure units of labour along the horizontal axis and output along the vertical axis. With L units of labour, the firm can at most produce q_1 units of output.

According to the law of variable proportions, the marginal product of an input initially rises and then after a certain level of employment, it starts falling. The MP curve therefore, looks like an inverse 'U'-shaped curve as in figure 3.2.

Let us now see what the AP curve looks like. For the first unit of the variable input, one can easily check that the MP and the

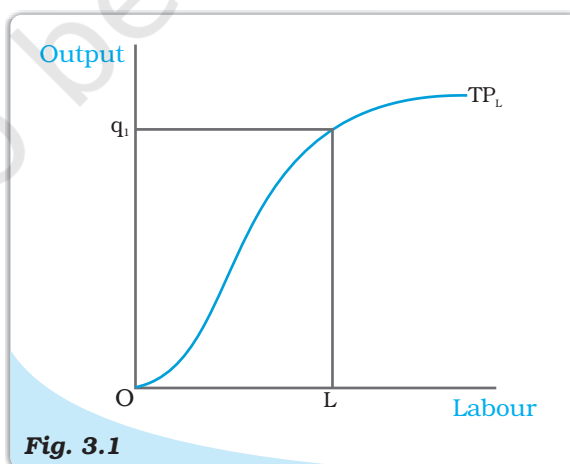


Fig. 3.1

Total Product. This is a total product curve for labour. When all other inputs are held constant, it shows the different output levels obtainable from different units of labour.

AP are same. Now as we increase the amount of input, the MP rises. AP being the average of marginal products, also rises, but rises less than MP. Then, after a point, the MP starts falling. However, as long as the value of MP remains higher than the value of the AP, the AP continues to rise. Once MP has fallen sufficiently, its value becomes less than the AP and the AP also starts falling. So AP curve is also inverse 'U'-shaped.

As long as the AP increases, it must be the case that MP is greater than AP. Otherwise, AP cannot rise. Similarly, when AP falls, MP has to be less than AP. It follows that MP curve cuts AP curve from above at its maximum.

Figure 3.2 shows the shapes of AP and MP curves for a typical firm.

The AP of factor 1 is maximum at L . To the left of L , AP is rising and MP is greater than AP. To the right of L , AP is falling and MP is less than AP.

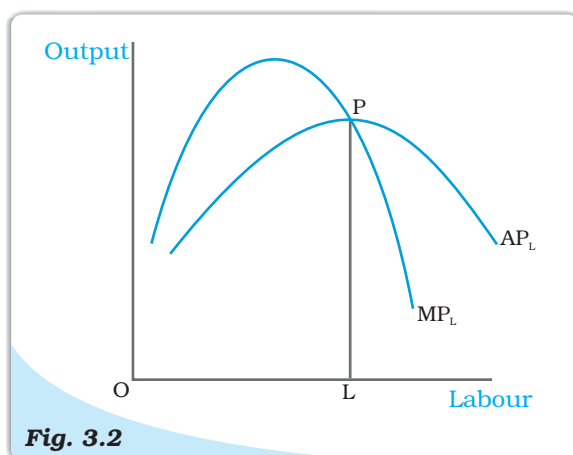


Fig. 3.2

Average and Marginal Product. These are average and marginal product curves of labour.

3.6 RETURNS TO SCALE

The law of variable proportions arises because factor proportions change as long as one factor is held constant and the other is increased. What if both factors can change? Remember that this can happen only in the long run. One special case in the long run occurs when both factors are increased by the *same proportion*, or factors are scaled up.

When a proportional increase in all inputs results in an increase in output by the same proportion, the production function is said to display **Constant returns to scale** (CRS).

When a proportional increase in all inputs results in an increase in output by a larger proportion, the production function is said to display **Increasing Returns to Scale** (IRS)

Decreasing Returns to Scale (DRS) holds when a proportional increase in all inputs results in an increase in output by a smaller proportion.

For example, suppose in a production process, all inputs get doubled. As a result, if the output gets doubled, the production function exhibits CRS. If output is less than doubled, then DRS holds, and if it is more than doubled, then IRS holds.

Returns to Scale

Consider a production function

$$q = f(x_1, x_2)$$

where the firm produces q amount of output using x_1 amount of factor 1 and x_2 amount of factor 2. Now suppose the firm decides to increase the employment level of both the factors t ($t > 1$) times. Mathematically, we

can say that the production function exhibits constant returns to scale if we have,

$$f(tx_1, tx_2) = t.f(x_1, x_2)$$

ie the new output level $f(tx_1, tx_2)$ is exactly t times the previous output level $f(x_1, x_2)$.

Similarly, the production function exhibits increasing returns to scale if,

$$f(tx_1, tx_2) > t.f(x_1, x_2).$$

It exhibits decreasing returns to scale if,

$$f(tx_1, tx_2) < t.f(x_1, x_2).$$

3.7 Costs

In order to produce output, the firm needs to employ inputs. But a given level of output, typically, can be produced in many ways. There can be more than one input combinations with which a firm can produce a desired level of output. In Table 3.1, we can see that 50 units of output can be produced by three different input combinations ($L = 6, K = 3$), ($L = 4, K = 4$) and ($L = 3, K = 6$). The question is which input combination will the firm choose? With the input prices given, it will choose that combination of inputs which is least expensive. So, for every level of output, the firm chooses the least cost input combination. Thus the cost function describes the least cost of producing each level of output given prices of factors of production and technology.

Cobb-Douglas Production Function

Consider a production function

$$q = x_1^\alpha x_2^\beta$$

where α and β are constants. The firm produces q amount of output using x_1 amount of factor 1 and x_2 amount of factor 2. This is called a **Cobb-Douglas production function**. Suppose with $x_1 = \bar{x}_1$ and $x_2 = \bar{x}_2$, we have q_0 units of output, i.e.

$$q_0 = \bar{x}_1^\alpha \bar{x}_2^\beta$$

If we increase both the inputs t ($t > 1$) times, we get the new output

$$\begin{aligned} q_1 &= (t\bar{x}_1)^\alpha (t\bar{x}_2)^\beta \\ &= t^{\alpha+\beta} \bar{x}_1^\alpha \bar{x}_2^\beta \end{aligned}$$

When $\alpha + \beta = 1$, we have $q_1 = tq_0$. That is, the output increases t times. So the production function exhibits CRS. Similarly, when $\alpha + \beta > 1$, the production function exhibits IRS. When $\alpha + \beta < 1$ the production function exhibits DRS.

3.7.1 Short Run Costs

We have previously discussed the short run and the long run. In the short run, some of the factors of production cannot be varied, and therefore, remain fixed. The cost that a firm incurs to employ these fixed inputs is called the total fixed cost (TFC). Whatever amount of output the firm

produces, this cost remains fixed for the firm. To produce any required level of output, the firm, in the short run, can adjust only variable inputs. Accordingly, the cost that a firm incurs to employ these variable inputs is called the total variable cost (TVC). Adding the fixed and the variable costs, we get the total cost (TC) of a firm

$$TC = TVC + TFC \quad (3.6)$$

In order to increase the production of output, the firm must employ more of the variable inputs. As a result, total variable cost and total cost will increase. Therefore, as output increases, total variable cost and total cost increase.

In Table 3.3, we have an example of cost function of a typical firm. The first column shows different levels of output. For all levels of output, the total fixed cost is Rs 20. Total variable cost increases as output increases. With output zero, TVC is zero. For 1 unit of output, TVC is Rs 10; for 2 units of output, TVC is Rs 18 and so on. In the fourth column, we obtain the total cost (TC) as the sum of the corresponding values in second column (TFC) and third column (TVC). At zero level of output, TC is just the fixed cost, and hence, equal to Rs 20. For 1 unit of output, total cost is Rs 30; for 2 units of output, the TC is Rs 38 and so on.

The **short run average cost (SAC)** incurred by the firm is defined as the total cost per unit of output. We calculate it as

$$SAC = \frac{TC}{q} \quad (3.7)$$

In Table 3.3, we get the SAC-column by dividing the values of the fourth column by the corresponding values of the first column. At zero output, SAC is undefined. For the first unit, SAC is Rs 30; for 2 units of output, SAC is Rs 19 and so on.

Similarly, the **average variable cost (AVC)** is defined as the total variable cost per unit of output. We calculate it as

$$AVC = \frac{TVC}{q} \quad (3.8)$$

Also, **average fixed cost (AFC)** is

$$AFC = \frac{TFC}{q} \quad (3.9)$$

Clearly,

$$SAC = AVC + AFC \quad (3.10)$$

In Table 3.3, we get the AFC-column by dividing the values of the second column by the corresponding values of the first column. Similarly, we get the AVC-column by dividing the values of the third column by the corresponding values of the first column. At zero level of output, both AFC and AVC are undefined. For the first unit of output, AFC is Rs 20 and AVC is Rs 10. Adding them, we get the SAC equal to Rs 30.

The **short run marginal cost (SMC)** is defined as the change in total cost per unit of change in output

$$SMC = \frac{\text{change in total cost}}{\text{change in output}} = \frac{\Delta TC}{\Delta q} \quad (3.11)$$

where Δ represents the change in the value of the variable.

The last column in table 3.3 gives a numerical example for the calculation of SMC. Values in this column are obtained by dividing the change in TC by the change in output, at each level of output.

Thus at $q=5$,

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Change in TC} &= (\text{TC at } q=5) - (\text{TC at } q=4) \\ &= (53) - (49) \\ &= 4\end{aligned}\quad (3.12)$$

Change in $q = 1$

$$\text{SMC} = 4/1 = 4$$

Table 3.3: Various Concepts of Costs

Output (units) (q)	TFC (Rs)	TVC (Rs)	TC (Rs)	AFC (Rs)	AVC (Rs)	SAC (Rs)	SMC (Rs)
0	20	0	20	–	–	–	–
1	20	10	30	20	10	30	10
2	20	18	38	10	9	19	8
3	20	24	44	6.67	8	14.67	6
4	20	29	49	5	7.25	12.25	5
5	20	33	53	4	6.6	10.6	4
6	20	39	59	3.33	6.5	9.83	6
7	20	47	67	2.86	6.7	9.57	8
8	20	60	80	2.5	7.5	10	13
9	20	75	95	2.22	8.33	10.55	15
10	20	95	115	2	9.5	11.5	20

Just like the case of marginal product, marginal cost also is undefined at zero level of output. It is important to note here that in the short run, fixed cost cannot be changed. When we change the level of output, whatever change occurs to total cost is entirely due to the change in total variable cost. So in the short run, marginal cost is the increase in TVC due to increase in production of one extra unit of output. For any level of output, the sum of marginal costs up to that level gives us the total variable cost at that level. One may wish to check this from the example represented through Table 3.3. Average variable cost at some level of output is therefore, the average of all marginal costs up to that level. In Table 3.3, we see that when the output is zero, SMC is undefined. For the first unit of output, SMC is Rs 10; for the second unit, the SMC is Rs 8 and so on.

Shapes of the Short Run Cost Curves

Now let us see what these short run cost curves look like. You could plot the data from in table 3.3 by placing output on the x-axis and costs on the y-axis.

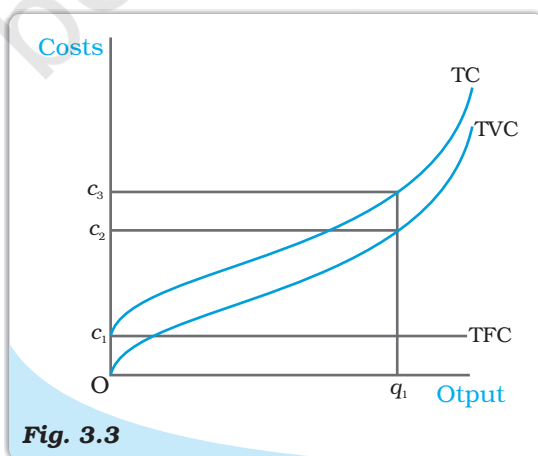


Fig. 3.3

Costs. These are total fixed cost (TFC), total variable cost (TVC) and total cost (TC) curves for a firm. Total cost is the vertical sum of total fixed cost and total variable cost.

Previously, we have discussed that in order to increase the production of output the firm needs to employ more of the variable inputs. This results in an increase in total variable cost, and hence, an increase in total cost. Therefore, as output increases, total variable cost and total cost increase. Total fixed cost, however, is independent of the amount of output produced and remains constant for all levels of production.

Figure 3.3 illustrates the shapes of total fixed cost, total variable cost and total cost curves for a typical firm. We place output on the x-axis and costs on the y-axis. TFC is a constant which takes the value c_1 and does not change with the change in output. It is, therefore, a horizontal straight line cutting the cost axis at the point c_1 . At q_1 , TVC is c_2 and TC is c_3 .

AFC is the ratio of TFC to q . TFC is a constant. Therefore, as q increases, AFC decreases. When output is very close to zero, AFC is arbitrarily large, and as output moves towards infinity, AFC moves towards zero. AFC curve is, in fact, a rectangular hyperbola. If we multiply any value q of output with its corresponding AFC, we always get a constant, namely TFC.

Figure 3.4 shows the shape of average fixed cost curve for a typical firm. We measure output along the horizontal axis and AFC along the vertical axis. At q_1 level of output, we get the corresponding average fixed cost at F . The TFC can be calculated as

$$\begin{aligned} TFC &= AFC \times \text{quantity} \\ &= OF \times Oq_1 \\ &= \text{the area of the rectangle } OFCq_1 \end{aligned}$$

We can also calculate AFC from TFC curve. In Figure 3.5, the horizontal straight line cutting the vertical axis at F is the TFC curve. At q_0 level of output, total fixed cost is equal to OF . At q_0 , the corresponding point on the TFC curve is A . Let the angle $\angle AOq_0$ be θ . The AFC at q_0 is

$$\begin{aligned} AFC &= \frac{TFC}{\text{quantity}} \\ &= \frac{Aq_0}{Oq_0} = \tan \theta \end{aligned}$$

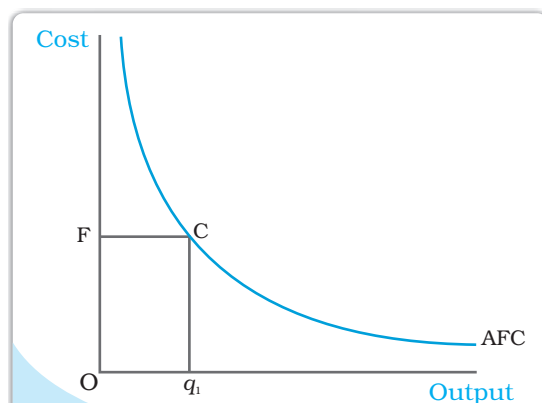


Fig. 3.4

Average Fixed Cost. The average fixed cost curve is a rectangular hyperbola. The area of the rectangle $OFCq_1$ gives us the total fixed cost.

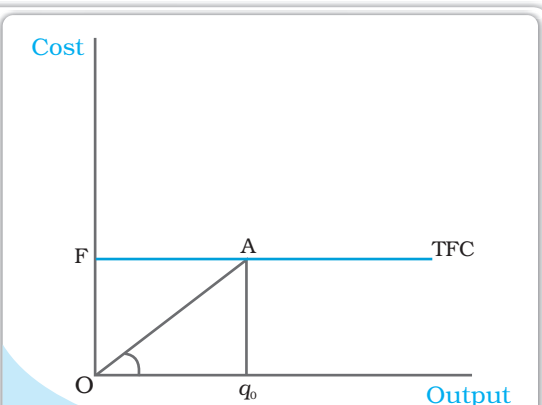


Fig. 3.5

The Total Fixed Cost Curve. The slope of the angle $\angle AOq_0$ gives us the average fixed cost at q_0 .

Let us now look at the SMC curve. Marginal cost is the additional cost that a firm incurs to produce one extra unit of output. According to the law of variable proportions, initially, the marginal product of a factor increases as employment increases, and then after a certain point, it decreases. This means initially to produce every extra unit of output, the requirement of the factor becomes less and less, and then after a certain point, it becomes greater and greater. As a result, with the factor price given, initially the SMC falls, and then after a certain point, it rises. SMC curve is, therefore, 'U'-shaped.

At zero level of output, SMC is undefined. The TVC at a particular level of output is given by the area under the SMC curve up to that level.

Now, what does the AVC curve look like? For the first unit of output, it is easy to check that SMC and AVC are the same. So both SMC and AVC curves start from the same point. Then, as output increases, SMC falls. AVC being the average of marginal costs, also falls, but falls less than SMC. Then, after a point, SMC starts rising. AVC, however, continues to fall as long as the value of SMC remains less than the prevailing value of AVC. Once the SMC has risen sufficiently, its value becomes greater than the value of AVC. The AVC then starts rising. The AVC curve is therefore 'U'-shaped.

As long as AVC is falling, SMC must be less than the AVC. As AVC rises, SMC must be greater than the AVC. So the SMC curve cuts the AVC curve from below at the minimum point of AVC.

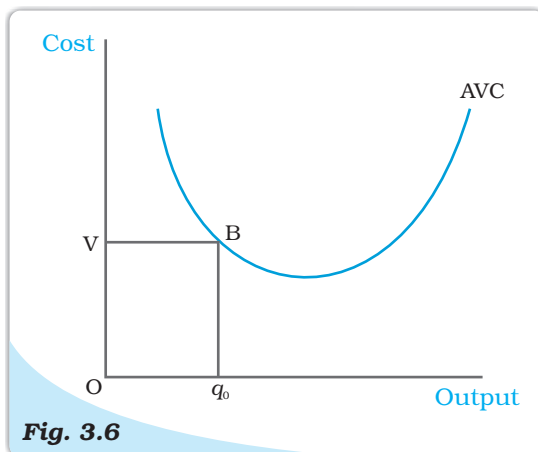


Fig. 3.6

The Average Variable Cost Curve. The area of the rectangle $OV B q_0$ gives us the total variable cost at q_0 .

In Figure 3.7, we measure output along the horizontal axis and TVC along the vertical axis. At q_0 level of output, OV is the total variable cost. Let the angle $\angle EOq_0$ be equal to θ . Then, at q_0 , the AVC can be calculated as

$$\begin{aligned} AVC &= \frac{TVC}{\text{output}} \\ &= \frac{Eq_0}{Oq_0} = \tan \theta \end{aligned}$$

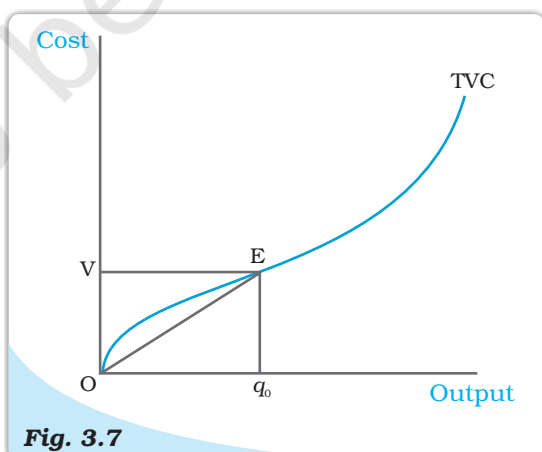


Fig. 3.7

The Total Variable Cost Curve. The slope of the angle $\angle EOq_0$ gives us the average variable cost at q_0 .

In Figure 3.6 we measure output along the horizontal axis and AVC along the vertical axis. At q_0 level of output, AVC is equal to OV . The total variable cost at q_0 is

$$\begin{aligned} TVC &= AVC \times \text{quantity} \\ &= OV \times Oq_0 \\ &= \text{the area of the} \\ &\quad \text{rectangle } OV Bq_0. \end{aligned}$$

Let us now look at SAC. SAC is the sum of AVC and AFC. Initially, both AVC and AFC decrease as output increases. Therefore, SAC initially falls. After a certain level of output production, AVC starts rising, but AFC continues to fall. Initially the fall in AFC is greater than the rise in AVC and SAC is still falling. But, after a certain level of production, rise in AVC becomes larger than the fall in AFC. From this point onwards, SAC is rising. SAC curve is therefore 'U'-shaped.

It lies above the AVC curve with the vertical difference being equal to the value of AFC. The minimum point of SAC curve lies to the right of the minimum point of AVC curve.

Similar to the case of AVC and SMC, as long as SAC is falling, SMC is less than the SAC. When SAC is rising, SMC is greater than the SAC. SMC curve cuts the SAC curve from below at the minimum point of SAC.

Figure 3.8 shows the shapes of short run marginal cost, average variable cost and short run average cost curves for a typical firm. AVC reaches its minimum at q_1 units of output. To the left of q_1 , AVC is falling and SMC is less than AVC. To the right of q_1 , AVC is rising and SMC is greater than AVC. SMC curve cuts the AVC curve at 'P' which is the minimum point of AVC curve. The minimum point of SAC curve is 'S' which corresponds to the output q_2 . It is the intersection point between SMC and SAC curves. To the left of q_2 , SAC is falling and SMC is less than SAC. To the right of q_2 , SAC is rising and SMC is greater than SAC.

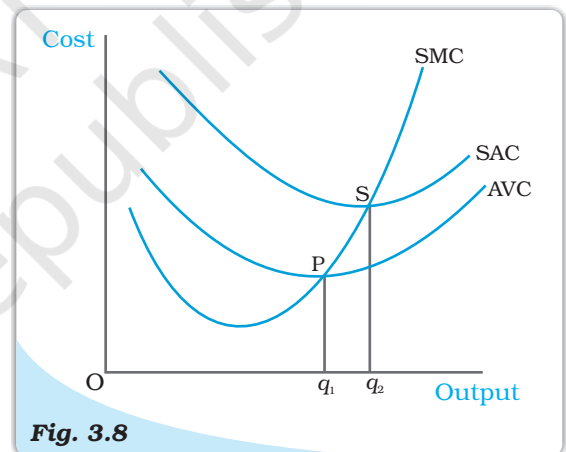


Fig. 3.8

Short Run Costs. Short run marginal cost, average variable cost and average cost curves.

3.7.2 Long Run Costs

In the long run, all inputs are variable. There are no fixed costs. The total cost and the total variable cost therefore, coincide in the long run. **Long run average cost** (LRAC) is defined as cost per unit of output, i.e.

$$LRAC = \frac{TC}{q} \quad (3.13)$$

Long run marginal cost (LRMC) is the change in total cost per unit of change in output. When output changes in discrete units, then, if we increase production from $q_1 - 1$ to q_1 units of output, the marginal cost of producing q_1^{th} unit will be measured as

$$LRMC = (TC \text{ at } q_1 \text{ units}) - (TC \text{ at } q_1 - 1 \text{ units}) \quad (3.14)$$

Just like the short run, in the long run, the sum of all marginal costs up to some output level gives us the total cost at that level.

Shapes of the Long Run Cost Curves

We have previously discussed the returns to scales. Now let us see their implications for the shape of LRAC.

IRS implies that if we increase all the inputs by a certain proportion, output increases by more than that proportion. In other words, to increase output by a certain proportion, inputs need to be increased by less than that proportion. With the input prices given, cost also increases by a lesser proportion. For example, suppose we want to double the output. To do that, inputs need to be increased, but less than double. The cost that the firm incurs to hire those inputs therefore also need to be increased by less than double. What is happening to the average cost here? It must be the case that as long as IRS operates, average cost falls as the firm increases output.

DRS implies that if we want to increase the output by a certain proportion, inputs need to be increased by more than that proportion. As a result, cost also increases by more than that proportion. So, as long as DRS operates, the average cost must be rising as the firm increases output.

CRS implies a proportional increase in inputs resulting in a proportional increase in output. So the average cost remains constant as long as CRS operates.

It is argued that in a typical firm IRS is observed at the initial level of production. This is then followed by the CRS and then by the DRS. Accordingly, the LRAC curve is a 'U'-shaped curve. Its downward sloping part corresponds to IRS and upward rising part corresponds to DRS. At the minimum point of the LRAC curve, CRS is observed.

Let us check how the LRMC curve looks like. For the first unit of output, both LRMC and LRAC are the same. Then, as output increases, LRAC initially falls, and then, after a certain point, it rises. As long as average cost is falling, marginal cost must be less than the average cost. When the average cost is rising, marginal cost must be greater than the average cost. LRMC curve is therefore a 'U'-shaped curve. It cuts the LRAC curve from below at the minimum point of the LRAC. Figure 3.9 shows the shapes of the long run marginal cost and the long run average cost curves for a typical firm.

LRAC reaches its minimum at q_1 . To the left of q_1 , LRAC is falling and LRMC is less than the LRAC curve. To the right of q_1 , LRAC is rising and LRMC is higher than LRAC.

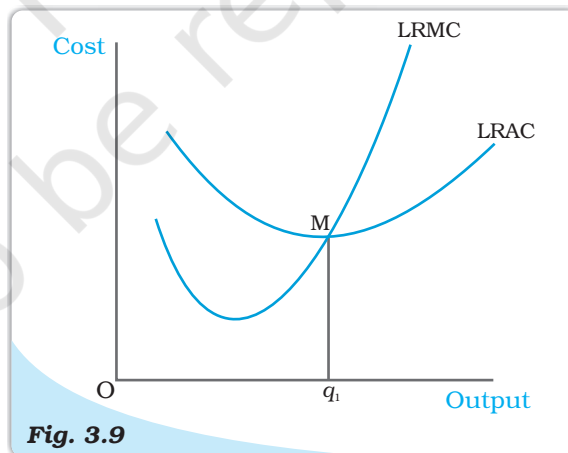


Fig. 3.9

Long Run Costs. Long run marginal cost and average cost curves.

Summary

- For different combinations of inputs, the production function shows the maximum quantity of output that can be produced.
- In the short run, some inputs cannot be varied. In the long run, all inputs can be varied.
- Total product is the relationship between a variable input and output when all other inputs are held constant.
- For any level of employment of an input, the sum of marginal products of every unit of that input up to that level gives the total product of that input at that employment level.
- Both the marginal product and the average product curves are inverse 'U'-shaped. The marginal product curve cuts the average product curve from above at the maximum point of average product curve.
- In order to produce output, the firm chooses least cost input combinations.
- Total cost is the sum of total variable cost and the total fixed cost.
- Average cost is the sum of average variable cost and average fixed cost.
- Average fixed cost curve is downward sloping.
- Short run marginal cost, average variable cost and short run average cost curves are 'U'-shaped.
- SMC curve cuts the AVC curve from below at the minimum point of AVC.
- SMC curve cuts the SAC curve from below at the minimum point of SAC.
- In the short run, for any level of output, sum of marginal costs up to that level gives us the total variable cost. The area under the SMC curve up to any level of output gives us the total variable cost up to that level.
- Both LRAC and LRMC curves are 'U' shaped.
- LRMC curve cuts the LRAC curve from below at the minimum point of LRAC.

Key Concepts

Production function
Long run
Marginal product
Law of diminishing marginal product
Cost function

Short run
Total product
Average product
Law of variable proportions
Returns to scale
Marginal cost, Average cost

Exercises

1. Explain the concept of a production function.
2. What is the total product of an input?
3. What is the average product of an input?
4. What is the marginal product of an input?
5. Explain the relationship between the marginal products and the total product of an input.
6. Explain the concepts of the short run and the long run.
7. What is the law of diminishing marginal product?
8. What is the law of variable proportions?
9. When does a production function satisfy constant returns to scale?
10. When does a production function satisfy increasing returns to scale?

11. When does a production function satisfy decreasing returns to scale?
12. Briefly explain the concept of the cost function.
13. What are the total fixed cost, total variable cost and total cost of a firm? How are they related?
14. What are the average fixed cost, average variable cost and average cost of a firm? How are they related?
15. Can there be some fixed cost in the long run? If not, why?
16. What does the average fixed cost curve look like? Why does it look so?
17. What do the short run marginal cost, average variable cost and short run average cost curves look like?
18. Why does the SMC curve cut the AVC curve at the minimum point of the AVC curve?
19. At which point does the SMC curve cut the SAC curve? Give reason in support of your answer.
20. Why is the short run marginal cost curve 'U'-shaped?
21. What do the long run marginal cost and the average cost curves look like?
22. The following table gives the total product schedule of labour. Find the corresponding average product and marginal product schedules of labour.

L	TP_L
0	0
1	15
2	35
3	50
4	40
5	48

23. The following table gives the average product schedule of labour. Find the total product and marginal product schedules. It is given that the total product is zero at zero level of labour employment.

L	AP_L
1	2
2	3
3	4
4	4.25
5	4
6	3.5

24. The following table gives the marginal product schedule of labour. It is also given that total product of labour is zero at zero level of employment. Calculate the total and average product schedules of labour.

L	MP_L
1	3
2	5
3	7
4	5
5	3
6	1

25. The following table shows the total cost schedule of a firm. What is the total fixed cost schedule of this firm? Calculate the TVC, AFC, AVC, SAC and SMC schedules of the firm.

Q	TC
0	10
1	30
2	45
3	55
4	70
5	90
6	120

26. The following table gives the total cost schedule of a firm. It is also given that the average fixed cost at 4 units of output is Rs 5. Find the TVC, TFC, AVC, AFC, SAC and SMC schedules of the firm for the corresponding values of output.

Q	TC
1	50
2	65
3	75
4	95
5	130
6	185

27. A firm's SMC schedule is shown in the following table. The total fixed cost of the firm is Rs 100. Find the TVC, TC, AVC and SAC schedules of the firm.

Q	TC
0	-
1	500
2	300
3	200
4	300
5	500
6	800

28. Let the production function of a firm be

$$Q = 5L^{\frac{1}{2}} K^{\frac{1}{2}}$$

Find out the maximum possible output that the firm can produce with 100 units of L and 100 units of K .

29. Let the production function of a firm be

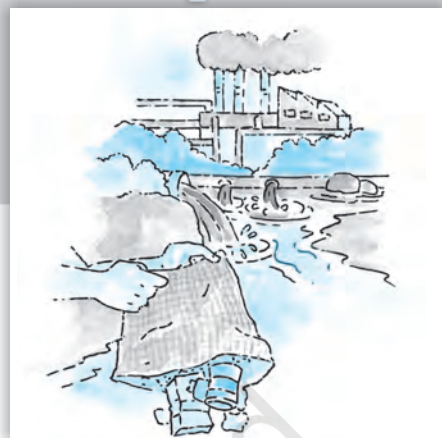
$$Q = 2L^2K^2$$

Find out the maximum possible output that the firm can produce with 5 units of L and 2 units of K . What is the maximum possible output that the firm can produce with zero unit of L and 10 units of K ?

30. Find out the maximum possible output for a firm with zero unit of L and 10 units of K when its production function is

$$Q = 5L + 2K$$

The Theory of the Firm under Perfect Competition



In the previous chapter, we studied concepts related to a firm's production function and cost curves. The focus of this chapter is different. Here we ask : how does a firm decide how much to produce? Our answer to this question is by no means simple or uncontroversial. We base our answer on a *critical*, if somewhat unreasonable, assumption about firm behaviour – a firm, we maintain, is a ruthless **profit maximiser**. So, the amount that a firm produces and sells in the market is that which maximises its profit. Here, we also assume that the firm sells whatever it produces so that 'output' and quantity sold are often used interchangeably.

The structure of this chapter is as follows. We first set up and examine in detail the profit maximisation problem of a firm. Then, we derive a firm's **supply curve**. The supply curve shows the levels of output that a firm chooses to produce at different market prices. Finally, we study how to aggregate the supply curves of individual firms and obtain the **market supply curve**.



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4.1 PERFECT COMPETITION: DEFINING FEATURES

In order to analyse a firm's profit maximisation problem, we must first specify the market environment in which the firm functions. In this chapter, we study a market environment called **perfect competition**. A perfectly competitive market has the following defining features:

1. The market consists of a large number of buyers and sellers
2. Each firm produces and sells a homogenous product. i.e., the product of one firm cannot be differentiated from the product of any other firm.
3. Entry into the market as well as exit from the market are free for firms.
4. Information is perfect.

The existence of a large number of buyers and sellers means that each individual buyer and seller is very small compared to the size of the market. This means that no individual buyer or seller can influence the market by their size. Homogenous products further mean that the product of each firm is identical. So a buyer can choose to buy from any firm in the market, and she gets the same product. Free entry and exit mean that it is easy for firms to enter the market, as well as to leave it. This condition is essential

for the large numbers of firms to exist. If entry was difficult, or restricted, then the number of firms in the market could be small. Perfect information implies that all buyers and all sellers are completely informed about the price, quality and other relevant details about the product, as well as the market.

These features result in the single most distinguishing characteristic of perfect competition: **price taking behaviour**. From the viewpoint of a firm, what does price-taking entail? A price-taking firm believes that if it sets a price above the market price, it will be unable to sell any quantity of the good that it produces. On the other hand, should the set price be less than or equal to the market price, the firm can sell as many units of the good as it wants to sell. From the viewpoint of a buyer, what does price-taking entail? A buyer would obviously like to buy the good at the lowest possible price. However, a price-taking buyer believes that if she asks for a price below the market price, no firm will be willing to sell to her. On the other hand, should the price asked be greater than or equal to the market price, the buyer can obtain as many units of the good as she desires to buy.

Price-taking is often thought to be a reasonable assumption when the market has many firms and buyers have perfect information about the price prevailing in the market. Why? Let us start with a situation where each firm in the market charges the same (market) price. Suppose, now, that a certain firm raises its price above the market price. Observe that since all firms produce the same good and all buyers are aware of the market price, the firm in question loses all its buyers. Furthermore, as these buyers switch their purchases to other firms, no “adjustment” problems arise; their demand is readily accommodated when there are so many other firms in the market. Recall, now, that an individual firm’s inability to sell any amount of the good at a price exceeding the market price is precisely what the price-taking assumption stipulates.

4.2 REVENUE

We have indicated that in a perfectly competitive market, a firm believes that it can sell as many units of the good as it wants by setting a price less than or equal to the market price. But, if this is the case, surely there is no reason to set a price lower than the market price. In other words, should the firm desire to sell some amount of the good, the price that it sets is exactly equal to the market price.

A firm earns revenue by selling the good that it produces in the market. Let the market price of a unit of the good be p . Let q be the quantity of the good produced, and therefore sold, by the firm at price p . Then, **total revenue (TR)** of the firm is defined as the market price of the good (p) multiplied by the firm’s output (q). Hence,

$$TR = p \times q$$

To make matters concrete, consider the following numerical example. Let the market for candles be perfectly competitive and let the market price of a box of candles be Rs 10. For a candle manufacturer, Table 4.1 shows how total revenue is related to output. Notice that when no box is sold, TR is equal to zero; if one box of candles is sold, TR is equal to $1 \times \text{Rs } 10 = \text{Rs } 10$; if two boxes of candles are produced, TR is equal to $2 \times \text{Rs } 10 = \text{Rs } 20$; and so on.

We can depict how the total revenue changes as the quantity sold changes through a **Total Revenue Curve**. A total revenue curve plots

Table 4.1: Total Revenue

Boxes sold	TR (in Rs)
0	0
1	10
2	20
3	30
4	40
5	50

the quantity sold or output on the X-axis and the Revenue earned on the Y-axis. Figure 4.1 shows the total revenue curve of a firm. Three observations are relevant here. First, when the output is zero, the total revenue of the firm is also zero. Therefore, the TR curve passes through point O. Second, the total revenue increases as the output goes up. Moreover, the equation ' $TR = p \times q$ ' is that of a straight line because p is constant. This means that the TR curve is an upward rising straight line. Third, consider the slope of this straight line. When the output is one unit (horizontal distance Oq_1 in Figure 4.1), the total revenue (vertical height Aq_1 in Figure 4.1) is $p \times 1 = p$. Therefore, the slope of the straight line is $Aq_1/Oq_1 = p$.

The **average revenue** (AR) of a firm is defined as total revenue per unit of output. Recall that if a firm's output is q and the market price is p , then TR equals $p \times q$. Hence

$$AR = \frac{TR}{q} = \frac{p \times q}{q} = p$$

In other words, for a price-taking firm, average revenue equals the market price.

Now consider Figure 4.2. Here, we plot the average revenue or market price (y -axis) for different values of a firm's output (x -axis). Since the market price is fixed at p , we obtain a horizontal straight line that cuts the y -axis at a height equal to p . This horizontal straight line is called the **price line**. It is also the firm's AR curve under perfect competition. The price line also depicts the demand curve facing a firm. Observe that the demand curve is perfectly elastic. This means that a firm can sell as many units of the good as it wants to sell at price p .

The **marginal revenue** (MR) of a firm is defined as the increase in total revenue for a unit increase in the firm's output. Consider table 4.1 again. Total revenue from the sale of 2 boxes of candles is Rs.20. Total revenue from the sale of 3 boxes of candles is Rs.30.

$$\text{Marginal Revenue (MR)} = \frac{\text{Change in total revenue}}{\text{Change in quantity}} = \frac{30 - 20}{3 - 2} = 10$$

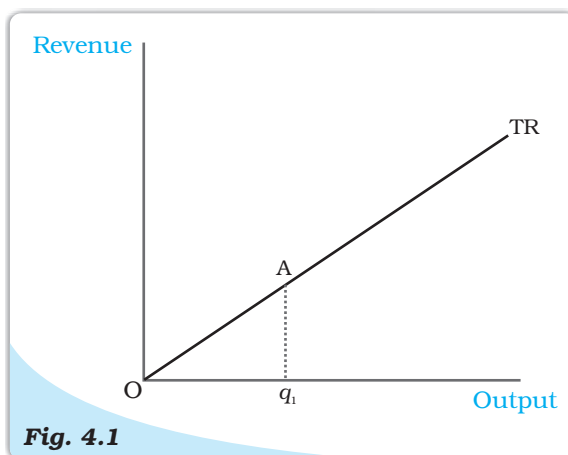


Fig. 4.1

Total Revenue curve. The total revenue curve of a firm shows the relationship between the total revenue that the firm earns and the output level of the firm. The slope of the curve, Aq_1/Oq_1 , is the market price.

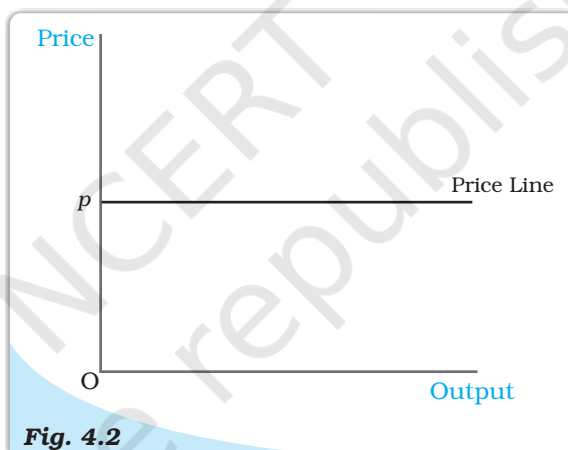


Fig. 4.2

Price Line. The price line shows the relationship between the market price and a firm's output level. The vertical height of the price line is equal to the market price, p .

Is it a coincidence that this is the same as the price? Actually it is not. Consider the situation when the firm's output changes from q_1 to q_2 . Given the market price p ,

$$\begin{aligned} MR &= (pq_2 - pq_1) / (q_2 - q_1) \\ &= [p (q_2 - q_1)] / (q_2 - q_1) \\ &= p \end{aligned}$$

Thus, for the perfectly competitive firm, $MR=AR=p$

In other words, for a price-taking firm, marginal revenue equals the market price.

Setting the algebra aside, the intuition for this result is quite simple. When a firm increases its output by one unit, this extra unit is sold at the market price. Hence, the firm's increase in total revenue from the one-unit output expansion – that is, MR – is precisely the market price.

4.3 PROFIT MAXIMISATION

A firm produces and sells a certain amount of a good. The firm's profit, denoted by π^1 , is defined to be the difference between its total revenue (TR) and its total cost of production (TC). In other words

$$\pi = TR - TC$$

Clearly, the gap between TR and TC is the firm's earnings net of costs.

A firm wishes to maximise its profit. The firm would like to identify the quantity q_0 at which its profits are maximum. By definition, then, at any quantity other than q_0 , the firm's profits are less than at q_0 . The critical question is: how do we identify q_0 ?

For profits to be maximum, three conditions must hold at q_0 :

1. The price, p , must equal MC
2. Marginal cost must be non-decreasing at q_0
3. For the firm to continue to produce, in the short run, price must be greater than the average variable cost ($p > AVC$); in the long run, price must be greater than the average cost ($p > AC$).

4.3.1 Condition 1

Profits are the difference between total revenue and total cost. Both total revenue and total cost increase as output increases. Notice that as long as the change in total revenue is greater than the change in total cost, profits will continue to increase. Recall that change in total revenue per unit increase in output is the marginal revenue; and the change in total cost per unit increase in output is the marginal cost. Therefore, we can conclude that as long as marginal revenue is greater than marginal cost, profits are increasing. By the same logic, as long as marginal revenue is less than marginal cost, profits will fall. It follows that for profits to be maximum, marginal revenue should equal marginal cost.

In other words, profits are maximum at the level of output (which we have called q_0) for which $MR = MC$

For the perfectly competitive firm, we have established that the $MR = P$. So the firm's profit maximizing output becomes the level of output at which $P=MC$.

4.3.2 Condition 2

Consider the second condition that must hold when the profit-maximising output level is positive. Why is it the case that the marginal cost curve cannot slope

¹It is a convention in economics to denote profit with the Greek letter π .

downwards at the profit-maximising output level? To answer this question, refer once again to Figure 4.3. Note that at output levels q_1 and q_4 , the market price is equal to the marginal cost. However, at the output level q_1 , the marginal cost curve is downward sloping. We claim that q_1 cannot be a profit-maximising output level. Why?

Observe that for *all* output levels slightly to the left of q_1 , the market price is lower than the marginal cost. But, the argument outlined in section 4.3.1 immediately implies that the firm's profit at an output level slightly smaller than q_1 exceeds that corresponding to the output level q_1 . This being the case, q_1 cannot be a profit-maximising output level.

4.3.3 Condition 3

Consider the third condition that must hold when the profit-maximising output level is positive. Notice that the third condition has two parts: one part applies in the short run while the other applies in the long run.

Case 1: Price must be greater than or equal to AVC in the short run

We will show that the statement of Case 1 (see above) is true by arguing that a profit-maximising firm, in the short run, will *not* produce at an output level wherein the market price is lower than the AVC.

Let us turn to Figure 4.4. Observe that at the output level q_1 , the market price p is lower than the AVC. We claim that q_1 cannot be a profit-maximising output level. Why?

Notice that the firm's total revenue at q_1 is as follows

$$\begin{aligned} TR &= \text{Price} \times \text{Quantity} \\ &= \text{Vertical height } Op \times \text{width } Oq_1 \\ &= \text{The area of rectangle } OpAq_1 \end{aligned}$$

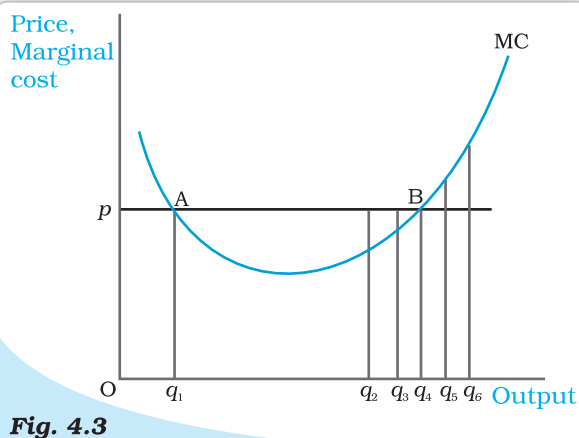


Fig. 4.3

Conditions 1 and 2 for profit maximisation.

The figure is used to demonstrate that when the market price is p , the output level of a profit-maximising firm cannot be q_1 (marginal cost curve, MC, is downward sloping), q_2 and q_3 (market price exceeds marginal cost), or q_5 and q_6 (marginal cost exceeds market price).

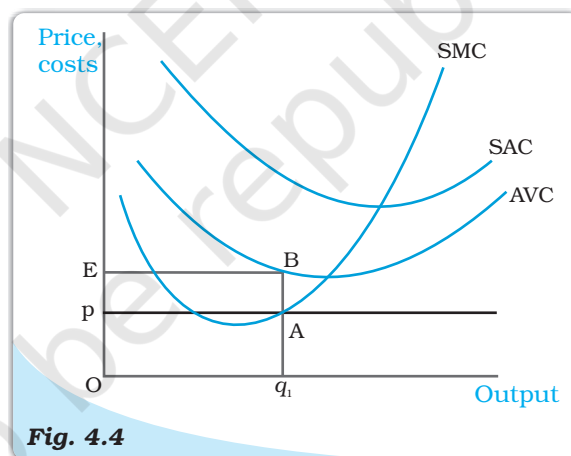


Fig. 4.4

Price-AVC Relationship with Profit Maximisation (Short Run).

The figure is used to demonstrate that a profit-maximising firm produces zero output in the short run when the market price, p , is less than the minimum of its average variable cost (AVC). If the firm's output level is q_1 , the firm's total variable cost exceeds its revenue by an amount equal to the area of rectangle $pEBA$.

Similarly, the firm's total variable cost at q_1 is as follows

$$\begin{aligned}\text{TVC} &= \text{Average variable cost} \times \text{Quantity} \\ &= \text{Vertical height } OE \times \text{Width } Oq_1 \\ &= \text{The area of rectangle } OEBq_1\end{aligned}$$

Now recall that the firm's profit at q_1 is $TR - (TVC + TFC)$; that is, [the area of rectangle $OpAq_1$] – [the area of rectangle $OEBq_1$] – TFC . What happens if the firm produces zero output? Since output is zero, TR and TVC are zero as well. Hence, the firm's profit at zero output is equal to $-TFC$. But, the area of rectangle $OpAq_1$ is strictly less than the area of rectangle $OEBq_1$. Hence, the firm's profit at q_1 is [(area $EBAp$) – TFC], which is strictly less than what it obtains by not producing at all. So, the firm will choose not to produce at all, and exit from the market.

Case 2: Price must be greater than or equal to AC in the long run

We will show that the statement of Case 2 (see above) is true by arguing that a profit-maximising firm, in the long run, will *not* produce at an output level wherein the market price is lower than the AC .

Let us turn to Figure 4.5. Observe that at the output level q_1 , the market price p is lower than the (long run) AC . We claim that q_1 cannot be a profit-maximising output level. Why?

Notice that the firm's total revenue, TR , at q_1 is the area of the rectangle $OpAq_1$ (the product of price and quantity) while the firm's total cost, TC , is the area of the rectangle $OEBq_1$ (the product of average cost and quantity). Since the area of rectangle $OEBq_1$ is larger than the area of rectangle $OpAq_1$, the firm incurs a loss at the output level q_1 . But, in the long run set-up, a firm that shuts down production has a profit of zero. Again, the firm chooses to exit in this case.

4.3.4 The Profit Maximisation Problem: Graphical Representation

Using the material in sections 3.1, 3.2 and 3.3, let us graphically represent a firm's profit

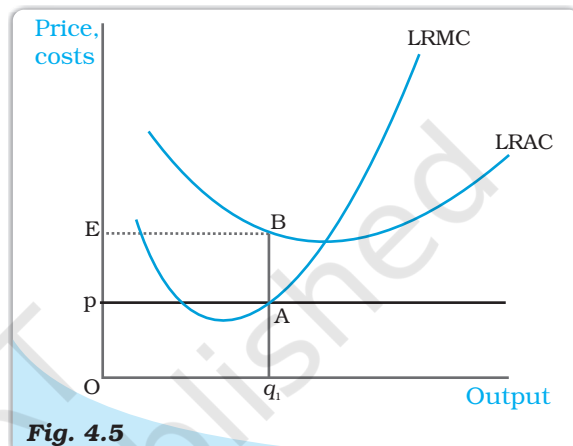


Fig. 4.5

Price-AC Relationship with Profit Maximisation (Long Run). The figure is used to demonstrate that a profit-maximising firm produces zero output in the long run when the market price, p , is less than the minimum of its long run average cost ($LRAC$). If the firm's output level is q_1 , the firm's total cost exceeds its revenue by an amount equal to the area of rectangle $pEBA$.

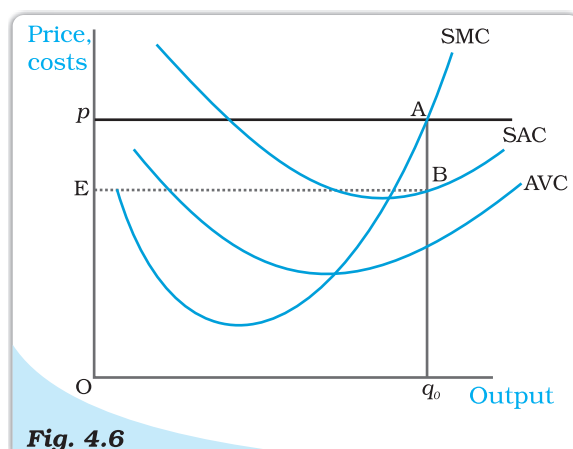


Fig. 4.6

Geometric Representation of Profit Maximisation (Short Run). Given market price p , the output level of a profit-maximising firm is q_0 . At q_0 , the firm's profit is equal to the area of rectangle $EpAB$.

maximisation problem in the short run. Consider Figure 4.6. Notice that the market price is p . Equating the market price with the (short run) marginal cost, we obtain the output level q_0 . At q_0 , observe that SMC slopes upwards and p exceeds AVC. Since the three conditions discussed in sections 3.1-3.3 are satisfied at q_0 , we maintain that the profit-maximising output level of the firm is q_0 .

What happens at q_0 ? The total revenue of the firm at q_0 is the area of rectangle $OpAq_0$ (the product of price and quantity) while the total cost at q_0 is the area of rectangle $OEBq_0$ (the product of short run average cost and quantity). So, at q_0 , the firm earns a profit equal to the area of the rectangle $EpAB$.

4.4 SUPPLY CURVE OF A FIRM

A firm's '**supply**' is the quantity that it chooses to sell at a given price, given technology, and given the prices of factors of production. A table describing the quantities sold by a firm at various prices, technology and prices of factors remaining unchanged, is called a **supply schedule**. We may also represent the information as a graph, called a supply curve. The **supply curve** of a firm shows the levels of output (plotted on the x -axis) that the firm chooses to produce corresponding to different values of the market price (plotted on the y -axis), again keeping technology and prices of factors of production unchanged. We distinguish between the **short run supply curve** and the **long run supply curve**.

4.4.1 Short Run Supply Curve of a Firm

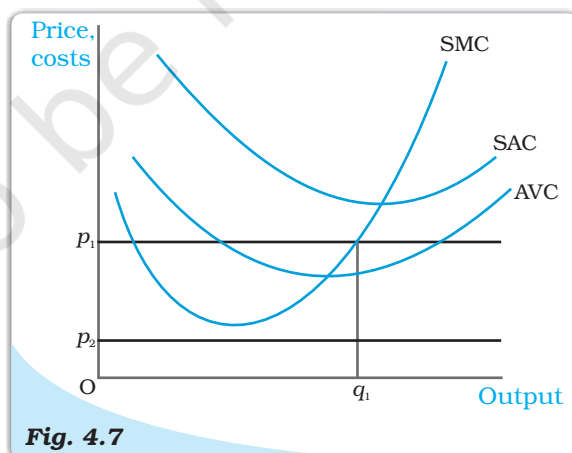
Let us turn to Figure 4.7 and derive a firm's short run supply curve. We shall split this derivation into two parts. We first determine a firm's profit-maximising output level when the market price is greater than or equal to the minimum AVC. This done, we determine the firm's profit-maximising output level when the market price is less than the minimum AVC.

Case 1: Price is greater than or equal to the minimum AVC

Suppose the market price is p_1 , which exceeds the minimum AVC. We start out by equating p_1 with SMC on the rising part of the SMC curve; this leads to the output level q_1 . Note also that the AVC at q_1 does not exceed the market price, p_1 . Thus, all three conditions highlighted in section 3 are satisfied at q_1 . Hence, when the market price is p_1 , the firm's output level in the short run is equal to q_1 .

Case 2: Price is less than the minimum AVC

Suppose the market price is p_2 , which is less than the minimum AVC. We have argued (see



Market Price Values. The figure shows the output levels chosen by a profit-maximising firm in the short run for two values of the market price: p_1 and p_2 . When the market price is p_1 , the output level of the firm is q_1 ; when the market price is p_2 , the firm produces zero output.

condition 3 in section 3) that if a profit-maximising firm produces a positive output in the short run, then the market price, p_2 , must be greater than or equal to the AVC at that output level. But notice from Figure 4.7 that for *all* positive output levels, AVC strictly exceeds p_2 . In other words, it cannot be the case that the firm supplies a positive output. So, if the market price is p_2 , the firm produces zero output.

Combining cases 1 and 2, we reach an important conclusion. A firm's short run supply curve is the rising part of the SMC curve from and above the minimum AVC together with zero output for all prices strictly less than the minimum AVC. In figure 4.8, the bold line represents the short run supply curve of the firm.

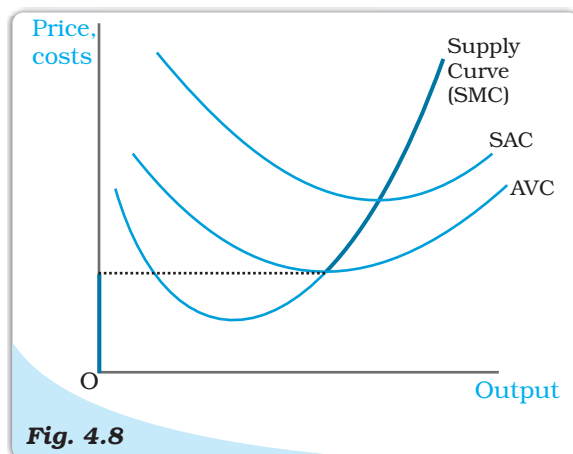


Fig. 4.8

The Short Run Supply Curve of a Firm. The short run supply curve of a firm, which is based on its short run marginal cost curve (SMC) and average variable cost curve (AVC), is represented by the bold line.

4.4.2 Long Run Supply Curve of a Firm

Let us turn to Figure 4.9 and derive the firm's long run supply curve. As in the short run case, we split the derivation into two parts. We first determine the firm's profit-maximising output level when the market price is greater than or equal to the minimum (long run) AC. This done, we determine the firm's profit-maximising output level when the market price is less than the minimum (long run) AC.

Case 1: Price greater than or equal to the minimum LRAC

Suppose the market price is p_1 , which exceeds the minimum LRAC. Upon equating p_1 with LRMC on the rising part of the LRMC curve, we obtain output level q_1 . Note also that the LRAC

at q_1 does not exceed the market price, p_1 . Thus, all three conditions highlighted in section 3 are satisfied at q_1 . Hence, when the market price is p_1 , the firm's supplies in the long run become an output equal to q_1 .

Case 2: Price less than the minimum LRAC

Suppose the market price is p_2 , which is less than the minimum LRAC. We have

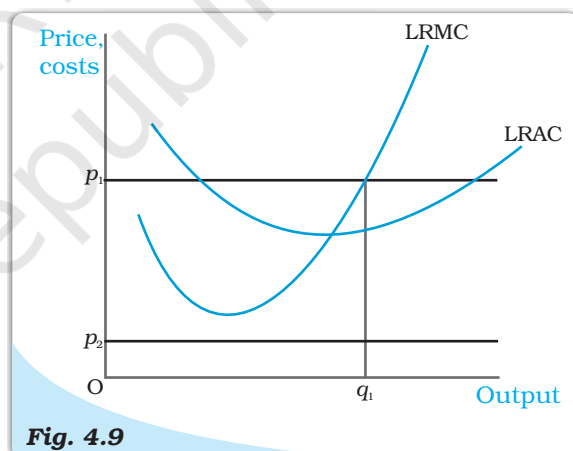


Fig. 4.9

Profit maximisation in the Long Run for Different Market Price Values. The figure shows the output levels chosen by a profit-maximising firm in the long run for two values of the market price: p_1 and p_2 . When the market price is p_1 , the output level of the firm is q_1 ; when the market price is p_2 , the firm produces zero output.

argued (see condition 3 in section 3) that if a profit-maximising firm produces a positive output in the long run, the market price, p_2 , must be greater than or equal to the LRAC at that output level. But notice from Figure 4.9 that for all positive output levels, LRAC strictly exceeds p_2 . In other words, it cannot be the case that the firm supplies a positive output. So, when the market price is p_2 , the firm produces zero output.

Combining cases 1 and 2, we reach an important conclusion. A firm's long run supply curve is the rising part of the LRMC curve from and above the minimum LRAC together with zero output for all prices less than the minimum LRAC. In Figure 4.10, the bold line represents the long run supply curve of the firm.

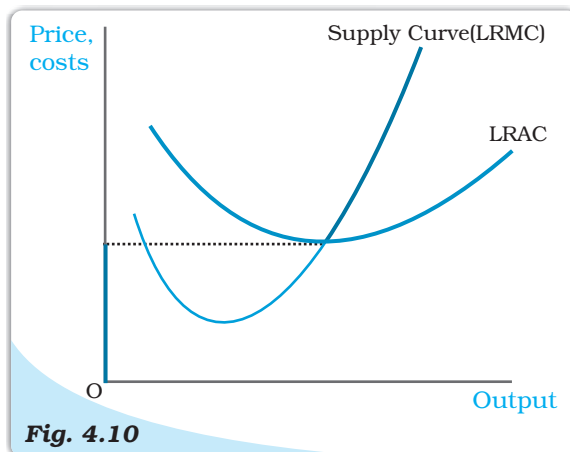


Fig. 4.10
The Long Run Supply Curve of a Firm. The long run supply curve of a firm, which is based on its long run marginal cost curve (LRMC) and long run average cost curve (LRAC), is represented by the bold line.

4.4.3 The Shut Down Point

Previously, while deriving the supply curve, we have discussed that in the short run the firm continues to produce as long as the price remains greater than or equal to the minimum of AVC. Therefore, along the supply curve as we move down, the last price-output combination at which the firm produces positive output is the point of minimum AVC where the SMC curve cuts the AVC curve. Below this, there will be no production. This point is called the short run **shut down point** of the firm. In the long run, however, the shut down point is the minimum of LRAC curve.

4.4.4 The Normal Profit and Break-even Point

The minimum level of profit that is needed to keep a firm in the existing business is defined as **normal profit**. A firm that does not make normal profits is not going to continue in business. Normal profits are therefore a part of the firm's total costs. It may be useful to think of them as an opportunity cost for entrepreneurship. Profit that a firm earns over and above the normal profit is called the **super-normal profit**. In the long run, a firm does not produce if it earns anything less than the normal profit. In the short run, however, it may produce even if the profit is less than this level. The point on the supply curve at which a firm earns only normal profit is called the **break-even point** of the firm. The point of minimum average cost at which the supply curve cuts the LRAC curve (in short run, SAC curve) is therefore the break-even point of a firm.

Opportunity cost

In economics, one often encounters the concept of opportunity cost. Opportunity cost of some activity is the gain foregone from the second best activity. Suppose you have Rs 1,000 which you decide to invest in your family business. What is the opportunity cost of your action? If you do not invest

this money, you can either keep it in the house-safe which will give you zero return or you can deposit it in either bank-1 or bank-2 in which case you get an interest at the rate of 10 per cent or 5 per cent respectively. So the maximum benefit that you may get from other alternative activities is the interest from the bank-1. But this opportunity will no longer be there once you invest the money in your family business. The opportunity cost of investing the money in your family business is therefore the amount of forgone interest from the bank-1.

4.5 DETERMINANTS OF A FIRM'S SUPPLY CURVE

In the previous section, we have seen that a firm's supply curve is a part of its marginal cost curve. Thus, *any* factor that affects a firm's marginal cost curve is of course a **determinant of its supply curve**. In this section, we discuss *two* such factors.

4.5.1 Technological Progress

Suppose a firm uses two factors of production – say, capital and labour – to produce a certain good. Subsequent to an organisational innovation by the firm, the same levels of capital and labour now produce more units of output. Put differently, to produce a given level of output, the organisational innovation allows the firm to use fewer units of inputs. It is expected that this will lower the firm's marginal cost at any level of output; that is, there is a rightward (or downward) shift of the MC curve. As the firm's supply curve is essentially a segment of the MC curve, technological progress shifts the supply curve of the firm to the right. At any given market price, the firm now supplies more units of output.

4.5.2 Input Prices

A change in input prices also affects a firm's supply curve. If the price of an input (say, the wage rate of labour) increases, the cost of production rises. The consequent increase in the firm's average cost at any level of output is usually accompanied by an increase in the firm's marginal cost at any level of output; that is, there is a leftward (or upward) shift of the MC curve. This means that the firm's supply curve shifts to the left: at any given market price, the firm now supplies fewer units of output.

Impact of a unit tax on supply

A unit tax is a tax that the government imposes per unit sale of output. For example, suppose that the unit tax imposed by the government is Rs 2. Then, if the firm produces and sells 10 units of the good, the total tax that the firm must pay to the government is $10 \times \text{Rs } 2 = \text{Rs } 20$.

How does the long run supply curve of a firm change when a unit tax is imposed? Let us turn to figure 4.11. Before the unit tax is imposed, LRMC^0 and LRAC^0 are, respectively, the long run marginal cost curve and the long run average cost curve of the firm. Now, suppose the government puts in place a unit tax of Rs t . Since the firm must pay an extra Rs t for each unit of the good produced, the firm's long run average cost and long run marginal cost at any level of output increases by Rs t . In Figure 4.11, LRMC^1 and LRAC^1 are, respectively, the long run marginal cost curve and the long run average cost curve of the firm upon imposition of the unit tax.

Recall that the long run supply curve of a firm is the rising part of the LRMC curve from and above the minimum LRAC together with zero output for all prices less than the minimum LRAC. Using this observation in Figure 4.12, it is immediate that S^0 and S^1 are, respectively, the long run supply curve of the firm before and after the imposition of the unit tax. Notice that the unit tax shifts the firm's long run supply curve to the left: at any given market price, the firm now supplies fewer units of output.

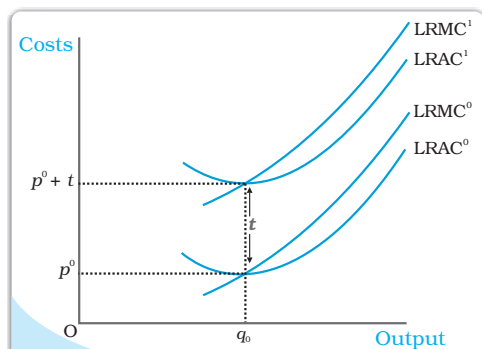


Fig. 4.11

Cost Curves and the Unit Tax. $LRAC^0$ and $LRMC^0$ are, respectively, the long run average cost curve and the long run marginal cost curve of a firm before a unit tax is imposed. $LRAC^1$ and $LRMC^1$ are, respectively, the long run average cost curve and the long run marginal cost curve of a firm after a unit tax of Rs t is imposed.

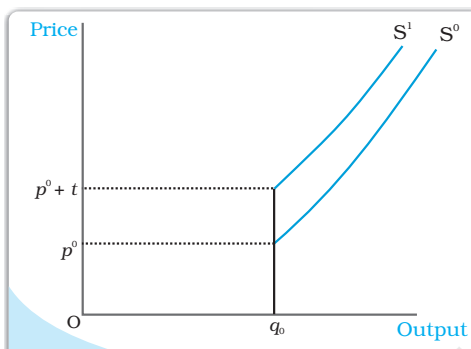


Fig. 4.12

Supply Curves and Unit Tax. S^0 is the supply curve of a firm before a unit tax is imposed. After a unit tax of Rs t is imposed, S^1 represents the supply curve of the firm.

4.6 MARKET SUPPLY CURVE

The market supply curve shows the output levels (plotted on the x -axis) that firms in the market produce in aggregate corresponding to different values of the market price (plotted on the y -axis).

How is the market supply curve derived? Consider a market with n firms: firm 1, firm 2, firm 3, and so on. Suppose the market price is fixed at p . Then, the output produced by the n firms in aggregate is [supply of firm 1 at price p] + [supply of firm 2 at price p] + ... + [supply of firm n at price p]. In other words, the market supply at price p is the summation of the supplies of individual firms at that price.

Let us now construct the market supply curve geometrically with just two firms in the market: firm 1 and firm 2. The two firms have different cost structures. Firm 1 will not produce anything if the market price is less than $\bar{p}_1$ while firm 2 will not produce anything if the market price is less than $\bar{p}_2$. Assume also that $\bar{p}_2$ is greater than $\bar{p}_1$.

In panel (a) of Figure 4.13 we have the supply curve of firm 1, denoted by S_1 ; in panel (b), we have the supply curve of firm 2, denoted by S_2 . Panel (c) of Figure 4.13 shows the market supply curve, denoted by S_m . When the market price is strictly below $\bar{p}_1$, both firms choose not to produce any amount of the good; hence, market supply will also be zero for all such prices. For a market

price greater than or equal to $\bar{p}_1$ but strictly less than $\bar{p}_2$, only firm 1 will produce a positive amount of the good. Therefore, in this range, the market supply curve coincides with the supply curve of firm 1. For a market price greater than or equal to $\bar{p}_2$, both firms will have positive output levels. For example, consider a situation wherein the market price assumes the value p_3 (observe that p_3 exceeds $\bar{p}_2$). Given p_3 , firm 1 supplies q_3 units of output while firm 2 supplies q_4 units of output. So, the market supply at price p_3 is q_5 , where $q_5 = q_3 + q_4$. Notice how the market supply curve, S_m , in panel (c) is being constructed: we obtain S_m by taking a horizontal summation of the supply curves of the two firms in the market, S_1 and S_2 .

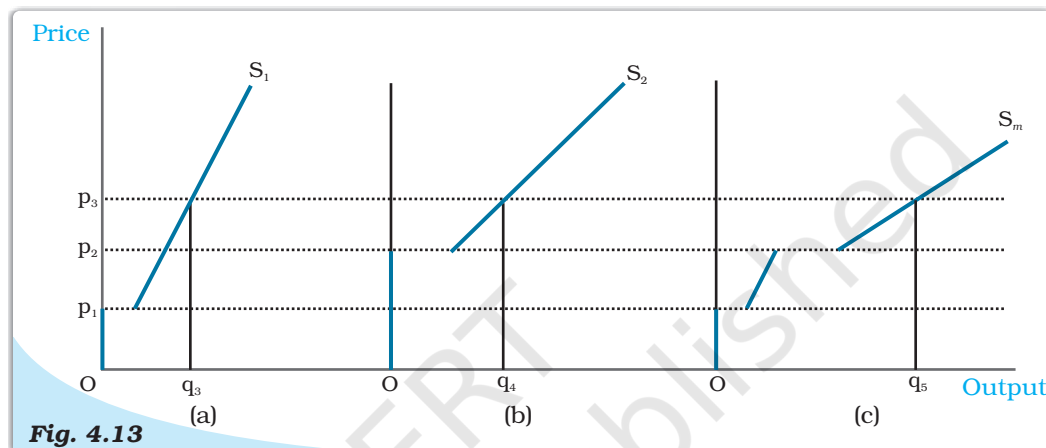


Fig. 4.13 *The Market Supply Curve Panel.* (a) shows the supply curve of firm 1. Panel (b) shows the supply curve of firm 2. Panel (c) shows the market supply curve, which is obtained by taking a horizontal summation of the supply curves of the two firms.

It should be noted that the market supply curve has been derived for a fixed number of firms in the market. As the number of firms changes, the market supply curve shifts as well. Specifically, if the number of firms in the market increases (decreases), the market supply curve shifts to the right (left).

We now supplement the graphical analysis given above with a related numerical example. Consider a market with two firms: firm 1 and firm 2. Let the supply curve of firm 1 be as follows

$$S_1(p) = \begin{cases} 0 & : p < 10 \\ p - 10 & : p \geq 10 \end{cases}$$

Notice that $S_1(p)$ indicates that (1) firm 1 produces an output of 0 if the market price, p , is strictly less than 10, and (2) firm 1 produces an output of $(p - 10)$ if the market price, p , is greater than or equal to 10. Let the supply curve of firm 2 be as follows

$$S_2(p) = \begin{cases} 0 & : p < 15 \\ p - 15 & : p \geq 15 \end{cases}$$

The interpretation of $S_2(p)$ is identical to that of $S_1(p)$, and is, hence, omitted. Now, the market supply curve, $S_m(p)$, simply sums up the supply curves of the two firms; in other words

$$S_m(p) = S_1(p) + S_2(p)$$

But, this means that $S_m(p)$ is as follows

$$S_m(p) = \begin{cases} 0 & : p < 10 \\ p - 10 & : p \geq 10 \text{ and } p < 15 \\ (p - 10) + (p - 15) = 2p - 25 & : p \geq 15 \end{cases}$$

4.7 PRICE ELASTICITY OF SUPPLY

The price elasticity of supply of a good measures the responsiveness of quantity supplied to changes in the price of the good. More specifically, the price elasticity of supply, denoted by e_s , is defined as follows

$$\text{Price elasticity of supply, } e_s = \frac{\text{Percentage change in quantity supplied}}{\text{Percentage change in price}}$$

$$= \frac{\frac{\Delta Q}{Q} \times 100}{\frac{\Delta P}{P} \times 100} = \frac{\Delta Q}{Q} \times \frac{P}{\Delta P}$$

Where ΔQ is the change in quantity of the good supplied to the market as market price changes by ΔP .

To make matters concrete, consider the following numerical example. Suppose the market for cricket balls is perfectly competitive. When the price of a cricket ball is Rs10, let us assume that 200 cricket balls are produced in aggregate by the firms in the market. When the price of a cricket ball rises to Rs 30, let us assume that 1,000 cricket balls are produced in aggregate by the firms in the market.

The percentage change in quantity supplied and market price can be estimated using the information summarised in the table below:

Price of Cricket balls (P)	Quantity of Cricket balls produced and sold (Q)
Old price : $P_1 = 10$	Old quantity : $Q_1 = 200$
New price : $P_2 = 30$	New quantity: $Q_2 = 1000$

$$\text{Percentage change in quantity supplied} = \frac{\Delta Q}{Q_1} \times 100$$

$$\begin{aligned} &= \frac{Q_2 - Q_1}{Q_1} \times 100 \\ &= \frac{1000 - 200}{200} \times 100 \\ &= 400 \end{aligned}$$

$$\text{Percentage change in market price} = \frac{\Delta P}{P_1} \times 100$$

$$\begin{aligned}
 &= \frac{P_2 - P_1}{P_1} \times 100 \\
 &= \frac{30 - 10}{10} \times 100 \\
 &= 200
 \end{aligned}$$

Therefore, price elasticity of supply, $e_s = \frac{400}{200} = 2$

When the supply curve is vertical, supply is completely insensitive to price and the elasticity of supply is zero. In other cases, when supply curve is positively sloped, with a rise in price, supply rises and hence, the elasticity of supply is positive. Like the price elasticity of demand, the price elasticity of supply is also independent of units.

The Geometric Method

Consider the Figure 4.14. Panel (a) shows a straight line supply curve. S is a point on the supply curve. It cuts the price-axis at its positive range and as we extend the straight line, it cuts the quantity-axis at M which is at its negative range. The price elasticity of this supply curve at the point S is given by the ratio, Mq_0/Oq_0 . For any point S on such a supply curve, we see that $Mq_0 > Oq_0$. The elasticity at any point on such a supply curve, therefore, will be greater than 1.

In panel (c) we consider a straight line supply curve and S is a point on it. It cuts the quantity-axis at M which is at its positive range. Again the price elasticity of this supply curve at the point S is given by the ratio, Mq_0/Oq_0 . Now, $Mq_0 < Oq_0$ and hence, $e_s < 1$. S can be any point on the supply curve, and therefore at all points on such a supply curve $e_s < 1$.

Now we come to panel (b). Here the supply curve goes through the origin. One can imagine that the point M has coincided with the origin here, i.e., Mq_0 has become equal to Oq_0 . The price elasticity of this supply curve at the point S is given by the ratio, Oq_0/Oq_0 which is equal to 1. At any point on a straight line, supply curve going through the origin price elasticity will be one.

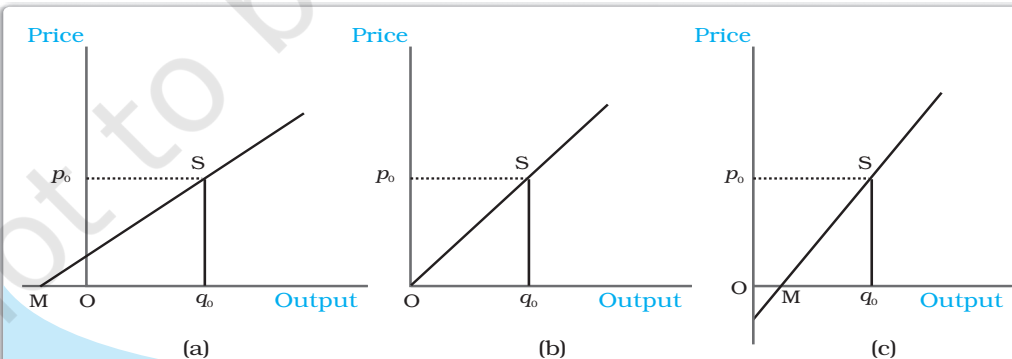


Fig. 4.14

Price Elasticity Associated with Straight Line Supply Curves. In panel (a), price elasticity (e_s) at S is greater than 1. In panel (b), price elasticity (e_s) at S is equal to 1. In panel (c), price elasticity (e_s) at S is less than 1.

- In a perfectly competitive market, firms are price-takers.
- The total revenue of a firm is the market price of the good multiplied by the firm's output of the good.
- For a price-taking firm, average revenue is equal to market price.
- For a price-taking firm, marginal revenue is equal to market price.
- The demand curve that a firm faces in a perfectly competitive market is perfectly elastic; it is a horizontal straight line at the market price.
- The profit of a firm is the difference between total revenue earned and total cost incurred.
- If there is a positive level of output at which a firm's profit is maximised in the short run, three conditions must hold at that output level
 - (i) $p = SMC$
 - (ii) SMC is non-decreasing
 - (iii) $p \geq AVC$.
- If there is a positive level of output at which a firm's profit is maximised in the long run, three conditions must hold at that output level
 - (i) $p = LRMC$
 - (ii) $LRMC$ is non-decreasing
 - (iii) $p \geq LRAC$.
- The short run supply curve of a firm is the rising part of the SMC curve from and above minimum AVC together with 0 output for all prices less than the minimum AVC .
- The long run supply curve of a firm is the rising part of the $LRMC$ curve from and above minimum $LRAC$ together with 0 output for all prices less than the minimum $LRAC$.
- Technological progress is expected to shift the supply curve of a firm to the right.
- An increase (decrease) in input prices is expected to shift the supply curve of a firm to the left (right).
- The imposition of a unit tax shifts the supply curve of a firm to the left.
- The market supply curve is obtained by the horizontal summation of the supply curves of individual firms.
- The price elasticity of supply of a good is the percentage change in quantity supplied due to one per cent change in the market price of the good.

Perfect competition
Profit maximisation
Market supply curve

Revenue, Profit
Firms supply curve
Price elasticity of supply

1. What are the characteristics of a perfectly competitive market?
2. How are the total revenue of a firm, market price, and the quantity sold by the firm related to each other?
3. What is the 'price line'?
4. Why is the total revenue curve of a price-taking firm an upward-sloping straight line? Why does the curve pass through the origin?

5. What is the relation between market price and average revenue of a price-taking firm?
6. What is the relation between market price and marginal revenue of a price-taking firm?
7. What conditions must hold if a profit-maximising firm produces positive output in a competitive market?
8. Can there be a positive level of output that a profit-maximising firm produces in a competitive market at which market price is not equal to marginal cost? Give an explanation.
9. Will a profit-maximising firm in a competitive market ever produce a positive level of output in the range where the marginal cost is falling? Give an explanation.
10. Will a profit-maximising firm in a competitive market produce a positive level of output in the short run if the market price is less than the minimum of AVC ? Give an explanation.
11. Will a profit-maximising firm in a competitive market produce a positive level of output in the long run if the market price is less than the minimum of AC ? Give an explanation.
12. What is the supply curve of a firm in the short run?
13. What is the supply curve of a firm in the long run?
14. How does technological progress affect the supply curve of a firm?
15. How does the imposition of a unit tax affect the supply curve of a firm?
16. How does an increase in the price of an input affect the supply curve of a firm?
17. How does an increase in the number of firms in a market affect the market supply curve?
18. What does the price elasticity of supply mean? How do we measure it?
19. Compute the total revenue, marginal revenue and average revenue schedules in the following table. Market price of each unit of the good is Rs 10.

Quantity Sold	TR	MR	AR
0			
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			

20. The following table shows the total revenue and total cost schedules of a competitive firm. Calculate the profit at each output level. Determine also the market price of the good.

Quantity Sold	TR (Rs)	TC (Rs)	Profit
0	0	5	
1	5	7	
2	10	10	
3	15	12	
4	20	15	
5	25	23	
6	30	33	
7	35	40	

21. The following table shows the total cost schedule of a competitive firm. It is given that the price of the good is Rs 10. Calculate the profit at each output level. Find the profit maximising level of output.

Output	TC (Rs)
0	5
1	15
2	22
3	27
4	31
5	38
6	49
7	63
8	81
9	101
10	123

22. Consider a market with two firms. The following table shows the supply schedules of the two firms: the SS_1 column gives the supply schedule of firm 1 and the SS_2 column gives the supply schedule of firm 2. Compute the market supply schedule.

Price (Rs)	SS_1 (units)	SS_2 (units)
0	0	0
1	0	0
2	0	0
3	1	1
4	2	2
5	3	3
6	4	4

23. Consider a market with two firms. In the following table, columns labelled as SS_1 and SS_2 give the supply schedules of firm 1 and firm 2 respectively. Compute the market supply schedule.

Price (Rs)	SS_1 (kg)	SS_2 (kg)
0	0	0
1	0	0
2	0	0
3	1	0
4	2	0.5
5	3	1
6	4	1.5
7	5	2
8	6	2.5

24. There are three identical firms in a market. The following table shows the supply schedule of firm 1. Compute the market supply schedule.

Price (Rs)	SS_1 (units)
0	0
1	0
2	2
3	4
4	6
5	8
6	10
7	12
8	14



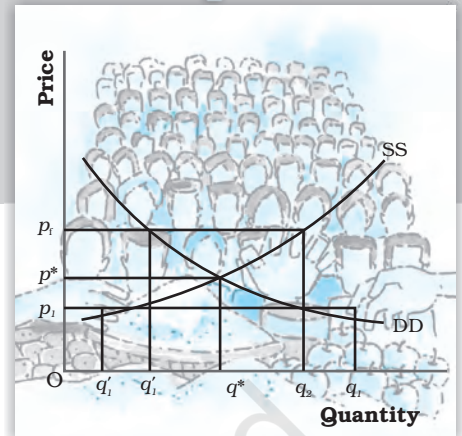
25. A firm earns a revenue of Rs 50 when the market price of a good is Rs 10. The market price increases to Rs 15 and the firm now earns a revenue of Rs 150. What is the price elasticity of the firm's supply curve?

26. The market price of a good changes from Rs 5 to Rs 20. As a result, the quantity supplied by a firm increases by 15 units. The price elasticity of the firm's supply curve is 0.5. Find the initial and final output levels of the firm.



27. At the market price of Rs 10, a firm supplies 4 units of output. The market price increases to Rs 30. The price elasticity of the firm's supply is 1.25. What quantity will the firm supply at the new price?

Market Equilibrium



This chapter will be built on the foundation laid down in Chapters 2 and 4 where we studied the consumer and firm behaviour when they are price takers. In Chapter 2, we have seen that an individual's demand curve for a commodity tells us what quantity a consumer is willing to buy at different prices when he takes price as *given*. The market demand curve in turn tells us how much of the commodity all the consumers taken together are willing to purchase at different prices when everyone takes price as *given*. In Chapter 4, we have seen that an individual firm's supply curve tells us the quantity of the commodity that a profit-maximising firm would wish to sell at different prices when it takes price as *given* and the market supply curve tells us how much of the commodity all the firms taken together would wish to supply at different prices when each firm takes price as *given*.

In this chapter, we combine both consumers' and firms' behaviour to study market equilibrium through demand-supply analysis and determine at what price equilibrium will be attained. We also examine the effects of demand and supply shifts on equilibrium. At the end of the chapter, we will look at some of the applications of demand-supply analysis.

5.1 EQUILIBRIUM, EXCESS DEMAND, EXCESS SUPPLY

A perfectly competitive market consists of buyers and sellers who are driven by their self-interested objectives. Recall from Chapters 2 and 4 that objectives of the consumers are to maximise their respective preference and that of the firms are to maximise their respective profits. Both the consumers' and firms' objectives are compatible in the equilibrium.

An equilibrium is defined as a situation where the plans of all consumers and firms in the market match and the market clears. In equilibrium, the aggregate quantity that all firms wish to sell equals the quantity that all the consumers in the market wish to buy; in other words, market supply equals market demand. The price at which equilibrium is reached is called **equilibrium price** and the quantity bought and sold at this price is called **equilibrium quantity**. Therefore, (p^*, q^*) is an equilibrium if

$$q^D(p^*) = q^S(p^*)$$



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where p^* denotes the equilibrium price and $q^D(p^*)$ and $q^S(p^*)$ denote the market demand and market supply of the commodity respectively at price p^* .

If at a price, market supply is greater than market demand, we say that there is an **excess supply** in the market at that price and if market demand exceeds market supply at a price, it is said that **excess demand** exists in the market at that price. Therefore, equilibrium in a perfectly competitive market can be defined alternatively as zero excess demand-zero excess supply situation. Whenever market supply is not equal to market demand, and hence the market is not in equilibrium, there will be a tendency for the price to change. In the next two sections, we will try to understand what drives this change.

Out-of-equilibrium Behaviour

From the time of Adam Smith (1723-1790), it has been maintained that in a perfectly competitive market an 'Invisible Hand' is at play which changes price whenever there is imbalance in the market. Our intuition also tells us that this 'Invisible Hand' should raise the prices in case of 'excess demand' and lower the prices in case of 'excess supply'. Throughout our analysis we shall maintain that the 'Invisible Hand' plays this very important role. Moreover, we shall take it that the 'Invisible Hand' by following this process is able to reach the equilibrium. This assumption will be taken to hold in all that we discuss in the text.

5.1.1 Market Equilibrium: Fixed Number of Firms

Recall that in Chapter 2 we have derived the market demand curve for price-taking consumers, and for price-taking firms the market supply curve was derived in Chapter 4 under the assumption of a fixed number of firms. In this section with the help of these two curves we will look at how supply and demand forces work together to determine where the market will be in equilibrium when the number of firms is fixed. We will also study how the equilibrium price and quantity change due to shifts in demand and supply curves.

Figure 5.1 illustrates equilibrium for a perfectly competitive market with a fixed number of firms. Here SS denotes the market supply curve and DD denotes the market demand curve for a commodity. The market supply curve SS shows how much of the commodity, firms would wish to supply at different prices, and the demand curve DD tells us how much of the commodity, the consumers would be willing to purchase at different prices. Graphically, an equilibrium is a point where the market supply curve intersects the market demand curve because this is where the market demand equals market supply. At any other point, either there is excess supply or

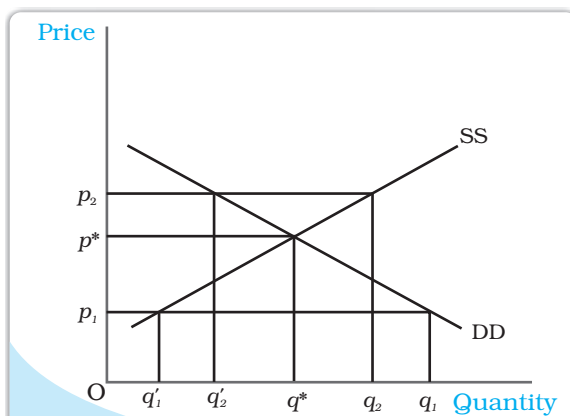


Fig. 5.1

Market Equilibrium with Fixed Number of Firms. Equilibrium occurs at the intersection of the market demand curve DD and market supply curve SS. The equilibrium quantity is q^* and the equilibrium price is p^* . At a price greater than p^* , there will be excess supply, and at a price below p^* , there will be excess demand.

there is excess demand. To see what happens when market demand does not equal market supply, let us look in figure 5.1 again.

In Figure 5.1, if the prevailing price is p_1 , the market demand is q_1 whereas the market supply is q_1' . Therefore, there is excess demand in the market equal to $q_1' - q_1$. Some consumers who are either unable to obtain the commodity at all or obtain it in insufficient quantity will be willing to pay more than p_1 . The market price would tend to increase. All other things remaining the same as price rises, quantity demanded falls and quantity supplied increases. The market moves towards the point where the quantity that the firms want to sell is equal to the quantity that the consumers want to buy. This happens when price is p^* , the supply decisions of the firms only match with the demand decisions of the consumers.

Similarly, if the prevailing price is p_2 , the market supply (q_2) will exceed the market demand (q_2') at that price giving rise to excess supply equal to $q_2 - q_2'$. Some firms will not be then able to sell quantity they want to sell; so, they will lower their price. All other things remaining the same as price falls, quantity demanded rises, quantity supplied falls, and at p^* , the firms are able to sell their desired output since market demand equals market supply at that price. Therefore, p^* is the equilibrium price and the corresponding quantity q^* is the equilibrium quantity.

To understand the equilibrium price and quantity determination more clearly, let us explain it through an example.

EXAMPLE 5.1

Let us consider the example of a market consisting of identical¹ farms producing same quality of wheat. Suppose the market demand curve and the market supply curve for wheat are given by:

$$\begin{aligned} q^D &= 200 - p & \text{for } 0 \leq p \leq 200 \\ &= 0 & \text{for } p > 200 \\ q^S &= 120 + p & \text{for } p \geq 10 \\ &= 0 & \text{for } 0 \leq p < 10 \end{aligned}$$

where q^D and q^S denote the demand for and supply of wheat (in kg) respectively and p denotes the price of wheat per kg in rupees.

Since at equilibrium price market clears, we find the equilibrium price (denoted by p^*) by equating market demand and supply and solve for p^* .

$$\begin{aligned} q^D(p^*) &= q^S(p^*) \\ 200 - p^* &= 120 + p^* \end{aligned}$$

Rearranging terms,

$$\begin{aligned} 2p^* &= 80 \\ p^* &= 40 \end{aligned}$$

Therefore, the equilibrium price of wheat is Rs 40 per kg. The equilibrium quantity (denoted by q^*) is obtained by substituting the equilibrium price into either the demand or the supply curve's equation since in equilibrium quantity demanded and supplied are equal.

¹Here, by identical we mean that all farms have same cost structure.

$$q^D = q^* = 200 - 40 = 160$$

Alternatively,

$$q^S = q^* = 120 + 40 = 160$$

Thus, the equilibrium quantity is 160 kg.

At a price less than p^* , say $p^1 = 25$

$$q^D = 200 - 25 = 175$$

$$q^S = 120 + 25 = 145$$

Therefore, at $p_1 = 25$, $q^D > q^S$ which implies that there is excess demand at this price.

Algebraically, excess demand (ED) can be expressed as

$$\begin{aligned} ED(p) &= q^D - q^S \\ &= 200 - p - (120 + p) \\ &= 80 - 2p \end{aligned}$$

Notice from the above expression that for any price less than $p^*(= 40)$, excess demand will be positive.

Similarly, at a price greater than p^* , say $p_2 = 45$

$$q^D = 200 - 45 = 155$$

$$q^S = 120 + 45 = 165$$

Therefore, there is excess supply at this price since $q^S > q^D$. Algebraically, excess supply (ES) can be expressed as

$$\begin{aligned} ES(p) &= q^S - q^D \\ &= 120 + p - (200 - p) \\ &= 2p - 80 \end{aligned}$$

Notice from the above expression that for any price greater than $p^*(= 40)$, excess supply will be positive.

Therefore, at any price greater than p^* , there will be excess supply, and at any price lower than p^* , there will be excess demand.

Wage Determination in Labour Market

Here we will briefly discuss the theory of wage determination under a perfectly competitive market structure using the demand-supply analysis. The basic difference between a labour market and a market for goods is with respect to the source of supply and demand. In the labour market, households are the suppliers of labour and the demand for labour comes from firms whereas in the market for goods, it is the opposite. Here, it is important to point out that by labour, we mean the hours of work provided by labourers and not the number of labourers. The wage rate is determined at the intersection of the demand and supply curves of labour where the demand for and supply of labour balance. We shall now see what the demand and supply curves of labour look like.

To examine the demand for labour by a single firm, we assume that the labour is the only variable factor of production and the labour market is perfectly competitive, which in turn, implies that each firm takes wage rate as *given*. Also, the firm we are concerned with, is perfectly competitive in

nature and carries out production with the goal of profit maximisation. We also assume that given the technology of the firm, the law of diminishing marginal product holds.

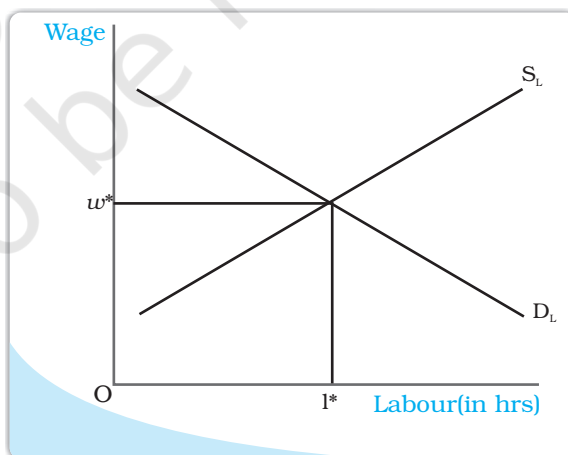
The firm being a profit maximiser will always employ labour upto the point where the extra cost she incurs for employing the last unit of labour is equal to the additional benefit she earns from that unit. The extra cost of hiring one more unit of labour is the wage rate (w). The extra output produced by one more unit of labour is its marginal product (MP_L) and by selling each extra unit of output, the additional earning of the firm is the marginal revenue (MR) she gets from that unit. Therefore, for each extra unit of labour, she gets an additional benefit equal to marginal revenue times marginal product which is called **Marginal Revenue Product of Labour (MRP_L)**. Thus, while hiring labour, the firm employs labour up to the point where

$$w = MRP_L \\ \text{and } MRP_L = MR \times MP_L$$

Since we are dealing with a perfectly competitive firm, marginal revenue is equal to the price of the commodity^a and hence marginal revenue product of labour in this case is equal to the value of marginal product of labour (VMP_L).

As long as the VMP_L is greater than the wage rate, the firm will earn more profit by hiring one more unit of labour, and if at any level of labour employment VMP_L is less than the wage rate, the firm can increase her profit by reducing a unit of labour employed.

Given the assumption of the law of diminishing marginal product, the fact that the firm always produces at $w = VMP_L$ implies that the demand curve for labour is downward sloping. To explain why it is so, let us assume at some wage rate w_1 , demand for labour is l_1 . Now, suppose the wage rate increases to w_2 . To maintain the wage- VMP_L equality, VMP_L should also increase. The price of the commodity remaining constant^b, this is possible only if MP_L increases which in turn implies that less labour should be employed owing to the diminishing marginal productivity of labour. Hence, at higher wage, less labour is demanded thereby leading to a downward sloping demand curve. To arrive at the market demand curve from individual firms' demand curve, we simply add up the demand for labour by individual firms at different wages and since each firm demands less labour as wage increases, the market demand curve is also downward sloping.



Wage is determined at the point where the labour demand and supply curves intersect.

^aRecall from Chapter 4 that for a perfectly competitive firm, marginal revenue equals price.

^bSince the firm under consideration is perfectly competitive, it believes it cannot influence the price of the commodity.

Having explored the demand side, we now turn to the supply side. As already mentioned, it is the households which determine how much labour to supply at a given wage rate. Their supply decision is essentially a choice between income and leisure. On the one hand, individuals enjoy leisure and find work irksome and on the other, they value income for which they must work.

So there is a trade-off between enjoying leisure and spending more hours for work. To derive the labour supply curve for a single individual, let us assume at some wage rate w_1 , the individual supplies l_1 units of labour. Now suppose the wage rises to w_2 . This increase in wage rate will have two effects: First, due to the increase in wage rate, the opportunity cost of leisure increases which makes leisure costlier. Therefore, the individual will want to enjoy less leisure. As a result, they will work for longer hours. Second, because of the increase in wage rate to w_2 , the purchasing power of the individual increases. So, she would want to spend more on leisure activities. The final effect of the increase in wage rate will depend on which of the two effects predominates. At low wage rates, the first effect dominates the second and so the individual will be willing to supply more labour with an increase in wage rate. But at high wage rates, the second effect dominates the first and the individual will be willing to supply less labour for every increase in wage rate. Thus, we get a backward bending individual labour supply curve which shows that up to a certain wage rate for every increase in wage rate, there is an increased supply of labour. Beyond this wage rate for every increase in wage rate, labour supply will decrease. Nevertheless, the market supply curve of labour, which we obtain by aggregating individuals' supply at different wages, will be upward sloping because though at higher wages some individuals may be willing to work less, many more individuals will be attracted to supply more labour.

With an upward sloping supply curve and downward sloping demand curve, the equilibrium wage rate is determined at the point where these two curves intersect; in other words, where the labour that the households wish to supply is equal to the labour that the firms wish to hire. This is shown in the diagram.

Shifts in Demand and Supply

In the above section, we studied market equilibrium under the assumption that tastes and preferences of the consumers, prices of the related commodities, incomes of the consumers, technology, size of the market, prices of the inputs used in production, etc remain constant. However, with changes in one or more of these factors either the supply or the demand curve or both may shift, thereby affecting the equilibrium price and quantity. Here, we first develop the general theory which outlines the impact of these shifts on equilibrium and then discuss the impact of changes in some of the above mentioned factors on equilibrium.

Demand Shift

Consider Figure 5.2 in which we depict the impact of demand shift when the number of firms is fixed. Here, the initial equilibrium point is E where the market demand curve DD_0 and the market supply curve SS_0 intersect so that q_0 and p_0 are the equilibrium quantity and price respectively.

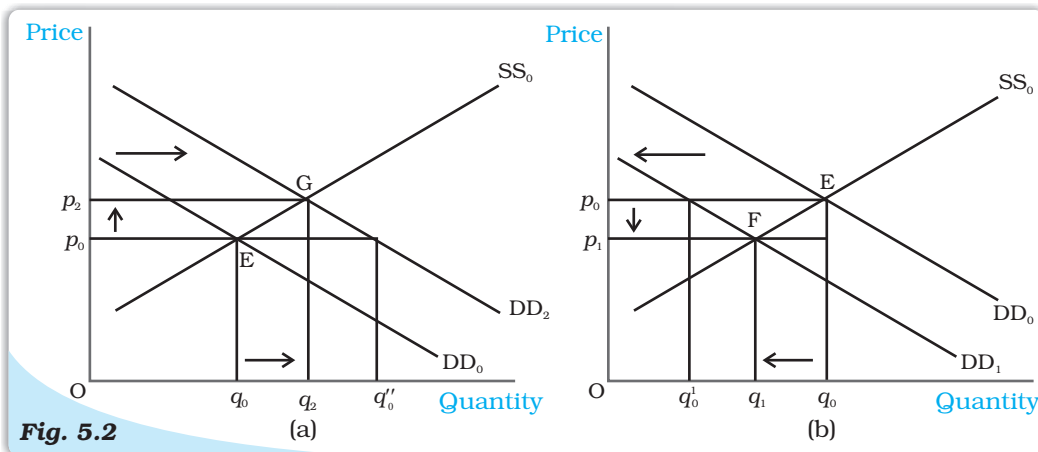


Fig. 5.2

Shifts in Demand. Initially, the market equilibrium is at E. Due to the shift in demand to the right, the new equilibrium is at G as shown in panel (a) and due to the leftward shift, the new equilibrium is at F, as shown in panel (b). With rightward shift the equilibrium quantity and price increase whereas with leftward shift, equilibrium quantity and price decrease.

Now suppose the market demand curve shifts rightward to DD_2 with supply curve remaining unchanged at SS_0 , as shown in panel (a). This shift indicates that at any price the quantity demanded is more than before. Therefore, at price p_0 now there is excess demand in the market equal to $q_0q'_0$. In response to this excess demand some individuals will be willing to pay higher price and the price would tend to rise. The new equilibrium is attained at G where the equilibrium quantity q_2 is greater than q_0 and the equilibrium price p_2 is greater than p_0 .

Similarly if the demand curve shifts leftward to DD_1 , as shown in panel (b), at any price the quantity demanded will be less than what it was before the shift. Therefore, at the initial equilibrium price p_0 now there will be excess supply in the market equal to q'_0q_0 in response to which some firms will reduce the price of their commodity so that they can sell their desired quantity. The new equilibrium is attained at the point F at which the demand curve DD_1 and the supply curve SS_0 intersect and the resulting equilibrium price p_1 is less than p_0 and quantity q_1 is less than q_0 . Notice that *the direction of change in equilibrium price and quantity is same whenever there is a shift in demand curve.*

Having developed the general theory, we now consider some examples to understand how demand curve and the equilibrium quantity and price are affected in response to a change in some of the aforementioned factors which are also enlisted in Chapter 2. More specifically, we would analyse the impact of increase in consumers' income and an increase in the number of consumers on equilibrium.

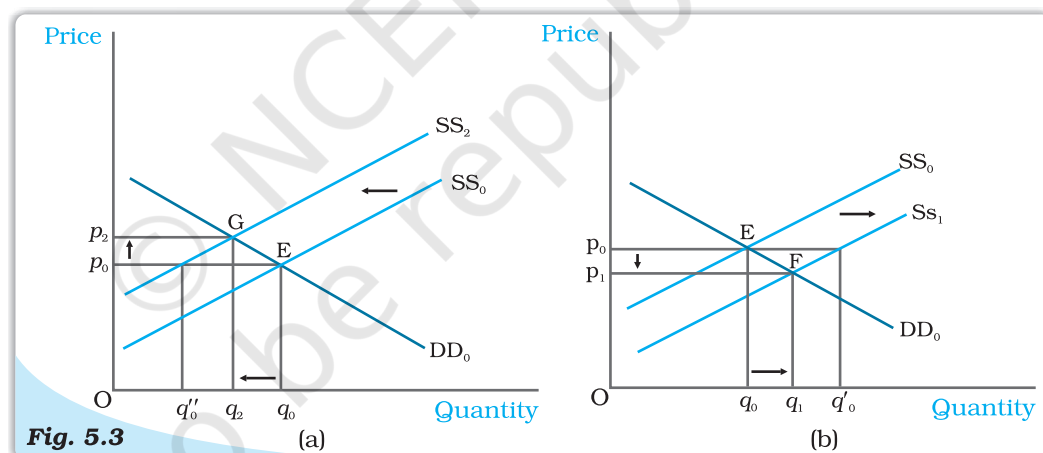
Suppose due to a hike in the salaries of the consumers, their incomes increase. How would it affect equilibrium? With an increase in income, consumers are able to spend more money on some goods. But recall from Chapter 2 that the consumers will spend less on an inferior good with increase in income whereas for a normal good, with prices of all commodities and tastes and preferences of the consumers held constant, we would expect the demand for the good to increase at each price as a result of which the market demand curve will shift rightward. Here we consider the example of a normal good like clothes, the demand for which increases with increase in income of consumers, thereby causing a rightward shift in the demand curve. However, this income increase does not have any impact on

the supply curve, which shifts only due to some changes in the factors relating to technology or cost of production of the firms. Thus, the supply curve remains unchanged. In the Figure 5.2 (a), this is shown by a shift in the demand curve from DD_0 to DD_2 but the supply curve remains unchanged at SS_0 . From the figure, it is clear that at the new equilibrium, the price of clothes is higher and the quantity demanded and sold is also higher.

Now let us turn to another example. Suppose due to some reason, there is increase in the number of consumers in the market for clothes. As the number of consumers increases, other factors remaining unchanged, at each price, more clothes will be demanded. Thus, the demand curve will shift rightwards. But this increase in the number of consumers does not have any impact on the supply curve since the supply curve may shift only due to changes in the parameters relating to firms' behaviour or with an increase in the number of firms, as stated in Chapter 4. This case again can be illustrated through Figure 5.2(a) in which the demand curve DD_0 shifts rightward to DD_2 , the supply curve remaining unchanged at SS_0 . The figure clearly shows that compared to the old equilibrium point E, at point G which is the new equilibrium point, there is an increase in both price and quantity demanded and supplied.

Supply Shift

In Figure 5.3, we show the impact of a shift in supply curve on the equilibrium price and quantity. Suppose, initially, the market is in equilibrium at point E where the market demand curve DD_0 intersects the market supply curve SS_0 such that the equilibrium price is p_0 and the equilibrium quantity is q_0 .



Shifts in Supply. Initially, the market equilibrium is at E. Due to the shift in supply curve to the left, the new equilibrium point is G as shown in panel (a) and due to the rightward shift the new equilibrium point is F, as shown in panel (b). With rightward shift, the equilibrium quantity increases and price decreases whereas with leftward shift, equilibrium quantity decreases and price increases.

Now, suppose due to some reason, the market supply curve shifts leftward to SS_2 with the demand curve remaining unchanged, as shown in panel (a). Because of the shift, at the prevailing price, p_0 , there will be excess demand equal to $q_0'' - q_0$ in the market. Some consumers who are unable to obtain the good will be willing to pay higher prices and the market price tends to increase. The new equilibrium is attained at point G where the supply curve SS_2 intersects the demand curve DD_0 such that q_2 quantity will be bought and sold at price p_2 . Similarly, when supply curve shifts rightward, as shown in panel (b), at p_0 there will be supply excess of

goods equal to $q_0 q_0'$. In response to this excess supply, some firms will reduce their price and the new equilibrium will be attained at F where the supply curve SS_1 intersects the demand curve DD_0 such that the new market price is p_1 at which q_1 quantity is bought and sold. Notice the directions of change in price and quantity are opposite whenever there is a shift in supply curve.

Now with this understanding, we can analyse the behaviour of equilibrium price and quantity when various aspects of the market change. Here, we will consider the effect of an increase in input price and an increase in number of firms on equilibrium.

Let us consider a situation where all other things remaining constant, there is an increase in the price of an input used in the production of a commodity. This will increase the marginal cost of production of the firms using this input. Therefore, at each price, the market supply will be less than before. Hence, the supply curve shifts leftward. In the Figure 5.3(a), this is shown by a shift in the supply curve from SS_0 to SS_2 . But this increase in input price has no impact on the demand of the consumers since it does not depend on the input prices directly. Therefore, the demand curve remains unchanged. In Figure 5.3(a), this is shown by the demand curve remaining unchanged at DD_0 . As a result, compared to the old equilibrium, now the market price rises and quantity produced decreases.

Let us discuss the impact of an increase in the number of firms. Since at each price now more firms will supply the commodity, the supply curve shifts to the right but it does not have any effect on the demand curve. This example can be illustrated by Figure 5.3(b) where the supply curve shifts from SS_0 to SS_1 whereas the demand curve remains unchanged at DD_0 . From the figure, we can say that there will be a decrease in price of the commodity and increase in the quantity produced compared to the initial situation.

Simultaneous Shifts of Demand and Supply

What happens when both demand and supply curves shift simultaneously? The simultaneous shifts can happen in four possible ways:

- (i) Both supply and demand curves shift rightwards.
- (ii) Both supply and demand curves shift leftwards.
- (iii) Supply curve shifts leftward and demand curve shifts rightward.
- (iv) Supply curve shifts rightward and demand curve shifts leftward.

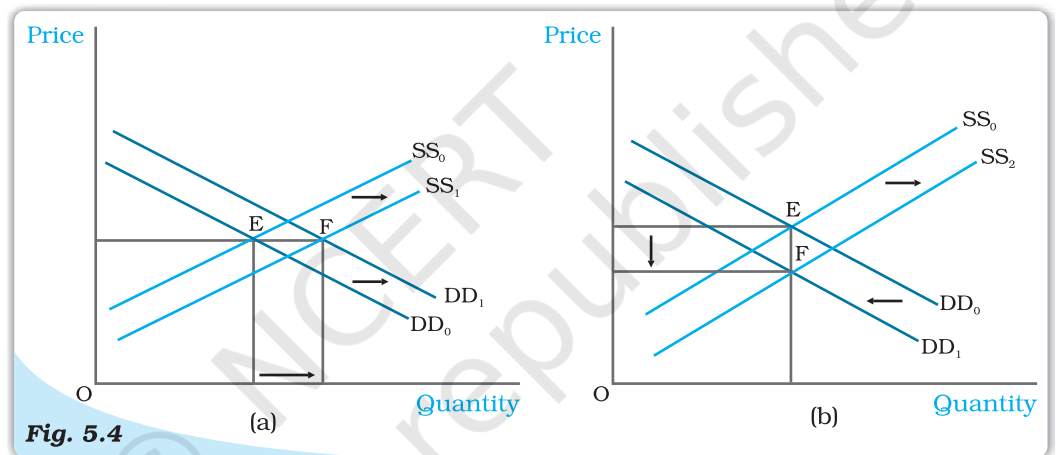
The impact on equilibrium price and quantity in all the four cases are given in Table 5.1. Each row of the table describes the direction in which the equilibrium price and quantity will change for each possible combination of the simultaneous shifts in demand and supply curves. For instance, from the second row of the table, we see that due to a rightward shift in both demand and supply curves, the equilibrium quantity increases invariably but the equilibrium price may either increase, decrease or remain unchanged. The actual direction in which the price will change will depend on the magnitude of the shifts. Check this yourself by varying the magnitude of shifts for this particular case.

In the first two cases which are shown in the first two rows of the table, the impact on equilibrium quantity is unambiguous but the equilibrium price may change, if at all, in either direction depending on the magnitudes of shifts. In the next two cases, shown in the last two rows of the table, the effect on price is unambiguous whereas effect on quantity depends on the magnitude of shifts in the two curves.

Table 5.1: Impact of Simultaneous Shifts on Equilibrium

Shift in Demand	Shift in Supply	Quantity	Price
Leftward	Leftward	Decreases	May increase, decrease or remain unchanged
Rightward	Rightward	Increases	May increase, decrease or remain unchanged
Leftward	Rightward	May increase, decrease or remain unchanged	Decreases
Rightward	Leftward	May increase, decrease or remain unchanged	Increases

Here we give diagrammatic representations for case (ii) and case (iii) in Figure 5.4 and leave the rest as exercises for the readers.



Simultaneous Shifts in Demand and Supply. Initially, the equilibrium is at E where the demand curve DD_0 and supply curve SS_0 intersect. In panel (a), both the supply and the demand curves shift rightward leaving price unchanged but a higher equilibrium quantity. In panel (b), the supply curve shifts rightward and demand curve shifts leftward leaving quantity unchanged but a lower equilibrium price.

In the Figure 5.4(a), it can be seen that due to rightward shifts in both demand and supply curves, the equilibrium quantity increases whereas the equilibrium price remains unchanged, and in Figure 5.4(b), equilibrium quantity remains the same whereas price decreases due to a leftward shift in demand curve and a rightward shift in supply curve.

5.1.2 Market Equilibrium: Free Entry and Exit

In the last section, the market equilibrium was studied under the assumption that there is a fixed number of firms. In this section, we will study market equilibrium when firms can enter and exit the market freely. Here, for simplicity, we assume that all the firms in the market are identical.

What is the implication of the entry and exit assumption? This assumption implies that in equilibrium no firm earns supernormal profit or incurs loss by remaining in production; in other words, the equilibrium price will be equal to the minimum average cost of the firms.

To see why it is so, suppose, at the prevailing market price, each firm is earning supernormal profit. The possibility of earning supernormal profit will attract some new firms. As new firms enter the market supply curve shifts rightward. However, demand remains unchanged. This causes market price to fall. As prices fall, supernormal profits are eventually wiped out. At this point, with all firms in the market earning normal profit, no more firms will have incentive to enter. Similarly, if the firms are earning less than normal profit at the prevailing price, some firms will exit which will lead to an increase in price, and with sufficient number of firms, the profits of each firm will increase to the level of normal profit. At this point, no more firm will want to leave since they will be earning normal profit here. Thus, with free entry and exit, each firm will always earn normal profit at the prevailing market price.



Free for all

Recall from the previous chapter that the firms will earn supernormal profit so long as the price is greater than the minimum average cost and at prices less than minimum average cost, they will earn less than normal profit. Therefore, at prices greater than the minimum average cost, new firms will enter, and at prices below minimum average cost, existing firms will start exiting. At the price level equal to the minimum average cost of the firms, each firm will earn normal profit so that no new firm will be attracted to enter the market. Also the existing firms will not leave the market since they are not incurring any loss by producing at this point. So, this price will prevail in the market.

Therefore, free entry and exit of the firms imply that the market price will always be equal to the minimum average cost, that is

$$p = \min AC$$

From the above, it follows that the equilibrium price will be equal to the minimum average cost of the firms. In equilibrium, the quantity supplied will be determined by the market demand at that price so that they are equal. Graphically, this is shown in Figure 5.5 where the market will be in equilibrium at point E at which the demand curve DD intersects the $p_0 = \min AC$ line such that the market price is p_0 and the total quantity demanded and supplied is equal to q_0 .

At $p_0 = \min AC$ each firm supplies same amount of output,

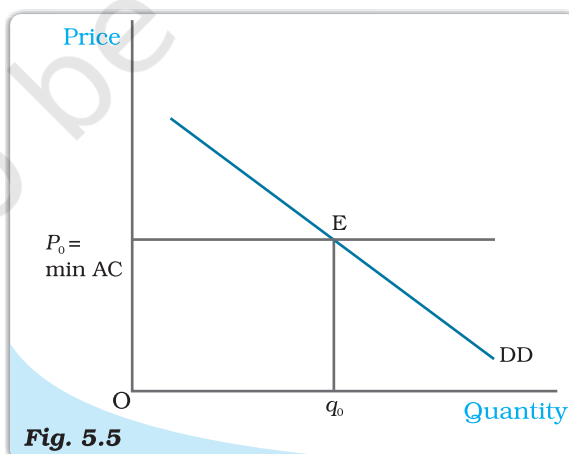


Fig. 5.5
Price Determination with Free Entry and Exit. With free entry and exit in a perfectly competitive market, the equilibrium price is always equal to min AC and the equilibrium quantity is determined at the intersection of the market demand curve DD with the price line $p = \min AC$.

say q_{of} . Therefore, the equilibrium number of firms in the market is equal to the number of firms required to supply q_0 output at p_0 , each in turn supplying q_{of} amount at that price. If we denote the equilibrium number of firms by n_0 , then

$$n_0 = \frac{q_0}{q_{of}}$$

To understand the equilibrium price and quantity determination more clearly, let us look at the following example.

EXAMPLE 5.2

Consider the example of a market for wheat such that the demand curve for wheat is given as follows

$$\begin{aligned} q^D &= 200 - p & \text{for } 0 \leq p \leq 200 \\ &= 0 & \text{for } p > 200 \end{aligned}$$

Assume that the market consists of identical firms. The supply curve of a single firm is given by

$$\begin{aligned} q_f^S &= 10 + p & \text{for } p \geq 20 \\ &= 0 & \text{for } 0 \leq p < 20 \end{aligned}$$

The free entry and exit of firms would mean that the firms will never produce below minimum average cost because otherwise they will incur loss from production in which case they will exit the market.

As we know, with free entry and exit, the market will be in equilibrium at a price which equals the minimum average cost of the firms. Therefore, the equilibrium price is

$$p_0 = 20$$

At this price, market will supply that quantity which is equal to the market demand. Therefore, from the demand curve, we get the equilibrium quantity:

$$q_0 = 200 - 20 = 180$$

Also at $p_0 = 20$, each firm supplies

$$q_{of} = 10 + 20 = 30$$

Therefore, the equilibrium number of firms is

$$n_0 = \frac{q_0}{q_{of}} = \frac{180}{30} = 6$$

Thus, with free entry and exit, the equilibrium price, quantity and number of firms are Rs 20, 180 kg and 6 respectively.

Shifts in Demand

Let us examine the impact of shift in demand on equilibrium price and quantity when the firms can freely enter and exit the market. From the previous section, we know that free entry and exit of the firms would imply that under all circumstances equilibrium price will be equal to the minimum average cost of the existing firms. Under this condition, even if the market demand curve shifts in either direction, at the new equilibrium, the market will supply the desired quantity at the same price.

In Figure 5.6, DD_0 is the market demand curve which tells us how much quantity will be demanded by the consumers at different prices and p_0 denotes

the price which is equal to the minimum average cost of the firms. The initial equilibrium is at point E where the demand curve DD_0 cuts the $p_0 = \min AC$ line and the total quantity demanded and supplied is q_0 . The equilibrium number of firms is n_0 in this situation.

Now suppose the demand curve shifts to the right for some reason. At p_0 there will be excess demand for the commodity. Some dissatisfied consumers will be willing to pay higher price for the commodity, so the price tends to rise. This gives rise to a possibility of earning supernormal profit which will attract new firms to the market. The entry of these new firms will eventually wipe out the supernormal profit and the price will again reach p_0 . Now higher quantity will be supplied at the same price. From the panel (a), we can see that the new demand curve DD_1 intersects the $p_0 = \min AC$ line at point F such that the new equilibrium will be (p_0, q_1) where q_1 is greater than q_0 . The new equilibrium number of firms n_1 is greater than n_0 because of the entry of new firms. Similarly, for a leftward shift of the demand curve to DD_2 , there will be

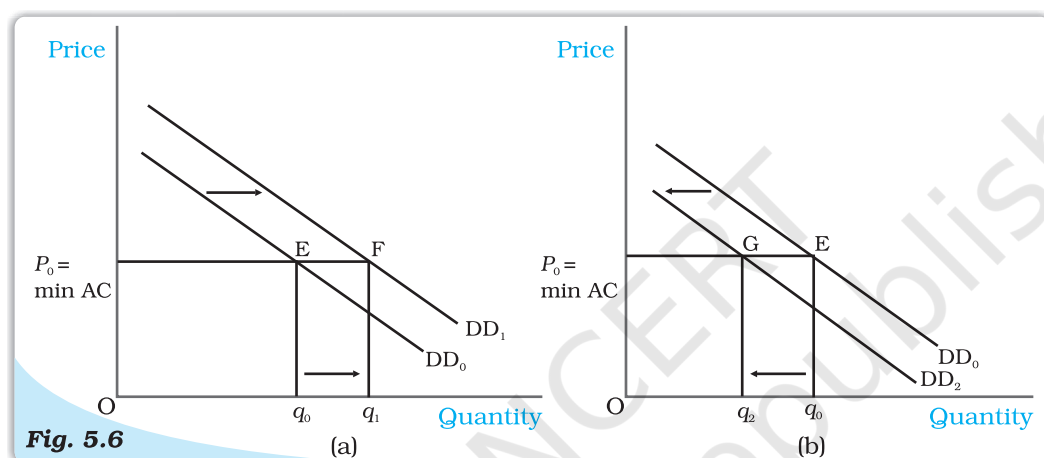


Fig. 5.6 *Shifts in Demand.* Initially, the demand curve was DD_0 , the equilibrium quantity and price were q_0 and p_0 respectively. With rightward shift of the demand curve to DD_1 , as shown in panel (a), the equilibrium quantity increases and with leftward shift of the demand curve to DD_2 , as shown in panel (b), the equilibrium quantity decreases. In both the cases, the equilibrium price remains unchanged at p_0 .

excess supply at the price p_0 . In response to this excess supply, some firms, which will be unable to sell their desired quantity at p_0 , will wish to lower their price. The price tends to decrease which will lead to the exit of some of the existing firms and the price will again reach p_0 . Therefore, in the new equilibrium, less quantity will be supplied which will be equal to the reduced demand at that price. This is shown in panel (b) where due to the shift of demand curve from DD_0 to DD_2 , quantity demanded and supplied will decrease to q_2 whereas the price will remain unchanged at p_0 . Here, the equilibrium number of firms, n_2 is less than n_0 due to the exit of some existing firms. Thus, *due to a shift in demand rightwards (leftwards), the equilibrium quantity and number of firms will increase (decrease) whereas the equilibrium price will remain unchanged.*

Here, we should note that with free entry and exit, shift in demand has a larger effect on quantity than it does with the fixed number of firms. But unlike with fixed number of firms, here, we do not have any effect on equilibrium price at all.

5.2 APPLICATIONS

In this section, we try to understand how the supply-demand analysis can be applied. In particular, we look at two examples of government intervention in the form of price control. Often, it becomes necessary for the government to regulate the prices of certain goods and services when their prices are either too

high or too low in comparison to the desired levels. We will analyse these issues within the framework of perfect competition to look at what impact these regulations have on the market for these goods.



5.2.1 Price Ceiling

It is not very uncommon to come across instances where government fixes a maximum allowable price for certain goods. The government-imposed upper limit on the price of a good or service is called **price ceiling**. Price ceiling is generally imposed on necessary items like wheat, rice, kerosene, sugar and it is fixed below the market-determined price since at the market-determined price some section of the population will not be able to afford these goods.

Let us examine the effects of price ceiling on market equilibrium through the example of market for wheat.

Figure 5.7 shows the market supply curve SS and the market demand curve DD for wheat.

The equilibrium price and quantity of wheat are p^* and q^* respectively. When the government imposes price ceiling at p_c which is lower than the equilibrium price level, there will be an excess demand for wheat in the market at that price. The consumers demand q_c kilograms of wheat whereas the firms supply q'_c kilograms.

Hence, though the intention of the government was to help the consumers, it could end up creating shortage of wheat. How is the quantity of wheat (q'_c) then distributed among the consumers? One way of doing this is to distribute it to everyone, through a system of rationing. Ration coupons are issued to the consumers so that no individual can buy more than a certain amount of wheat and this stipulated amount of wheat is sold through ration shops which are also called fair price shops.

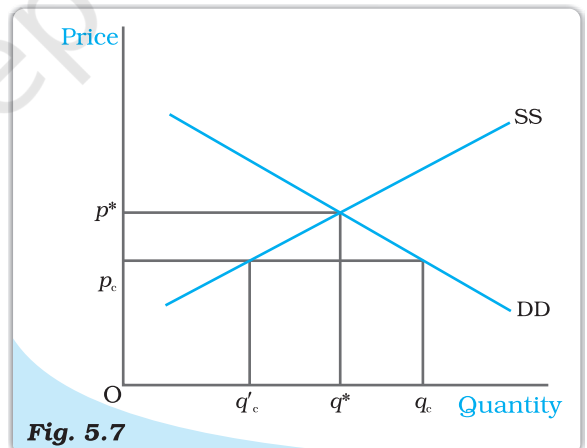


Fig. 5.7

Effect of Price Ceiling in Wheat Market. The equilibrium price and quantity are p^* and q^* respectively. Imposition of price ceiling at p_c gives rise to excess demand in the wheat market.

In general, price ceiling accompanied by rationing of the goods may have the following adverse consequences on the consumers: (a) Each consumer has to stand in long queues to buy the good from ration shops. (b) Since all consumers will not be satisfied by the quantity of the goods that they get from the fair price shop, some of them will be willing to pay higher price for it. This may result in the creation of black market.

5.2.2 Price Floor

For certain goods and services, fall in price below a particular level is not desirable and hence the government sets floors or minimum prices for these goods and services. The government-imposed lower limit on the price that may be charged for a particular good or service is called **price floor**. Most well-known examples of imposition of price floor are agricultural price support programmes and the minimum wage legislation.

Through an agricultural price support programme, the government imposes a lower limit on the purchase price for some of the agricultural goods and the floor is normally set at a level higher than the market-determined price for these goods. Similarly, through the minimum wage legislation, the government ensures that the wage rate of the labourers does not fall below a particular level and here again the minimum wage rate is set above the equilibrium wage rate.

Figure 5.8 shows the market supply and the market demand curve for a commodity on which price floor is imposed. The market equilibrium here would occur at price p^* and quantity q^* . But when the government imposes a floor higher than the equilibrium price at p_f , the market demand is q_f whereas the firms want to supply q'_f , thereby leading to an excess supply in the market equal to $q'_f - q_f$.

In the case of agricultural support, to prevent price from falling because of excess supply, government needs to buy the surplus at the predetermined price.

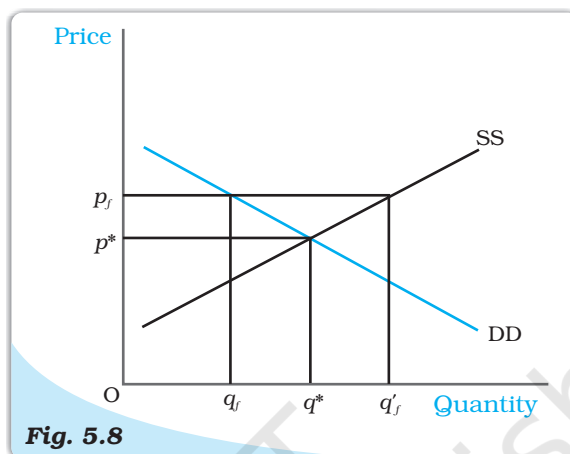


Fig. 5.8

Effect of Price Floor on the Market for Goods.
The market equilibrium is at (p^*, q^*) . Imposition of price floor at p_f gives rise to an excess supply.

- In a perfectly competitive market, equilibrium occurs where market demand equals market supply.
- The equilibrium price and quantity are determined at the intersection of the market demand and market supply curves when there is fixed number of firms.
- Each firm employs labour upto the point where the marginal revenue product of labour equals the wage rate.
- With supply curve remaining unchanged when demand curve shifts rightward (leftward), the equilibrium quantity increases (decreases) and equilibrium price increases (decreases) with fixed number of firms.

- With demand curve remaining unchanged when supply curve shifts rightward (leftward), the equilibrium quantity increases (decreases) and equilibrium price decreases (increases) with fixed number of firms.
- When both demand and supply curves shift in the same direction, the effect on equilibrium quantity can be unambiguously determined whereas the effect on equilibrium price depends on the magnitude of the shifts.
- When demand and supply curves shift in opposite directions, the effect on equilibrium price can be unambiguously determined whereas the effect on equilibrium quantity depends on the magnitude of the shifts.
- In a perfectly competitive market with identical firms if the firms can enter and exit the market freely, the equilibrium price is always equal to minimum average cost of the firms.
- With free entry and exit, the shift in demand has no impact on equilibrium price but changes the equilibrium quantity and number of firms in the same direction as the change in demand.
- In comparison to a market with fixed number of firms, the impact of a shift in demand curve on equilibrium quantity is more pronounced in a market with free entry and exit.
- Imposition of price ceiling below the equilibrium price leads to an excess demand.
- Imposition of price floor above the equilibrium price leads to an excess supply.

Key Concepts

Equilibrium
Excess demand
Excess supply
Marginal revenue product of labour
Value of marginal product of labour
Price ceiling, Price floor

Exercises

1. Explain market equilibrium.
2. When do we say there is excess demand for a commodity in the market?
3. When do we say there is excess supply for a commodity in the market?
4. What will happen if the price prevailing in the market is
 - (i) above the equilibrium price?
 - (ii) below the equilibrium price?
5. Explain how price is determined in a perfectly competitive market with fixed number of firms.
6. Suppose the price at which equilibrium is attained in exercise 5 is above the minimum average cost of the firms constituting the market. Now if we allow for free entry and exit of firms, how will the market price adjust to it?
7. At what level of price do the firms in a perfectly competitive market supply when free entry and exit is allowed in the market? How is equilibrium quantity determined in such a market?
8. How is the equilibrium number of firms determined in a market where entry and exit is permitted?
9. How are equilibrium price and quantity affected when income of the consumers
 - (a) increase?
 - (b) decrease?
10. Using supply and demand curves, show how an increase in the price of shoes affects the price of a pair of socks and the number of pairs of socks bought and sold.

11. How will a change in price of coffee affect the equilibrium price of tea? Explain the effect on equilibrium quantity also through a diagram.
12. How do the equilibrium price and quantity of a commodity change when price of input used in its production changes?
13. If the price of a substitute(Y) of good X increases, what impact does it have on the equilibrium price and quantity of good X?
14. Compare the effect of shift in demand curve on the equilibrium when the number of firms in the market is fixed with the situation when entry-exit is permitted.
15. Explain through a diagram the effect of a rightward shift of both the demand and supply curves on equilibrium price and quantity.
16. How are the equilibrium price and quantity affected when
 - (a) both demand and supply curves shift in the same direction?
 - (b) demand and supply curves shift in opposite directions?
17. In what respect do the supply and demand curves in the labour market differ from those in the goods market?
18. How is the optimal amount of labour determined in a perfectly competitive market?
19. How is the wage rate determined in a perfectly competitive labour market?
20. Can you think of any commodity on which price ceiling is imposed in India? What may be the consequence of price-ceiling?
21. A shift in demand curve has a larger effect on price and smaller effect on quantity when the number of firms is fixed compared to the situation when free entry and exit is permitted. Explain.
22. Suppose the demand and supply curve of commodity X in a perfectly competitive market are given by:

$$q^D = 700 - p$$

$$q^S = 500 + 3p \text{ for } p \geq 15$$

$$= 0 \text{ for } 0 \leq p < 15$$

Assume that the market consists of identical firms. Identify the reason behind the market supply of commodity X being zero at any price less than Rs 15. What will be the equilibrium price for this commodity? At equilibrium, what quantity of X will be produced?
23. Considering the same demand curve as in exercise 22, now let us allow for free entry and exit of the firms producing commodity X. Also assume the market consists of identical firms producing commodity X. Let the supply curve of a single firm be explained as

$$q_f^S = 8 + 3p \text{ for } p \geq 20$$

$$= 0 \text{ for } 0 \leq p < 20$$
 - (a) What is the significance of $p = 20$?
 - (b) At what price will the market for X be in equilibrium? State the reason for your answer.
 - (c) Calculate the equilibrium quantity and number of firms.
24. Suppose the demand and supply curves of salt are given by:

$$q^D = 1,000 - p \quad q^S = 700 + 2p$$
 - (a) Find the equilibrium price and quantity.
 - (b) Now suppose that the price of an input used to produce salt has increased so that the new supply curve is

$$q^S = 400 + 2p$$

How does the equilibrium price and quantity change? Does the change conform to your expectation?
 - (c) Suppose the government has imposed a tax of Rs 3 per unit of sale of salt. How does it affect the equilibrium price and quantity?
25. Suppose the market determined rent for apartments is too high for common people to afford. If the government comes forward to help those seeking apartments on rent by imposing control on rent, what impact will it have on the market for apartments?

Glossary

Average cost Total cost per unit of output.

Average fixed cost Total fixed cost per unit of output.

Average product Output per unit of the variable input.

Average revenue Total revenue per unit of output.

Average variable cost Total variable cost per unit of output.

Break-even point is the point on the supply curve at which a firm earns normal profit.

Budget line consists of all bundles which cost exactly equal to the consumer's income.

Budget set is the collection of all bundles that the consumer can buy with her income at the prevailing market prices.

Constant returns to scale is a property of production function that holds when a proportional increase in all inputs results in an increase in output by the same proportion.

Cost function For every level of output, it shows the minimum cost for the firm.

Decreasing returns to scale is a property of production function that holds when a proportional increase in all inputs results in an increase in output by less than the proportion.

Demand curve is a graphical representation of the demand function. It gives the quantity demanded by the consumer at each price.

Demand function A consumer's demand function for a good gives the amount of the good that the consumer chooses at different levels of its price when the other things remain unchanged.

Duopoly is a market with just two firms.

Equilibrium is a situation where the plans of all consumers and firms in the market match.

Excess demand If at a price market, demand exceeds market supply, it is said that excess demand exists in the market at that price.

Excess supply If at a price market, supply is greater than market demand, it is said that there is excess supply in the market at that price.

Firm's supply curve shows the levels of output that a profit-maximising firm will choose to produce at different values of the market price.

Fixed input An input which cannot be varied in the short run is called a fixed input.

Income effect The change in the optimal quantity of a good when the purchasing power changes consequent upon a change in the price of the good is called the income effect.

Increasing returns to scale is a property of production function that holds when a proportional increase in all inputs results in an increase in output by more than the proportion.

Indifference curve is the locus of all points among which the consumer is indifferent.

Inferior good A good for which the demand decreases with increase in the income of the consumer is called an inferior good.

Isoquant is the set of all possible combinations of the two inputs that yield the same maximum possible level of output.

Law of demand If a consumer's demand for a good moves in the same direction as the consumer's income, the consumer's demand for that good must be inversely related to the price of the good.

Law of diminishing marginal product If we keep increasing the employment of an input with other inputs fixed then eventually a point will be reached after which the marginal product of that input will start falling.

Law of variable proportions The marginal product of a factor input initially rises with its employment level when the level of employment of the input is low. But after reaching a certain level of employment, it starts falling.

Long run refers to a time period in which all factors of production can be varied.

Marginal cost Change in total cost per unit of change in output.

Marginal product Change in output per unit of change in the input when all other inputs are held constant.

Marginal revenue Change in total revenue per unit change in sale of output.

Marginal revenue product(MRP) of a factor Marginal Revenue times Marginal Product of the factor.

Market supply curve shows the output levels that firms in the market produce in aggregate corresponding to different values of the market price.

Monopolistic competition is a market structure where there exist a very large number of sellers selling differentiated but substitutable products.

Monopoly A market structure in which there is a single seller and there are sufficient restrictions to prevent any other seller from entering the market.

Monotonic preferences A consumer's preferences are monotonic if and only if between any two bundles, the consumer prefers the bundle which has more of at least one of the goods and no less of the other good as compared to the other bundle.

Normal good A good for which the demand increases with increase in the income of the consumer is called a normal good.

Normal profit The profit level that is just enough to cover the explicit costs and opportunity costs of the firm is called the normal profit.

Oligopoly A market consisting of more than one (but few) sellers is called an oligopoly.

Opportunity cost of some activity is the gain foregone from the second best activity.

Perfect competition A market environment wherein (i) all firms in the market produce the same good and (ii) buyers and sellers are price-takers.

Price ceiling The government-imposed upper limit on the price of a good or service is called price ceiling.

Price elasticity of demand for a good is defined as the percentage change in demand for the good divided by the percentage change in its price.

Price elasticity of supply is the percentage change in quantity supplied due to a one per cent change in the market price of the good.

Price floor The government-imposed lower limit on the price that may be charged for a particular good or service is called price floor.

Price line is a horizontal straight line that shows the relationship between market price and a firm's output level.

Production function shows the maximum quantity of output that can be produced by using different combinations of the inputs.

Profit is the difference between a firm's total revenue and its total cost of production.

Short run refers to a time period in which some factors of production cannot be varied.

Shut down point In the short run, it is the minimum point of AVC curve and in the long run, it is the minimum point of LRAC curve.

Substitution effect The change in the optimal quantity of a good when its price changes and the consumer's income is adjusted so that she can just buy the bundle that she was buying before the price change is called the substitution effect.

Super-normal profit Profit that a firm earns over and above the normal profit is called the super-normal profit.

Total cost is the sum of total fixed cost and total variable cost.

Total fixed cost The cost that a firm incurs to employ fixed inputs is called the total fixed cost.

Total physical product Same as the total product.

Total product If we vary a single input keeping all other inputs constant, then for different levels of employment of that input we get different levels of output from the production function. This relationship between the variable input and output is referred to as total product.

Total return Same as the total product.

Total revenue is equal to the market price of the good multiplied by the quantity of the good sold by a firm.

Total revenue curve shows the relationship between firm's total revenue and firm's output level.

Total variable cost The cost that a firm incurs to employ variable inputs is called the total variable cost.

Value of marginal product (VMP) of a factor Price times Marginal Product of the factor.

Variable input An input the amount of which can be varied.